MIND IT!

THE COMPLETE IDIOT'S GUIDE

From Zero to Quizmaster: Everything You Need to Create, Host and Play Mind It!



Version 1.69 · updated for build 126 · real screenshots of the app

Contents

PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING MIND IT! 5

1. Welcome to Mind It! 5
2. Why Play Mind It!? — All Its Perks 7
3. Equipment and Setup 9

PART TWO — CREATING A QUIZ 13

4. Installing and Opening Mind It! 13
5. Creating Your First Quiz: THE BIG FAT QUIZ 18
6. The Complete Question Database Guide 27

PART THREE — TEAMS AND CONNECTIVITY 36

7. Teams, Players and Quizmaster 36
8. Connecting Player Phones 42
9. Connection Health and Pre-Game Checks ✅ 48

PART FOUR — COMPLETE GAMEPLAY RULES 52

10. Understanding the Game Board 53
11. Complete Scoring Rules 57
12. Every Special Ability — Complete Guide 62
13. Game Modes 75
14. Timers 79

PART FIVE — HOSTING THE GAME 81

15. Every Quizmaster Button Explained 81
16. Audience View 91
17. Complete Example — Host an Entire Game 100
18. Final Round 113
19. Ending a Game 119

PART SIX — ADDITIONAL FEATURES 122

20. Achievements, Statistics and Historic Games 122
21. Themes, Audio and Personalisation 127
22. Backups and Game Recovery 129

🆘 HELP! MY GAME CLOSED IN THE MIDDLE OF A QUIZ! 131

PART SEVEN — TROUBLESHOOTING AND HOSTING TIPS 132

23. Complete Troubleshooting Guide 132
24. Tips for Hosting a Great Quiz 135

PART EIGHT — QUICK REFERENCE AND APPENDICES 137

25. The Printable Quick-Reference Materials 137

Appendix A — Feature status at a glance 138
Appendix B — Things found while writing this guide 139
Appendix C — Keyboard shortcuts (laptop) 140
Appendix D — Glossary 141
Appendix E — Frequently asked questions 142

For Mind It! version 1.69 (updated for build 126 — the Windows app `Mind It!.exe`, the Mac app `Mind It!.app` for Apple Silicon Macs and the Android tablet app). Writing the guide changed nothing in the app; build 112 then added the changes the owner approved, and this edition describes them.

New in build 112 (all ✅): the TV shows the phone join QR code before the game · 📶 Devices → **Phone Join QR (for Teams)** · ties are decided by **most correct answers** on the TV too · **Undo** gives chips back · at least **2 teams** · no Phoenix in Phone Buzzer Mode · a **one-player team** takes its player's name and picture · phones say "Thanks For Playing!" after every END GAME · no speed-bonus countdown on a Triple Gamble.

New in builds 113–114 (all ✅): places (1st, 2nd…) on the TV score cards · long team names fit the Now Playing bar · ⚡ speed bonus shown on the Correct button · correct-answer counts on the final podium and the phones' scoreboard · a hand-edited question value is kept · 🚀 "Phoenix Climber" achievement · the Final question locks once the Final starts · Final phone answers close 2 seconds after time's up · bigger Setup buttons on the tablet · Replace Round warns about repeated questions · clearer Phone Buzzer Mode on the TV · licences in About · team phones vibrate when they're needed (Android).

New in builds 115–117 (all ✅): in Phone Buzzer Mode, Correct / Wrong wait until a team buzzes — on the laptop and on the tablet · no Phoenix on the browser-only web link (no phone server) · if Mind It! opens on a different network port, your saved game, theme, sound and house rules come with it · accepted alternate answers can still be added during the Final · in Phone Buzzer Mode the tablet drops the turn-order line and the laptop says who buzzed first (build 117) · a new 2-page **Rehearsal Checklist** for the real devices.

New in build 118 (all ✅, layout only): pop-up messages appear beside the laptop's right-hand panel instead of over its buttons · the board panel shows "questions left" once · one **Begin Game** button on Setup (in the bar at the bottom) · Correct and Wrong are the same size · a slimmer header on Setup.

New in build 119 (all ✅, layout only): on a portrait tablet the quiz name gets the top row and the buttons sit below · chip names show in full on the tablet · on team phones, "Connected" and **Change Team Code** share one line under the scoreboard · the game record page shows each team's score beside its name · the Random Team Generator shows every team count on one row. (The joined-phone screenshot in Chapter 8 is new; some other tablet and phone screenshots were taken before these small changes.)

New in build 120 (all ✅): the **Board & Flow** card sits above the Back / Next buttons of Audio & Presentation · **Export History To Excel** appears once in Backups & Data · the leftover step numbers (1, 4, 5) are gone · the automatic **Speed Bonus Points** show in a normal box. · **Random Team Generator:** tap two players to swap, **+** to move, ↶ **Undo**, ⟲ **Reset to Generated Teams** (Chapter 7.4).

New in build 121 (all ✅, quality fixes — nothing to learn): team phones that check in normally no longer flicker between *Connected* and *Unstable* in Connection Health · the Quizmaster tablet no longer redraws its whole screen every second (numbers you are typing stay put) · on team phones the **BUZZ IN** button is no longer rebuilt several times a second, so every tap counts · the laptop's **Join link & QR code** section stays open · the 📱 phone remote no longer speeds up after each button press · **an unfinished game is no longer lost** if Mind It! is opened and closed again without choosing **Resume saved game** or **Start fresh** — it is offered every time until you choose.

New in build 122 (✅, owner's decision): 👑 **Returning Champion** only when last game's **whole winning team** is on one team tonight (a one-player winner crowns the team that player is on) — split winners mean no crown (12.5).

New in build 123 (✅, owner's decisions): restoring a backup or loading a game file **always asks first** — even with no game running — so a quiz you're still setting up can't be replaced by accident (22.3) · a **Mac version** of the laptop app (4.1b, 🟡 not yet tried on a real Mac).

New in build 124 (✅): 🗑 **Delete a player** from Player Profiles — past games keep their name (7.2b) · the Mac app now comes for **Apple Silicon Macs only** (4.1b).

New in build 125 (✅): 🗑 **Recently Deleted** — restore a deleted player for 30 days (7.2b) · ☑ **Select** several players to archive or delete together (7.2c) · 🛟 **Safety backups** made automatically before anything is replaced or removed (22.3b) · the tablet keeps what you're typing when the laptop changes the scores (11.9) · 🖼 **Results Picture** for any game in Historic Games (20.8).

New in build 126 (✅): 📲 **Mind It! on the home screen** — on an iPhone or iPad, Safari's **Share → Add to Home Screen** now gives a proper **Mind It!** icon that opens full-screen, for team phones and the 📱 Phone Remote (8.6) · the downloads are also on your private GitHub page, as single complete files, plus the **webpage version** (4.1, 4.1c).

How to Use This Guide

- **Never hosted a quiz?** Read Part One, then follow Chapter 5 (*Creating Your First Quiz*) and Chapter 17 (*Complete Example*) with the app open in front of you.
- **Hosting tonight and in a hurry?** Print the two-page **Quizmaster Cheat Sheet** (`MIND_IT_QUIZMASTER_CHEAT_SHEET.pdf`) and read the **Quick Start** (`MIND_IT_QUICK_START.pdf`). Before your first real quiz night, tick through the **Rehearsal Checklist** (`MIND_IT_REHEARSAL_CHECKLIST.pdf`) on the real devices.
- **A player?** You only need the two-page **Player's Guide** (`MIND_IT_PLAYERS_GUIDE.pdf`).
- **Something broke?** Jump to *HELP! My Game Closed in the Middle of a Quiz!* (end of Chapter 22) or Chapter 23 (*Troubleshooting*).

What the little labels mean

This guide is honest about what was checked and how. You will see these labels:

Label	Meaning
✅ **Verified**	Seen working in Mind It! 1.69 (build 111, or builds 112–114 for their changes) while this guide was written — in the real app on a test computer, with test tablets and phones simulated in a browser — and/or covered by the app's automatic test suites.
🟡 **Not verified on real hardware**	The feature is in the app, but it has not been checked on a real Windows PC, a real Galaxy Tab, a real iPhone/Android phone, a real TV, or with real sound. It *should* work; nobody has watched it work on that device.
🔵 **Approved, unfinished or undecided**	The behaviour is in the app, but the owner has an open question about it. It may change later.
⚪ **Idea only — not in the app**	Discussed at some point, but it does not exist. Don't go looking for it.

About the pictures. Every screenshot marked 📸 is a **real screenshot of Mind It! 1.69** — build 111, or build 112–114 where the caption says so — captured from the actual app (the laptop app on a test computer, with the tablet and phone screens opened in a browser at tablet and phone sizes). The numbered yellow circles were added afterwards to point things out. Nothing is a mock-up. The test computer's network address (`192.0.2.2`) and the quiz content are examples — yours will differ.

About the money sign. Mind It! shows every score and value with the **UAE Dirham sign** (it looks like a "D" with two lines through it). In this guide we simply write numbers: "+200" means "200 points".

PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING MIND IT!

1. Welcome to Mind It!

What is Mind It?

Mind It! is a **TV game-show quiz for a room full of people**. Think of a big board of questions on the TV, teams taking turns to pick them, points flying up and down, secret bets, a few naughty special powers, and a dramatic Final Round — all run by one person, the **Quizmaster**, from a laptop (and, if you like, a tablet in your hand).

Nobody needs to install anything on their phone. Nobody needs the internet. Everything runs over your own Wi-Fi from the laptop.

The cast

Who / what	What it does
The Quizmaster (you)	Runs the show from the laptop's **host panel** — and/or from the **Android tablet** as a remote. Sees the answers. Decides if answers are right.
The laptop (`Mind It!.exe` on Windows, or `Mind It!.app` on a Mac)	The brain. It keeps the scores, saves everything, runs the timer and serves the phones and tablet over Wi-Fi.
The Audience View (the TV or projector)	What the room sees: the board, the question, the scores, the drama. It **never** shows answers before you reveal them, never shows secret wagers, never shows team codes.
The tablet (optional, Android)	A remote control for the Quizmaster: Correct / Wrong / Pass / timer / wagers / End Game, with the answer shown only on the tablet. It can also run a whole game on its own.
Team phones (optional but fun)	Each team's private keypad: secret wagers, special chips, the buzzer (in Buzzer Mode) and typed Final Round answers. **Normal answers are said out loud.**

How a game works — in plain English

1. **Teams.** 2 to 8 teams play. Each team has at least one player.
2. **The board.** Each round has a board of **6 categories × 5 questions**. Questions lower down are harder and worth more (for example 200, 400, 600, 800, 1,000).
3. **Taking turns.** The team whose turn it is picks a category and value ("Pub Grub for 200, please!"). The Quizmaster opens it. The question appears on the TV and the clock starts (45 seconds).
4. **Answering.** The team **says** its answer out loud. - **Right:** they win the question's points (plus maybe a bonus). - **Wrong:** they **lose** the question's points, and the same question goes to the next team with a fresh clock. - **Pass:** they lose nothing, and the question goes to the next team.
5. **Next turn.** The next question always belongs to the team **after** the one that picked the last question — even if someone else answered it.
6. **Surprises.** Hidden **Daily Doubles** let a team bet. Special **chips** (Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up) change the stakes.
7. **Rounds.** Up to 4 board rounds. Each new round is worth more.
8. **The Final Round.** One last question. Every team that isn't below zero secretly bets any amount from 0 up to its score, then types its answer on its phone. Right = win the bet. Wrong = lose the bet.

9. **The winner** is the team with the most points after the Final. Then come the awards, the stats and the bragging rights.

How do teams win?

Most points at the end. Scores can go **below zero** (wrong answers cost points), so being clever about when to pass matters. If two teams finish level on points, the team that **answered the most questions correctly** wins — on the TV and in the records. Only if that is level too do they share the win (see Chapter 18).

What makes Mind It! different from a normal pub quiz?

- **It's a show, not a worksheet.** The TV does the drama: animations, a heartbeat in the last 10 seconds, "WRONG ANSWER → NEXT TEAM'S TURN" banners, a podium at the end.
- **Wrong answers cost points.** That makes passing a real decision.
- **Secret bets.** Daily Doubles and the Final are wagered privately on phones. The TV only says "Locked in".
- **Special chips.** Once-per-game powers that can swing a game.
- **Fair turns.** The app keeps the team order, so nobody argues about whose turn it is.
- **It remembers.** Player profiles, history, achievements and leaderboards build up quiz night after quiz night.

A typical game, start to finish (the 60-second version)

> Four teams arrive: **Crime Master Gogo, Tequila Mockingbird, Hungover Achiever and The Groovefather**. The Quizmaster opens Mind It! on the laptop, plugs in the TV, types the quiz name **THE BIG FAT QUIZ**, picks 2 rounds plus a Final, and adds the players to teams. Teams scan the QR code on the TV with their phones and type their 4-letter team codes.
>
> The Quizmaster presses **Begin Game**. The TV shows *Tonight's Teams*, then the Round 1 board. Crime Master Gogo picks *Pub Grub for 200*, answers quickly and correctly: **+200, plus a speed bonus of +100**. Tequila Mockingbird gets a 400 wrong (**–400**) and Hungover Achiever steals it (**+400**). Someone finds a Daily Double, someone plays a Triple Gamble, someone's designated player has to finish their drink…
>
> After Round 2 comes the **Final Round**: category *SPACE*. Teams bet secretly on their phones, the question appears, teams type their answers, and the Quizmaster reveals them one by one, lowest score first. **Hungover Achiever** — who was in last place, deep below zero, after Round 1 — wins with 3,400. The TV crowns the winner, shows the awards, and the Quizmaster taps **END GAME**. Everything is saved.

That exact game is played out step by step, with every score, in **Chapter 17**.

---

2. Why Play Mind It!? — All Its Perks

Everything in this chapter exists in Mind It! 1.69 today. (Ideas that do *not* exist are listed in Appendix A, so you won't be disappointed.)

Perk	What it does	Why it makes the night better
📺 **Game-show presentation** ✅	A full-screen Audience View with a gold-and-navy board, animated board fill, "Now Playing" banner, score cards, a ring timer, banners for every result, and a podium at the end.	It feels like a TV show, not a quiz sheet. People lean in.
✍️ **Your own questions** ✅	Type questions in, import an Excel/CSV template, or pick from your **Question Database**. Pictures, answer pictures and media links can go with a question.	Your quiz, your jokes, your local trivia.
🗂️ **Categories & multiple rounds** ✅	1–4 board rounds of 6 categories × 5 questions, plus an optional Final Round. Values rise every round automatically.	Easy start, big finish.
♟️ **Strategy** ✅	Wrong answers cost points, passing is free, bonuses reward bravery and speed.	Every team has decisions to make, not just facts to remember.
💰 **Daily Doubles** ✅	Hidden on the board (1, 2, 2, 3 per round by default). The finder bets secretly.	Instant tension, and comebacks.
🎲 **Special chips** ✅	**Triple Gamble** (3× points, 6× on a Daily Double), **Phoenix** (a catch-up power for the team far behind) and **Bottoms Up** (finish your drink and lose nothing).	Big moments everyone remembers.
🤫 **Secret wagers on phones** ✅	Teams bet on their own phones. The TV only says "Locked in".	Real poker-face drama.
📱 **Phones as private keypads** ✅	No app to install: phones open a web page served by your laptop.	Players join in seconds.
🔔 **Phone Buzzer Mode** ✅	An optional fastest-finger mode: phones become buzzers; the first valid buzz (as received by the laptop) wins.	A totally different, frantic game.
📊 **Live scoreboard** ✅	Scores, places and "who's next" are always on the TV. Phones show your score and place too.	No arguing about the score.
🎨 **12 themes** ✅	Default Mind It!, Christmas, Halloween, Ramadan / Eid, Diwali, Summer, Bollywood, Sports, Comic Book, Wizard / Magical School, Gaming, Movies — with optional theme sounds.	Dress the quiz for the occasion.
👫 **Player profiles** ✅	Each person has a profile with a picture, nickname and statistics that follow them from game to game.	Rivalries!
🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** ✅	59 per-game achievements, 11 career badges, 6 milestones, 10 host achievements, and a "Fun Stats" slideshow after every game.	Even the losers win something.
📚 **Historic Games & leaderboard** ✅	Every finished game is saved as a frozen snapshot. A leaderboard ranks players (All Time / This Season / This Month).	Seasons, champions, legends.
👑 **Returning Champion** ✅	Last game's winning team walks on wearing the crown — if the whole team is back together.	Bragging rights carry over.

Perk	What it does	Why it makes the night better
🛠️ **Quiz customisation** ✅	Presets (Classic, Full Show, Family Night) or switch each rule on/off. Timers, bonuses, number of Daily Doubles, turn order, wager display.	Make it gentle for family, savage for the regulars.
📴 **Works offline** ✅	No internet needed. Phones and the tablet connect to the laptop over your own Wi-Fi (or the laptop's hotspot).	Works in a basement, a hall, a garden.
💾 **Game recovery** ✅	Autosave after every change, "Resume saved game" after a crash, backup files, hand-over to another device.	A crash is a hiccup, not a disaster.
📶 **Connection Health** ✅	One screen shows whether the laptop, tablet, TV window and every team phone are talking, with a **Test All Connections** button.	Check before the guests arrive.
🎭 **Rehearsal mode** ✅	Play a test game where nothing counts — no history, no stats.	Practise without spoiling the records.
📲 **Tablet remote** ✅ / 🟡	Run the game from an Android tablet anywhere in the room. (Built and tested in the browser; not re-checked on a real Galaxy Tab for this guide.)	Walk among the teams like a real host.

3. Equipment and Setup

What you need

Item	Needed?	Notes
Windows laptop (Windows 10 or 11) **or an Apple Silicon Mac** (M1–M4, macOS 11 or newer, since build 123)	**Yes** (unless you run the whole game on the tablet)	Runs `Mind It!.exe` (no installation; a "portable" program) or `Mind It!.app` on a Mac (4.1b).
TV, projector or second screen	Strongly recommended	Connected by HDMI cable, or wireless display / casting. Shows the Audience View.
Wi-Fi network (no internet needed)	Needed for phones and the tablet	All devices must be on the **same** network. Or use the laptop's **mobile hotspot**.
Android tablet	Optional	Install the Mind It! APK. Used as the Quizmaster remote, or to run a game on its own.
One phone per team	Optional (but you lose secret wagers, chips, buzzers and typed Final answers without them)	Any modern phone browser (Chrome, Safari). Nothing to install.
Speakers	Recommended	Sound effects, the "Mind It!" sting, thinking music, the heartbeat.

Setup A — Laptop only

The simplest setup. Good for a first game.

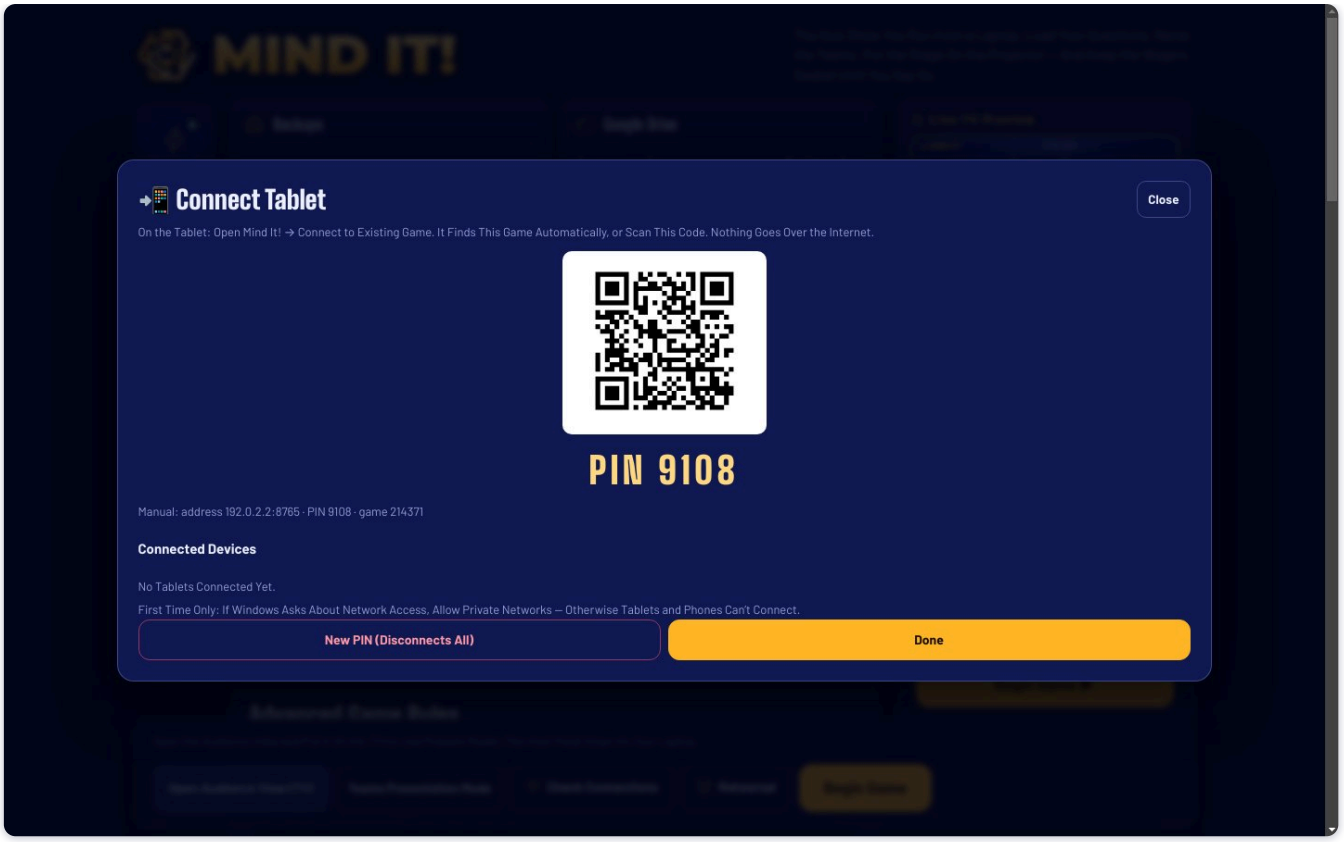
1. Open `Mind It!.exe` on the laptop.
2. Connect the TV (HDMI) and open the **Audience View** (Chapter 16). Drag that window to the TV and make it full screen.
3. Keep the **host panel** (the main window) on the laptop screen. Only you can see it — it shows the answers.
4. Run the game with the mouse or the keyboard shortcuts (C = Correct, W = Wrong, S = Pass… see Appendix C).

Without phones, the Quizmaster types the Daily Double and Final wagers into the host panel (teams can whisper or write them down). Chips are designed for team phones, but the Quizmaster can still switch a chip on for the picking team from the 🎟 **Team Chips** card (Chapter 12).

Setup B — Laptop + Tablet

The laptop stays the brain and drives the TV. The tablet is your remote control.

1. Laptop: **Connect ▾ → Connect Tablet** (or Setup → 6 · Advanced → Connect Tablet). A QR code and a 4-digit **PIN** appear.
2. Tablet: open Mind It! → **Connect To Laptop**. It finds the laptop game automatically ("LAPTOP GAME FOUND") — tap **Connect** — or scan the code / type the PIN.
3. From now on you can press Correct / Wrong / Pass on the tablet. The answer shows **only** on the tablet when you tap "Tap To Show Answer".

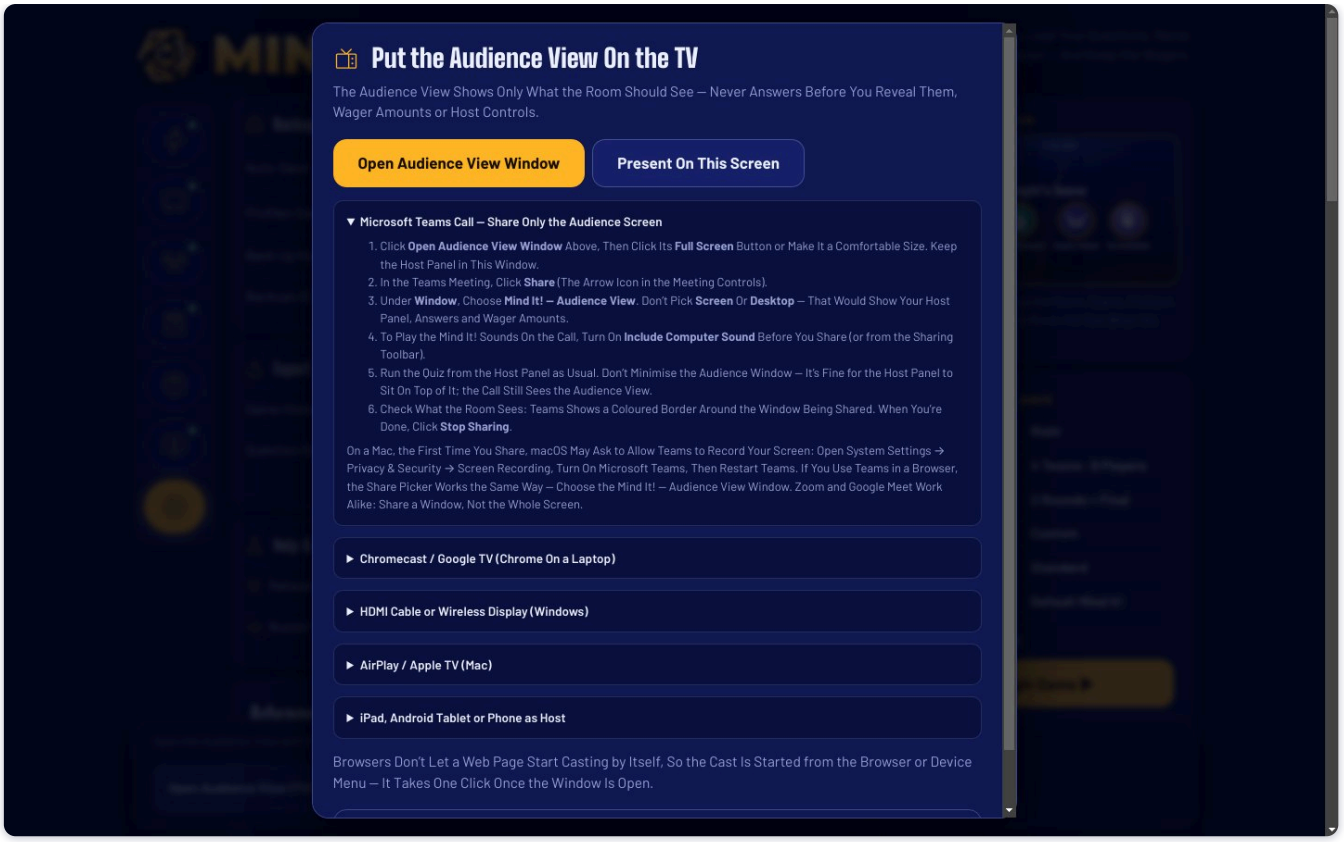


📸 *Real screenshot — Connect Tablet on the laptop (QR code and PIN).*

> **Who is in charge?** The **laptop** is the boss while the tablet is connected. The tablet sends button presses to the laptop, and the laptop confirms them. Only one device controls the game at a time.

Setup C — The Audience Display (TV / projector)

- **HDMI cable** (easiest): plug the laptop into the TV, set Windows to *Extend* the display (Windows key + P → Extend), open the Audience View window and move it to the TV, then press its **Full Screen** button.
- **Wireless display / Chromecast / AirPlay / a Microsoft Teams call**: the app has a built-in guide: Setup → 5 · Audio & Presentation → 📺 **TV Display Guide**. It explains each method step by step. (**Audience View ▾ → TV Display Settings** is where you adjust screen size and safe margins and check the TV.) 🟡 Casting was not tested with real TVs for this guide.
- **One screen only?** Use **Present On This Screen** (full-screen Audience View on the laptop itself; Esc to exit). In Present Mode a tap or mouse move shows the controls.



📸 *Real screenshot — the built-in TV Display Guide.*

Setup D — Player phones

Phones open a web page served by the laptop (the address looks like `http://192.168.x.x:8765/play`). Teams scan the QR code shown on the TV before the game, type their 4-letter **team code**, and they're in. Full steps in Chapter 8.

Phones are used for **private** things only: secret wagers, chips, the buzzer (Buzzer Mode) and typing the Final answer. **They never see questions or answers.**

Wi-Fi and the internet — what's the difference?

- **Internet** = getting out to the world (websites, Google). **Mind It! does not need it.** The only optional online feature is the Google Drive backup.
- **Local network** = devices in the same room talking to each other through the same Wi-Fi router (or the laptop's hotspot). **Mind It! needs this** for phones and the tablet.

So a Wi-Fi that "has no internet" is fine. But a Wi-Fi that stops devices talking to each other (common on **guest**, **hotel**, **office** and **café** networks — called *client isolation*) is not. The fix is easy: turn on the **laptop's mobile hotspot** and have everyone join that instead (Chapter 9).

✅ Before You Start — checklist

Tick these off 20 minutes before the guests sit down:

- [ ] Laptop plugged into power (don't run a quiz on battery) and **sleep turned off** (or at least set to "never" while plugged in).
- [ ] `Mind It!.exe` open; the quiz loaded (Setup shows "✓ Ready to Start").
- [ ] TV connected; **Audience View** open on the TV, full screen.
- [ ] Sound on: press **Test Sound** (Setup → 5 · Audio & Presentation).
- [ ] Wi-Fi: the laptop, the tablet and the phones on the **same** network (or the laptop's hotspot).
- [ ] Tablet connected (**Connected** shows in green at the top of the tablet).

- [ ] One phone per team joined with its team code.
- [ ] 📶 **Check Connections → TEST ALL CONNECTIONS** says "All set".
- [ ] Every team has at least one player, and a Quizmaster is chosen.
- [ ] Questions checked (Setup → 4 · Rounds & Questions → *Template Check: No problems found*).
- [ ] A backup file saved (**⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now**).
- [ ] Optional: a 2-minute 🎭 **Rehearsal** to test the TV, sound and phones.

PART TWO — CREATING A QUIZ

4. Installing and Opening Mind It!

4.1 Windows (the laptop app) 🟡

Mind It! for Windows is one **portable** program: `Mind It!.exe`. There is no installer and nothing to uninstall. Because the file is big (about 66 MB), it is delivered in **three parts plus a small "joiner"**:

- `Mind It!.exe.part1`, `Mind It!.exe.part2`, `Mind It!.exe.part3`
- `Join Mind It - build 126.bat` (the joiner)

Step by step

1. Download all four files into the **same folder** (your *Downloads* folder is fine).
2. Double-click `Join Mind It - build 126.bat`. A black window opens, finds the three parts (it recognises them by their exact size, even if your browser renamed them, and it also looks in *Downloads*), joins them and checks the final size.
3. When it says **"Done - Mind It!.exe is ready in this folder"**, press any key. You can delete the three part files.
4. Double-click `Mind It!.exe`. - If Windows shows **"Windows protected your PC"** (SmartScreen), click **More info → Run anyway**. This happens because the app isn't code-signed. - The first time, Windows may ask whether Mind It! may use the network. **Tick "Private networks" and allow it.** Without this, the tablet and phones can't connect.
5. Mind It! opens straight into **Setup** — that is the laptop's "main menu".

> **Updating to a newer build:** run the new joiner in the same folder. It replaces the old `Mind It!.exe` (close Mind It! first — the joiner refuses to replace a running app). Your players, history, questions and saved game are **not** stored inside the .exe, so they are kept. Still, save a backup file first (Chapter 22) — it costs ten seconds.

🟡 The joiner was tested on a non-Windows test system, not on a real Windows PC, for this guide.

> **No parts on GitHub (since build 126):** the owner's private download page on GitHub (**MindIt-Downloads**) holds each build as **single complete files** — `Windows/Mind It!.exe`, the tablet APK, the Mac zip, the guides and the webpage. Open a file there and press **Download raw file** (⤓). The EXE from GitHub needs no joiner: just replace your old `Mind It!.exe` with it.

4.1b Mac (the laptop app on a Mac) 🟡 — since build 123

The same laptop app also comes for a Mac with **Apple Silicon** (M1, M2, M3, M4 — macOS 11 Big Sur or newer). It does everything the Windows app does — TV window, phones, tablet, saving — and keeps its own players, history and Question Database on that Mac. (Older **Intel** Macs aren't supported from build 124 on.)

Is my Mac Apple Silicon? Apple menu → About This Mac. It should say **Chip: Apple M1/M2/M3/M4...**.

The app comes in parts (about 100 MB): `Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip.part1` … `.part5`.

Step by step

1. Download all the parts into your **Downloads** folder (delete any older Mind It! parts there first, so only the new ones get joined).

2. Open **Terminal** (press ⌘-Space, type *Terminal*, press Return), paste this line and press Return: `cd ~/Downloads && cat "Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip.part"* > "Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip" && open "Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip"`
3. The Mac unzips it into `Mind It!.app`. Drag it into **Applications**. You can delete the parts and the .zip.
4. Open it. The first time, macOS says it can't check the app for malicious software (it isn't signed with an Apple developer certificate). Click **Done**, then go to the **Apple menu → System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down to *"Mind It! was blocked..."* and click **Open Anyway** (enter your password). On macOS 14 or older you can instead **Control-click the app → Open → Open**. You only do this once.
5. When the Mac asks, **Allow** Mind It! to **find devices on your local network** and to **accept incoming network connections** — without this the tablet and phones can't connect. The camera is only used for the optional Host Cam.

> **Moving from the Windows laptop?** Make a backup file on Windows (Chapter 22) and restore it on the Mac. **Updating:** quit Mind It! (⌘Q), replace `Mind It!.app` in Applications with the new one; your data stays.

🟡 The Mac app was built and checked on the build machine (app contents, the tested quiz page inside, Apple's own "ad-hoc" signature) but **has not been run on a real Mac**. Try it at home before a quiz night.

> **Mac from GitHub (since build 126):** the GitHub download page has the Mac app as **one zip** — download it, double-click it, then carry on from step 3. No Terminal needed.

4.1c The webpage version (`mindit.html`) 🟡 — since build 126 on GitHub

The whole of Mind It! also comes as **one webpage file**, `mindit.html` (in the **Web** folder of the GitHub download page). It is the same quiz as the laptop app, with nothing to install: **double-click it on any computer** and it opens in Chrome, Edge or Safari.

What's different from the laptop app:

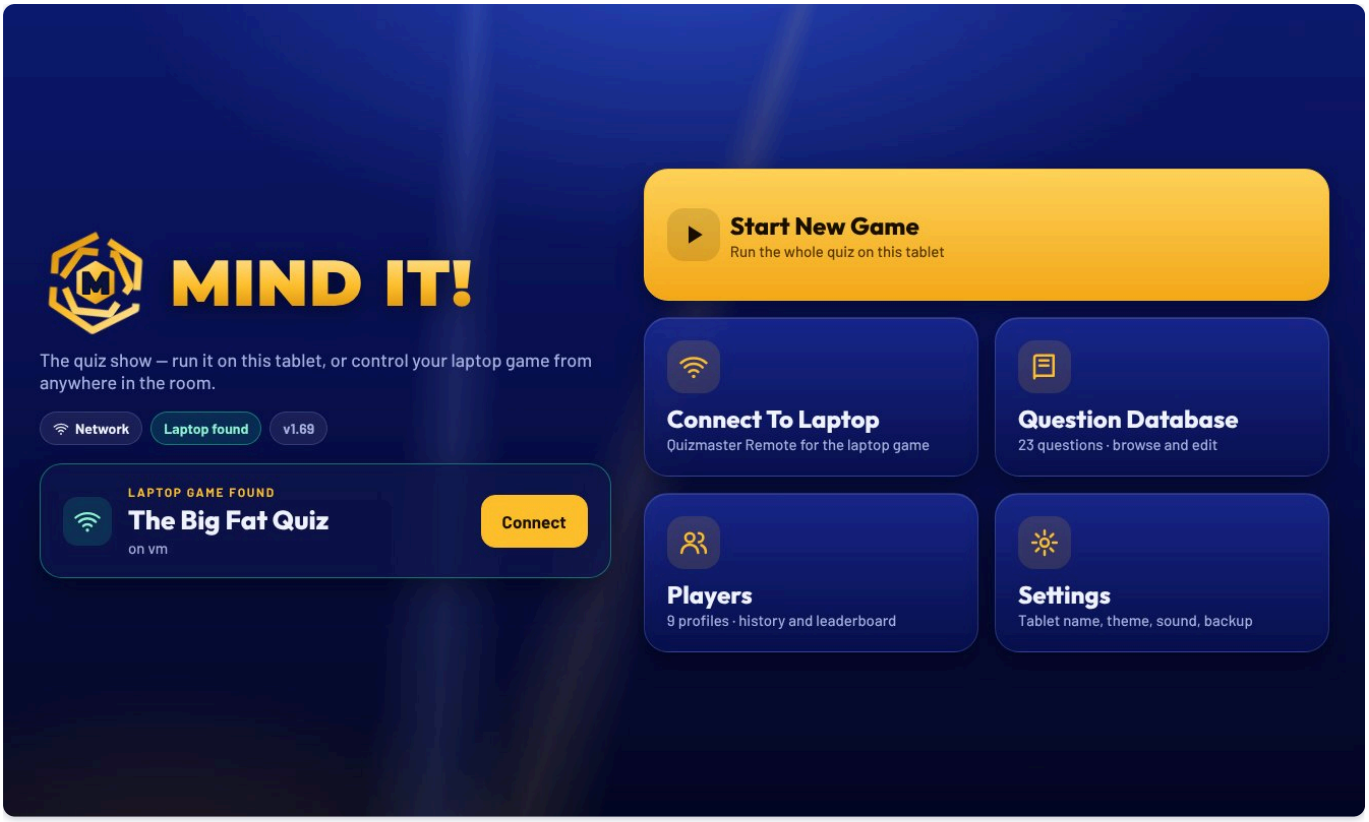
- **No phones and no tablet.** A webpage can't be a "server", so team phones, the tablet remote, the 📱 Phone Remote and Phone Buzzer Mode don't work, and the Phoenix chip isn't handed out. Play it like a board game, with the Quizmaster scoring on the computer.
- **Its own data.** Players, history and the Question Database are kept by that browser on that computer, separately from the laptop app. To move them, make a backup file in one (Chapter 22) and restore it in the other. Clearing the browser's history and site data deletes them, so make backups.
- **The TV:** use the 📺 **Audience View** button as usual — it opens a second browser window you drag to the TV (allow pop-ups if the browser asks).
- **iPhone and iPad:** a downloaded webpage file opens in the Files preview, which doesn't run Mind It! properly. On a phone, use the laptop app's join link instead and put it on the home screen (8.6).

🟡 The webpage is the exact page tested inside the laptop app. Opened as a downloaded file it was checked on the build machine in Chrome's engine (it starts, keeps a saved game and players after closing and reopening, and the Audience View opens), not on a real PC or Mac.

4.2 Android (the tablet app) 🟡

The tablet app is the file `Mind It! for Android (Galaxy Tab).apk`.

1. Copy or download the APK onto the tablet.
2. Tap it. Android asks to allow installing apps from this source (*Install unknown apps*) — allow it for your file manager or browser.
3. Tap **Install** (or **Update** if an older Mind It! is already installed — updates install over the old app because they are signed with the same key, so the tablet's data stays).
4. Open **Mind It!**. You land on the tablet's **Main Menu**.



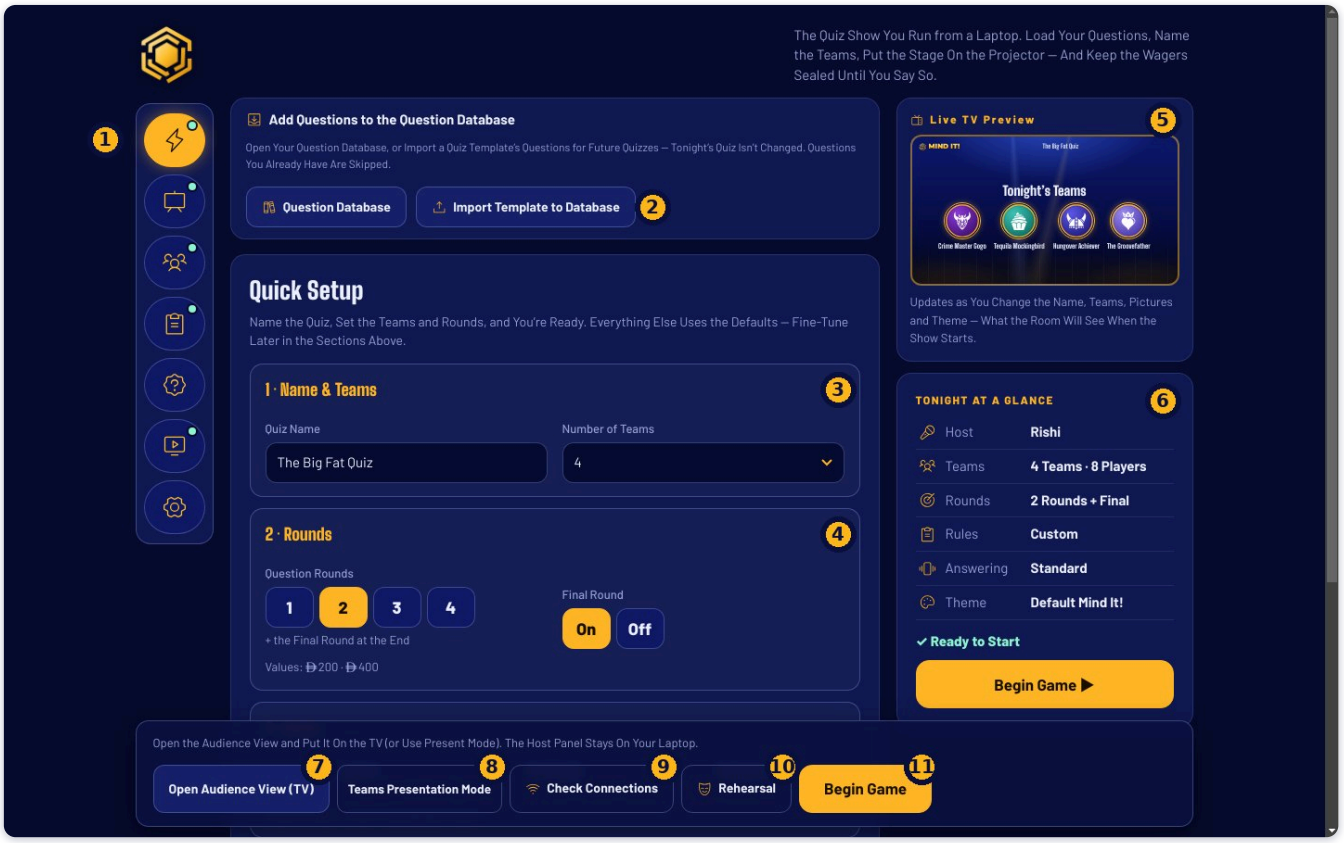
📸 *Real screenshot — the tablet Main Menu (start screen). Here it has already found a laptop game.*

Button	What it does
Start New Game	Run the **whole quiz on the tablet** (no laptop).
Connect To Laptop	Become the Quizmaster remote for the laptop game. When the tablet sees a laptop game on the Wi-Fi it shows a **LAPTOP GAME FOUND** card with a **Connect** button.
Question Database	Browse and edit the questions stored on the tablet.
Players	Player profiles, history and the leaderboard.
Settings	Tablet name, theme, sound, backup.

The little chips under the logo show the **Network** state, whether a **Laptop** was **found**, and the version (**v1.69**).

🟡 Installing over the old app, network discovery and camera QR scanning were not re-checked on a real Galaxy Tab for this guide.

4.3 Finding your way around the laptop



📸 *Real screenshot — Setup, the first screen of the laptop app (Quick Setup).*

1. **Setup sections rail.** The round buttons on the left are the setup sections, top to bottom: ⚡ **Quick Setup**, **1 · Game**, **2 · Teams & Players**, **3 · Gameplay & Rules**, **4 · Rounds & Questions**, **5 · Audio & Presentation**, **6 · Advanced**. Hover over (or long-press) a button to see its name; a small dot marks a section that has a status note.
2. **Question Database / Import Template to Database.** Add questions for future quizzes. *Tonight's quiz isn't changed.*
3. **Name & Teams.** The quiz name (shown under the logo on the TV) and the number of teams (2–8).
4. **Rounds.** 1–4 question rounds, Final Round On/Off, and the automatic values.
5. **Live TV Preview.** What the TV will show when the show starts.
6. **Tonight at a Glance.** Host, teams, rounds, rules, answering mode and theme in one box, plus ✓ **Ready to Start** (or what's missing).
7. **Open Audience View (TV).**
8. **Teams Presentation Mode** (for sharing the Audience View in a Microsoft Teams call).
9. 📶 **Check Connections** (Chapter 9).
10. 🎭 **Rehearsal** — a practice game where nothing counts.
11. **Begin Game** — start the show.

The top bar during a game (Chapter 15 explains every button): 📺 **Audience View ▾**, 📲 **Connect ▾**, the tablet status, 🔊 **Sound**, 📶 **Teams x/y** (connected team phones — tap it for Connection Health), 🔐 **Team Codes**, ⋯ **▾** (Intermission, Mind It! Sting, About & Credits, Backups & Restore) and **Setup**.

4.4 Loading, resuming and "going back to the main menu"

- **Mind It! saves the game automatically after every change.** If the app or the computer closes during a game, open Mind It! again: Setup offers **Resume saved game** or **Start fresh**. Choose **Resume saved game** (Chapter 22).
- **Pressing Setup during a game pauses it.** Setup then offers **Return to game** or **Start a new game**.
- **The laptop's "main menu" is Setup.** At the end of a game, **END GAME** (on the tablet) or **Back to Setup** (on the laptop's final screens) saves the results and returns to Setup.

- **The tablet's main menu** is the start screen above. After END GAME the tablet shows "THANKS FOR PLAYING!" and returns there.
- **Loading a quiz from a file:** Setup → 4 · Rounds & Questions → **Upload Your Question Template** accepts Excel (.xlsx), CSV or a saved Mind It! game (.json).

4.5 What is "Quizmaster Mode"?

You may see a button called **QUIZMASTER MODE** on a phone. It belongs to the **browser-only "web link" version** of Mind It! (used without the laptop app): it opens the host controls on that device after you type the Quizmaster password. **You don't need it with the laptop app and tablet**, which this guide covers. The password is known to the owner and is deliberately not printed anywhere in this guide. 🟡 The web-link version was republished with build 114 (11 Oct 2026); it hasn't been checked on real devices.

---

5. Creating Your First Quiz: THE BIG FAT QUIZ

We'll build a real quiz called **THE BIG FAT QUIZ** with 4 teams, 2 rounds and a Final. Follow along on the laptop.

Step 1 — Create a new game

Open Mind It!. If you see an old quiz you don't want, go to **6 · Advanced → Reset → New Quiz (Reset to Defaults)**. This resets the quiz name, teams, settings and questions to the defaults. **Player profiles and their history are never touched.**

> 💡 You don't have to reset. If your Question Database has 10 or more questions, a brand-new game is filled automatically with random questions from it (newest questions first).

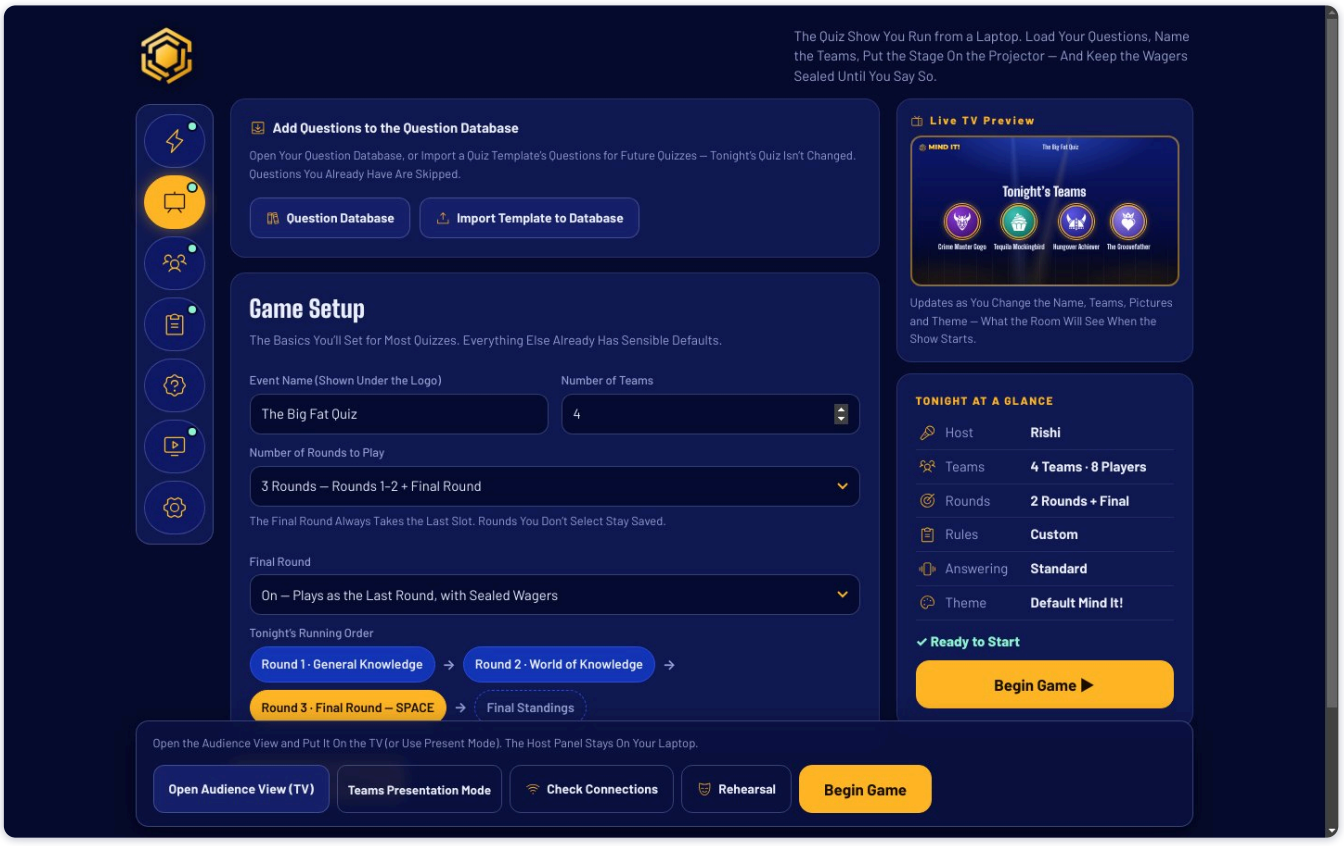
Step 2 — Enter the quiz name

⚡ **Quick Setup → 1 · Name & Teams → Quiz Name:** type `The Big Fat Quiz`. It appears under the logo on the TV ("Event Name").

Step 3 — Choose the number of rounds

⚡ **Quick Setup → 2 · Rounds → Question Rounds:** tap **2**. Leave **Final Round: On**. The box shows the values: *Values: 200 · 400* (the first-row value of each round).

The same choice in more detail is in **1 · Game → Number of Rounds to Play**: "1 Round — Round 1 only", "2 Rounds — Round 1 + Final Round", "3 Rounds — Rounds 1–2 + Final Round", "4 Rounds — Rounds 1–3 + Final Round", "5 Rounds — Rounds 1–4 + Final Round". *(In that list, "rounds" counts the Final too.)* Rounds you don't use stay saved but never appear in the game.



📸 *Real screenshot — 1 · Game: event name, number of rounds, Final Round, and tonight's running order.*

Step 4 — Select the game mode

3 · Gameplay & Rules → Answering Mode:

- ● **Standard Mode** — "Teams answer out loud in turn — the normal game." **Choose this for your first game.**
- ○ **Phone Buzzer Mode** — "Teams buzz in from their phones; the first buzz answers." (Chapter 13.)

Also on this page, pick a **rules preset** (Step 7 below explains them): **Classic**, **Full Show**, **Family Night** or **Custom**.

Step 5 — Select question categories

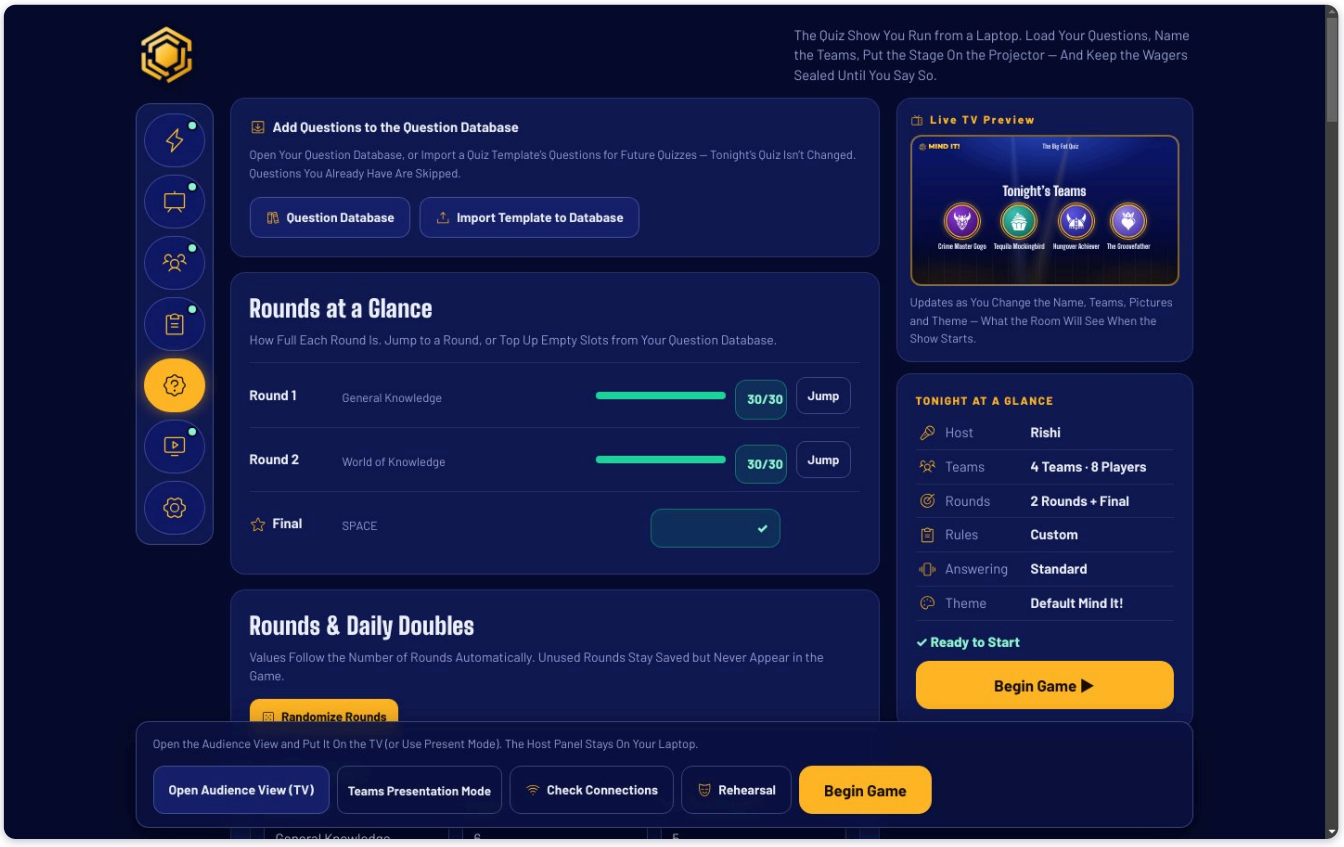
Each round needs 6 categories of 5 questions. You have three easy options:

1. **Use what's already there.** New games are filled automatically from your Question Database.
2. 🎲 **Randomize Rounds** (4 · Rounds & Questions) — refills the rounds with random database questions (it asks first). The newest questions and categories get priority; each column gets a different category; nothing repeats.
3. 🔄 **Replace a round or a single category** with one you choose from the database (Chapter 6.6).

Or load a whole quiz from a spreadsheet: **4 · Rounds & Questions → Upload Your Question Template** (download the **Starter Template (.xlsx)** first — it's a complete sample quiz with a Quizmaster guide; replace the yellow cells with your questions).

Step 6 — Choose (and check) the questions

In **4 · Rounds & Questions → Review & Edit Clues** every round is listed with its categories and questions. Each category has 🔄 **Replace** and ↕ **Reorder** buttons; each question shows a status (✔ **Ready**) and a ⋯ menu. 👁 **Preview Questions** shows a question exactly as the TV will — on a private copy, so nothing counts and nothing is marked as used.



📸 *Real screenshot — 4 · Rounds & Questions: how full each round is ("30/30"), values, Daily Doubles.*

Step 7 — Configure question values (and the rules)

Values are automatic. You don't have to type a single number:

Question rounds in play	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Round 4
1, 2 or 3 rounds	200 · 400 · 600 · 800 · 1,000	400 · 800 · 1,200 · 1,600 · 2,000	600 · 1,200 · 1,800 · 2,400 · 3,000	—
4 rounds	250 · 500 · 750 · 1,000 · 1,250	500 · 1,000 · 1,500 · 2,000 · 2,500	750 · 1,500 · 2,250 · 3,000 · 3,750	1,000 · 2,000 · 3,000 · 4,000 · 5,000

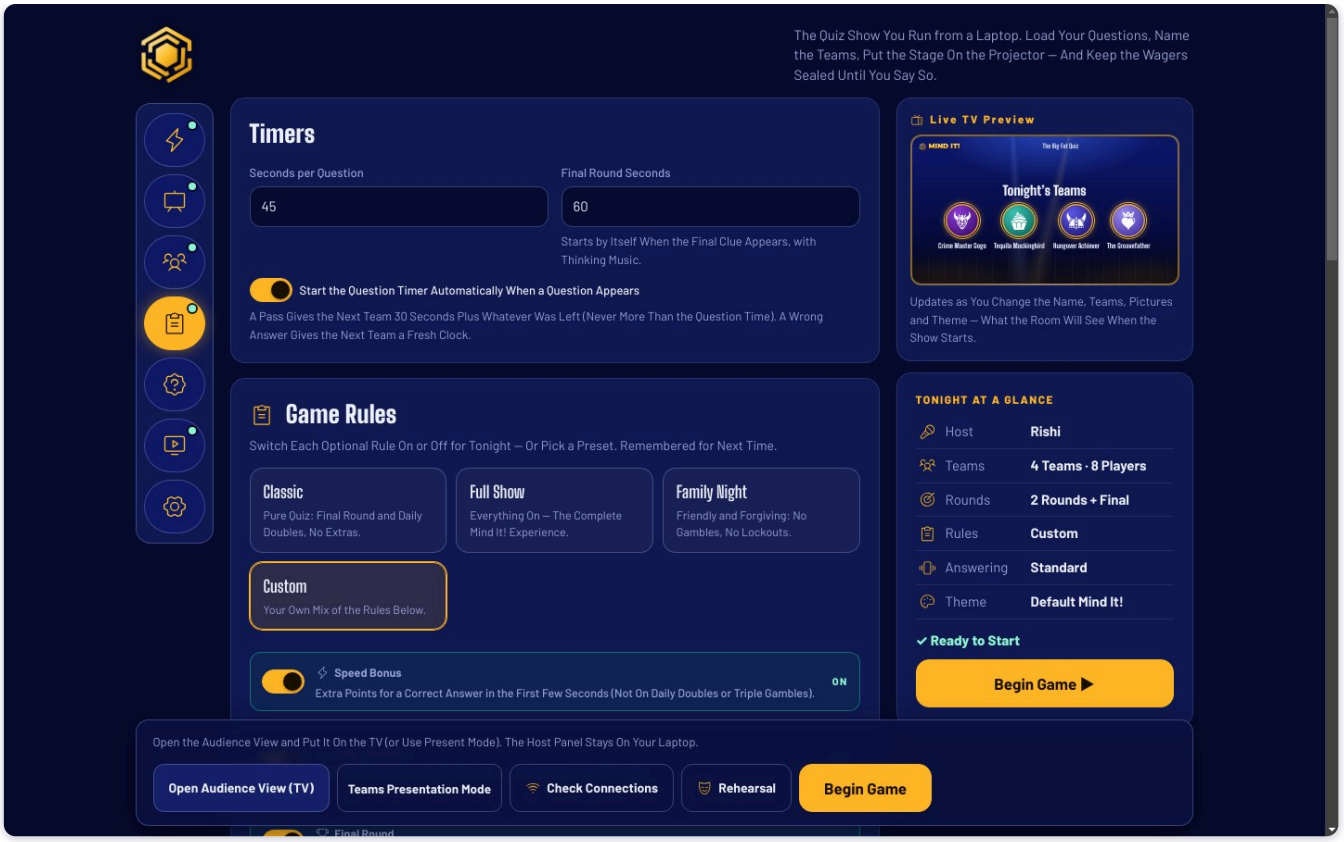
How it works: each round has a **starting value** (the top row): 200 / 400 / 600 for 1–3 rounds, or 250 / 500 / 750 / 1,000 for 4 rounds. **Row k is worth starting value × k.** So THE BIG FAT QUIZ (2 rounds) has Round 1 = 200–1,000 and Round 2 = 400–2,000. The Final Round has no board value — it is played with wagers. ✅ *Verified: the replayed game in Chapter 17 used exactly 200…1,000 and 400…2,000.*

Want your own values? Change a round's **Starting Value (Q1)** in 4 · Rounds & Questions — that switches automatic values off for your quiz. Editing **one single question's** value by hand (in Review & Edit Clues) also switches to your own values, so **Begin Game keeps it** (build 113). **Use Automatic Values** turns them back on.

Rules presets (3 · Gameplay & Rules → 📋 Game Rules):

Rule	Classic	(default)	Family Night
⚡ Speed Bonus	off	on	off
🎁 Pass-On Bonus	off	on	on
🏆 Final Round	on	on	on
🔐 Sealed Daily Double Wagers	on	on	off
🎲 Triple Gamble Chips	off	on	off
🔥 Phoenix Chip	off	on	on
🍺 Bottoms Up Chip	off	on	off
👑 Returning Champion	off	on	on
🔥 True Daily Double Moment	on	on	on
🔥 Streak Flames	off	on	on
📳 Early-Buzz Lockout	on	on	off
🎬 Board Fill Animation	on	on	on

Change any single switch and the preset shows **Custom**. Your choices are remembered on this device for next time. Changing a rule during a game asks first and applies from the next question.



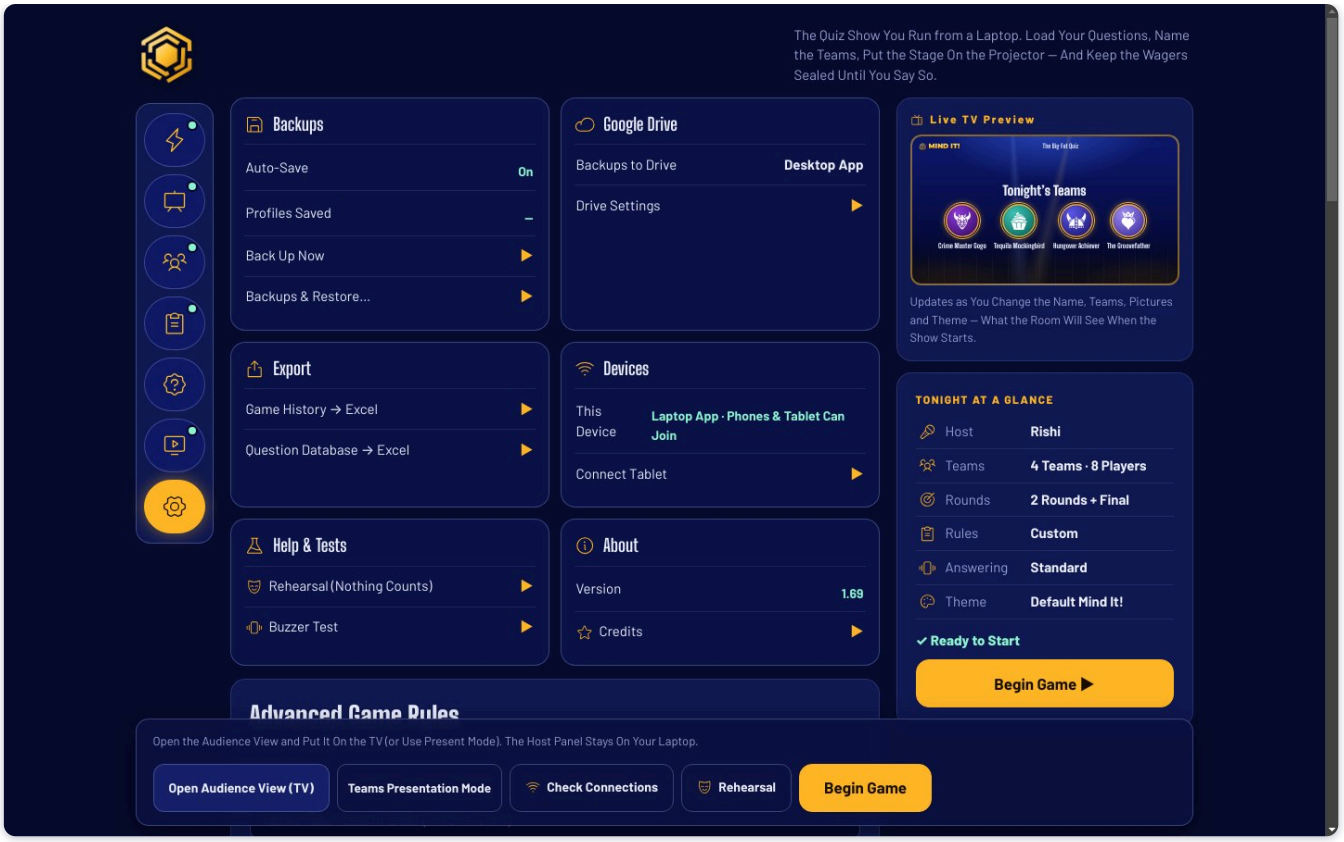
📸 *Real screenshot — 3 · Gameplay & Rules: timers and the rule switches.*

Other settings on 3 · Gameplay & Rules (defaults in bold):

- **Seconds per Question: 45** · **Final Round Seconds: 60** · **Start the Question Timer Automatically: on**.
- **Pass-On Bonus: On — % of the question's value per pass (25%)** · or a fixed number of points per pass (100) · or Off.
- **Speed Bonus: On** — automatic, **50%** of the lowest question value in each round (Round 1: 100 · Round 2: 200 for THE BIG FAT QUIZ) · **Answer Within: 10 seconds**.
- **Daily Doubles per round: 1 · 2 · 2 · 3** (4 · Rounds & Questions), placed **at random on the top two questions of a category** (or "I'll pick them before the round", or "Use the clues marked DD").

6 · Advanced → Advanced Game Rules:

- **Turn Order: Teams take turns in order (1 → 2 → 3 → 1)** or *Classic — whoever answers correctly picks next*.
- **Daily Double Wager On Screen: Sealed until the answer is scored** or *Shown before the clue*.
- **Daily Double Cap for Low Scores: 1,000** — a team may wager up to its score, or up to this amount if its score is lower.

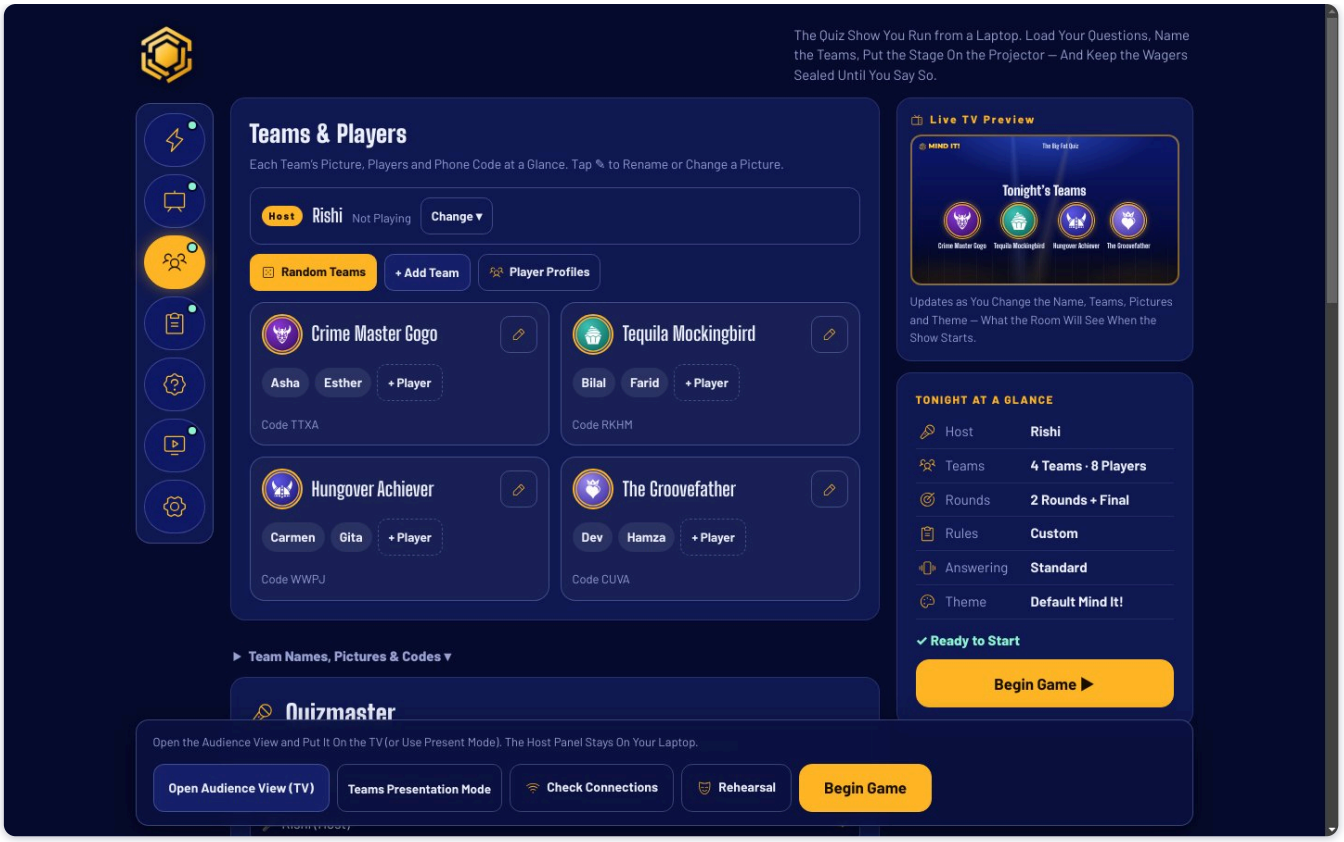


📸 *Real screenshot — 6 · Advanced (backups, Google Drive, export, devices, help & tests, about).*

Step 8 — Create the teams

2 · Teams & Players. Each team card shows its picture, its players, **+ Player**, and its **4-letter code** (e.g. *Code TRYT*). Tap ✎ to rename a team or change its picture. **+ Add Team** adds one (up to 8). Mind It! needs **at least 2 teams** — the number of teams can't be set below 2. 🎲 **Random Teams** shuffles your players into teams for you.

Name ours: **Crime Master Gogo**, **Tequila Mockingbird**, **Hungover Achiever**, **The Groovefather**.

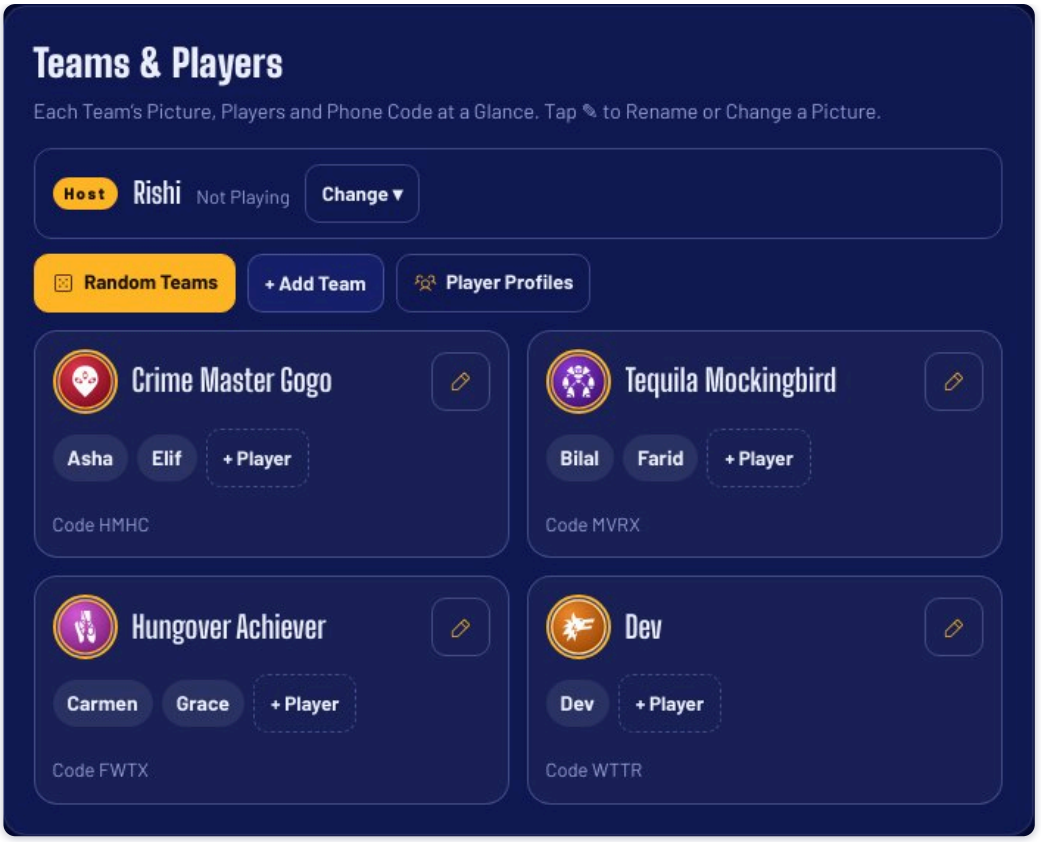


📸 *Real screenshot — 2 · Teams & Players.*

Step 9 — Assign the players

Tap **+ Player** on each team and pick people from your Player Database (or create a new person on the spot). **Every team needs at least one player** before Begin Game (a Rehearsal is exempt). A person can't be in two teams.

A team with only one player *is* that player. It automatically takes the player's **name** and **picture** — on the TV, the phones, the scores and the records. Its name box is then locked (hover over it: "One-player team: it uses Dev's name and picture. Add a second player to give the team its own name."). Add a second player and the team gets back the name it had before. ✅ *(New in build 112.)*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — 2 · Teams & Players: the fourth team has one player, Dev, so the team is called "Dev".*

Step 10 — Select the Quizmaster

2 · Teams & Players → 🎤 Quizmaster → Host. One Quizmaster per game; the Quizmaster **can't** also play. New games pick the player named **Rishi** as Quizmaster when that profile exists (otherwise the last Quizmaster). If Rishi wants to play tonight, press 🎮 **Rishi Wants to Play** and choose who hosts instead (Chapter 7.6).

Step 11 — Choose the theme

5 · Audio & Presentation → Theme. Tap one of the 12 themes (each has a ▶ **Sounds** preview). **Theme Intensity** (Subtle · Standard · **Full**) only changes decorations and animations, never the layout. Details in Chapter 21.

Step 12 — Review the setup

Look at **Tonight at a Glance** on the right: *Host · Teams (4 Teams · 8 Players) · Rounds (2 Rounds + Final) · Rules · Answering · Theme*. When everything is fine it says ✔ **Ready to Start**. If something is missing (for example a team without a player), it says what — and **Begin Game** explains it too.

Step 13 — Save the quiz

The quiz is **saved automatically** on this computer. To keep a copy:

- **Save Quiz to Question Database** (4 · Rounds & Questions, or inside the Question Database) — adds tonight's questions to your database for future quizzes. (A finished game also adds all its questions automatically.)
- **Save Everything (.json)** — the whole quiz in one file you can load later.
- **Export Questions (.xlsx)** — tonight's questions as an editable spreadsheet.
- **⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now** — a full backup (game, players, history and Question Database).

Step 14 — Start the game

1. Open the Audience View on the TV (**Open Audience View (TV)**). Before the game, the TV shows a **"Scan to Join Your Team"** QR code with the phone link — teams scan it and type their team code (Chapter 8). It stays up on *Tonight's Teams*

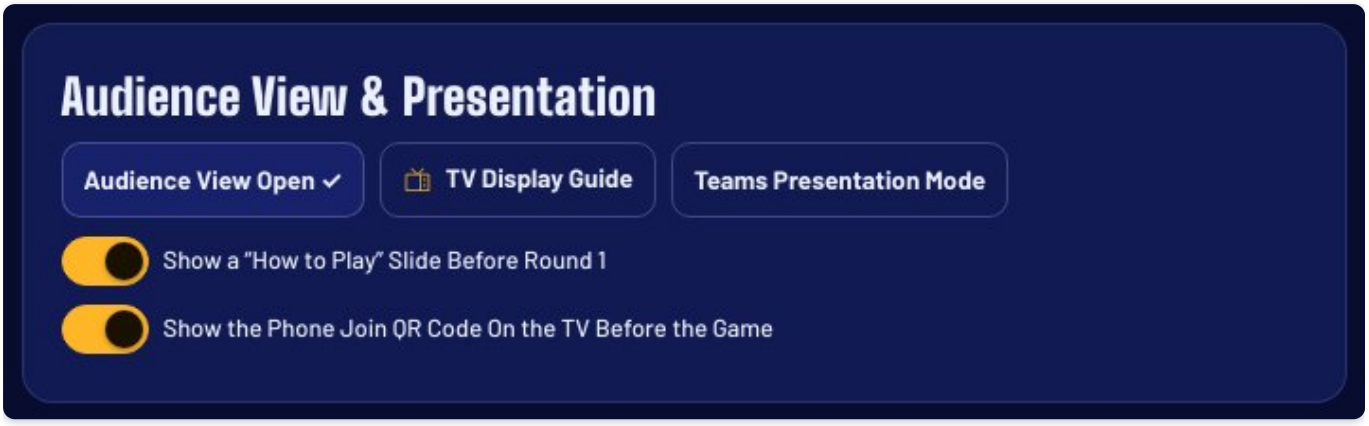
and disappears when Round 1 starts.

2. Press 📶 **Check Connections** if you use phones or a tablet (Chapter 9).
3. Press **Begin Game** ▶.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the TV before the game, with the phone join QR code at the bottom.*

Don't want the code on the TV (for example, nobody is using phones)? Switch off **5 · Audio & Presentation → Audience View & Presentation → Show the Phone Join QR Code On the TV Before the Game** (it's on by default).



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the switch, just under "Show a How to Play slide".*

The TV shows **Tonight's Teams**, then the Round 1 categories, then the board. The first team lights up as **Now Playing**. You're live! 🎉

> **Common mistakes on setup day** - Pressing Begin Game with the Audience View closed — no problem, just open it; the show waits for you. - A team with no players — Begin Game stops and tells you which team. - The Quizmaster still listed in a team — Begin Game offers **Remove & Start**. - Forgetting that "Number of Rounds to Play" on *1 · Game* counts the Final. Quick Setup's "Question Rounds" doesn't.

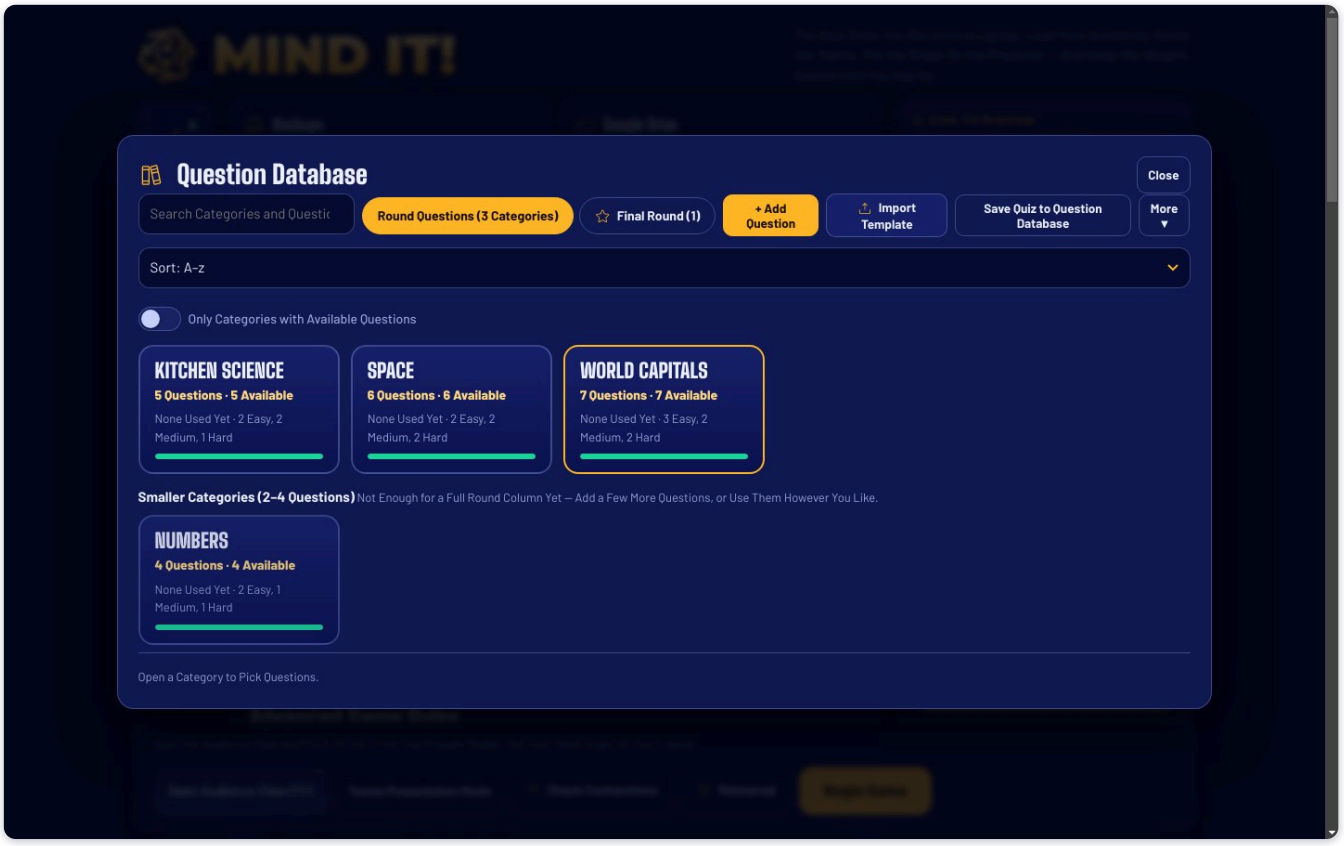
How the Final Round question is selected

- Every quiz has **one Final question** (category + question + answer + accepted alternate answers).
- When rounds are filled from the database, questions marked ⭐ **Final Round Question** (and single-question categories) are kept for the Final; the **newest** Final candidate becomes the Final.
- To choose a different one: **4 · Rounds & Questions → ⭐ Final Round Question → ⇄ Switch Final Question** (or the Question Database's ⭐ Final Round tab). It warns if that question is already used in a round.
- **Once the Final Round has started, its question is locked** until the game ends (build 114): Switch Final Question and "Use as Final" say *Final Question Locked*, and the Final editor is greyed out (you can still change your host note and add accepted alternate answers).
- **Accepted Alternate Answers (comma-separated)** help the automatic answer checker (Chapter 18).
- Turn the Final off with **Final Round: Off** — the game then ends after the last board round with "FINAL STANDINGS".

---

6. The Complete Question Database Guide

The **Question Database** is your library of questions, kept on the device and included in backups. Open it from 📚 **Question Database** (top of Setup) or 4 · Rounds & Questions.



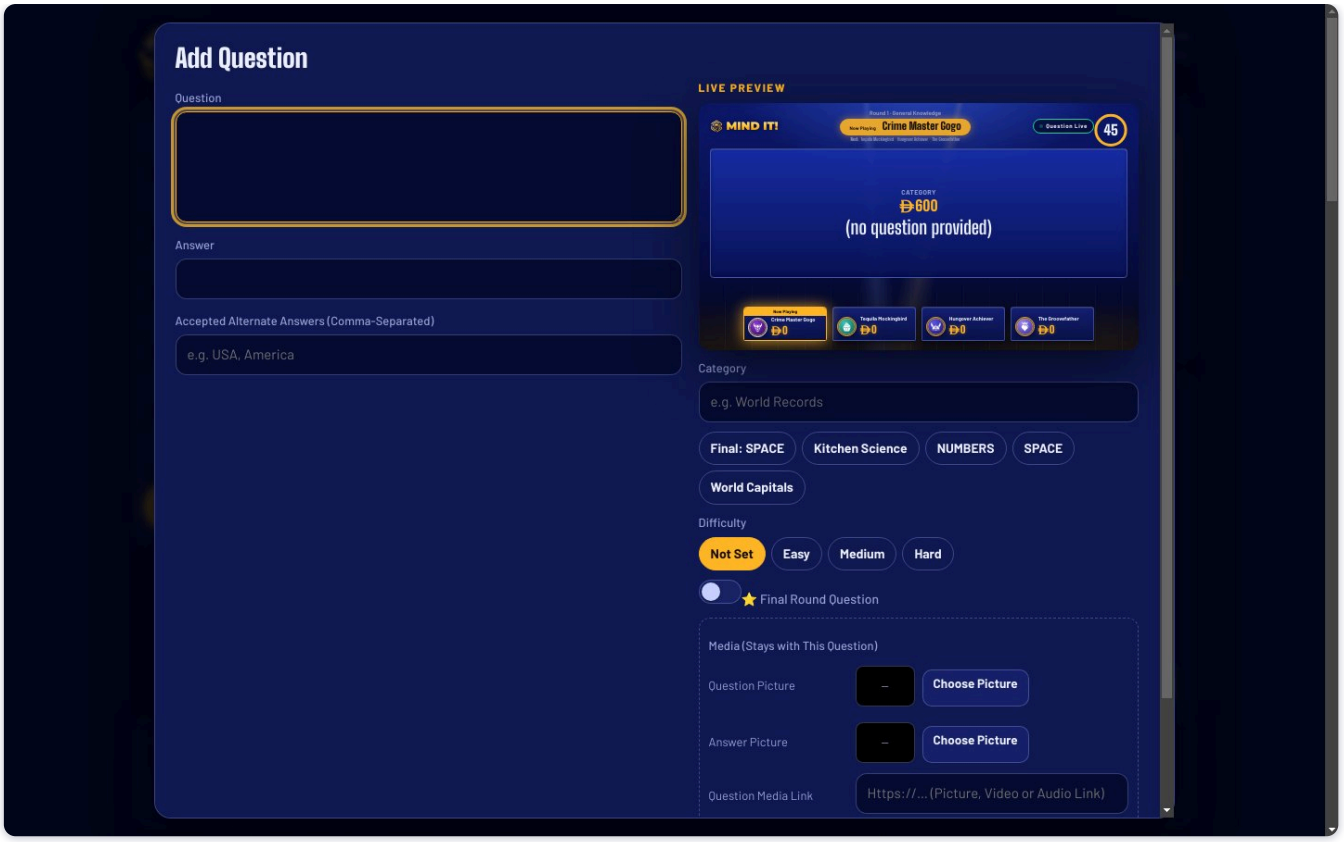
📸 Real screenshot — the Question Database. Categories are shown as cards with counts.

6.1 Finding your way around

- **Round Questions (N Categories)** and ⭐ **Final Round (N)** — two tabs.
- **+ Add Question**, ⬆ **Import Template**, **Save Quiz to Question Database**, **More ▾** (exports).
- **Sort:** A–Z · Most Questions · Most Available. **Only Categories with Available Questions** hides used-up ones.
- Each **category card** says how many questions it has, how many are **available** (not used yet), and the mix of difficulties ("2 Easy, 2 Medium, 1 Hard").
- **Smaller categories (2–4 questions)** are listed separately — not enough for a full column of 5 yet.
- **Open a category** to see and select its questions.

6.2 Adding a question

+ Add Question opens a form with a **Live Preview** of how it will look on the TV.

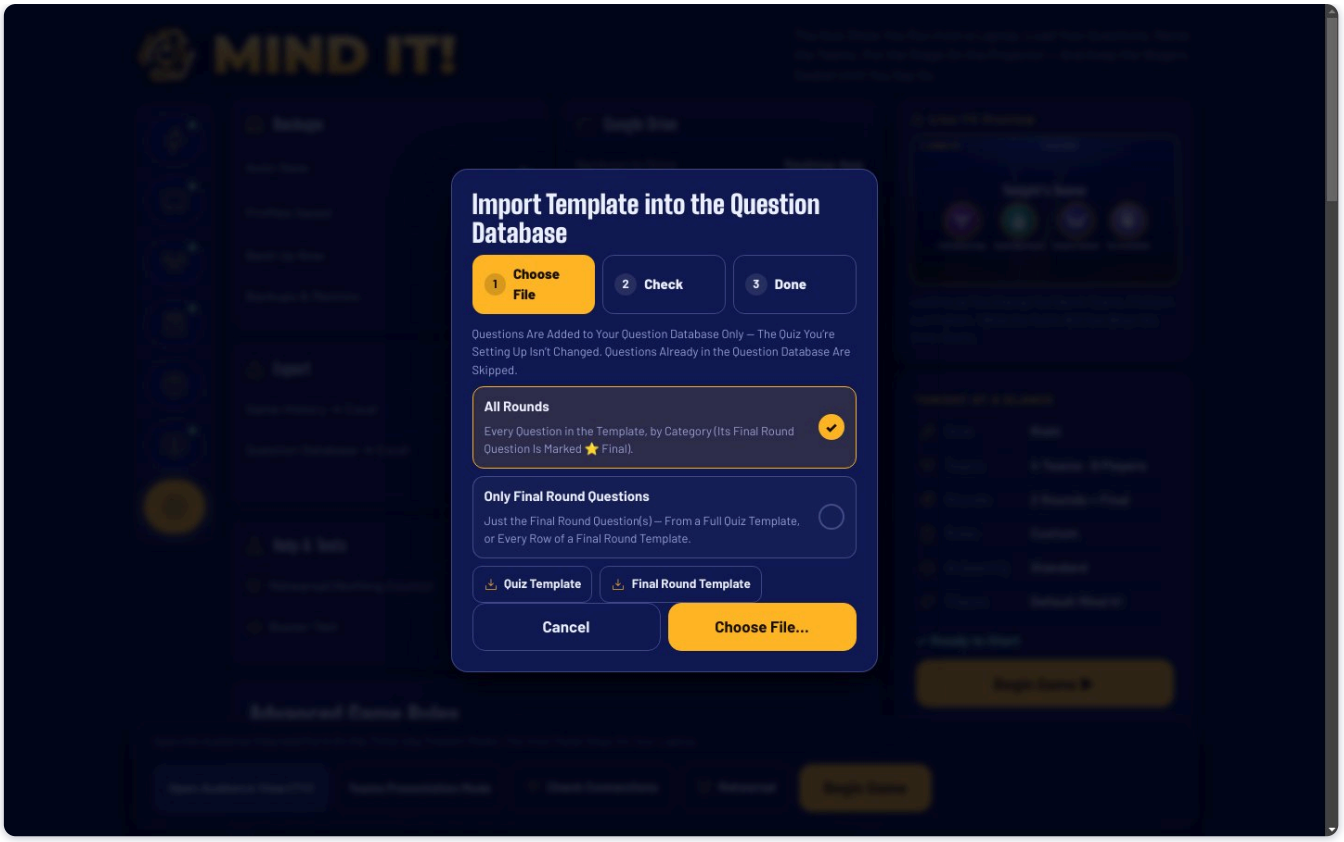


📸 *Real screenshot — Add Question.*

Fill in: **Question**, **Answer**, **Accepted Alternate Answers** (comma-separated), **Category** (pick one or type a new name — that *creates* the category), **Difficulty** (Not Set / Easy / Medium / Hard), ⭐ **Final Round Question** (tick for Final questions), and optional **media**: a Question Picture, an Answer Picture, a Question Media Link and an Answer Media Link. Then **Save**, or **Save & Add Another**.

6.3 Importing many questions at once

⬆ **Import Template** → **1 Choose File** → **2 Check** → **3 Done**. Choose **All Rounds** (every question, by category; its Final question is marked ⭐) or **Only Final Round Questions**. Download a blank ⬇ **Quiz Template** or ⬇ **Final Round Template** from the same screen. Questions already in your database are **skipped** — no duplicates. *Questions are added to the Question Database only — the quiz you're setting up isn't changed.*



📸 *Real screenshot — Import Template into the Question Database.*

6.4 Editing, moving and deleting

Inside a category you can tick questions (**Select All**, **Select All Available**, **Select Unplayed**) and then:

- ✎ **Edit** a question (text, answer, alternates, difficulty, pictures). Edits flow into tonight's rounds and the Final by question ID — but **never** into questions already played, and **never** into Historic Games (those are frozen snapshots).
- **Move To Category** — move selected questions to another category.
- **Rename** — rename the category. (That's how you "edit a category".)
- **Delete From Question Database** / **Delete Category** — permanent; the app asks first. Save a backup before big clean-ups.
- ➕ **Add To Round** — put selected questions into the round you're editing (it skips duplicates within a round unless you tick "Allow the same question twice in one round").
- **Export As Quiz Template (.xlsx)**.

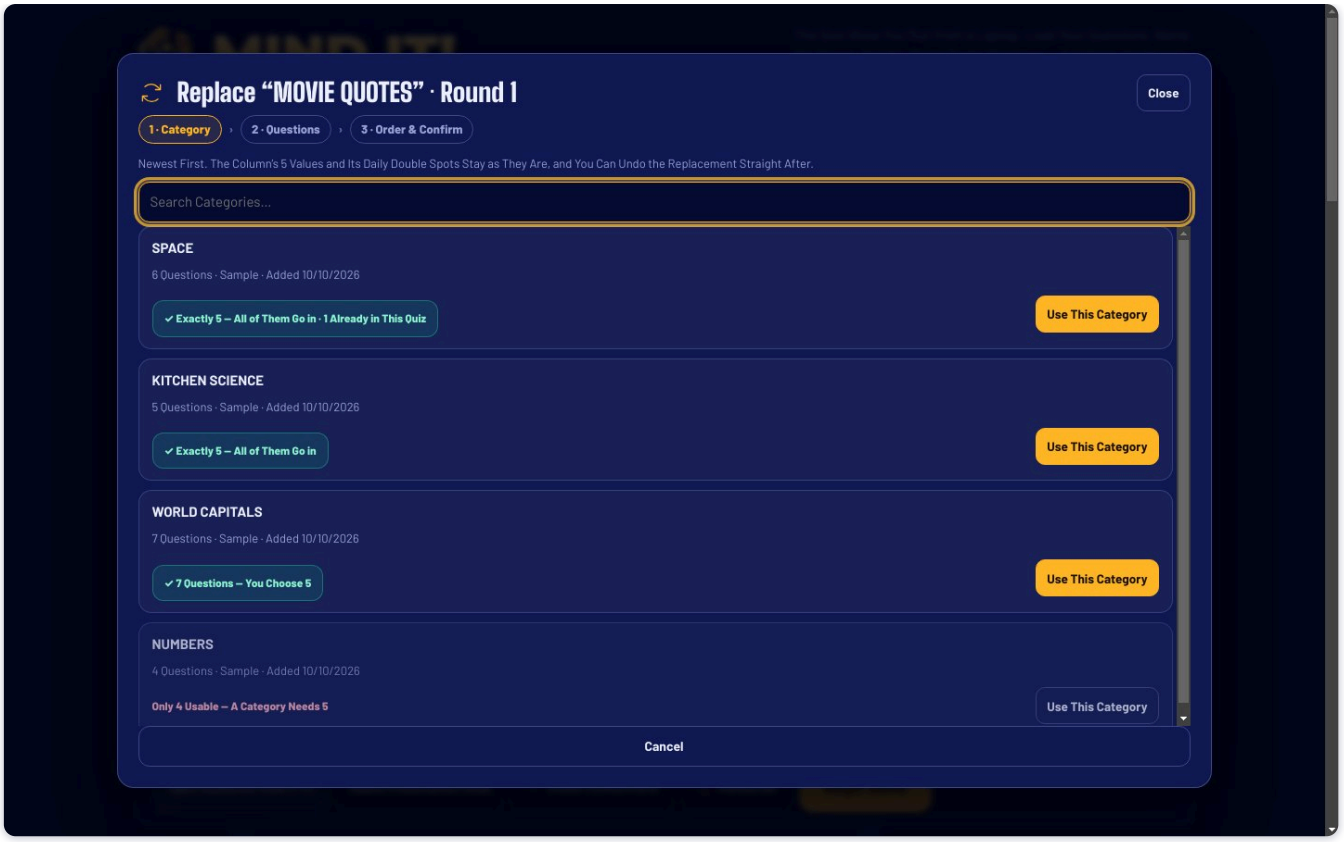
6.5 Searching, filtering, difficulty, preview

- **Search** boxes appear in the category list and inside the replace/choose screens (they search questions *and* answers).
- **Difficulty filter** chips: All · Easy · Medium · Hard · Not Set.
- 👁 **Preview** shows any question as the TV would, on a private copy. It never touches the timer, scores, wagers, the "used" flags, Historic Games, the TV, the tablet or the phones.

6.6 Replacing a category — choosing exactly five ✅

In **4 · Rounds & Questions**, every category has 🔄 **Replace**. Three steps: **1 Category › 2 Questions › 3 Order & Confirm**.

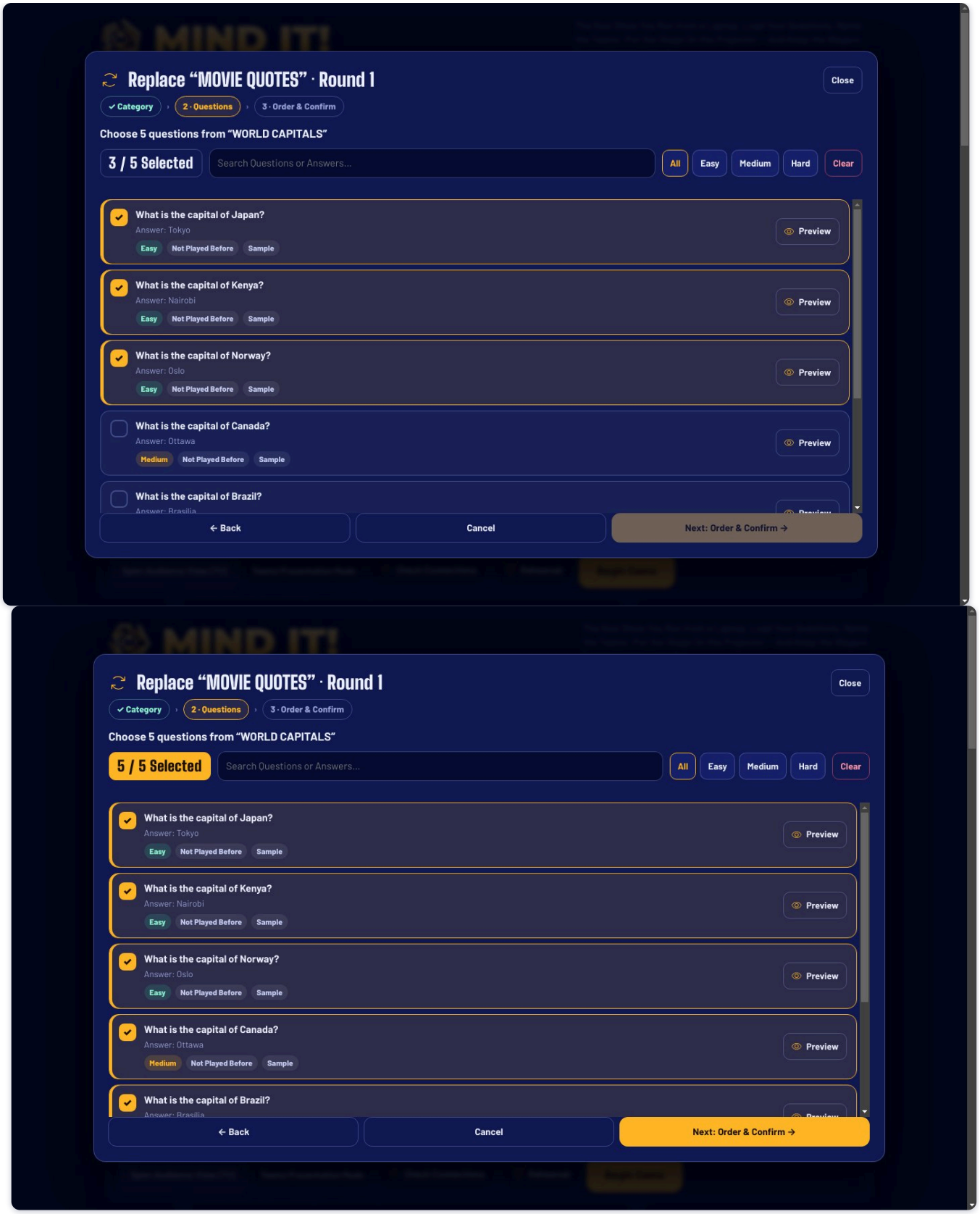
Step 1 — Category. Categories are listed newest first with a search box. Each shows how many usable questions it has:



📸 *Real screenshot — Replace "MOVIE QUOTES" · Round 1: choosing a category.*

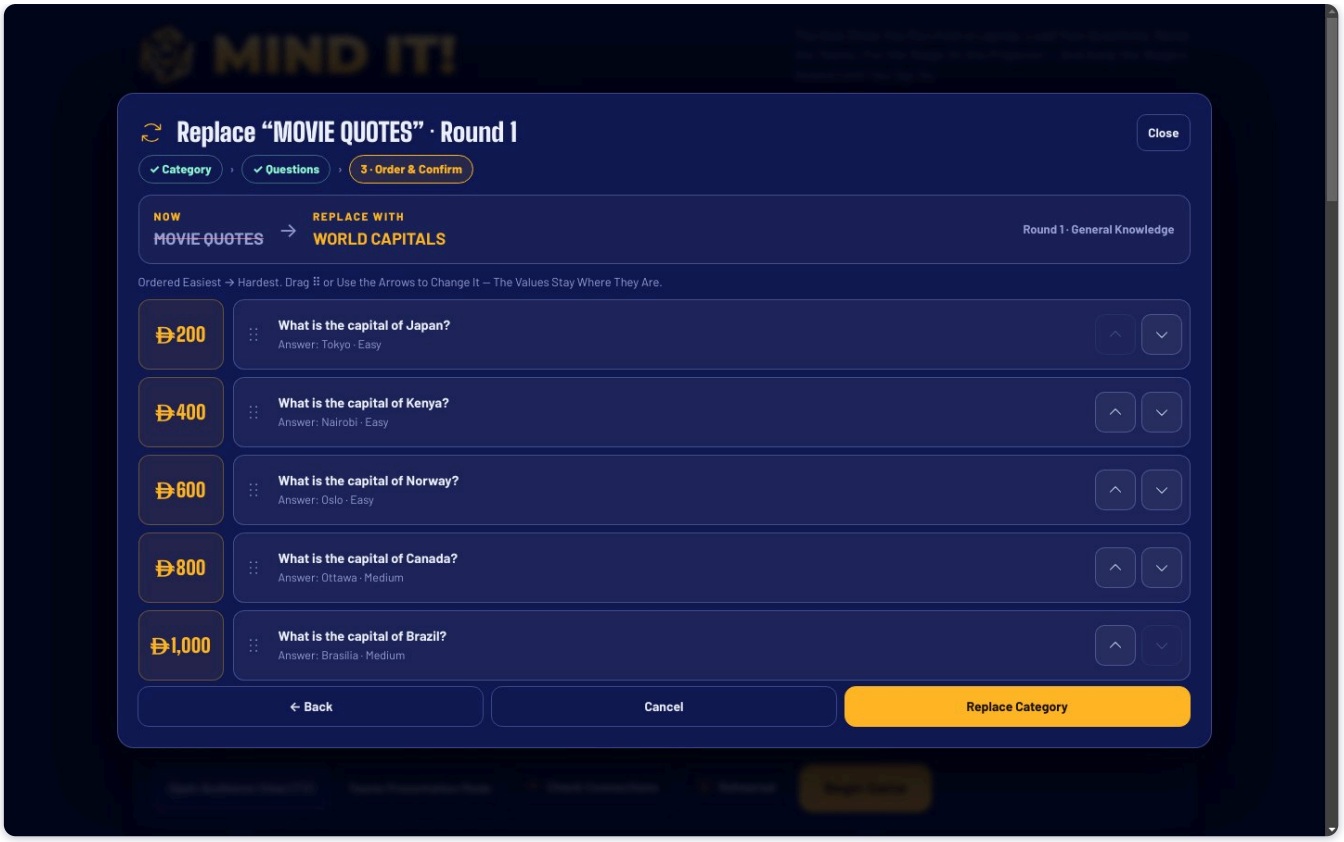
- **Exactly 5 usable** ("✓ Exactly 5 — all of them go in"): all five go in, no picking.
- **More than 5** ("✓ 7 questions — you choose 5"): you pick **exactly five** in step 2.
- **Fewer than 5** ("Only 4 usable — a category needs 5"): **blocked** — "Nothing has been changed" and **← Choose Another Category**.
- Questions already used elsewhere in this quiz (a round or the Final) are **never offered**.

Step 2 — Questions. The counter reads **"0 / 5 Selected"** and **Next: Order & Confirm →** stays greyed out until you have exactly 5. Use the search box, the difficulty chips and 👁 **Preview**. Each question shows its difficulty and whether it was **played before**.



📸 Real screenshots — choosing 5 of the 7 "WORLD CAPITALS" questions: 3 / 5 selected (Next is still greyed), then 5 / 5 (Next lights up).

Step 3 — Order & Confirm. The five are ordered **easiest → hardest** by default. Drag them, or use the ▲▼ arrows. The values stay with the rows (200, 400, 600…), and **Daily Double spots stay where they were**. Press **Replace Category**.



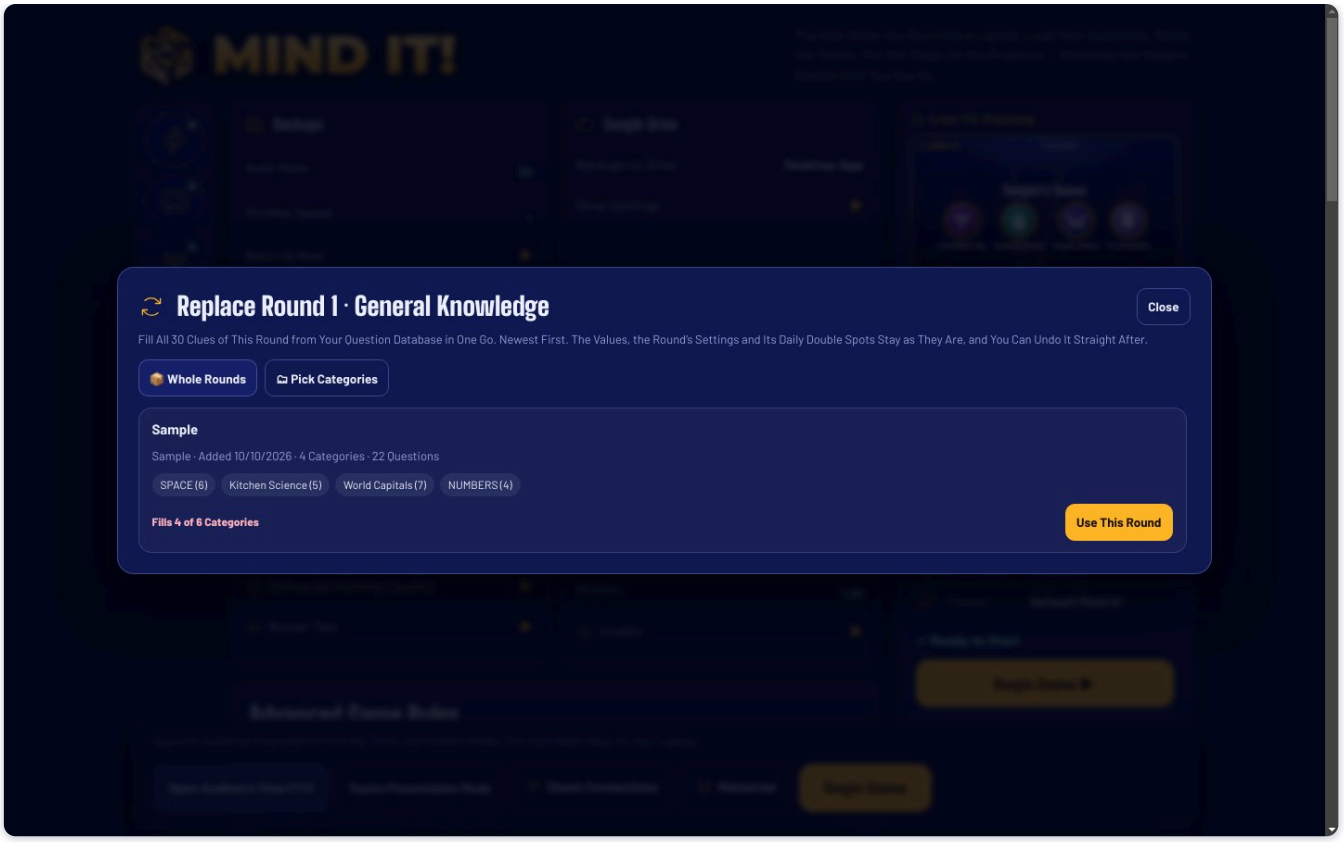
📸 Real screenshot — Order & Confirm: "Now MOVIE QUOTES → Replace with WORLD CAPITALS".

After replacing:

- It's **all-or-nothing** and you can **↩ Undo replace** straight after.
- Accepted alternate answers are copied; the Question Database itself is not changed.
- The editor **stays on the same round** you were editing, so you can carry on with the next category. (The open round tab — even the Final tab — is remembered.)
- It is refused if a paused game has a question from that category open.

6.7 Replacing a whole round

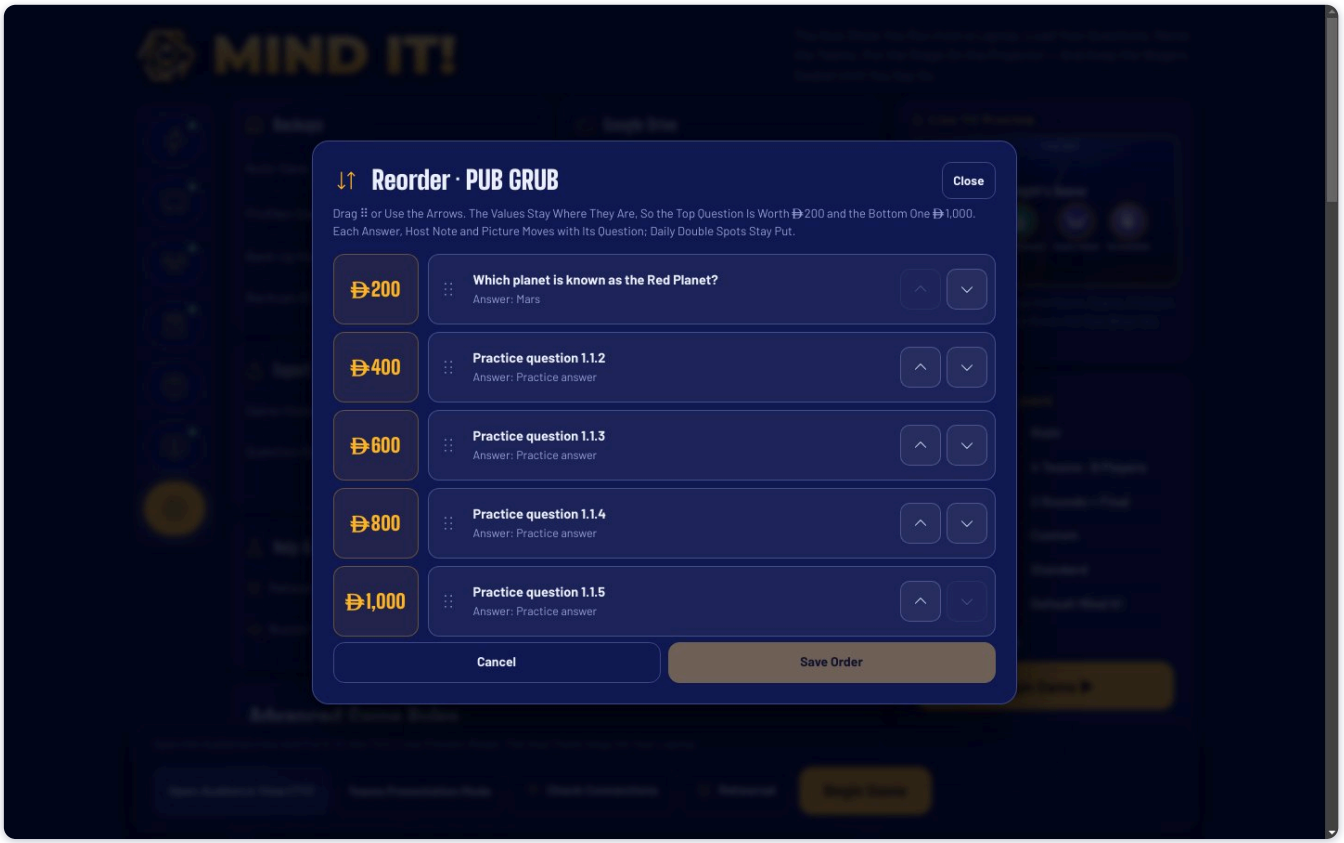
🔄 **Replace Round from Database** offers 📦 **Whole Rounds** (complete rounds, newest first, "✓ Fills the whole round") or 🗂 **Pick Categories** (tick up to 6, in board order). Values, round settings and Daily Double spots are kept, and there is **↩ Undo replace**. If any of the round's questions are **already in tonight's quiz** (another round or the Final), the list marks it (**⚠ 30 Already in Tonight's Quiz**) and the confirmation says how many and where, with **Replace Anyway** (build 114).



📸 *Real screenshot — Replace Round 1.*

6.8 Reordering questions in a category

↕ **Reorder** — drag a question up or down, or use the arrows. The **values stay with the row positions**, and **Daily Double spots stay in place** (by position). Played questions can't move while a game is paused. This is deliberate: the owner decided Daily Double spots stay where they are (October 2026).



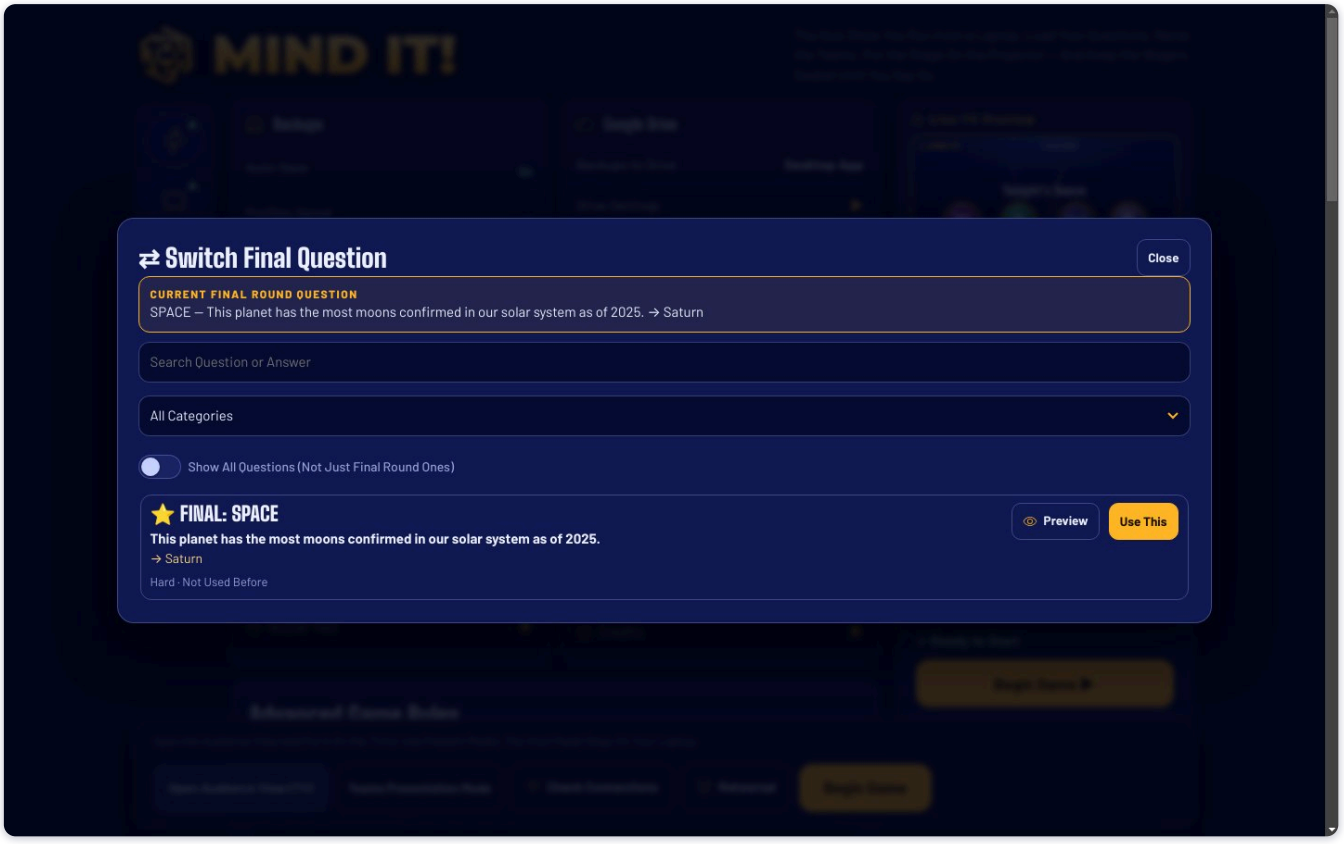
📸 *Real screenshot — Reorder · PUB GRUB.*

6.9 Reuse, duplicates and "used" questions

- **Used questions.** A finished game marks its questions as used ("Played 1× before"). Category cards count what is still **available**.
- **Reuse avoidance.** When rounds are filled automatically, questions that tonight's players saw in their **last 3 games** are avoided — as long as at least 80% of the needed questions can be fresh (gaps are never left). 🎲 **Play Again (New Questions)** also skips the last game's questions when at least 60 others exist.
- **Duplicates.** Importing skips questions you already have. Adding a duplicate to a round is refused unless you allow it.
- **Auto-add.** A finished game adds **all** its quiz questions to the database (not just the ones played). Loading a template does the same. Rehearsals never add anything.

6.10 Switching the Final Round question

⇄ **Switch Final Question** lists Final-Round questions (tick **Show All Questions** to see every question). Each has 👁 **Preview** and **Use This**. It warns if the question is already in a round. Once the Final has started, the Final question is **locked** (build 114) — Switch Final Question just says so.



📸 *Real screenshot — Switch Final Question.*

6.11 Writing great questions (tips from experienced Quizmasters)

- **One clear answer.** "Which planet is known as the Red Planet?" — good. "Name a red thing in space" — argument guaranteed.
- **Add accepted alternates** for spellings and short forms (*Brasília, Brasilia*). The Final's checker uses them.
- **Difficulty = how many teams would know it.** Easy: most of the room. Medium: about half. Hard: one team, if you're lucky. Put easy at 200, hard at 1,000.
- **Mix topics** across the six categories: something for the sports fan, the film buff, the foodie, the geek.
- **Balance rounds:** don't put all the hard questions in Round 1. Order each column easiest → hardest (Replace Category does this by default; ↕ **Reorder** lets you drag questions yourself).
- **Short questions read better on the TV.** Long ones aren't errors — they shrink to fit and show "ℹ Long — shown smaller on TV" — but they slow the game.

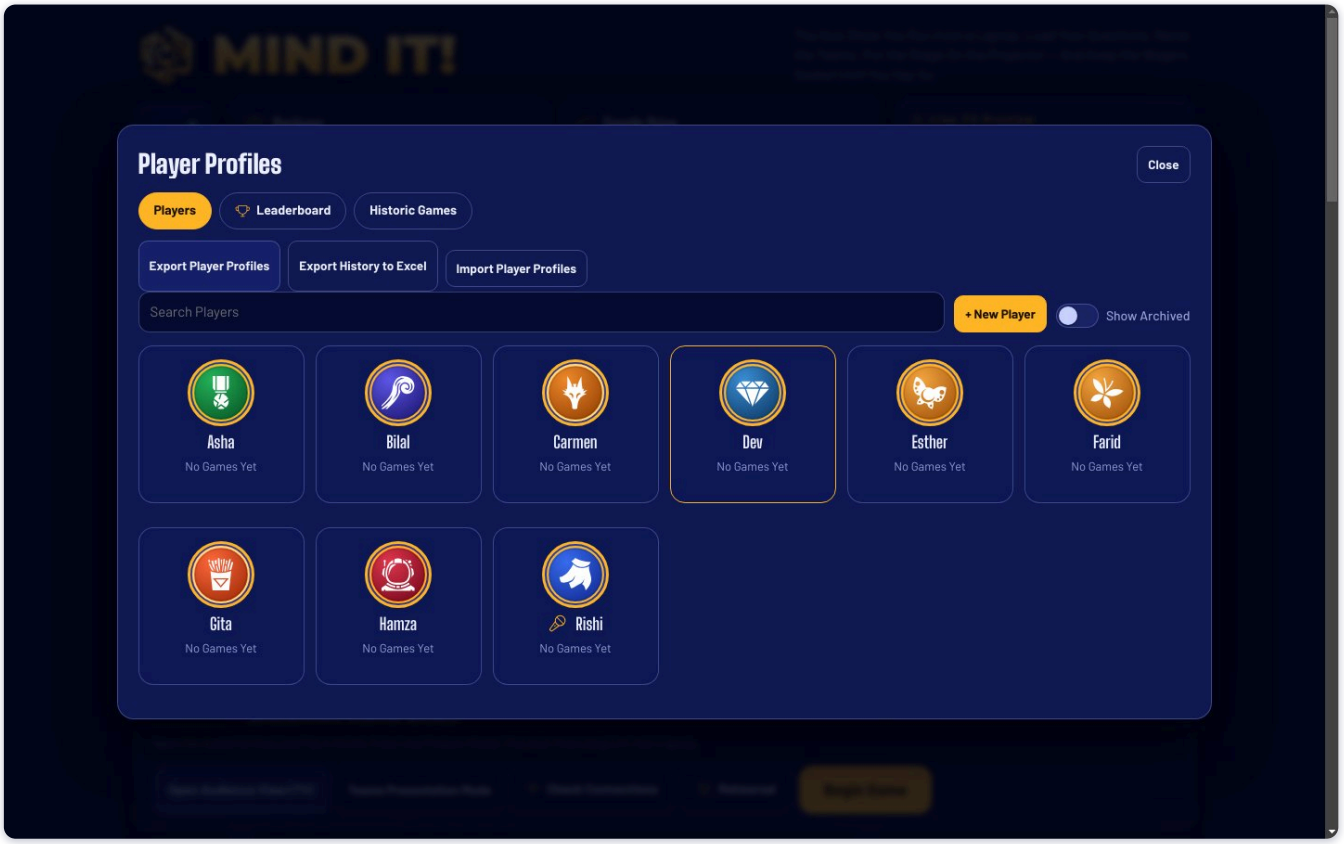
- **A strong Final question** is answerable by everyone in one or two words, has a single correct answer, and sounds harder than it is. Avoid "as of" facts that may change — or say the date in the question, as in our example ("...as of 2025").
- **Check facts twice.** You'll be the one explaining it to a table of Tequila Mockingbirds.

PART THREE — TEAMS AND CONNECTIVITY

7. Teams, Players and Quizmaster

7.1 Players live in the Player Database

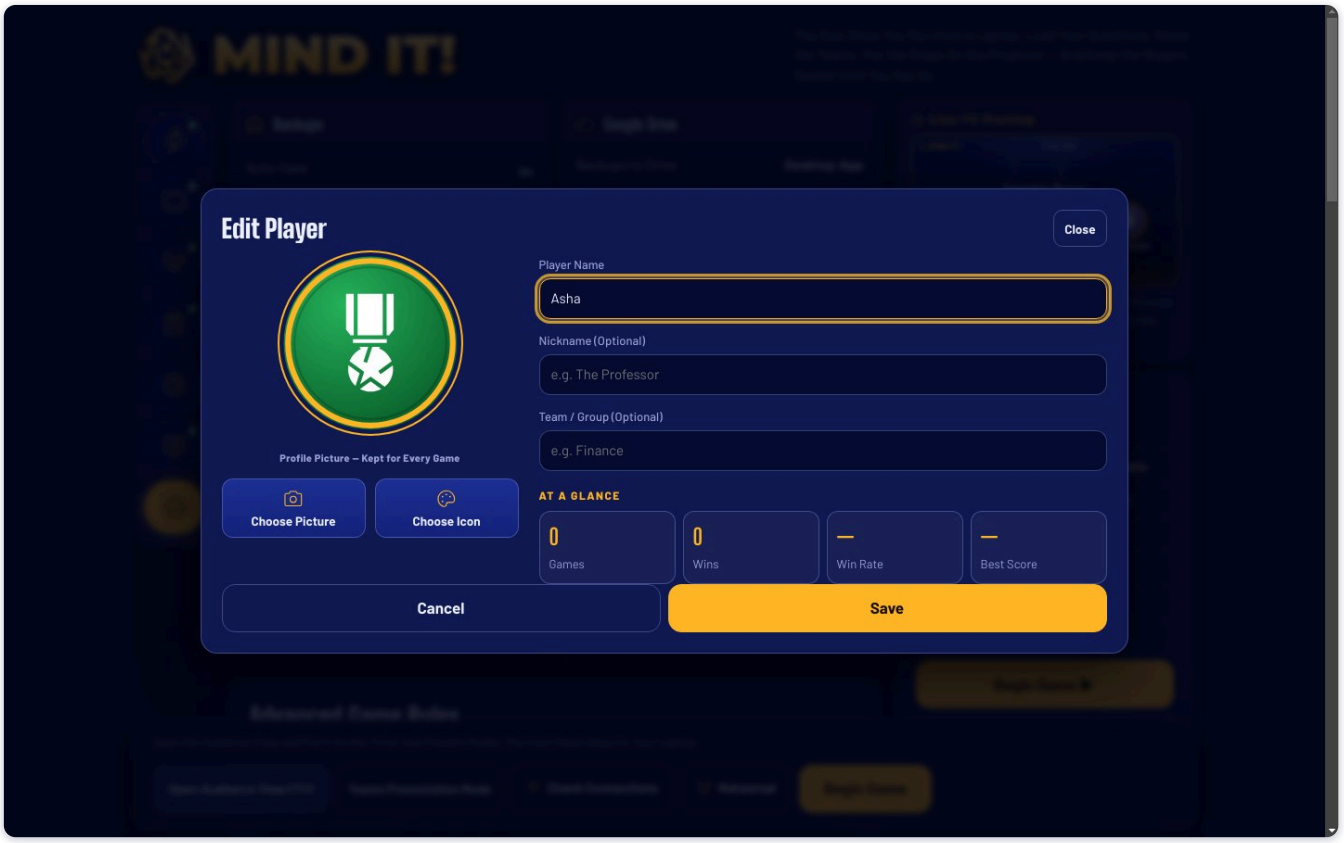
Mind It! remembers **people**, not just team names. Each person is created once in the **Player Database**, and their picture and statistics follow them from game to game. Open it from **2 · Teams & Players → 👥 Player Profiles** (or 6 · Advanced → 👥 All Players & Historic Games).



📸 Real screenshot — Player Profiles (tabs: Players · 🏆 Leaderboard · Historic Games).

- **+ New Player** — create a person.
- **Show Archived** — show people you archived (archiving hides someone without deleting their history).
- 🗑 **Delete** (on a player's own page, since build 124) — remove someone (7.2b); 🗑 **Recently Deleted** brings them back for 30 days (since build 125).
- ☑ **Select** (since build 125) — tick several players, then **Archive** or 🗑 **Delete** them together (7.2c).
- **Export Player Profiles / Import Player Profiles** — move all players, pictures and game records to another device. Import **merges**: nothing already there is lost, and the current game isn't changed.
- **Export History to Excel** — every Historic Game as a spreadsheet.

7.2 Creating and editing a player

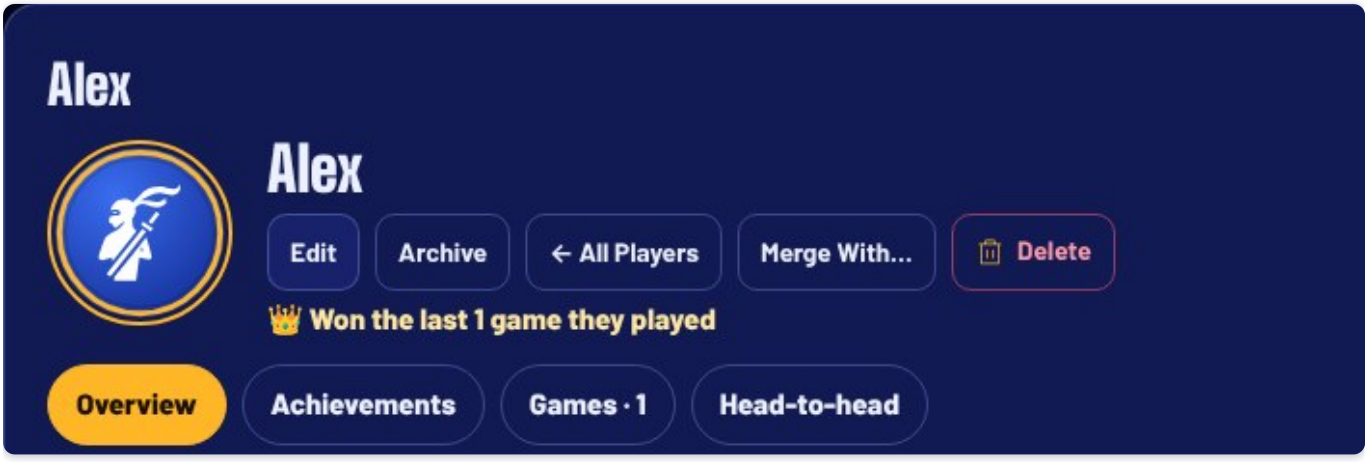


📸 *Real screenshot — Edit Player.*

Fields: **Player Name**, **Nickname (optional)**, **Team / Group (optional)**, and a **profile picture** — **Choose Picture** (a photo; iPhone HEIC photos are supported and can be cropped) or **Choose Icon** (one of the built-in badges). **At a Glance** shows games, wins, win % and best score. Names, nicknames and groups can be up to 40 characters. Press **Save**.

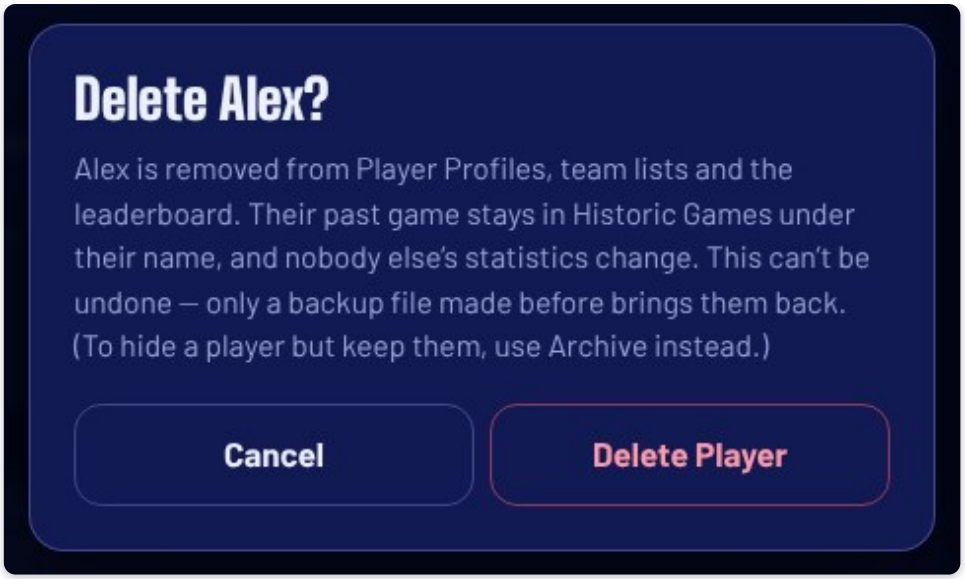
7.2b Deleting a player (since build 124)

Open the player (**Player Profiles → tap their name**) and press 🗑 **Delete** — the red button at the end of the row *Edit · Archive · ← All Players · Merge With…*.



📸 *Real screenshot — a player's page with 🗑 Delete (build 124).*

Mind It! asks first:



📸 *Real screenshot — the question before deleting.*

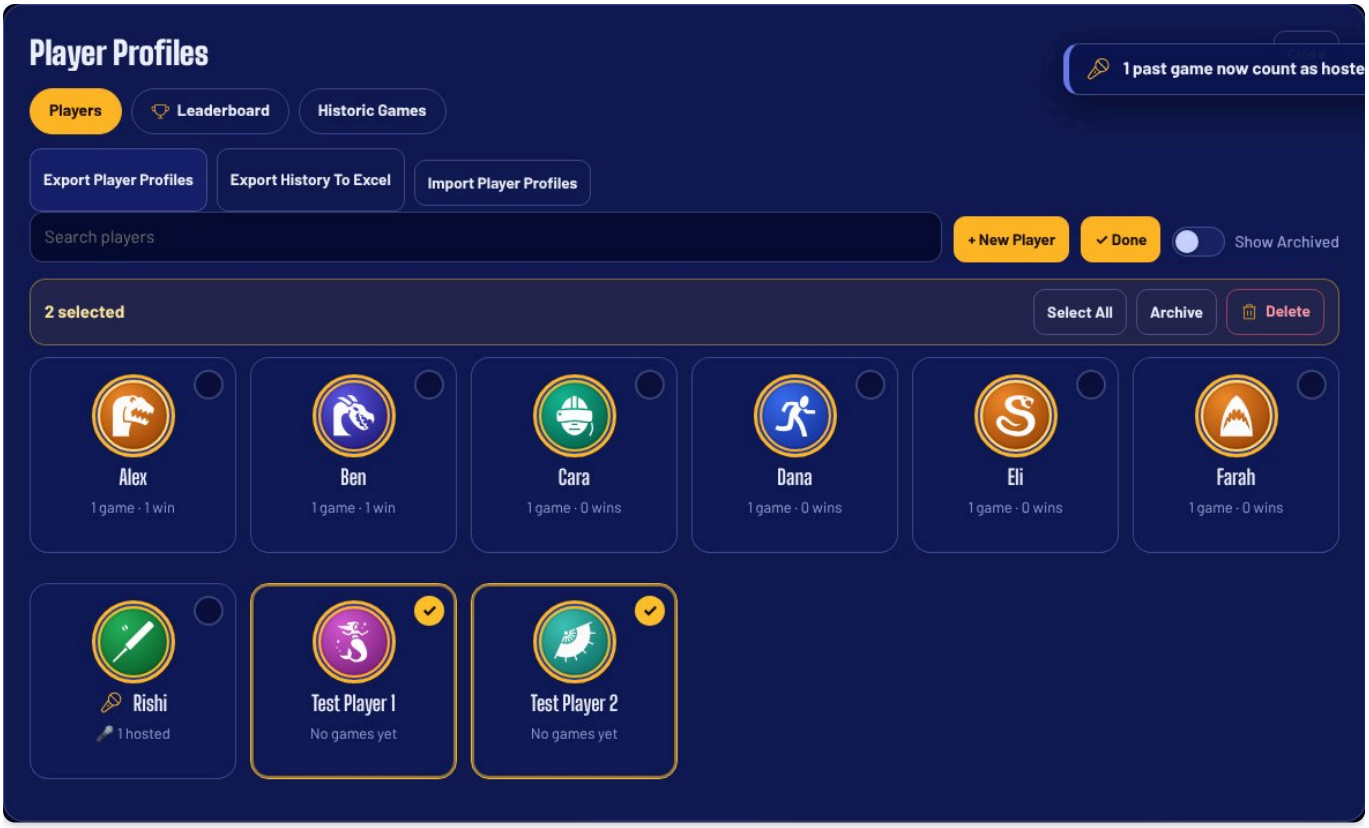
- **Delete Player** removes them from Player Profiles, the team lists, the Random Team Generator, the Quizmaster list and the leaderboard.
- **Their past games stay.** Historic Games still shows their name in the games they played, and **nobody else's statistics change**.
- **On Setup** they are taken off their team (and off Quizmaster) automatically. **During a game** you can't delete someone who is playing — finish or end the game first.
- **The tablet and the laptop** get the deletion the next time they sync, and a sync never brings the player back.
- **Changed your mind?** Since build 125: **Player Profiles → 🗑 Recently Deleted → ↻ Restore** brings them back — profile, picture and statistics — for **30 days**. After that only their name stays (in Historic Games). A **safety backup** is also made just before every deletion (22.3b). To hide someone but keep them, **Archive** is still there.



📸 *Real screenshot — 🗑 Recently Deleted (build 125).*

7.2c Selecting several players (since build 125)

Player Profiles → ☑ Select. Tap players to tick them (tap again to untick; **Select All** ticks everyone shown). Then **Archive** or **🗑 Delete** — one question for all of them. Players who are in the game being played are left out. **✔ Done** leaves Select mode.



📸 *Real screenshot — Select mode with two players ticked.*

7.3 Teams

On **2 · Teams & Players**:

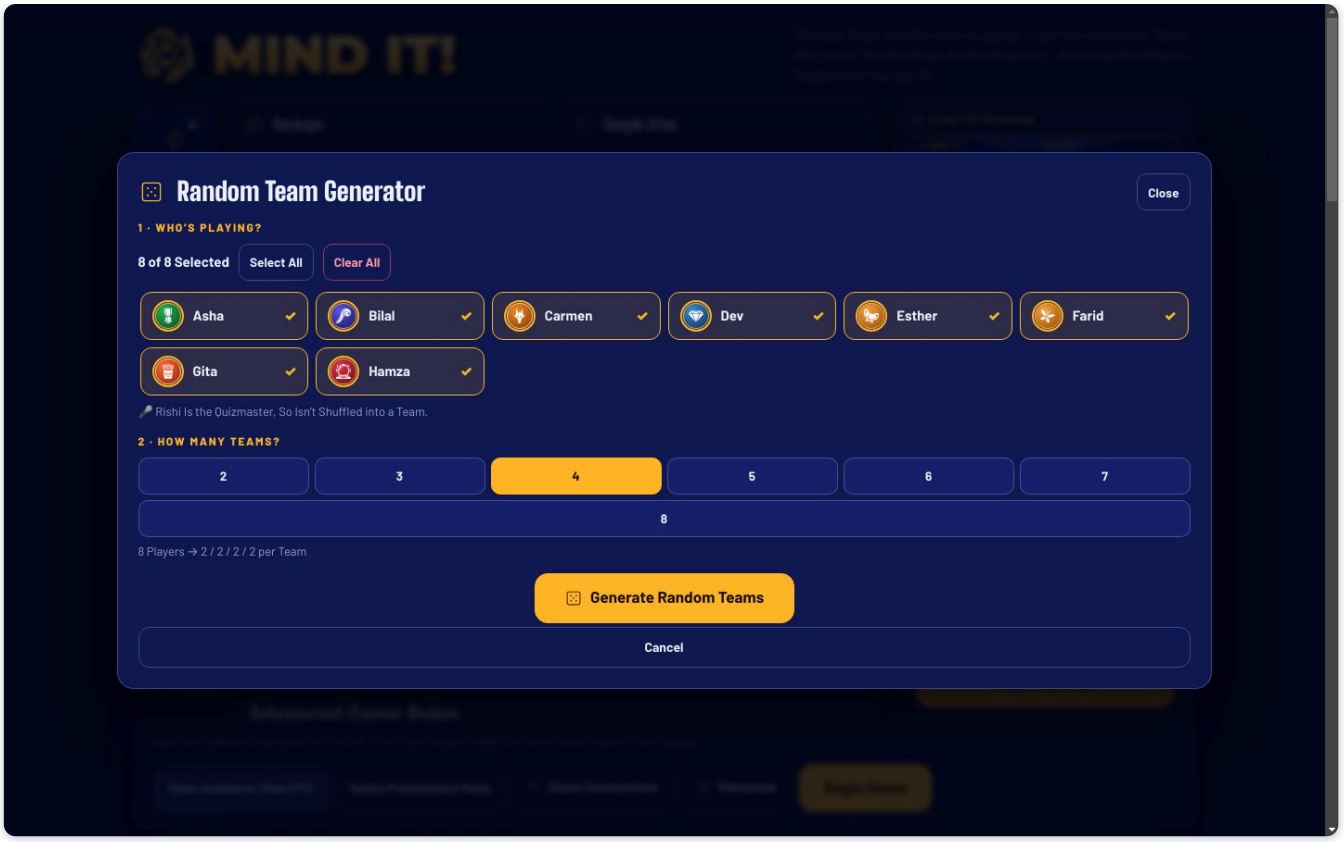
- **Number of teams:** 2–8 (default 4, named "Team 1–4" until you rename them). Mind It! needs at least 2 teams.
- ✎ on a team card: rename it, choose its **picture** or one of the built-in team icons.
- **+ Player** — add a person from the Player Database (or create one there and then).
- **Code XXXX** — the team's **4-letter phone code** (letters only, never shown on the TV). Codes are regenerated when a new game starts after one was played. A "New code" option exists if a code leaks (the old one then stops working).
- **A one-player team is that player:** it automatically uses the player's **name** and profile **picture**, and its name box is locked until a second player joins (then the team gets its old name back). A team with several players uses its own name and its own picture or icon. Every team always has a picture.
- **Rules Begin Game checks:** every team needs at least one player; nobody may be in two teams; a player who no longer exists can't be in a team; the Quizmaster can't be in a team.

7.4 Random teams

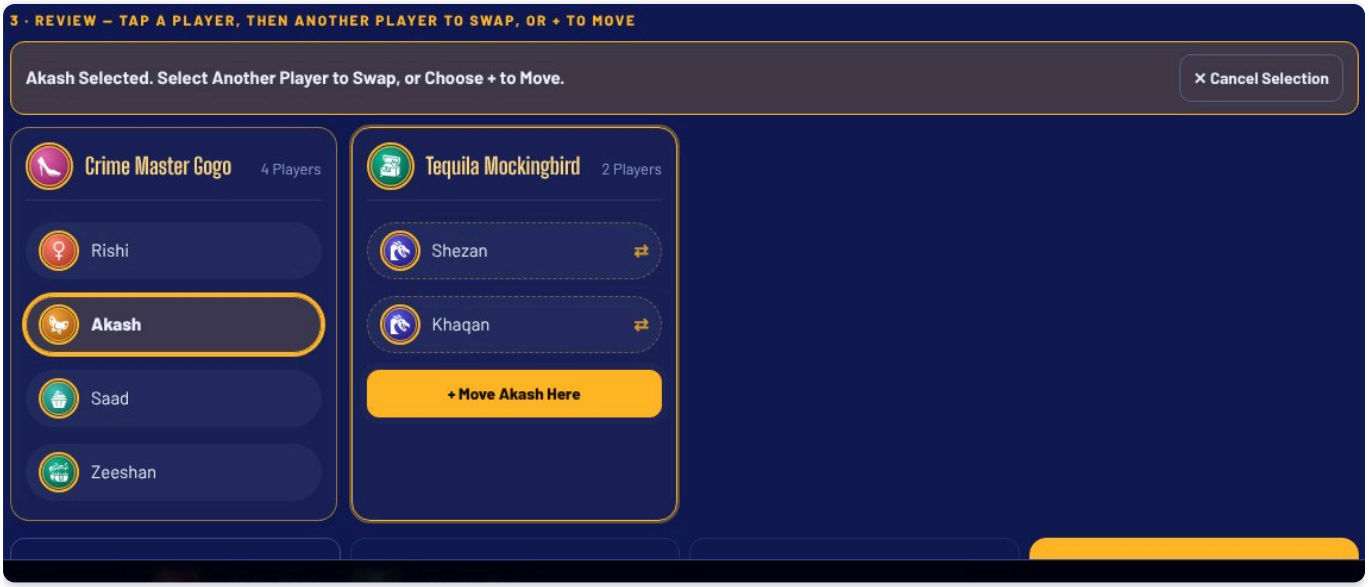
🎲 **Random Teams** opens the **Random Team Generator**: tick **who's playing**, choose **how many teams** (2–8, never more teams than players), and press 🎲 **Generate Random Teams**. Teams are split as evenly as possible (e.g. 11 players into 4 teams = 2/3/3/3). The Quizmaster is never shuffled into a team.

Balancing the teams by hand (build 120) — nothing is regenerated and nothing needs confirming until you're happy:

- **Swap:** tap a player (they light up), then tap a player on **another** team — the two change places. Tapping the same player again, or **✕ Cancel Selection**, cancels; tapping someone else on the **same** team just selects them instead.
- **Move:** tap a player, then **+ Move <name> here** on another team. The **+** glows on teams with fewer players. A team's only player can't be moved out (every team needs at least one) — swap instead.
- **↶ Undo Last Change** steps back through your swaps and moves; **⟲ Reset to Generated Teams** (asks first) puts the shuffle back.
- **✓ Confirm Teams** saves the teams exactly as they are on screen.



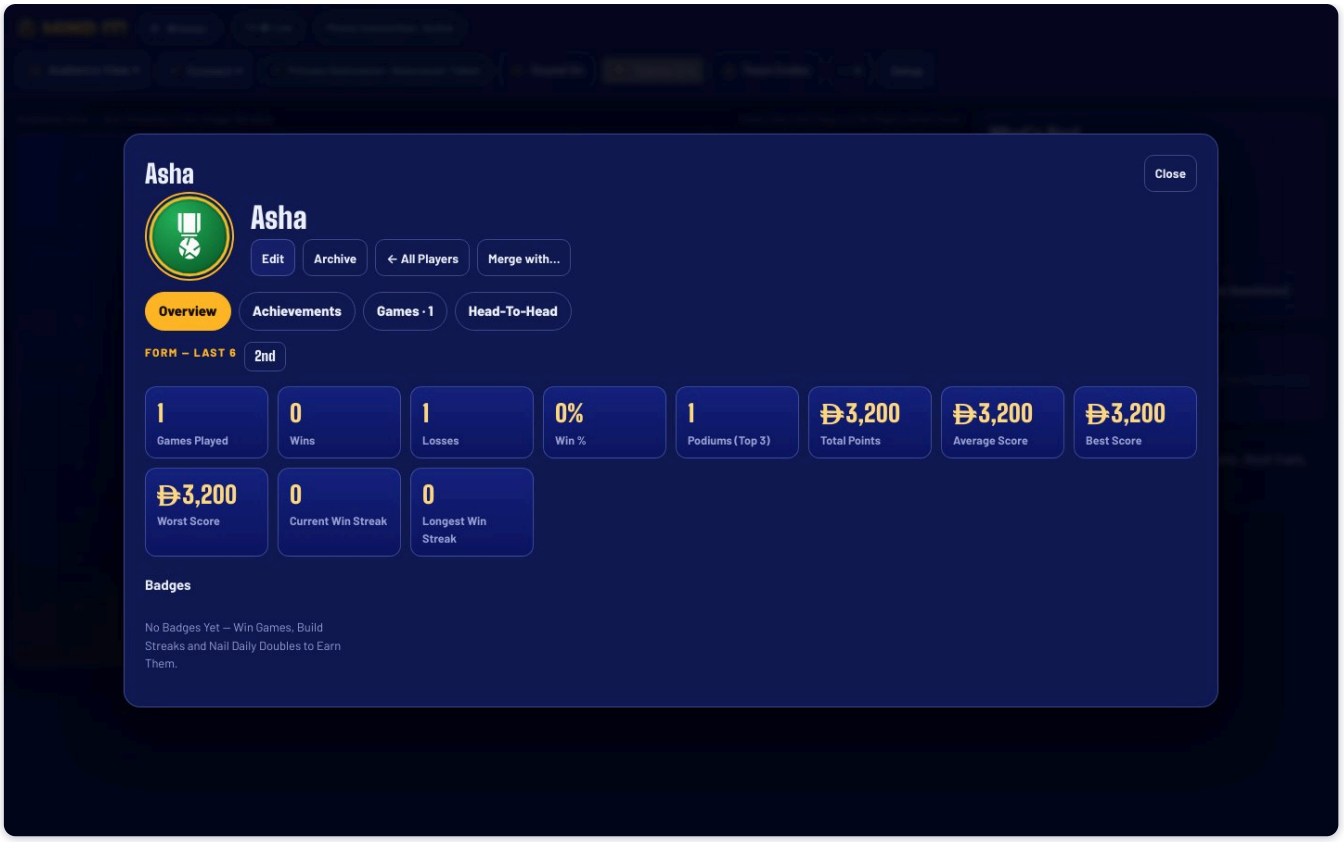
📸 Real screenshot — Random Team Generator: 8 players → 2 / 2 / 2 / 2 per team.



📸 Real screenshot (build 120) — Akash selected: ⇄ marks the players he can swap with, and "+ Move Akash Here" glows on the smaller team.

7.5 Player statistics and host statistics

Tap a player (or **Stats & History** on their card) to open their page: **Overview · Achievements · Games · Head-to-Head**, plus host statistics if they have hosted. Statistics are worked out from the saved game records, so they are always consistent with history.



📸 *Real screenshot — a player's page after one game.*

Player stats (🎮) and **host stats (🎤)** are kept separately. A game counts as *hosted* or *played* for a person — never both.

7.6 The Quizmaster rule — one person, one role

- **Exactly one Quizmaster per game**, chosen in **2 · Teams & Players → 🎤 Quizmaster → Host**.
- **The Quizmaster can't play in a team in the same game.** The Host list shows who is already playing ("Asha — Playing in Crime Master Gogo"), and says "The Quizmaster can't also play in a team."
- **Default Quizmaster:** every new game picks the (non-archived) player named **Rishi** when that profile exists; otherwise the last Quizmaster.
- **If Rishi wants to play:** press 🎮 **Rishi Wants to Play** (the button uses the current Quizmaster's name). You must **choose** a replacement Quizmaster — someone who isn't playing, or "+ New Person To Host". Nothing is swapped automatically.
- **If you pick someone who is playing** as Quizmaster, the app asks first, then removes them from their team.
- **If the Quizmaster is still in a team at Begin Game**, the game won't start; it offers a one-tap **Remove & Start**.
- Rishi's own profile is never deleted or changed by any of this.

✅ *Verified in the app's automated tests and in the setup screens shown above.*

---

8. Connecting Player Phones

Phones don't install anything. They open a web page served **by the laptop** over your Wi-Fi.

8.1 Step by step

1. **Show the QR code.** The easiest way: **the TV shows it** ("Scan to Join Your Team", with the link and "Then Type Your Team Code") from the moment the Audience View opens until Round 1 starts — at the bottom of the welcome screen, and in the top-right corner of *Tonight's Teams* so it never covers a team. (Switch: 5 · Audio & Presentation → *Show the Phone Join QR Code On the TV Before the Game*.) The same code is also in: - 📲 **Connect ▾ → 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams)** — opens 📱 **Team Phones — Join** with the code, the link and a 🔐 **Team Codes** button; - **Setup → 6 · Advanced → 5 · Phones & Live Wagers** (the join QR code and the **Join Link**, e.g. `http://192.168.1.20:8765/play`); - **More controls → Phones → Join Link & QR Code** during a game.

The TV also shows a QR code automatically whenever wagers are open ("Scan to enter your wager").

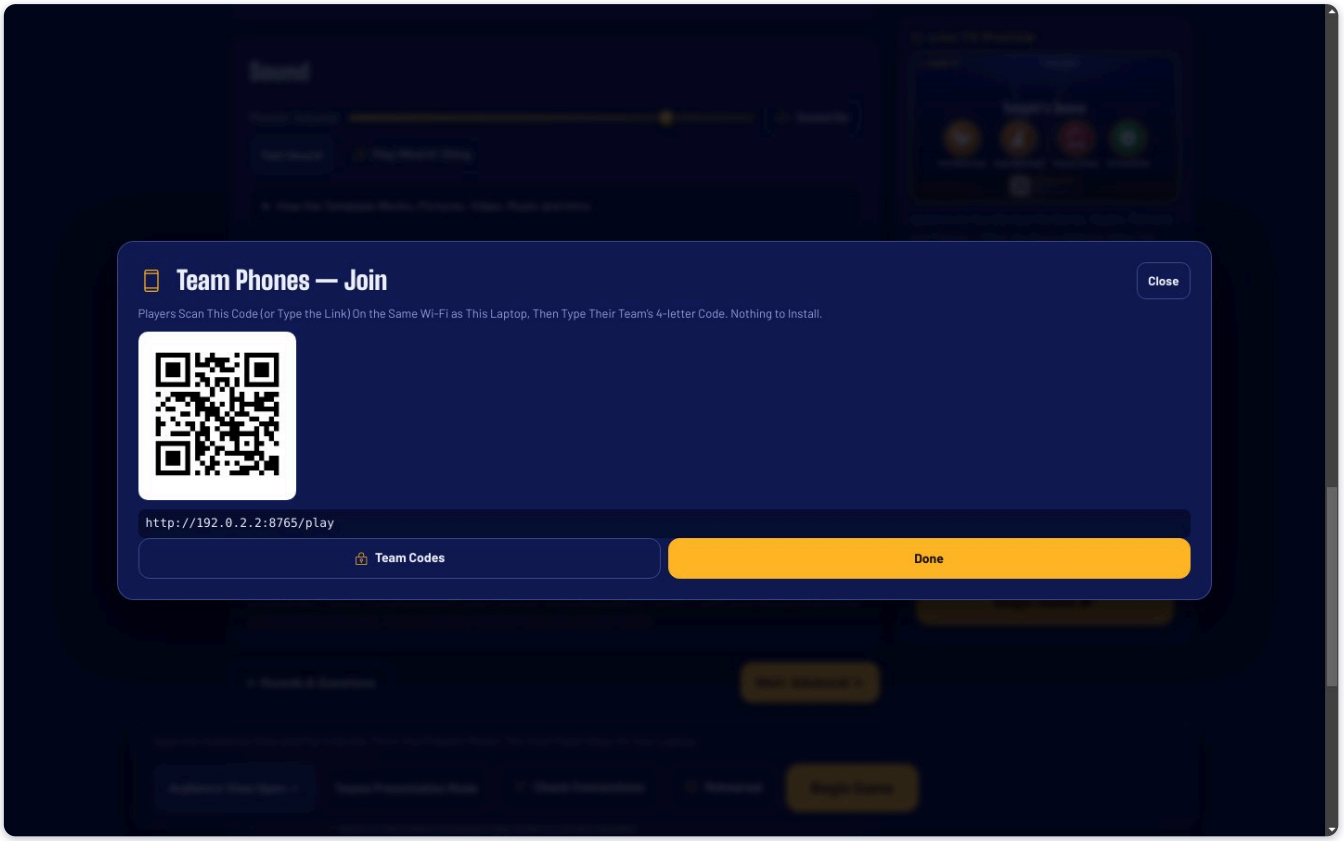


📸 *Real screenshot — the join QR code and link in Setup (6 · Advanced).*

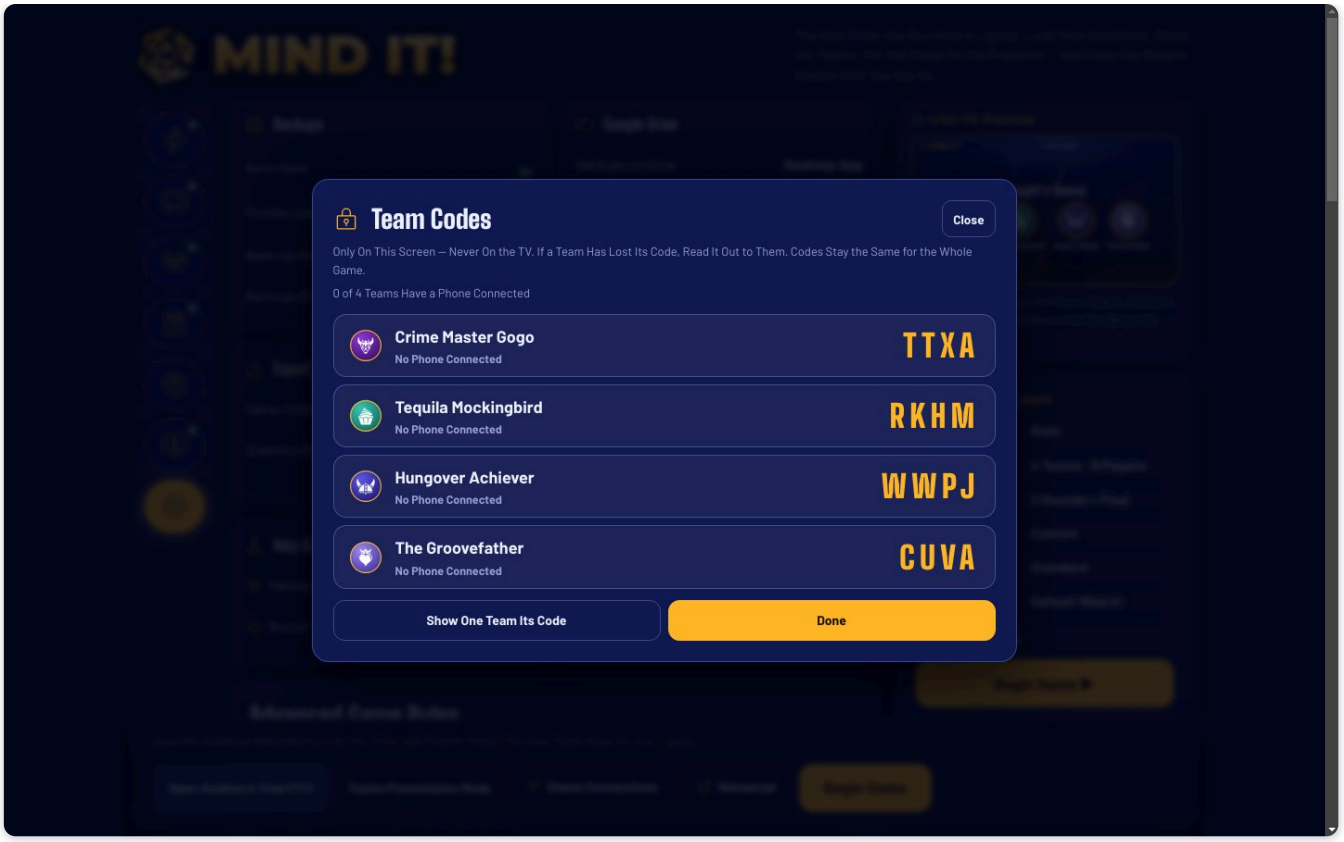
2. **Scan it.** iPhone: open the **Camera** and point it at the code, then tap the yellow link. Android: use the camera or Google Lens. (Or type the link into the browser.)
3. **The player page opens:** "Enter Your Team Code".
4. **Type the team's 4-letter code** and tap **Continue**. The Quizmaster reads codes from 🔐 **Team Codes** (top bar) — only on the host screen, never on the TV. **Show One Team Its Code** shows one team's code big enough to show them privately.
5. **You're in.** The phone shows the team name, its score and place ("=1st of 4"), and **Eyes On the TV**.
6. **Check it worked.** On the laptop, the top bar shows 📶 **Teams x/y** (connected teams) and 🔐 Team Codes shows "✓ Phone Connected" per team. Several phones per team are fine — the first phone to submit a wager "owns" it.



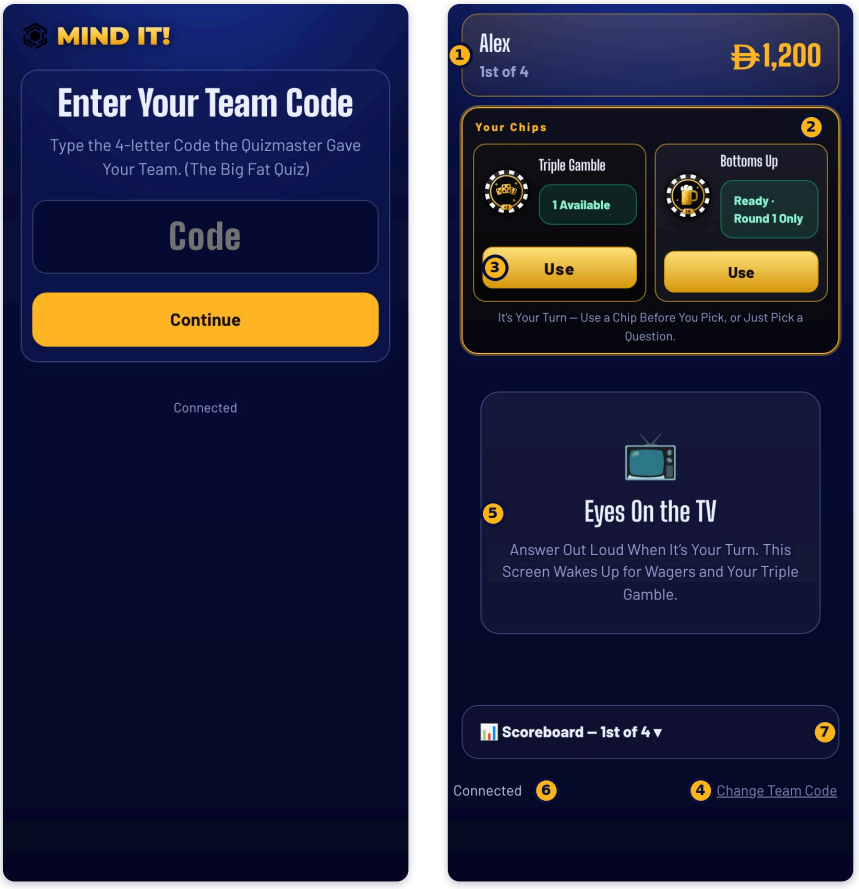
📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the TV on Tonight's Teams: the join code sits in the top-right corner so it never covers a team.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — 📲 Connect ▾ → 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams).*



📸 *Real screenshot — 🔐 Team Codes (host only).*



📸 *Real screenshots — joining (left) and a joined phone between questions (right).*

The joined phone, explained:

1. Team name, place and score.

2. **Your Chips** — the special chips the team still holds (Chapter 12).
3. **Use** — switch a chip on, *before* picking a question, on your own turn.
4. **Change Team Code** — signed into the wrong team? Tap this and type the right code. Since build 119 it sits at the bottom, beside the connection status.
5. **Eyes On the TV** — "Answer out loud when it's your turn. This screen wakes up for wagers and your Triple Gamble."
6. Connection status (see 8.4).
7. 📊 **Scoreboard** — tap to see all scores, with each team's correct answers (✓ 3) since build 113.

> ✅ **Fixed in build 112:** in build 111 the Devices button (then called *Phone Join Link / QR*) wrongly opened the Quizmaster's 📱 Phone Remote. It is now **Phone Join QR (for Teams)** and shows the players' join code. If you ever showed the old Phone Remote code to a room, open **Connect ▾ → Phone Remote** and press **New PIN (Disconnects Remotes)** or **Turn Remote Off**.

8.2 What phones are used for

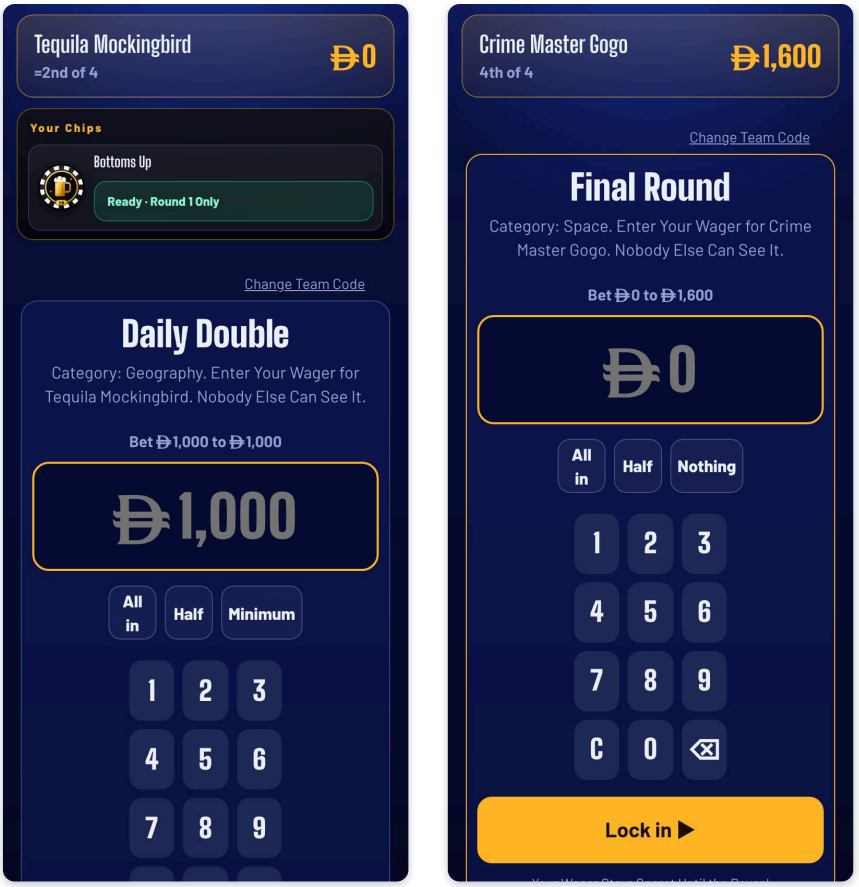
Phone job	When
Secret wagers	Daily Double (the team that found it) and the Final Round (every eligible team).
Special chips	Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up — on the team's own turn, before picking.
Buzzer	Only in **Phone Buzzer Mode**.
Final answer	Each team types and locks one answer in the Final Round — before time runs out (answers close 2 seconds after time's up, build 114).
Scores	Always — the team's score, place and the scoreboard.

Normal answers are spoken out loud. In Standard Mode the phone never shows the question or the answer.

📳 **Phones vibrate when they're needed** (build 114): when it becomes the team's turn to pick, and when its Daily Double or Final wager opens. 🟡 Android phones only — iPhones don't let web pages vibrate — and not tested on real phones.

8.3 Submitting a wager (the short version)

When it's time, the phone wakes up with a keypad: type the amount (or tap **All in / Half / Minimum** — in the Final: **All in / Half / Nothing**) and press **Lock in ▶**. It says **Wager Submitted ✓**. A locked wager can't be changed by the team — only the Quizmaster can change it (Chapter 18).



📸 *Real screenshots — a Daily Double wager (left) and a Final Round wager (right).*

8.4 Disconnections and reconnecting

- **Phones stay signed in.** If a phone locks, a player switches apps, or the laptop restarts, the phone reconnects by itself when it can. Nobody needs to re-type the code.
- When a phone is locked or in the background it tells the laptop and checks in less often (it saves battery); Connection Health shows it as **Asleep / In Background**. It wakes up when unlocked.
- A small status line appears only when there's a problem: **Connection Unstable** (amber), **Reconnecting to Host...** (amber), **Connection Lost — Retrying...** (red), then a brief green **Connected** when it's back. It never covers the screen once the phone has joined.
- **Wrong team?** Tap **Change Team Code**.

8.5 Phone troubleshooting

Problem	Android	iPhone
The QR code opens nothing	Use the camera app or Google Lens; or type the link into Chrome.	Use the Camera app (not a QR app with adverts); tap the yellow banner. Or type the link into Safari.
"This site can't be reached" / spins forever	Turn **mobile data off** and make sure the phone is on **the same Wi-Fi** as the laptop. Some phones switch to mobile data when the Wi-Fi "has no internet" — tap "Stay connected" / "Keep Wi-Fi".	Same Wi-Fi as the laptop; turn off **Private Relay** or any VPN; check *Settings → Wi-Fi → (network) → Limit IP Address Tracking* is off if it misbehaves.
Works for some phones, not others	Guest/hotel/office Wi-Fi often blocks devices from seeing each other. Turn on the **laptop's mobile hotspot** and have everyone join it.	Same.

Problem	Android	iPhone
"Team code rejected"	Check the code in 🔐 **Team Codes** (letters only, no zero/O confusion — codes only use the letters A C D E F H J K M N P R T U V W X Y).	Same.
The phone shows an old game	Pull down to refresh the page.	Pull down to refresh in Safari. Opened from a **home-screen icon** (8.6)? There's no refresh: swipe up to the app switcher, swipe Mind It! away, and tap the icon again.

🟡 Real iPhones and Android phones were not tested for this guide (they were simulated in a browser at phone size).

8.6 Mind It! on the home screen (iPhone and iPad) 🟡 — since build 126

A team phone, or the Quizmaster's 📱 Phone Remote, can have its own **Mind It! icon** on the home screen, so it opens like an app — full-screen, with no Safari address bar.

1. Start Mind It! on the laptop and join as usual (8.1): scan the QR code, so Safari opens the player page. For the Quizmaster: scan the 📱 **Phone Remote** code (Connect ▾ → Phone Remote).
2. In Safari tap **Share** (the square with an arrow) → **Add to Home Screen** (on newer iPhones it may be under ⋯ → **Share**). Leave **Open as Web App** on if it's offered.
3. The name is already **Mind It!** and the icon is the gold **M** logo. Tap **Add**.
4. Next time, tap the icon instead of scanning. The laptop must be running Mind It!, and the phone on the same Wi-Fi.

Good to know:

- **The first time you open the icon, type the team code again.** A home-screen app keeps its own sign-in, separate from Safari's.
- **The icon remembers the laptop's address.** On a different Wi-Fi (another house, the laptop's hotspot) the laptop usually gets a new address, so the icon won't connect. Scan the code again and add a new icon (delete the old one).
- **Phone Remote:** the icon also remembers the remote's PIN. After **New PIN (Disconnects Remotes)**, scan the new code and add the icon again.
- **No refresh button.** If it ever looks stuck, swipe it away in the app switcher and tap the icon again.
- **The screen locking pauses it.** It reconnects by itself when unlocked (8.4), but keep the phone awake during wagers and the Final.
- **Android phones:** Chrome's ⋮ → **Add to Home screen** gives the same icon. Because the laptop's address is a plain `http://` address, Chrome opens it as a normal tab, not full-screen.
- The webpage file (4.1c) can't do this. The icon must come from the laptop app's join or remote link.

🟡 Checked on the build machine with a phone-sized browser pretending to be an iPhone, not on a real iPhone or iPad. Try it once at home before a quiz night.

---

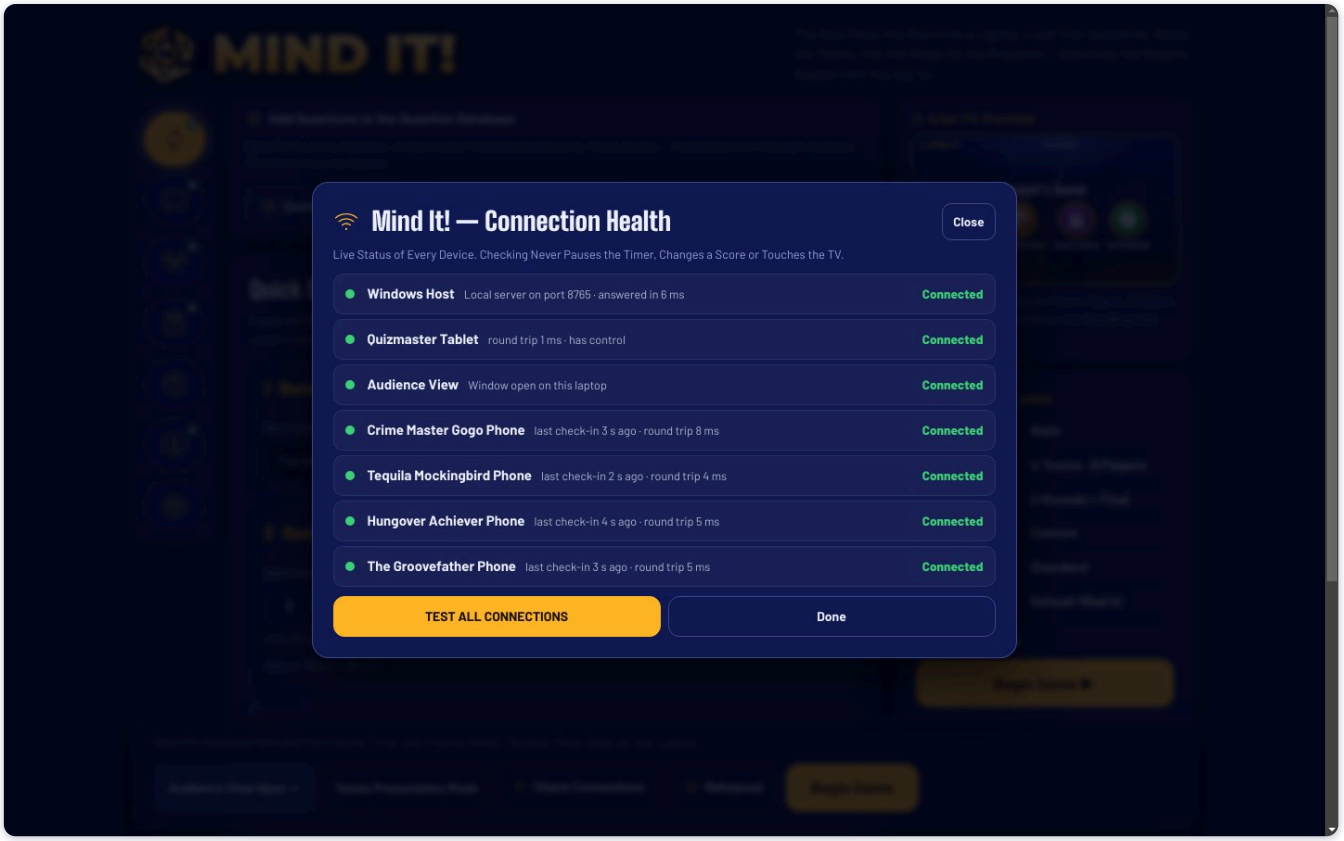
9. Connection Health and Pre-Game Checks ✅

9.1 Opening it

- In Setup: 📶 **Check Connections** (bottom bar).
- During a game: tap the 📶 **Teams x/y** chip in the top bar.
- On the tablet: its own connection sheet (tap the status at the top).

The window is called 📶 **Mind It! — Connection Health**. *Checking never pauses the timer, changes a score or touches the TV.*

9.2 What each line means



📸 *Real screenshot — everything connected (tablet, TV window and four phones).*

Line	What it checks	Typical detail
Windows Host	The laptop's own local server (port 8765).	"Local server on port 8765 · answered in 6 ms"
Quizmaster Tablet	The tablet's live link.	"round trip under 1 ms · has control"
Audience View	Whether the TV window is open on this laptop.	"Window open on this laptop" / "Not open"
<Team> Phone (one per team)	When that team's phone last checked in, and how fast.	"last check-in 2 s ago · round trip 8 ms"

Status words and colours:

Status	Colour	Meaning (phones)
Connected	🟢 green	Checked in within the last 4 seconds.

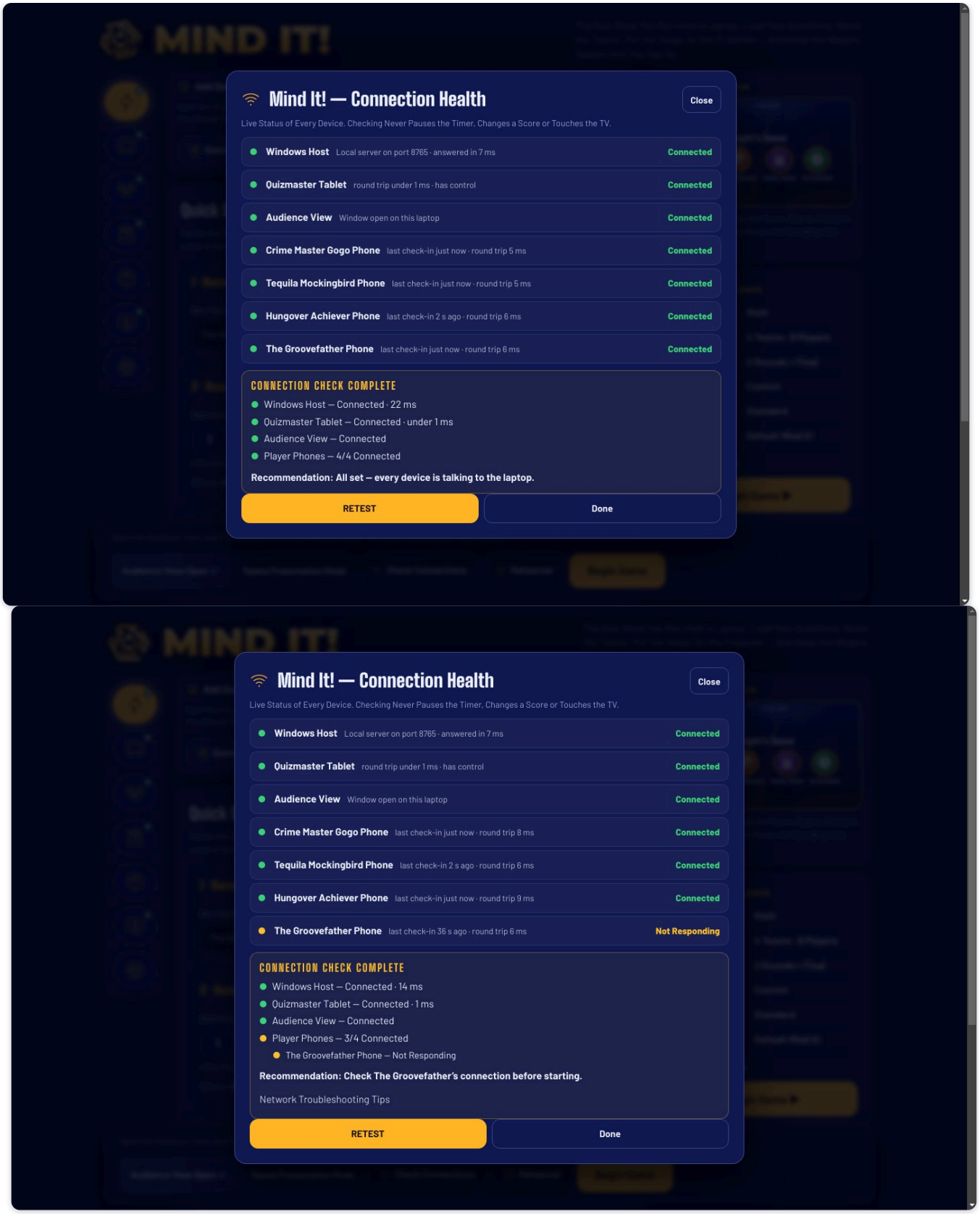
Status	Colour	Meaning (phones)
Unstable	🟠 amber	Last check-in 4–15 seconds ago.
Not Responding	🟠 amber	15–90 seconds ago.
Disconnected	🔴 red	More than 90 seconds ago (or the laptop's server isn't answering).
Asleep / In Background	grey	The phone is locked or the browser is in the background.
Not Yet Connected	grey	No phone has joined for this team.
Not Open / **Not Used**	grey	The TV window isn't open / phones and tablet need the laptop app.

The **round trip** in milliseconds is the latency (how long a message takes to go there and back). Under 100 ms is great; a few hundred is fine; seconds means a weak signal.

On the tablet the same list is a little simpler, so the tablet isn't redrawn every second just because a number changed: round trips are shown in bands (**under 100 ms**, **100–300 ms**, **300 ms – 1 s**, **over 1 s**), a connected phone says **last check-in just now**, and a phone that has dropped out says **less than a minute ago** (then minutes). The laptop's own Connection Health card shows the exact numbers.

9.3 TEST ALL CONNECTIONS

Press **TEST ALL CONNECTIONS**. For up to about 5 seconds every device is pinged ("the game carries on"). Then **CONNECTION CHECK COMPLETE** lists each device, and a **Recommendation**:



📸 *Real screenshots — all set (left: "Recommendation: All set — every device is talking to the laptop.") and a problem (right: one phone switched off — "Check The Groovefather's connection before starting.").*

Open **Network Troubleshooting Tips** for the built-in advice, then **RETEST**.

9.4 Fixing what it finds

- **Different Wi-Fi networks.** Every device must be on the *same* network as the laptop — not "Guest" on one and "Main" on another, and not the 5 GHz "-Ext" repeater of a different router.

- **Guest Wi-Fi / client isolation.** Many guest, hotel, office and café networks stop devices from talking to each other. Symptom: the laptop is fine, every phone fails. **Fix: turn on the laptop's mobile hotspot** (Windows Settings → Network & internet → Mobile hotspot) and join everything to it. The hotspot doesn't need internet.
- **VPN interference.** Turn off VPNs on the laptop, tablet and phones (including iPhone Private Relay).
- **Windows Firewall.** Mind It! must be allowed on **Private networks**. If you clicked "Cancel" on the first-run prompt: Windows Security → Firewall & network protection → Allow an app through firewall → tick *Mind It!* for Private. Also make sure your Wi-Fi is set to **Private**, not Public, in Windows.
- **Poor reception.** Keep the laptop and tablet near the router. Big halls: put the router (or the hotspot laptop) in the middle.
- **Laptop sleep.** Plug the laptop in. Mind It! keeps the screen awake during a game, but set Windows sleep to "Never" when plugged in to be safe.
- **Unresponsive phones.** Unlock it, bring the browser to the front, pull to refresh. Still dead? Close the tab and scan again — the team code is remembered.
- **Nothing connects at all?** Restart Mind It! on the laptop so its local server starts again (your game is autosaved — choose **Resume saved game**).

9.5 Internet vs local network — how to tell

Test	Result	What it means
The phone can open google.com but not the join link	Internet works, **local network doesn't**	Wrong network, guest isolation, VPN or firewall.
The phone can open the join link but not google.com	**Local network works**, no internet	Perfect for Mind It!. Nothing to fix.
Neither	The phone isn't really on that Wi-Fi	Reconnect the phone to the Wi-Fi (or the hotspot).

9.6 Reconnection warnings you might see

- **On the TV window:** an amber pill **"Reconnecting to Host..."** after 5 seconds without news from the host panel, a red **"Connection Lost — Retrying..."** after 20 seconds (or if the host window was closed), then a green **"Connected"** for 3 seconds. The board stays visible underneath. (Build 110 fixed the cause of most false "Reconnecting" messages: the host window is never slowed down by Windows any more.)
- **On the tablet:** "Connection Unstable", "Reconnecting to Host...", "Connection Lost — Retrying..." or "Laptop Not Responding — Retrying...". It retries by itself, quickly at first and then every few seconds. Buttons you press while it is offline are not lost silently — End Game, for example, is sent as soon as the connection is back.
- **On phones:** see 8.4.

PART FOUR — COMPLETE GAMEPLAY RULES

All rules in this part were read from the Mind It! 1.69 source code (build 112) and checked against the app's automated tests and the replayed example game in Chapter 17. Where the code and the project documents disagree, or the owner still has an open question, it says so (🔵).

10. Understanding the Game Board

10.1 The board on the TV (Audience View)

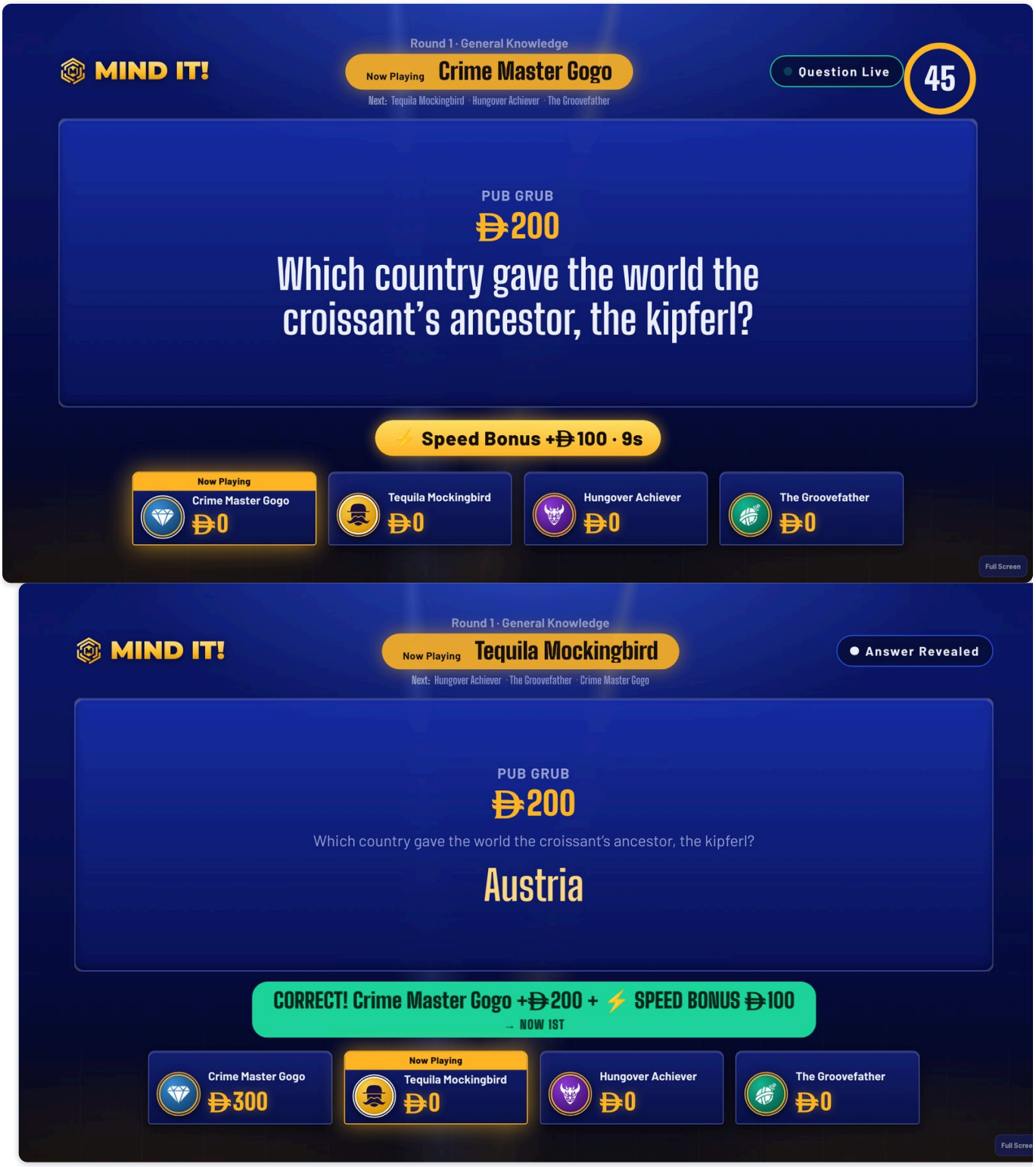


📸 *Real screenshot — the Round 1 board on the Audience View (1920 × 1080).*

1. **The Mind It! logo** (with the quiz name underneath when it's set).
2. **Round name and "Now Playing" banner** — whose turn it is, with **Next:** the teams after them, in order.
3. **Team score cards** — picture, name, score. The team whose turn it is has the gold **Now Playing** tab. Special-event marks appear here too: 🔥 streak flames, the Phoenix ember, the 👑 champion crown.
4. **Category headers** — six categories per round.
5. **Question values** — top row is easiest/cheapest, bottom row hardest/most valuable. A question that has been played disappears (the tile goes blank). Daily Doubles are hidden — they look like any other tile.
6. **Full Screen** button (the Audience View window's own button; it hides itself in full screen).

With 7–8 teams, the scores can move to a column on the right (setting: *TV Scoreboard Position*).

10.2 The question and answer screens



📸 Real screenshots — the question on the TV (left), and after a correct answer (right).

- **Category and value** above the question.
- **The ring timer** (top right) counts down from 45. A soft heartbeat plays in the last 10 seconds.
- **"Question Live"** pill while the question is open; **"Answer Revealed"** after it's answered or revealed.
- **⚡ Speed Bonus +100 · 9s** — the speed-bonus countdown under the question (only when it can still be earned).
- **Result banner** — e.g. **"CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +200 + ⚡ SPEED BONUS +100 — NOW 1ST"**, or **"WRONG ANSWER → HUNGOVER ACHIEVER'S TURN"**.
- **The answer** appears on the TV only after it is answered correctly or the Quizmaster presses **Reveal Answer**.

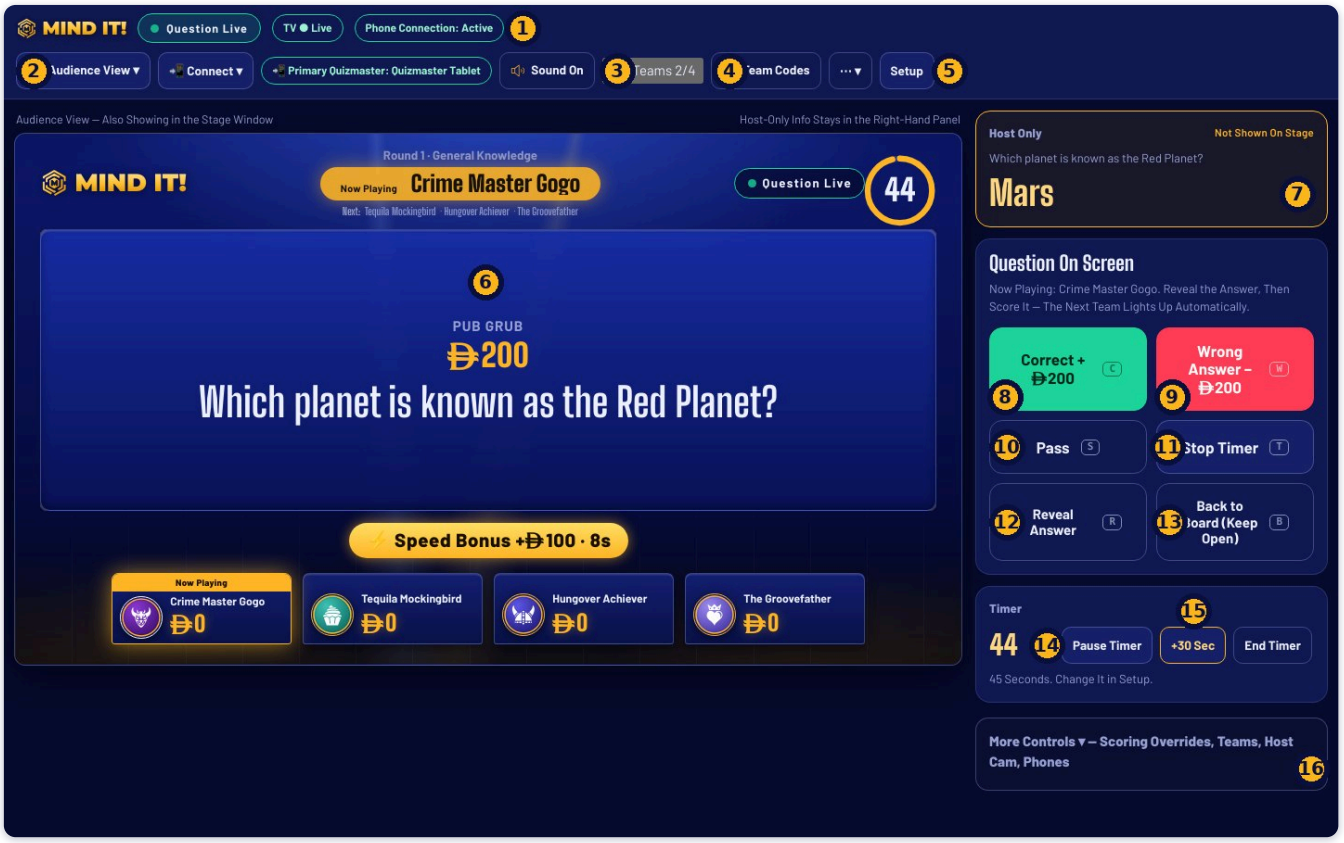
10.3 The board on the laptop (host panel)



📸 *Real screenshot — the laptop host panel with the board.*

1. **Top bar** — Audience View ▾, Connect ▾, tablet status, Sound, 📶 Teams, 🔐 Team Codes, ⋯ ▾, Setup (Chapter 15).
2. **Live copy of the Audience View** — exactly what the TV shows. **Click a value tile here to open that question** ("Tap a tile on the board preview to open it — the TV follows").
3. Team score cards (as on the TV).
4. Category headers.
5. Value tiles.
6. **NOW PICKING** — whose turn it is and the order after them.
7. **SCORES** — the live scoreboard.
8. **Round 1 · General Knowledge — Pick a Clue**: "30 Questions Left in This Round · Daily Doubles Hidden" and **Show Standings (P)**. Since build 118 this is one card (the screenshot shows the older layout, where the questions-left line was a card of its own).
9. 🎟️ **Team Chips — Use One for <team> ▾** (folded so you don't spoil anything; Chapter 12).
10. **More Controls ▾** — teams and turn order, adjust a score, Host Cam, phones, undo and resets.

10.4 The question on the laptop



📸 *Real screenshot — a question is live. The answer is only on the laptop (top right).*

1. Status pills: **Question Live**, **TV ● Live**, **Phone Connection: Active**.
2. **Audience View ▾ / Connect ▾** menus.
3. 📶 **Teams 2/4** — connected team phones; tap for Connection Health.
4. 🔐 **Team Codes**.
5. **Setup** (pauses the game).
6. The live TV copy (question, Now Playing, the ring timer, ⚡ Speed Bonus countdown).
7. **Host Only · Not Shown On Stage** — the question and **the answer**.
8. **Correct +200** (key **C**).
9. **Wrong Answer −200** (key **W**).
10. **Pass** (key **S**).
11. **Stop Timer** (key **T**).
12. **Reveal Answer** (key **R**).
13. **Back to Board (Keep Open)** (key **B**) — go back without scoring; the question stays open to pick again later.
14. **Pause Timer** (and End Timer).
15. **+30 Sec**.
16. **More Controls ▾**.

The tablet version of this screen is in Chapter 15.

---

11. Complete Scoring Rules

11.1 The big table

Situation	Score change	Example
Correct (normal question)	**+ value** (+ pass-on bonus) (+ speed bonus)	400 question → **+400**
Wrong (normal question)	**– value**; the same question goes to the next team with a **fresh full clock**	400 question → **–400**
Wrong, no penalty (key **X**)	**0**; the question goes on	—
Pass	**0**; the question goes on (timer: 30 s + time left, max 45 s)	—
Pass-on bonus	**+25% of the value per explicit pass** made earlier on this question	600 passed twice, then right → 600 + 300 = **+900**
Speed bonus	**+50% of the round's lowest value**, picking team only, within 10 s	200 right in 4 s (Round 1) → 200 + 100 = **+300**
Daily Double	**+ wager / – wager**	wager 1,000 → **+1,000** or **–1,000**
Triple Gamble	**+3× / –3× value**; on a Daily Double a **fixed 6×** wager	400 → **+1,200** or **–1,200**; DD 1,000 → **±6,000**
Phoenix	**+ max(value, min(2 × value + 20% of the gap, gap to leader))**; wrong = **0**	1,200 question, 3,000 behind → **+3,000**
Bottoms Up, wrong	Quizmaster decides: **✓ Finished → 0**, **× Not finished → – value**	800 → **0** or **–800**
Final Round	**+ wager / – wager** (wrong, no penalty → 0)	wager 1,000 → 2,400 becomes **3,400** or **1,400**
Adjust score	± any amount, with an optional reason (shown on the TV)	"+250 · Answer accepted on appeal"

Every score change is one entry in the game's **journal**, so **Undo** (key **U**) reverses exactly the last one — and, since build 112, puts back any chip that answer used (Chapter 12). Bonus amounts are rounded to the nearest point.

11.2 Correct answers ✅

The team gets the question's value, plus any bonus that applies. The TV shows "CORRECT! <team> +value", and "→ NOW 1ST ▲2" style news when their place changes.

> **Example.** Round 1, Crime Master Gogo picks Pub Grub 200 and answers in 4 seconds. 200 + speed bonus 100 = **+300**. Score: 0 → **300**.

11.3 Wrong answers and deductions ✅

The team **loses** the question's value. In normal turn order the **same question** goes to the next team (skipping teams marked Away), who gets a **fresh full clock** (45 s). A wrong answer itself never earns anyone a pass-on bonus.

> **Example.** Tequila Mockingbird gets Movie Quotes 400 wrong: **–400** (0 → –400). Hungover Achiever then answers it correctly: **+400** (0 → 400). No speed bonus for Hungover — they didn't pick it.

When every team that can still answer has tried, the question closes with **No One Got It — Close Clue**, no score.

11.4 Passing and "automatic passing" ✅

- **Pass** costs nothing. The question moves to the next team (not Away).
- **The passed-to team's timer** = **30 seconds + whatever was left, but never more than the question time (45 s).** Examples: 20 s left → 45 s (50 capped to 45). 8 s left → 38 s. After Time's Up (0 left) → 30 s.
- **"Automatic passing"** — Mind It! never passes on its own. When time runs out, the Quizmaster gets a ⏰ **Time's up for <team>** card with **WRONG ANSWER (–value)**, **PASS** or **Dismiss**. You decide.
- **Can't be passed:** Daily Doubles, Triple Gamble questions (including a Triple Gamble on a Daily Double). The Pass button disappears.
- Passing a **Phoenix** or **Bottoms Up** question uses up that chip with no chip bonus.

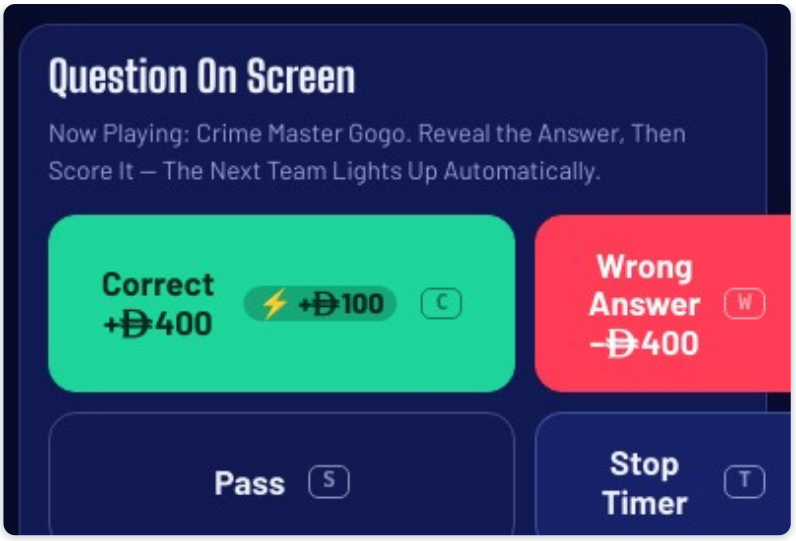
11.5 Pass-on bonus ✅

- **On by default** (Full Show, Family Night; off in Classic). **25% of the question's value for every explicit pass** made on that question before the correct answer. Two passes = 50%.
- Only **explicit Pass** presses count — a wrong answer never adds a bonus (but passes made earlier on the same question still count).
- Alternative setting: a **fixed number of points per pass** (default 100), or off.

What happened on a 500 question	Who scores	Bonus	Total
A passes, B right	B	1 pass × 25% = 125	**+625**
A passes, B passes, C right	C	2 × 25% = 250	**+750**
A passes, B wrong (–500), C right	C	1 pass (the wrong answer adds nothing) = 125	**+625**
A wrong (–500), B right	B	none	**+500**
Fixed 100 per pass: A passes, B passes, C right	C	2 × 100	**+700**

11.6 Speed bonus ✅

- **On** in Full Show (off in Classic and Family Night).
- **Amount: 50% of the lowest question value in the current round** — worked out live from the real values. THE BIG FAT QUIZ: Round 1 → **100**, Round 2 → **200**. (4-round quizzes: 125 / 250 / 375 / 500.)
- **Who:** only the team **whose turn it was** when the question opened (the "owner"), answering correctly **within 10 seconds** (setting *Answer Within*, 1–60 s) — measured from when the question first appeared to when Correct is pressed.
- **Never:** after a pass or a wrong answer; on Daily Doubles; on Triple Gambles.
- **It *is* added on top of a Phoenix answer, after the Phoenix cap** — so a fast Phoenix answer can finish slightly *ahead* of the leader. This is deliberate: the owner decided to keep it (October 2026).
- On the TV: "⚡ SPEED BONUS +100 · 7s" counts down under the question (only when it can still be earned — never on a Triple Gamble or a Daily Double); the result banner adds "+ ⚡ SPEED BONUS +100".
- On the laptop: while it can still be earned, the Correct button shows it — **Correct +200 ⚡ +100** — so you know what pressing it gives (build 113). The ⚡ part disappears by itself after 10 seconds.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — the laptop's Correct button while the speed bonus can still be earned.*

11.7 Daily Double scoring ✅ — see Chapter 12.1 for the full rules

Right **+wager**, wrong **−wager**. No pass, no pass-on bonus, no speed bonus.

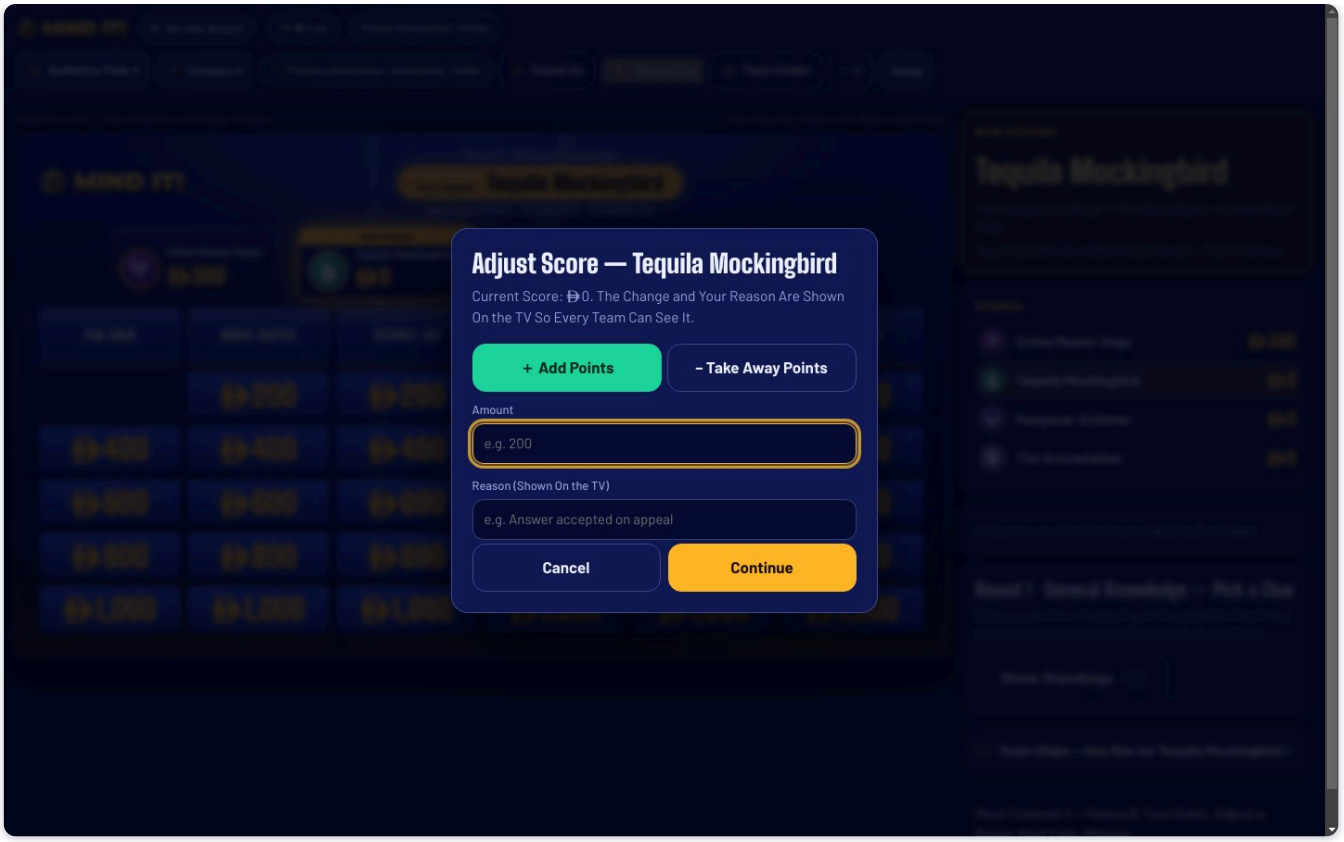
11.8 Negative scores ✅

Scores can go below zero. A team below zero:

- can still pick, answer and win points;
- on a Daily Double may still wager from the question's value up to 1,000 (the low-score cap) — see 12.1;
- **sits out the Final Round** (you need 0 or more to play the Final; a team on exactly 0 can play but can only wager 0).

11.9 Manual score adjustments ✅

More Controls ▾ → Adjust Score next to a team (or **± Adjust Score** on the tablet). On the tablet, what you type stays put even if the laptop changes the scores while you're typing (since build 125).



📸 *Real screenshot — Adjust Score.*

Choose **+ Add Points** or **– Take Away Points**, type the **Amount** (any whole number above 0, up to 9 digits) and an optional **Reason (shown on the TV)** (up to 80 characters), then **Continue**. The TV shows a banner for about 7 seconds, e.g. "SCORE ADJUSTMENT · Tequila Mockingbird +250 · Answer accepted on appeal · New score 250". Adjustments are journal entries — **Undo** reverses them — and they never trigger achievements.

11.10 How bonuses and powers combine

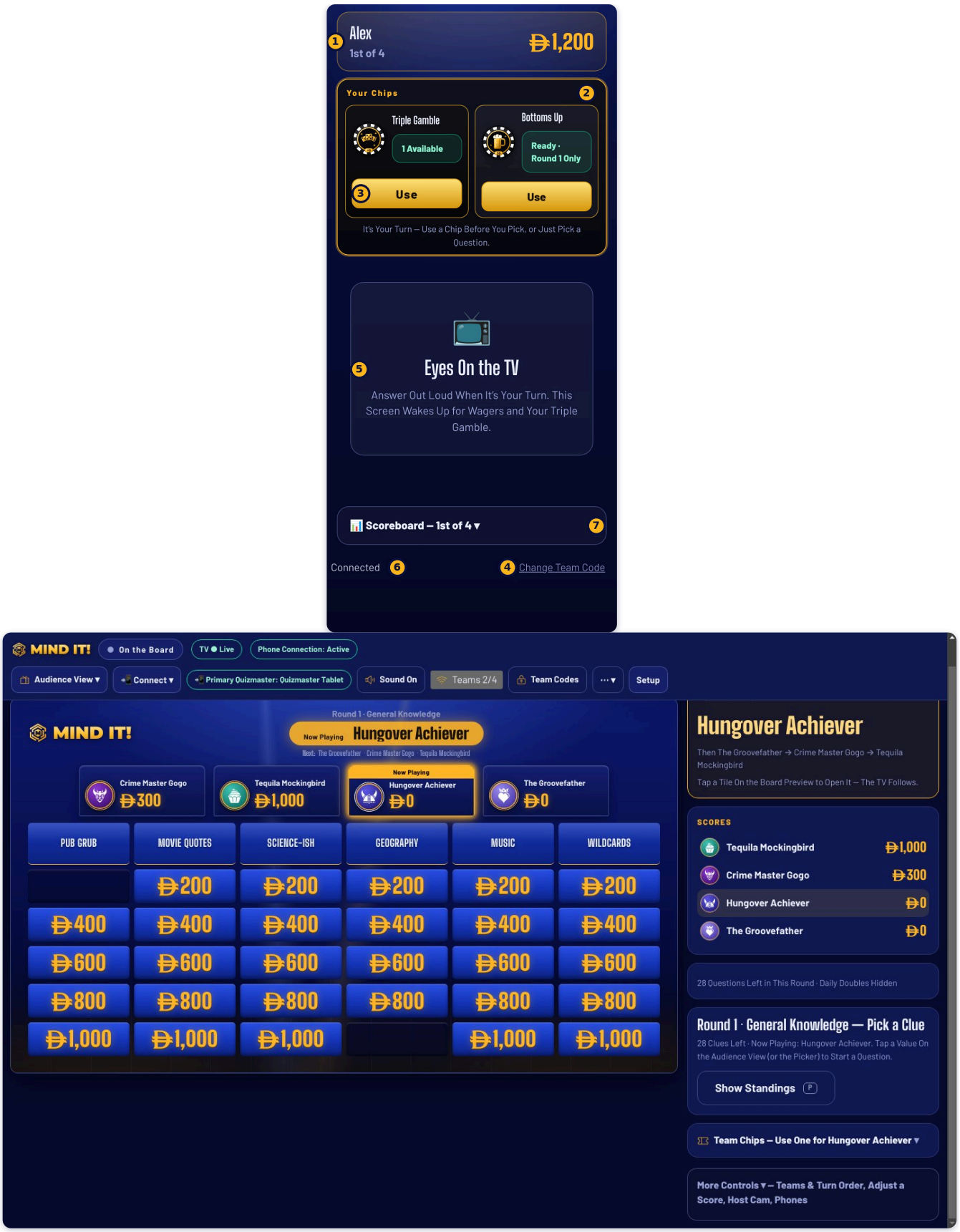
Combination	Allowed?	What happens
Pass-on bonus + speed bonus	Can't happen	Speed bonus is for the picking team only, and never after a pass.
Speed bonus on a Daily Double	No	—
Pass-on bonus on a Daily Double	No	DDs can't be passed.
Triple Gamble + speed / pass-on bonus	No	Neither applies.
Triple Gamble on a Daily Double	**Yes**	Becomes a fixed **6×** wager, starts straight away.
Phoenix on a Daily Double pick	No	The chip **isn't used** — it stays ready for the team's next pick.
Bottoms Up on a Daily Double pick	No	The chip **isn't used** — it stays ready.
Phoenix + speed bonus	**Yes**	Speed bonus added after the cap (kept on purpose).
Two chips on one question	**No**	While any chip is on, the other chips' **Use** buttons are hidden.
Chips in Phone Buzzer Mode	No	Chips need Standard Mode. The Phoenix isn't even handed out in Buzzer Mode.
Chips in the Final Round	No	All chips are hidden in the Final.

12. Every Special Ability — Complete Guide

Mind It! 1.69 has exactly **one board surprise** (the **Daily Double**) and **three chips** (**Triple Gamble**, **Phoenix**, **Bottoms Up**), plus three **bonuses** (speed, pass-on, and the **True Daily Double** moment). There are no other powers — ideas like Steal, Shield or Double Down chips were never built (Appendix A).

Shared chip rules ✅

- Chips need **Standard Mode**, the **laptop app** (its local server) and normally **team phones**. They are never available during Setup, in Phone Buzzer Mode, or in the Final Round. In Phone Buzzer Mode the Phoenix isn't handed out or announced at all (an unused one is put away if you switch to Buzzer Mode mid-game).
- **One chip per question.** While a chip is switched on, the other chips can't be used.
- **Teams use chips on their phone, on their own turn, before picking.**
- **Quizmaster override:** on the laptop's folded 🎟 **Team Chips** card (and on the tablet), the Quizmaster can **Use for <team>** (e.g. a team's phone is flat) or **Switch off** a chip before the pick — the team keeps it.
- On phones, a used chip shows **Used** for the rest of that round, then disappears.
- **Undo gives the chip back ✅** (build 112). Undoing a chip question's score puts every chip back exactly as it was before that answer: mark the question again and the chip still applies (Triple Gamble still ×3, Phoenix still capped at the leader, Bottoms Up back to before the wrong answer). If you undo every score of a chip question, the chip is back with the team, switched on for its pick. This works within the current round.



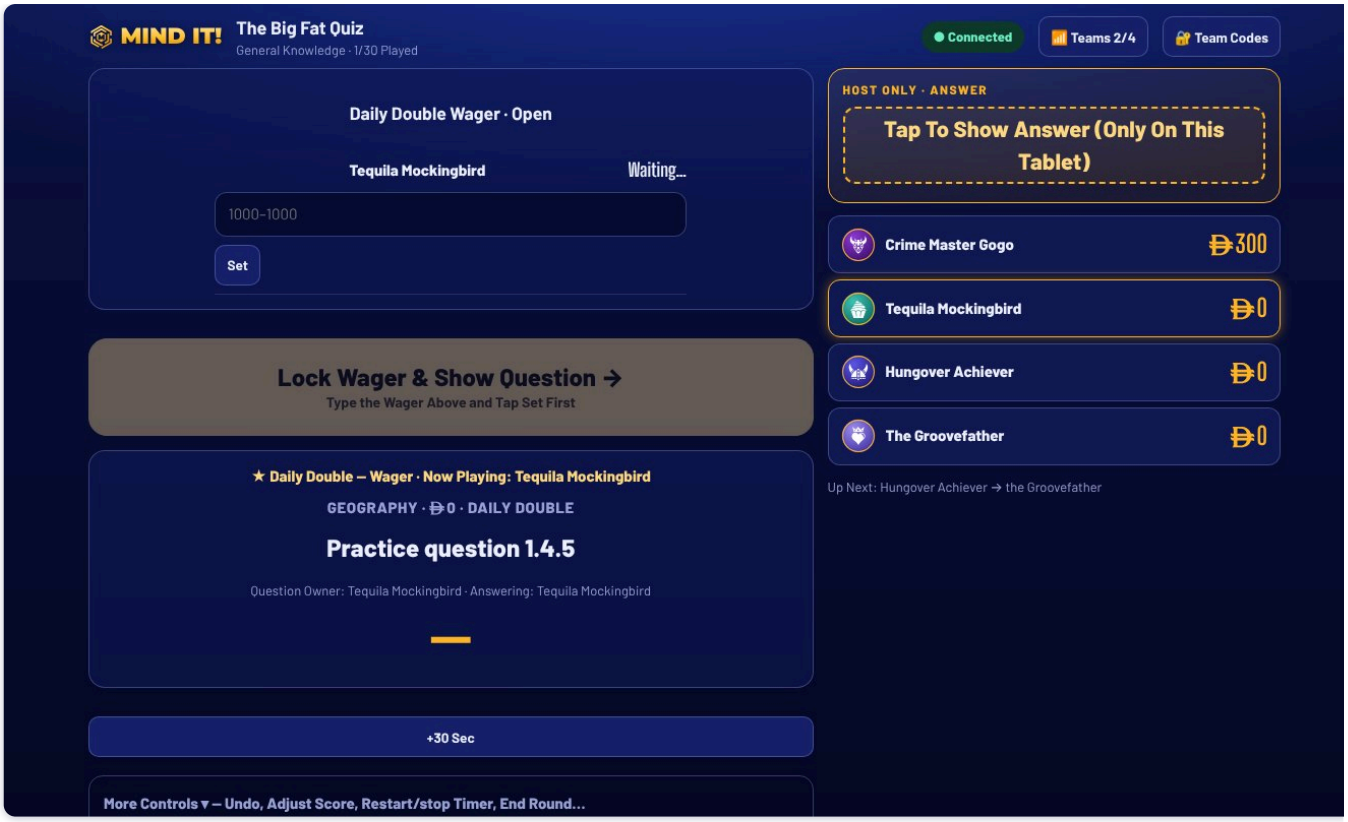
💣 Real screenshots — the phone chips (left) and the laptop's Team Chips card unfolded (right: "Triple Gamble · Ready · Use for Hungover Achiever", "Bottoms Up · Ready · Use for Hungover Achiever").

12.1 💰 Daily Double

Purpose	A hidden tile where the picking team bets on itself.

Who activates	Nobody — it's found by picking the tile.
When	Any time its tile is picked.
How many	Per round: **1 · 2 · 2 · 3** (Rounds 1–4); none in the Final. Change the count in 4 · Rounds & Questions (0 = none).
Placement	**At random on the top two values of a category** (spread one per category before any category gets two), fixed for the whole round (reset round, undo and reload don't move them). Or "I'll pick them before the round", or "Use the clues marked DD".
Confirmation	The wager must be locked: by the team's phone (starts the question automatically) or by the Quizmaster (**Lock Wager & Show Question**, greyed until a wager is set).
Cancel?	No. The Quizmaster can **change** the wager until the question is scored (laptop or tablet); the phone shows "Changed by host".
Wager	**Minimum = the question's value. Maximum = the biggest of: the team's score, 1,000 (the low-score cap), the question's value.** Quick picks: **All in / Half / Minimum**.
Correct	**+ wager**
Wrong	**– wager**, and the question ends (nobody else answers).
Passing	Not allowed. "🔒 DAILY DOUBLE — only <team> can answer".
Other abilities	Triple Gamble turns it into a 6× wager; Phoenix and Bottoms Up stay unused. No speed or pass-on bonus.
Phone	"Daily Double — Category: Geography. Enter your wager for <team>. Nobody else can see it." with the allowed range, a keypad and **Lock in**.
Quizmaster	"★ Daily Double — Wager" panel with the range, a wager box and **Lock Wager & Show Question**, plus the answer.
Audience View	A "Daily Double!" splash with the category and "<team> plays alone · no passing", a QR code to enter the wager, then "<team> has locked in a wager". The amount stays **sealed** until the answer is scored (Family Night shows it; setting *Daily Double Wager On Screen*).


Daily Double!
GEOGRAPHY
The Groovefather Plays Alone · No Passing
Full Screen
MIND IT!
Team Is Wagering
TV Live
Phone Connection: Active
Audience View
Connect
Primary Quizmaster: Quizmaster Tablet
Sound On
Teams 2/4
Team Codes
Setup
Audience View — Also Showing in the Stage Window
Host-Only Info Stays in the Right-Hand Panel
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Daily Double
Tequila Mockingbird
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
The Groovefather
Ð0
Daily Double!
GEOGRAPHY — Tequila Mockingbird Is in Control
Minimum Wager Ð1,000
Deciding...
Scan to Enter Your Wager
192.0.2.2:8765/play
Tequila Mockingbird: Scan the Code, Enter Your Wager and Show the Quizmaster Your Sealed Code
★ Daily Double — Wager
Tequila Mockingbird Tells You Its Wager (Ð1,000 to Ð1,000). Type It Below, Then Lock It in to Show the Question.
Daily Double Wager
Waiting for Tequila Mockingbird's Sealed Code — The Question Appears as Soon as a Valid Code Is Entered.
Tequila Mockingbird May Wager Ð1,000 (the Question's Value) Up to Ð1,000.
Wager Amount
Show
Minimum Ð1,000
Maximum Ð1,000
Lock Wager & Show Question
Hide Amounts
Host Only
Not Shown On Stage
Practice question 1.4.5
Practice answer
Undo & Resets
Undo Last Score
End Round Early
Reset Question
Reset Round
Reset Game
PUB GRUB Ð200 — Crime Master Gogo Correct (+ Speed Bonus



📸 *Real screenshots — Daily Double on the TV, the laptop and the tablet.*

Numbers:

Team score	Tile	Allowed wager
0	1,000	1,000 – 1,000 (the Groovefather in Chapter 17)
0	400	400 – 1,000
3,000	800	800 – 3,000
–600	600	600 – 1,000

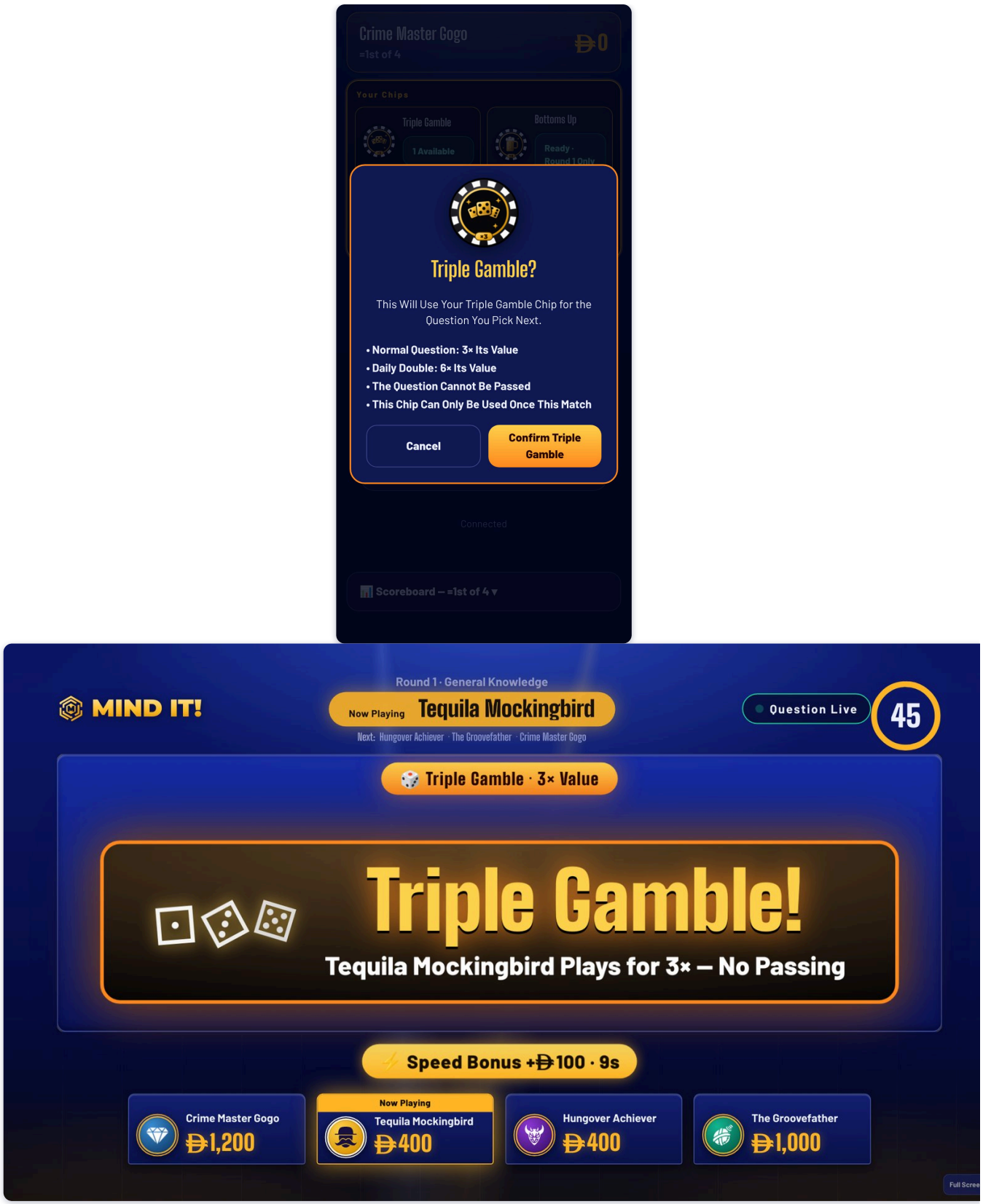
True Daily Double ✅: if a team with a score above 0 wagers **its whole score or more**, the TV plays a special "TRUE DAILY DOUBLE!" moment (rule switch, on in every preset). The scoring is unchanged: right doubles their score, wrong drops it to zero (or below if they bet more than their score). Achievement 🔥 True Daily Double Hero.

Tips: behind? Bet big. Ahead with little to gain? Bet the minimum. **Common mistake:** the Quizmaster forgetting to lock the wager — the question won't show until it's locked.

12.2 🎲 Triple Gamble (chip)

Purpose	Triple the stakes on one question.
Rule switch	On in Full Show; off in Classic and Family Night.
Who activates	The team, on its phone (**Use** → confirm). The Quizmaster can **Use for <team>** or **Switch off**.
When	On the team's own turn, **before picking**. Standard Mode only. Not in Rehearsal.
How many	**Once per team per game.** Every new game gives it back.

Confirmation	Yes — a phone screen "Triple Gamble?" lists the rules; **Confirm Triple Gamble** or **Cancel**. Then "Triple Gamble Active — now pick your question".
Cancel	**Cancel** on the confirm screen; after that only the Quizmaster can **Switch off** (before the pick) — the team keeps the chip.
Correct	**+3 × value** (on a Daily Double: **+6 × value**).
Wrong	**−3 × value** (DD: **−6 ×**). The question **ends** — it is never passed on. The next pick goes to the team after the gambler.
Passing	Not allowed. No pass-on bonus, no speed bonus. Time's up is handled like a Daily Double (no Time's-up card).
Wagering	On a Daily Double the chip **replaces** the normal wager with a fixed 6× value, and the question starts straight away.
Compatibility	Not with another chip. Works on DDs (6×).
Phone	Chip card "Triple Gamble · 1 Available · Use", then the confirm screen, then "Triple Gamble Active".
Quizmaster	The 🎟️ Team Chips card ("Use for…", "Switch off"); the score buttons show the tripled amount.
Audience View	Nothing until the question is picked (no spoilers), then a ~3-second **dice moment**: "Triple Gamble! <team> plays for 3× — no passing", and a "🎲 Triple Gamble · 3× Value" label on the question.
After the game	A "🎲 Triple Gamble Chips" summary (who gambled, who saved their chip). Achievements 🎲 Triple Threat, 💎 High Roller (6× DD right), ♠️ All In (used on the highest value available). Milestone 🎰 Gamble Master.



Real screenshots — the phone confirm screen and the TV dice moment.

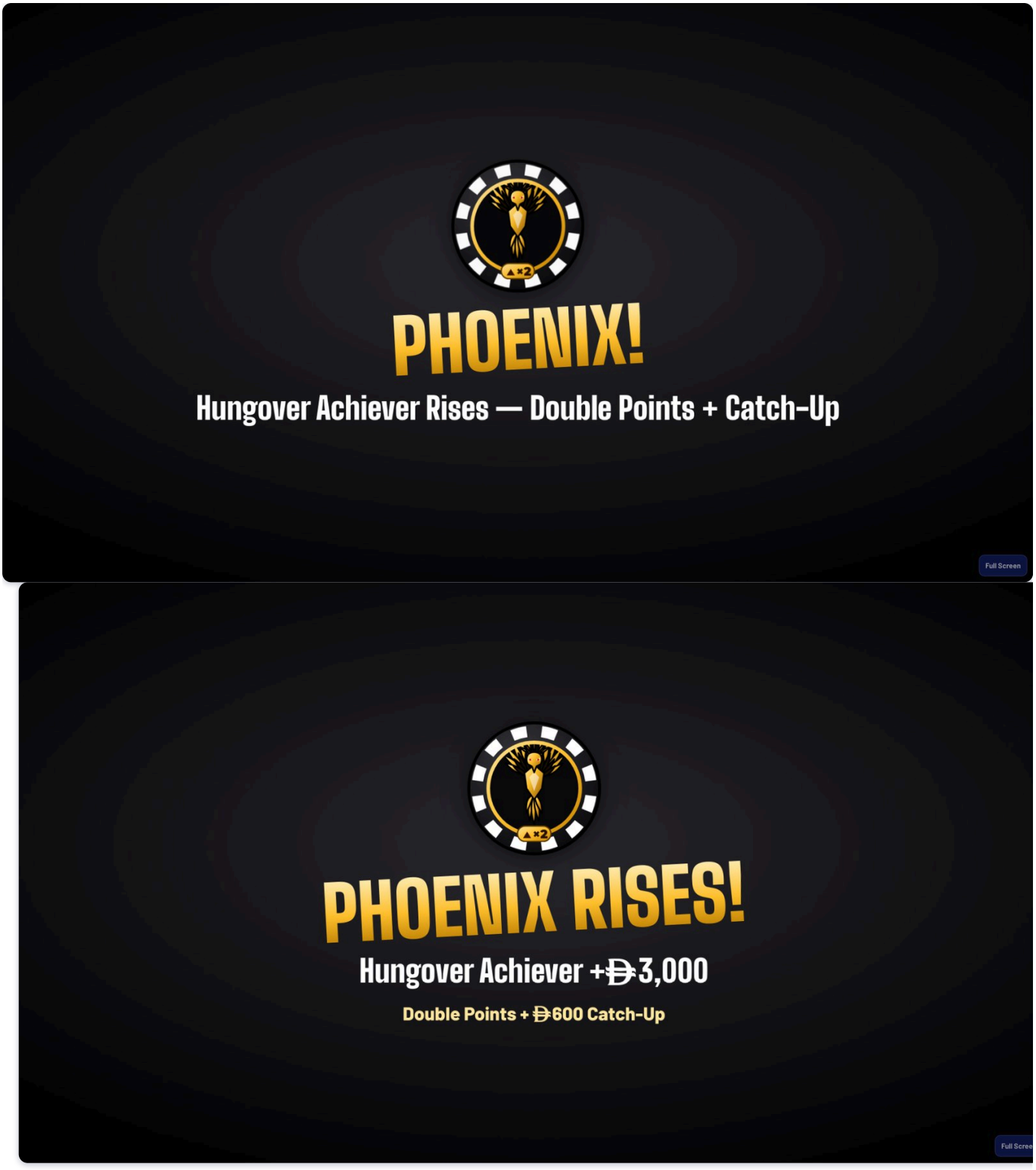
Numbers: Tequila Mockingbird (400 points) plays Triple Gamble on Wildcards 400: right → 400 × 3 = **+1,200** → **1,600**. Wrong would have been **–1,200** → **–800**. On a 1,000 Daily Double: **±6,000**.

Tips: use it on a category you own, on a mid-value question; a Triple Gamble on a Daily Double is the biggest swing in the game. **Common mistakes:** pressing Use *after* picking (too late — it's for the next pick); forgetting that a wrong answer can't be rescued by passing.

✅ Fixed in build 112: the "⚡ Speed Bonus" countdown is no longer shown under a Triple Gamble question (on the TV, the laptop and the tablet), because a Triple Gamble can never earn one. *(The screenshot above is from build 111 and still shows it.)*

12.3 🔥 Phoenix (chip)

Purpose	A catch-up power for a team that's far behind.
Rule switch	On in Full Show and Family Night; off in Classic.
Who gets it	Handed out at the **start of Rounds 2, 3 and 4** (never Round 1, never the Final) to **each team tied for last place** that hasn't used one — **only if it is more than 2,000 points behind the leader** (exactly 2,000 doesn't count). If every last-place team has already used theirs, the second-lowest team(s) get it (if more than 2,000 behind). If the last-place team is too close, **nobody** gets it. Nobody gets it if all teams are level.
Who activates	The holder, on its phone, on its own turn, before picking; or the Quizmaster ("Use for…").
How many	**Once per team per game** ("used" means played on a question — right, wrong or passed). Unused chips **expire** when the next round starts (and at the Final). A team never holds two.
Correct	**+ max(value , min(2 × value + catch-up , gap to the leader))**, where **catch-up = 20% of the gap to the leader** (measured when answering, rounded to the nearest 5). It draws level with the leader but **never passes them**, and it's **never less than the normal value**. Booked as one score entry.
Wrong	**Nothing lost** — and the question still passes on as normal.
Passing	Passing uses up the chip with no bonus.
Daily Double	Not used on a DD — "The Phoenix chip doesn't work on a Daily Double — it stays ready".
Compatibility	Never with another chip. Not in Phone Buzzer Mode — there it isn't handed out or announced at all.
Phone	A Phoenix chip card with **Use** ("A boost for the team that needs it most… If you're wrong you lose nothing. Each team can use the Phoenix once per game, and never in the Final Round.")
Quizmaster	The Team Chips card; the Correct button shows the real (capped) amount.
Audience View	"THE PHOENIX IS LIVE — <team> holds the Phoenix chip this round" after the round's board animation; a flickering 🔥 ember on the holder's score card (Phoenix holders are **public** by design); "PHOENIX! <team> rises — double points + catch-up" when used; "PHOENIX RISES! +3,000 · Double points + 600 catch-up" (or "… level with the leader — the Phoenix can't take you past").
Achievements	🔥 Rise From The Ashes (used it and won), 🚀 Phoenix Climber (climbed 2+ places in that round; called "Comeback Kid" before build 113).



📸 *Real screenshots — "PHOENIX!" and "PHOENIX RISES! Hungover Achiever +3,000 · Double Points + 600 Catch-Up".*

Numbers (all recalculated):

Holder	Leader	Gap	Tile	2 × tile + 20% gap	Capped at gap	Result
–600	2,400	3,000	1,200	2,400 + 600 = 3,000	3,000	**+3,000** → 2,400 (level) — *Chapter 17*
2,000	9,000	7,000	3,750	7,500 + 1,400 = 8,900	7,000	**+7,000** → 9,000 (level)
500	3,000	2,500	400	800 + 500 = 1,300	1,300	**+1,300** → 1,800
1,700	2,000	300*	2,000	4,000 + 60 = 4,060	300	max(2,000, 300) = **+2,000** → 3,700

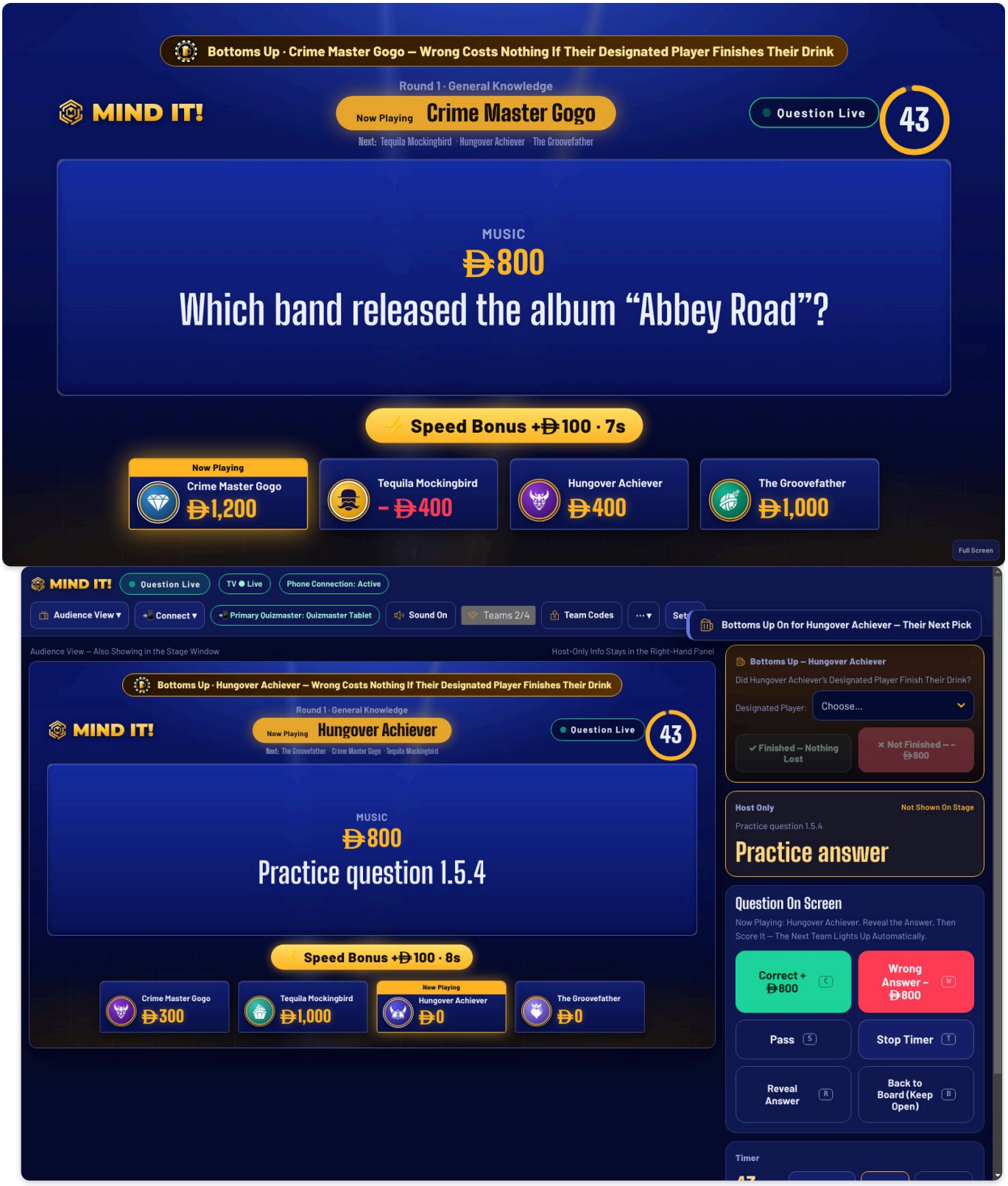
*The gap is measured when answering — it can shrink during the round after the chip was handed out.

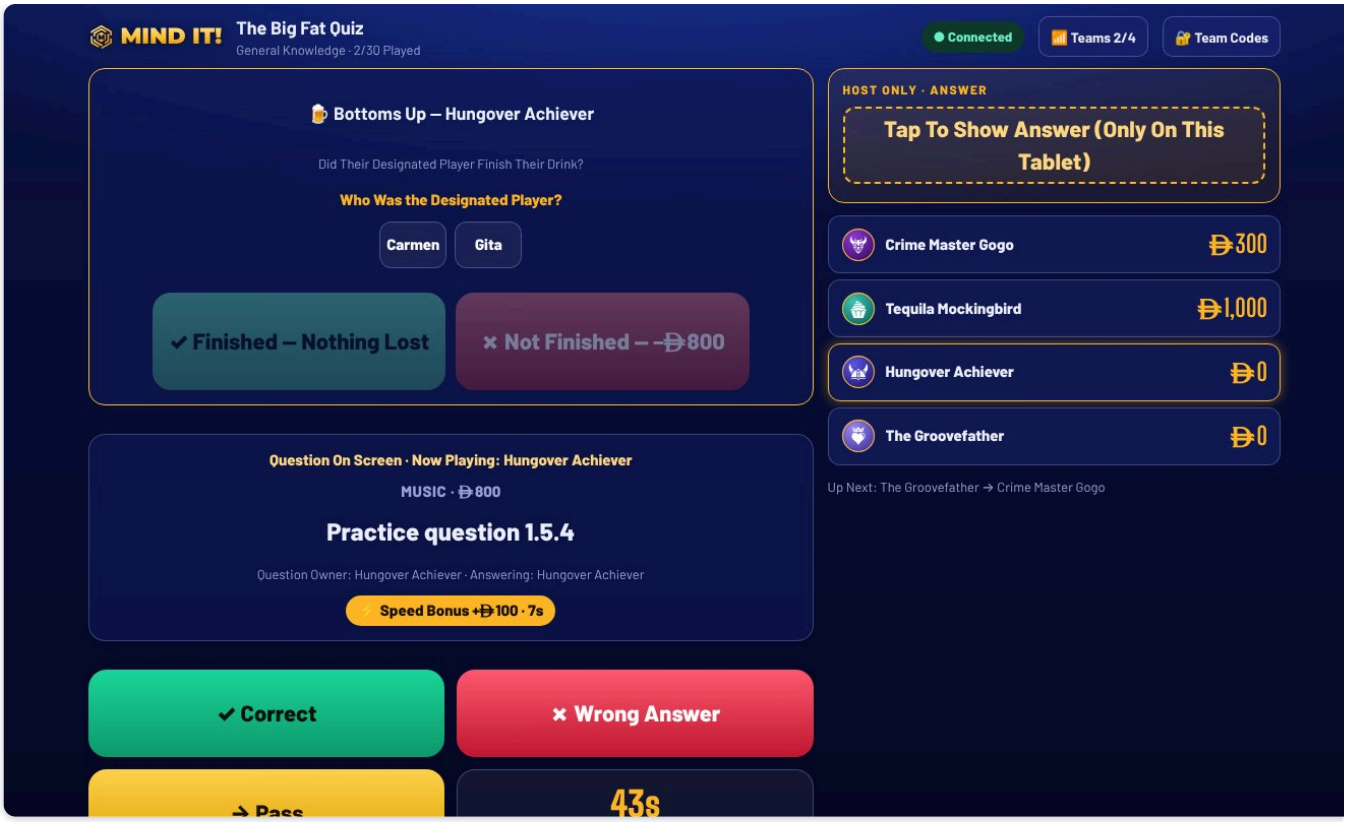
A fast Phoenix answer also gets the speed bonus *after* the cap, so it can end slightly above the leader — kept on purpose.

Tips: save it for a high-value question you're confident on — a wrong answer costs nothing anyway. **Common mistake:** waiting too long — it expires at the end of the round.

12.4 🍺 Bottoms Up (chip)

Purpose	A drinking-game safety net for Round 1.
Rule switch	On by default and in Full Show; off in Classic and Family Night.
Who / when	Every team gets one, **Round 1 only**. The team switches it on, on its phone, on its own turn, before picking (or the Quizmaster: "Use Bottoms Up for <team>?" → **Use it**).
How many	**Once per team per game.** It expires when Round 2 (or the Final) starts.
Confirmation	The phone asks **"Who's your designated player?"** and lists only that team's players; **Confirm** waits for a choice. The Quizmaster can set or change the player on the laptop or tablet.
Correct	Normal points.
Wrong	Scoring pauses and the timer stops. The TV shows **"BOTTOMS UP!" — the team's designated player must finish their drink to lose nothing**. The Quizmaster taps **✓ Finished — Nothing Lost** (**0**) or **× Not Finished — −value** (normal loss). Then the question passes on as usual.
Passing	Passing uses up the chip.
Daily Double	Not used on a DD — it stays ready.
Compatibility	Never with another chip. Not in Phone Buzzer Mode.
Audience View	A banner "Bottoms Up · <team> — Wrong costs nothing if their designated player finishes their drink" while the question is live.
Achievements	Go to the **designated player only**: 🍺 Bottoms Up! (finished) or 🫗 Glass Half Full (didn't). The app stores nothing about why anyone does or doesn't drink.


Bottoms Up · Crime Master Gogo — Wrong Costs Nothing If Their Designated Player Finishes Their Drink
MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing
Crime Master Gogo
Next: Tequila Mockingbird · Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather
Question Live
43
MUSIC
Ð800
Which band released the album “Abbey Road”?
Speed Bonus +Ð100 · 7s
Now Playing
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
Tequila Mockingbird
- Ð400
Hungover Achiever
Ð400
The Groovefather
Ð1,000
Full Screen
MIND IT!
Question Live
TV Live
Phone Connection: Active
Audience View
Connect
Primary Quizmaster: Quizmaster Tablet
Sound On
Teams 2/4
Team Codes
Bottoms Up On for Hungover Achiever — Their Next Pick
Audience View — Also Showing in the Stage Window
Host-Only Info Stays in the Right-Hand Panel
Bottoms Up · Hungover Achiever — Wrong Costs Nothing If Their Designated Player Finishes Their Drink
Round 1 · General Knowledge
MIND IT!
Now Playing
Hungover Achiever
Next: The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird
Question Live
43
MUSIC
Ð800
Practice question 1.5.4
Speed Bonus +Ð100 · 8s
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð1,000
Now Playing
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
The Groovefather
Ð0
Bottoms Up — Hungover Achiever
Did Hungover Achiever's Designated Player Finish Their Drink?
Designated Player:
Choose...
✓ Finished — Nothing Lost
× Not Finished — -Ð800
Host Only
Not Shown On Stage
Practice question 1.5.4
Practice answer
Question On Screen
Now Playing: Hungover Achiever. Reveal the Answer, Then Score It — The Next Team Lights Up Automatically.
Correct +Ð800
C
Wrong Answer -Ð800
W
Pass
S
Stop Timer
T
Reveal Answer
R
Back to Board (Keep Open)
B
Timer



📸 *Real screenshots — the TV while a Bottoms Up question is live, and the Quizmaster's decision on the laptop and tablet.*

Numbers: Crime Master Gogo (1,200) uses Bottoms Up on Music 800 and answers wrong. Designated player Asha finishes her drink → **0** (stays 1,200); the question passes to Tequila Mockingbird, who answers right: **+800**. If Asha hadn't finished: **−800** → 400.

Tips: any drink counts as long as it's the designated player's — keep it friendly and never pressure anyone; switch the rule off for family games (Family Night does). **Common mistake:** forgetting to choose the designated player — the Quizmaster can set it on the laptop card.

12.5 The bonuses (recap)

- ⚡ **Speed Bonus** — 11.6. 🎁 **Pass-On Bonus** — 11.5. 🔥 **True Daily Double** — 12.1.
- 🔥 **Streak Flames** (visual only): a team's score card catches fire at **3 correct in a row** ("🔥 3 IN A ROW"), "ON FIRE" at 5+. A pass doesn't break a streak; a wrong answer does. No points.
- 👑 **Returning Champion** (no points): last game's winners are introduced last in *Tonight's Teams*, wearing "👑 Champion ×N". **How the app decides (since build 122):** it looks at the most recent finished game with two or more teams and its winning team. A team tonight is the champion **only if every player of that winning team is on it** (extra players are fine). If the winner was a one-player team, the new team that player is on is the champion. If the winners are split across teams, or one of them isn't playing, there is no champion that night. Players deleted from Player Profiles aren't counted; teams without players are matched by team name. If last game ended in a tie, each winning team counts on its own and only one team wears the crown — the first in team order. **"N wins in a row"** counts back through the games whose whole winning team is on tonight's team.

12.6 Special abilities — comparison table

	💰 Daily Double	🎲 Triple Gamble	🔥 Phoenix	🍺 Bottoms Up
Type	Hidden tile	Chip	Chip	Chip
Who triggers	Whoever picks it	Team (phone) / QM	Team (phone) / QM	Team (phone) / QM

	💰 Daily Double	🎲 Triple Gamble	🔥 Phoenix	🍺 Bottoms Up
When	Any round except Final	Own turn, before pick	Own turn, before pick, Rounds 2–4	Own turn, before pick, Round 1 only
Limit	1/2/2/3 per round	Once per game	Once per game (if eligible)	Once per game
Right	+ wager	+ 3× (DD: 6×)	+ double + 20% of gap (capped at the leader)	+ value
Wrong	– wager	– 3× (DD: 6×)	0	0 if drink finished, else – value
Pass allowed	No	No	Yes (uses the chip)	Yes (uses the chip)
Speed bonus	No	No	Yes (after the cap)	Yes (normal question)
On a DD	—	6× fixed wager	Stays unused	Stays unused
Presets	All	Full Show	Full Show, Family Night	Full Show

13. Game Modes

13.1 Standard Mode (default) — best for beginners ✅

Teams take turns in order; the team **says** its answer; the Quizmaster marks it. Everything in Chapters 10–12 applies. Chips work only in this mode.

Turn order (6 · Advanced → Advanced Game Rules → Turn Order):

- **Teams take turns in order (1 → 2 → 3 → 1)** — default. The team whose turn it is when a question opens "owns" it. Wrong answers and passes move **the same question** to the next team. **The next question always goes to the team after the owner** — e.g. A passes, B answers → the next question is B's.
- **Classic — whoever answers correctly picks next**; a wrong answer doesn't move control.
- Host overrides: **Make Active** (More controls → Teams & Turn Order) and **A different team answered? (host override)** on the question.
- **Mark Away / Back in:** an Away team is skipped for turns, buzzers and the Final (at least one team must stay in).

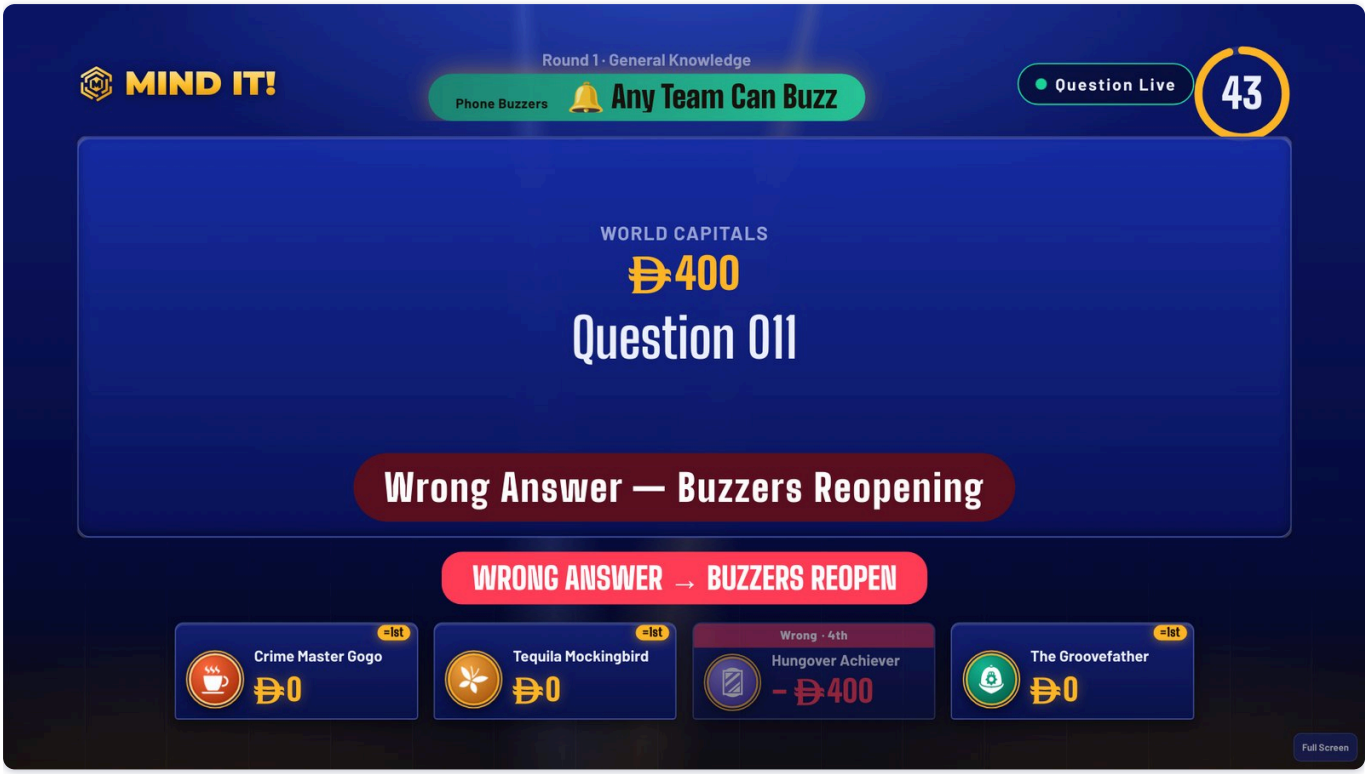
13.2 Phone Buzzer Mode ✅ (🟡 not tested with real phones)

Switch it on: 3 · Gameplay & Rules → Answering Mode → **Phone Buzzer Mode** (needs the laptop app). It can be changed mid-game (it asks, and applies from the next question). Try 📳 **Buzzer Test** first (⋯ / 📶 Devices or 6 · Advanced → Help & Tests).

- **Buzzers open on normal questions.** Daily Doubles and the Final keep their wager flows (no buzzers).
- **Early-Buzz Lockout** (on except Family Night): buzzers arm after a reading time (about 45 ms per character of the question, between 1.2 and 6 seconds). Phones say "Wait for the light..."; the TV shows "👂 LISTEN..." then **"🔔 BUZZERS OPEN"**. An early tap locks that team out for **½ second**. **Open Buzzers Now** skips the wait.
- **The first valid buzz wins — by arrival at the laptop**, never by phone clocks. Repeated or late taps are rejected.
- **Wrong:** that team is out for this question and buzzers reopen for the others (or close if nobody is left). **Correct:** buzzers close. **Time's up:** buzzers close.
- **Quizmaster tools: Cancel Buzz**, **Reopen Buzzers**. On the tablet, Correct/Wrong apply to whoever buzzed; until someone buzzes, the tablet shows 🔔 **Waiting For A Buzz...** instead (build 116).
- **On the TV** (build 114): while any team can buzz, the top bar says **Phone Buzzers · 🔔 Any Team Can Buzz** (no "Now Playing" team and no turn-order line); the team that buzzes becomes **Now Playing / Answering**; after a wrong answer the banner says **WRONG ANSWER → BUZZERS REOPEN** (or *No Teams Left To Buzz*). The ⚡ speed-bonus countdown disappears once a team other than the picker has buzzed — only the picking team can earn it.
- **Scoring** is exactly as in Standard Mode. Buzzing alone earns nothing. **Chips are not available** — the Phoenix isn't handed out in this mode (nor without the laptop app, e.g. on the browser-only web link — build 115) (the round log says "not given — Phone Buzzer Mode").
- **Phone states:** Wait for the light · BUZZ IN · Buzzed ("You're answering") · Too early · LOCKED ("Team X buzzed first") · Wrong — wait for a reopen · Waiting.
- Extras: "FIRST BUZZ: Team 2 · 0.13 s", buzzer Fun Stats (Fastest Buzzer, Quickest On Average, Jumped The Gun) and the ⚡ Lightning Reflexes achievement.

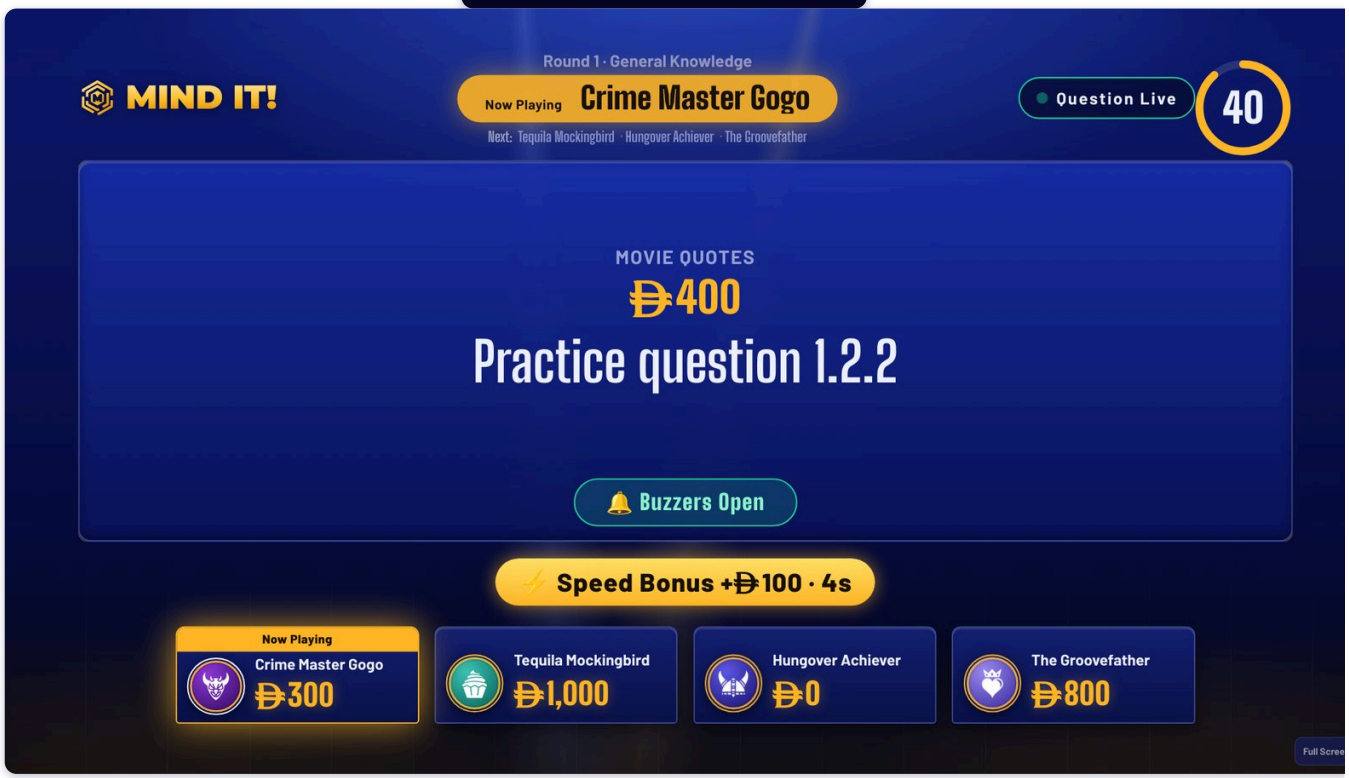


📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — the TV while any team can buzz.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — after a wrong answer: "WRONG ANSWER → BUZZERS REOPEN".*





📸 *Real screenshots — the phone buzzer, and the TV with buzzers open as it looked in build 111 (before the build 114 changes shown above).*

Which mode? Beginners and mixed groups: **Standard**. Quick-fire regulars who love a race: **Buzzer**. Standard is also the only mode with chips.

13.3 Other ways to play

- **Rules presets:** Classic (pure quiz), Full Show (everything), Family Night (friendly, no gambles) — 5.Step 7.

- 🎭 **Rehearsal** ✅ — "Play through the game to test the TV, sound, timers and phones. Nothing counts: no history, player stats, achievements, leaderboard or 'questions used'. When you finish, everything goes back exactly as it is now." Start it from Setup; finish with **End Rehearsal**. Every team doesn't need a player in a rehearsal; Triple Gamble is off.
- **Tablet-only game** 🟡 — **Start New Game** on the tablet runs the whole quiz on the tablet (no laptop). Without the laptop app there is no local server, so phones and chips aren't available; wagers are entered by the Quizmaster.
- 📱 **Phone Remote** 🟡 — a simple Quizmaster remote on any phone browser (Correct, Wrong, Pass, Reveal, Next, timer and Undo, with the answer only on the remote). Turn it on in 6 · Advanced → **Turn On Phone Remote**; it shows a QR code and a PIN.

---

14. Timers

14.1 The defaults ✅

Timer	Default	Range
Normal question	**45 s**	5–600 s
Final Round	**60 s** (with thinking music)	10–600 s
Passed question	**30 s + time left, max 45 s**	—
After a wrong answer	**a fresh 45 s** for the next team	—
Speed bonus window	**10 s**	1–60 s
Extend	**+30 s per press**	as many presses as you like

14.2 Starting, pausing, resuming

- **Start:** questions start their timer automatically **0.7 s** after appearing (setting *Start the Question Timer Automatically*, on by default). If it's off, start it yourself (key **T** or the timer button).
- **Pause / resume: Pause Timer** on the laptop (the timer button on the tablet: "⏸ Pause"). Press again to resume.
- **Stop Timer (T)** stops the clock; **End Timer** ends it now (time's up).

14.3 Extending (+30 Sec) ✅

- Adds **exactly 30 seconds** per press, never resets the clock, can be pressed again and again.
- Works on normal, passed, Daily Double and Final questions. When paused, it adds to the paused time.
- **Not after TIME'S UP.** The tablet has its own **+30 Sec** button.
- The TV shows "⏱ TIMER EXTENDED +30 SEC". Every extension is logged.
- Mind It! never extends automatically.

> **Example (Chapter 17):** Hungover Achiever is struggling with Music 1,000. The Quizmaster presses +30 Sec: the clock goes from 45 to **75** seconds. (The *Overtime Hero* achievement is for a correct answer after an extension.)

14.4 When time runs out

- **Normal question, other teams still to try (turn order):** a host card ⏰ **Time's up for <team>** offers **WRONG ANSWER** (–value), **PASS** or **Dismiss**. Nothing happens automatically. Common practice: if they gave no answer, PASS; if they said something wrong, WRONG.
- **Daily Double and Triple Gamble:** no card — mark it Correct or Wrong yourself.
- **Final Round:** nothing is locked when the 60 seconds end. Phones can still submit; you decide when to move on.
- **Passed after time's up:** the next team gets 30 s.
- **Sounds:** a soft **heartbeat in the last 10 seconds** (one beat per second, two per second in the last 5, louder towards the end; setting in 5 · Audio & Presentation), and beeps near the end. Phones show a header countdown that turns gold in the last 10 seconds.

14.5 Timer synchronisation and connection hiccups

The **laptop owns the clock**. The TV window, the tablet and the phones all show the laptop's timer. If the tablet or a phone drops out for a moment, the laptop's clock keeps running and the device catches up when it reconnects. (Build 110 stopped Windows from slowing down the host window when it's in the background, which was the cause of earlier TV "Reconnecting" messages and stuttering timers.)

If the **laptop** itself closes, the timer stops with it. Reopen Mind It! and **Resume saved game** — you're back on the same question; restart or extend the timer as fair (Chapter 22).

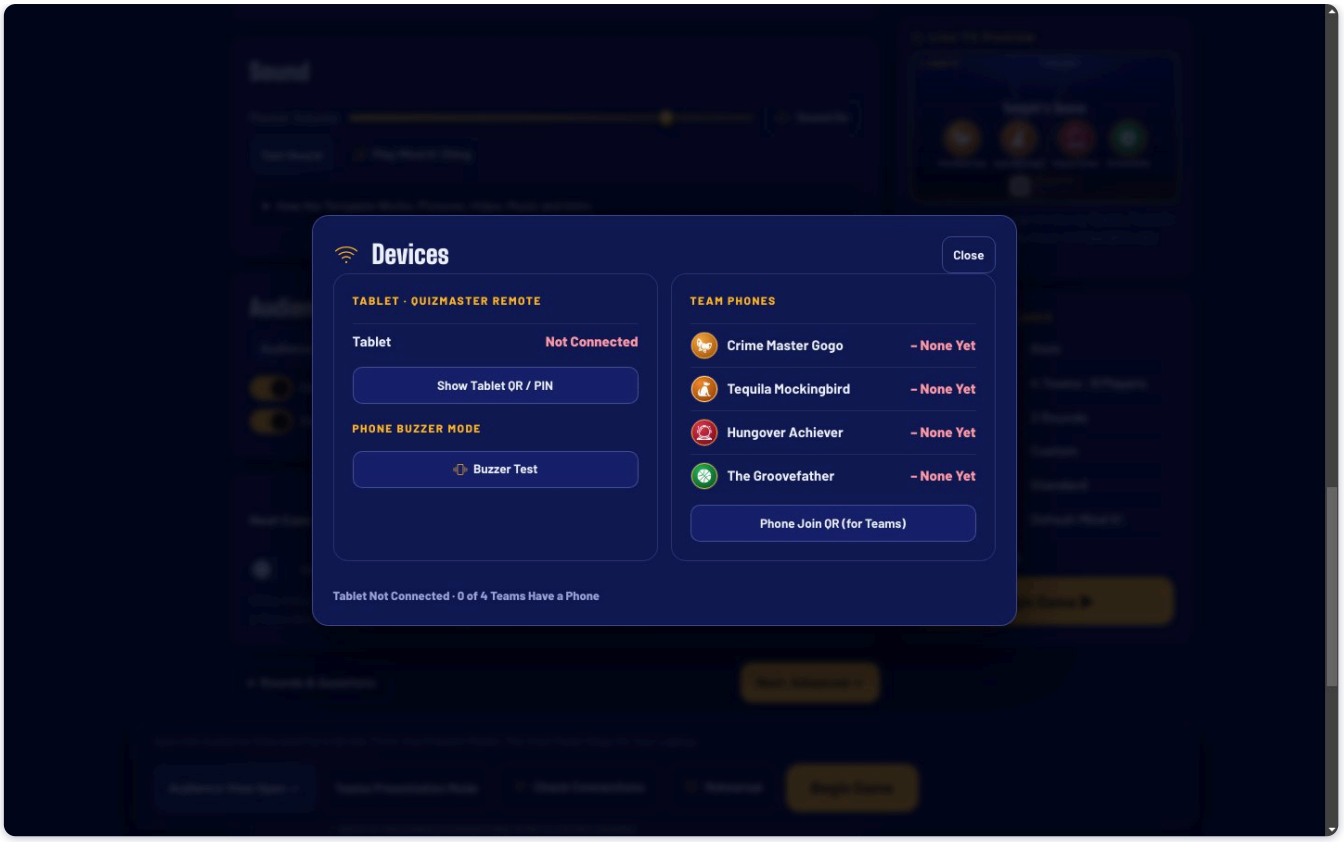
PART FIVE — HOSTING THE GAME

15. Every Quizmaster Button Explained

Most buttons exist on **both** the laptop and the tablet. Keyboard shortcuts work on the laptop (Appendix C).

15.1 The laptop's top bar (always there)

Button	What it does	When to use it
Status pills (**On the Board / Question Live / Answer Revealed / Standings...**, **TV ● Live**, **Phone Connection: Active**)	Show what's happening right now.	Glance at them.
📺 **Audience View ▾**	**Open Audience Window** (put it on the TV), **Present On This Screen** (full-screen here; Esc to exit), **Teams Presentation Mode** (for sharing in a Teams call), **TV Display Settings** (screen size, safe margins, check the TV).	Before the game; if the TV window was closed.
📲 **Connect ▾**	📶 **Devices** (tablet, team phones and buzzers at a glance, with **Phone Join QR (for Teams)** — the players' join code), **Connect Tablet** (QR + PIN), **Phone Remote** (the Quizmaster's simple remote on any phone browser — never show its code to players).	Before the game.
Tablet status (e.g. **Primary Quizmaster: Quizmaster Tablet**)	Which device is in control.	—
🔊 **Sound On / Off**	Mute or unmute.	Speeches, announcements.
📶 **Teams x/y**	Connected team phones. **Tap for Connection Health.**	Whenever a team says "my phone isn't working".
🔐 **Team Codes**	Every team's code (host only) and whether a phone is connected.	When a team needs its code.
⋯ ▾	☕ **Intermission** ("Back in 5 minutes" on the TV, with a countdown and the standings), 🎵 **Play the Mind It! Sting**, ★ **About & Credits** (version, open-source thanks and, since build 114, a **Licences** section), 💾 **Backups & Restore**.	Breaks; backups.
Setup	Opens Setup and **pauses** the game (Return to game / Start a new game).	Fixing a question or setting mid-game.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — Connect ▾ → 📶 Devices: the tablet, buzzer test and team phones at a glance. "Phone Join QR (for Teams)" opens the players' join code (Chapter 8).*

15.2 While picking (the board)

Button	What it does
Click a value tile on the board preview (or tap it on the tablet)	Opens that question for the team whose turn it is.
Show Standings (P)	Shows the standings on the TV for a moment (press again or continue to go back).
🎟 **Team Chips ▾**	Use a chip for the picking team, or switch one off (Chapter 12).
More Controls ▾ → Teams & Turn Order	**Make Active** (it's this team's turn), **Mark Away / Back in**, **Adjust Score**.

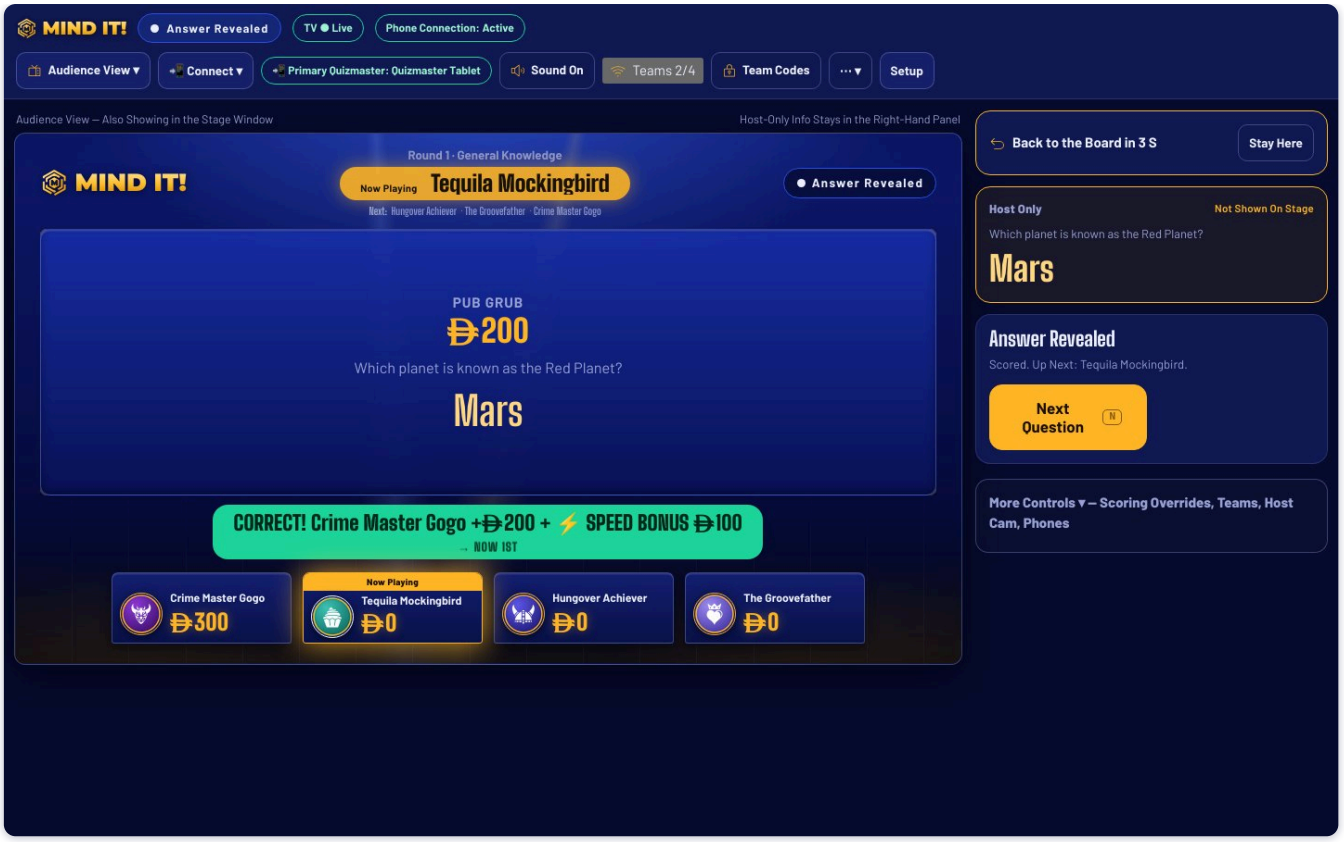
15.3 While a question is live

Button	Key	What it does	When
Correct +value	C	Award the points (+ bonuses). The TV shows the answer. While the speed bonus can be earned the button adds it: **Correct +200 ⚡ +100** (build 113).	The answering team said the right answer.
Wrong Answer –value	W	Deduct the points; pass the question to the next team with a fresh clock.	Wrong answer.
Wrong, no penalty	X	No deduction; the question moves on.	A fair "near miss" you don't want to punish, e.g. a technical problem.
Pass	S	No change; next team, timer = 30 s + time left (max 45).	The team says "pass".

Button	Key	What it does	When
Stop Timer	T	Stop/start the clock.	Discussion, interruptions.
Pause Timer · +30 Sec · End Timer	—	Pause/resume; add 30 seconds; end the time now.	Fairness calls.
Reveal Answer	R	Show the answer on the TV without scoring.	Nobody got it, or you want to show it after a ruling.
Back to Board (Keep Open)	B	Go back to the board without scoring; the question stays open to pick later.	You opened the wrong tile.
No One Got It — Close Clue	—	Close the question with no score.	Every team has tried.
A different team answered? (host override)	—	Score a different team than the one whose turn it is.	Someone shouted out of turn and you allow it.
⏰ Time's up for <team>: WRONG ANSWER / PASS / Dismiss	—	Appears when time runs out.	Decide what the silence meant.

15.4 After an answer

Button	Key	What it does
Next Question	N	Back to the board for the next team. (Mind It! also returns automatically 3½ s after a correct answer — tap **Stay Here** to stop that.)
Stay Here	—	Keep the answer on screen (for a story or an argument).
Undo Last Score	U	Reverse the last score entry (asks first).



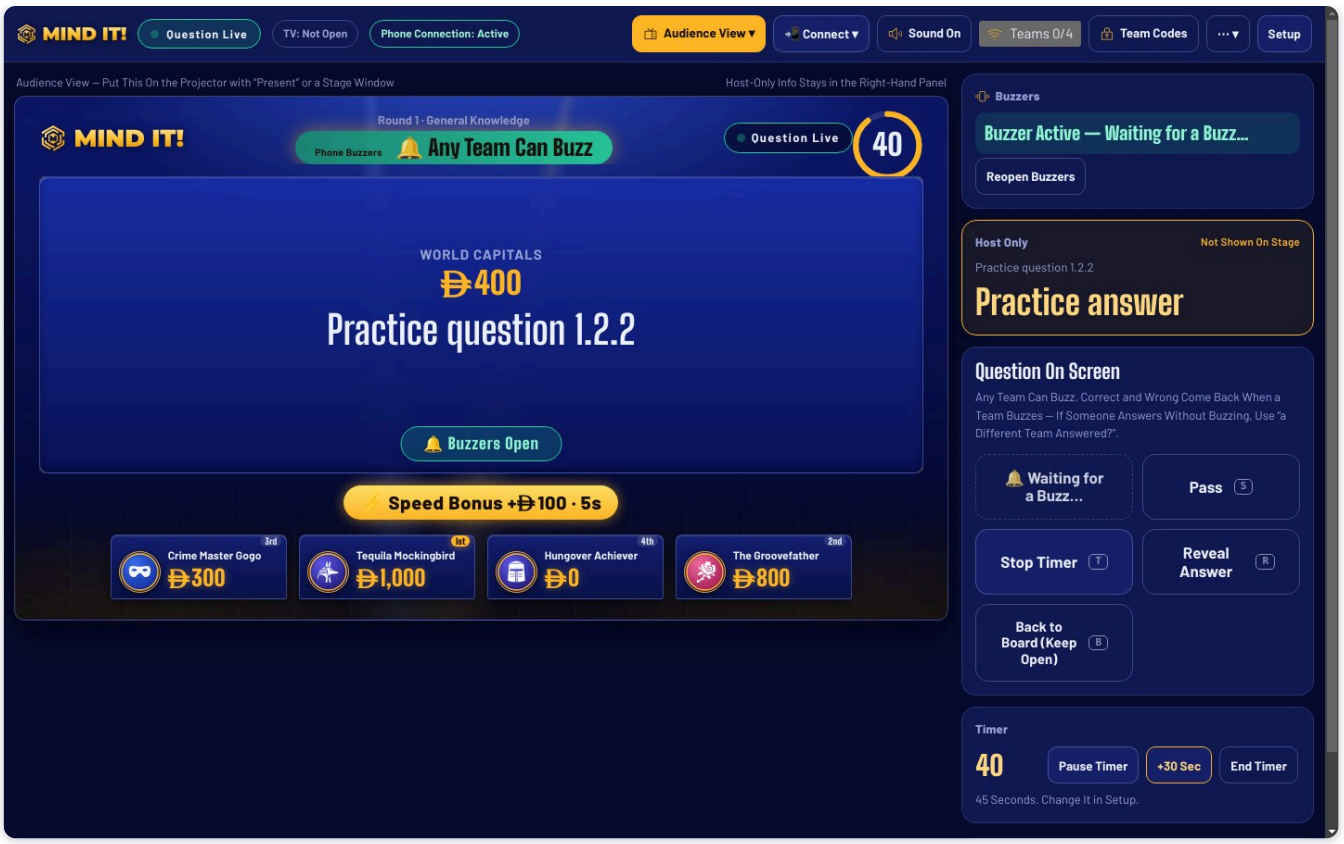
📸 *Real screenshot — after a correct answer: the TV copy shows the banner; the right panel offers Stay Here and Next Question.*

15.5 Daily Double, wager and chip controls

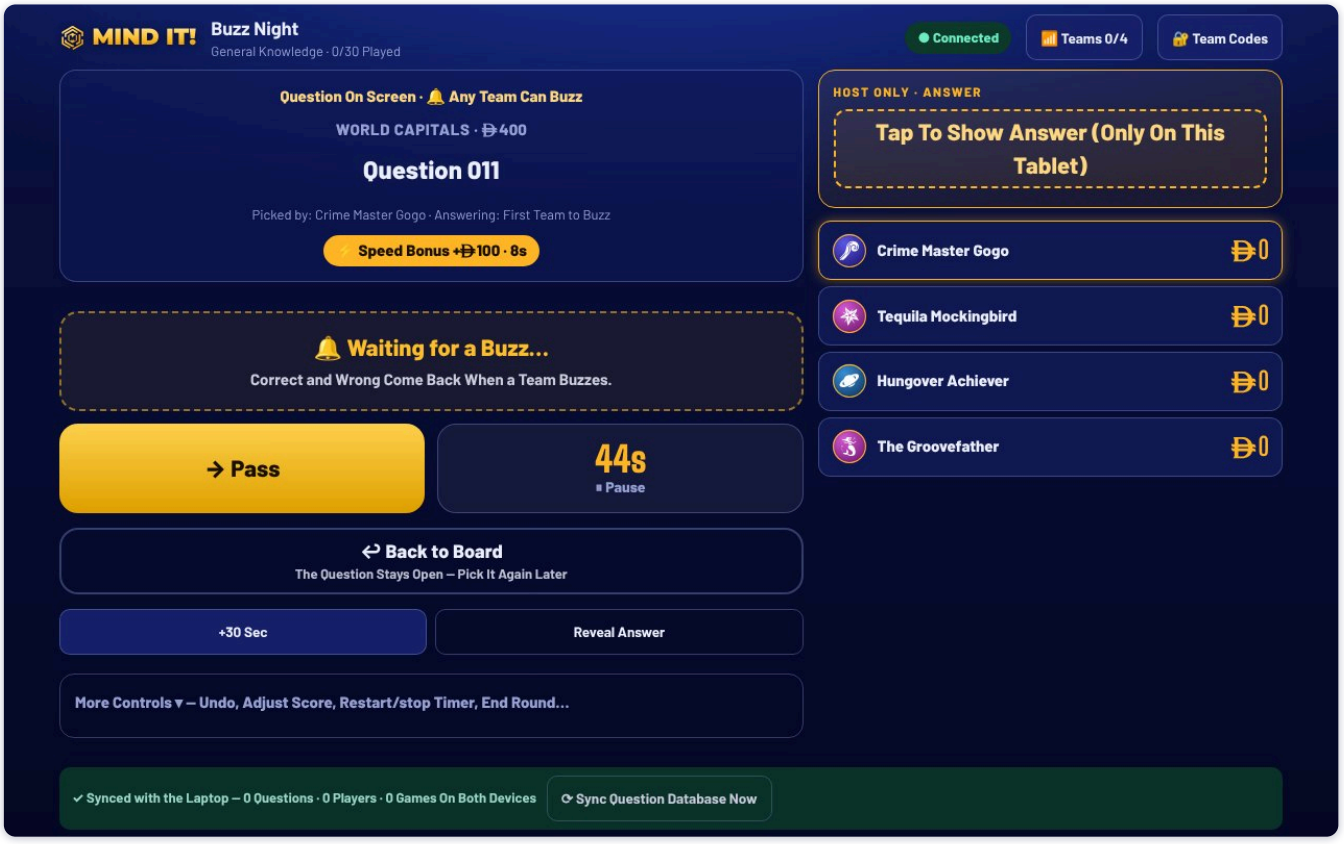
- **Lock Wager & Show Question** — after typing a team's DD wager (or the phone does it automatically). Quick picks **All in / Half / Minimum**.
- ✏️ **Change a Wager** — change a DD wager until it's scored, or a Final wager until that team is revealed. The TV keeps amounts hidden.
- **Bottoms Up decision** — **✓ Finished — Nothing Lost** / **✕ Not Finished — −value**, and the designated-player picker.
- 🎟️ **Team Chips** — **Use for <team>** / **Switch off**.

15.6 Buzzer controls (Phone Buzzer Mode)

Open Buzzers Now (skip the reading time), **Cancel Buzz** (ignore this buzz), **Reopen Buzzers**. Correct / Wrong act on the team that buzzed. **Until a team buzzes** (build 115) the laptop shows 🔔 **Waiting For A Buzz...** instead of Correct / Wrong, the C / W / X keys do nothing, and the tablet shows the same 🔔 **Waiting For A Buzz...** panel in place of its Correct / Wrong, with **Any Team Can Buzz** on its top line (build 116) — so no team can be scored by accident. Once a team buzzes, the laptop's hint says who buzzed first and that a wrong answer reopens the buzzers; after scoring it says who **picks next** (build 117). If a team answers without buzzing, use **A different team answered? (host override)**.

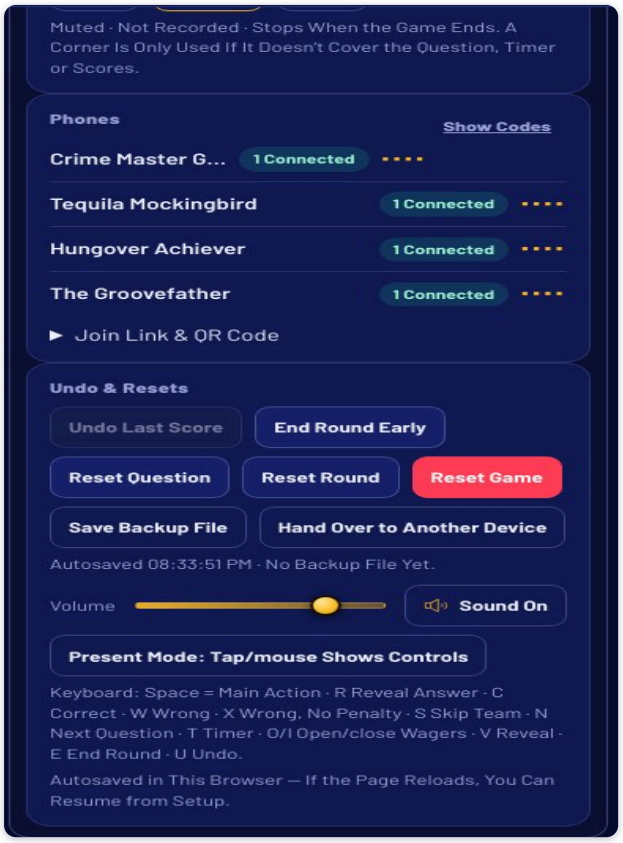


📸 *Real screenshot (build 116) — the laptop in Phone Buzzer Mode before anyone buzzes ("Buzzer Active — Waiting for a Buzz..."): Correct / Wrong come back when a team buzzes.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 117) — the tablet in Phone Buzzer Mode before anyone buzzes: Pass and the timer stay, Correct / Wrong come back when a team buzzes.*

15.7 Round and game navigation (More Controls ▾ → Undo & Resets)



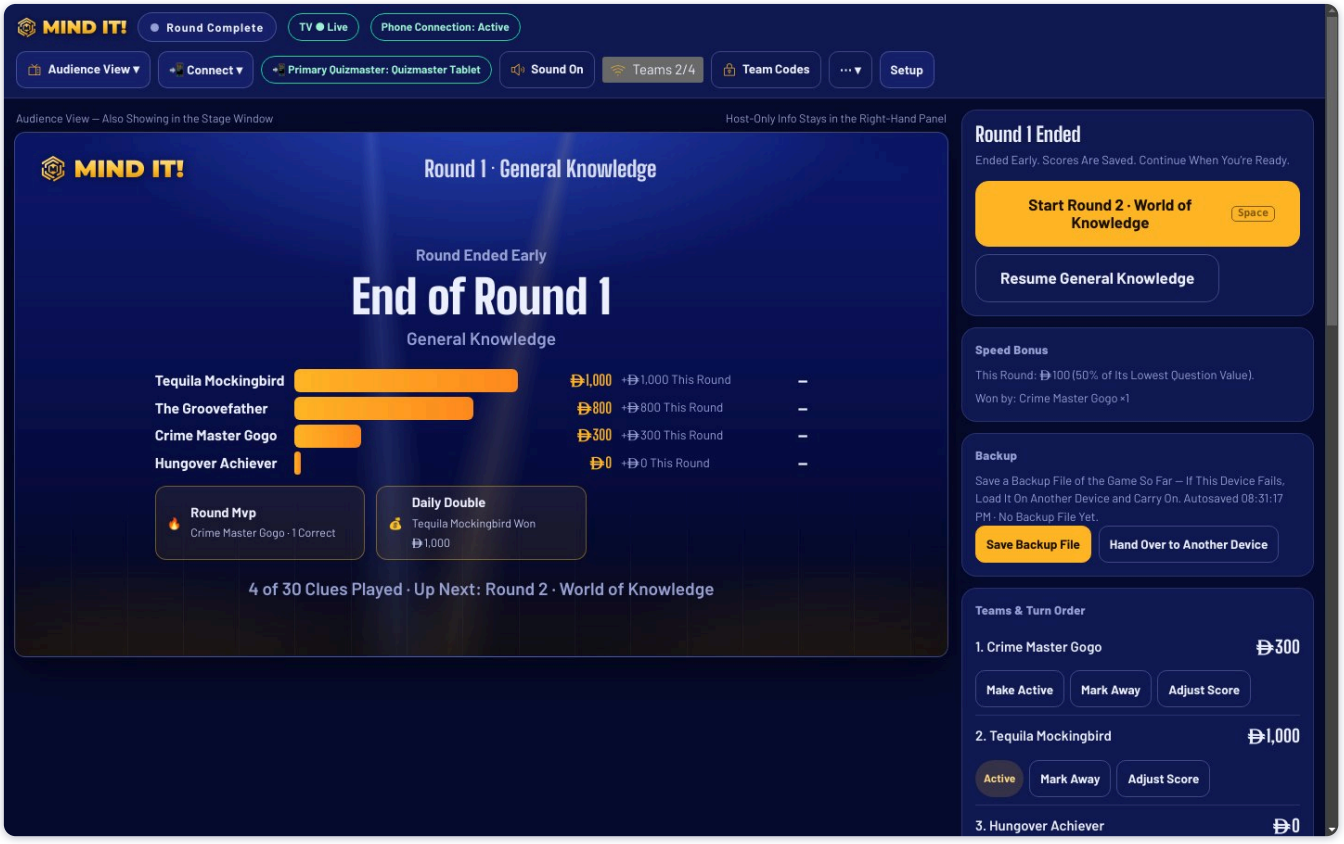
📸 *Real screenshot — the lower part of More Controls (Phones, Undo & Resets, volume, Present Mode and the keyboard list).*

Button	Key	What it does	Safety
Undo Last Score	U	Reverses the last score entry; the question reopens.	Asks first. Puts back any chip that answer used (build 112).
End Round Early	E	Ends the round now: stops the timer, closes any open question **unscored**, cancels an open wager, keeps scores → round summary.	Asks first.
Reset Question	—	Puts the current question back as if never opened.	Asks first.
Reset Round	—	Restarts the round (same Daily Double spots).	Asks first.
Reset Game (red)	—	Back to zero.	Asks first. **Save a backup first.**
Save Backup File	—	Downloads the full game as a file.	Always safe.
Hand Over to Another Device	—	Move the running game to another computer (Chapter 22).	—
Volume / Sound On	—	Master volume.	—
Present Mode: Tap/mouse shows controls	—	Or "keyboard only" in Present Mode.	—

Button	Key	What it does	Safety
Phones → Show Codes / Join Link & QR Code	—	Team phone status and the join QR.	Host only.
Host Cam	—	Off by default. A small live picture of you on the TV — video only, no sound, nothing recorded or uploaded. Corner (**Automatic (Safest)** / Top-Left / Top-Right / Bottom-Left / Bottom-Right) and size (Small / Medium / Large). 🟡 Not tested with a real camera.	—

15.8 Round summary

After a round: **Start Round 2 · <name>** ▶, **Resume <round>** (if you ended early by mistake), a host-only **Speed Bonus** card, **Save Backup File / Hand Over to Another Device**, and Teams & Turn Order.



📸 *Real screenshot — the laptop after Round 1.*

15.9 Final Round controls (Chapter 18 in detail)

Close Wagers (missing wagers count as 0 and stay editable) / **Reopen Wagers**, **Reveal Answer**, per team **Accept / Reject** (or **Accept Anyway / Mark Incorrect** when the checker disagrees), **Wrong, No Penalty**, ✎ **Edit Answer**, **Reveal <team> (V)**, **Show Final Standings**.

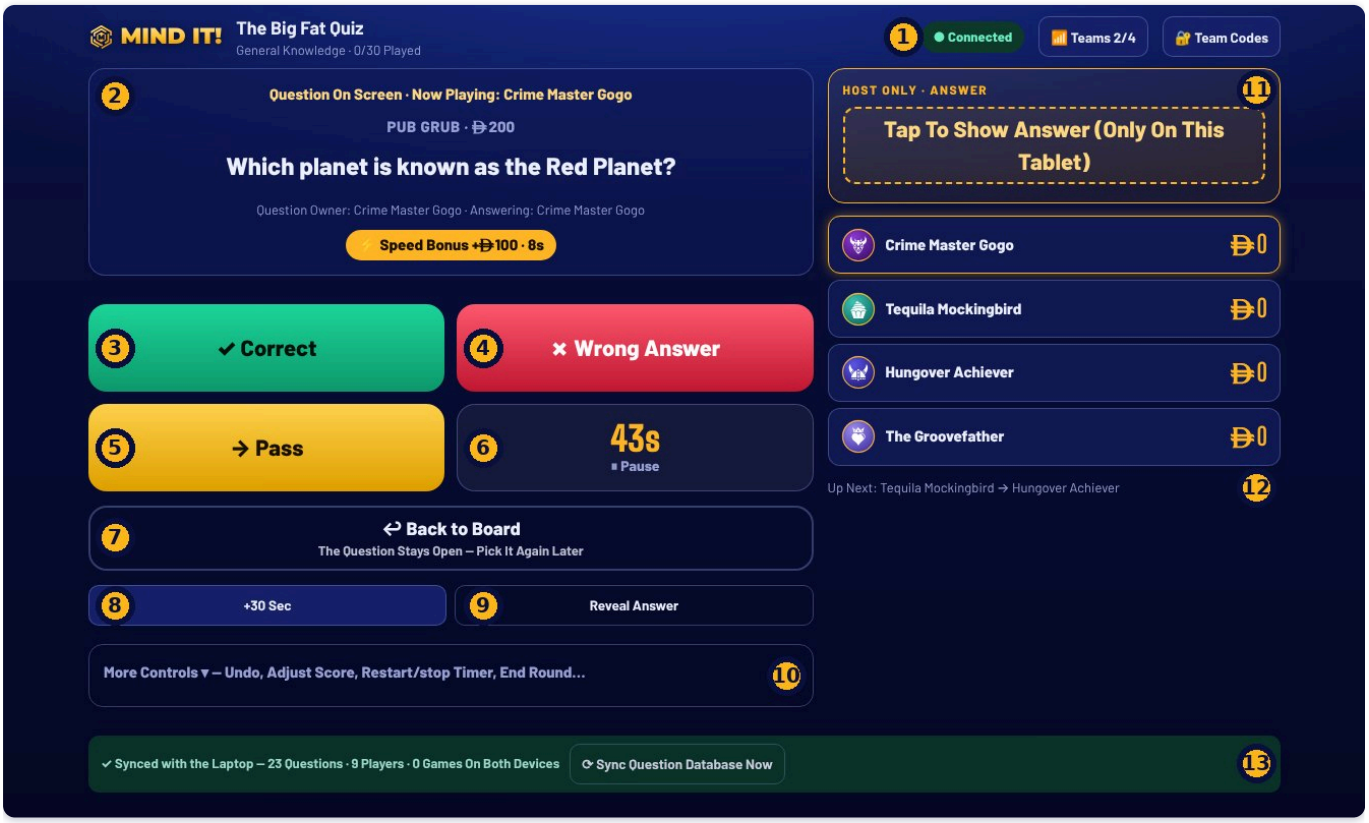
15.10 End of the game

On the standings: 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats (Space)**, **Winner Screen**, **Save Picture** (💾 Save Standings Picture — PNG), **Play Again** (new questions), **Play Again (Same Questions)**, **Back to Setup**. On the tablet: the big 🏁 **END GAME** button (Chapter 19).

15.11 Connection Health

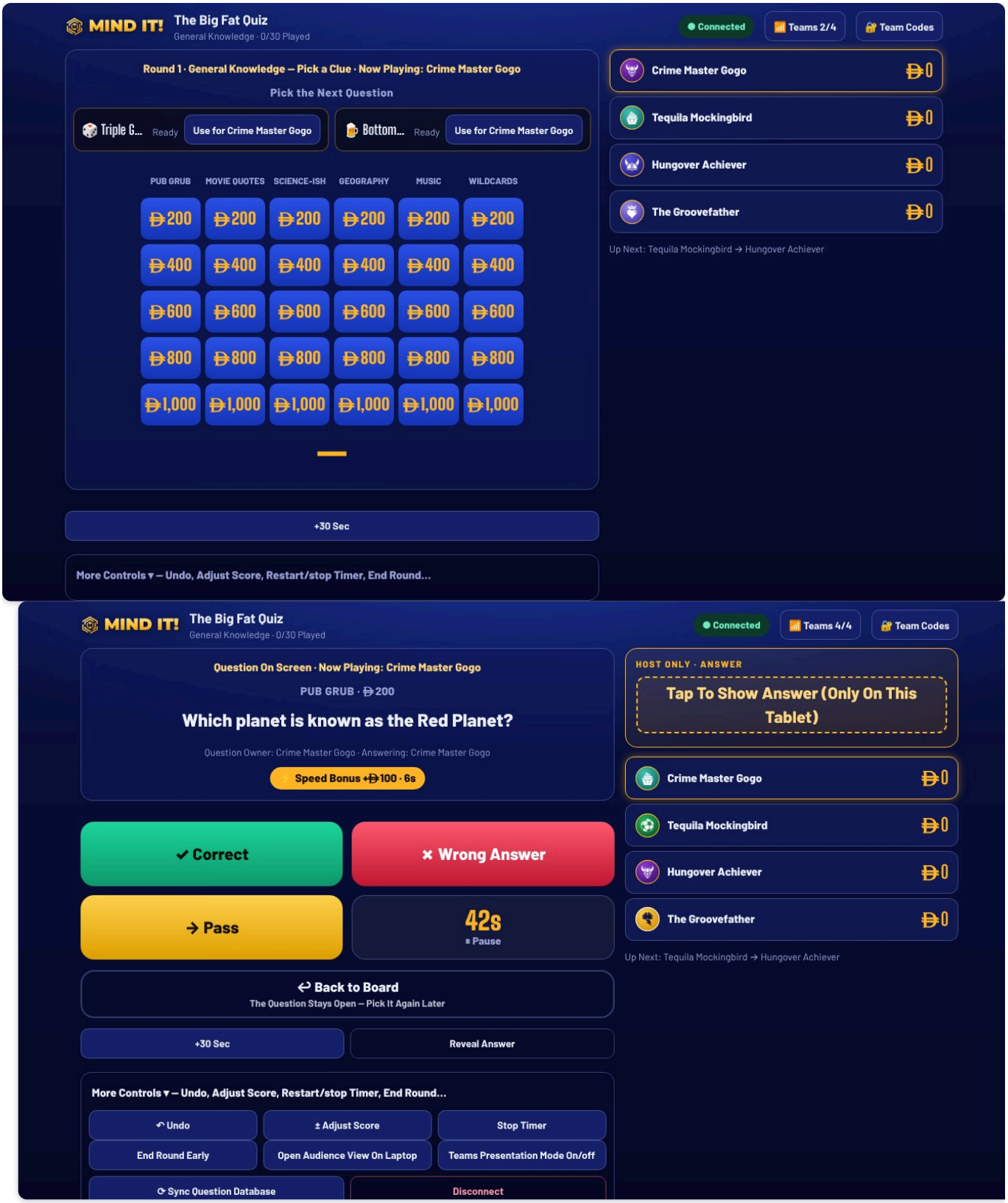
📶 **Check Connections** (Setup) / 📶 **Teams x/y** (in game) → **TEST ALL CONNECTIONS** → **RETEST** (Chapter 9).

15.12 The tablet remote



📸 *Real screenshot — the tablet remote during a question.*

1. **Connected** status, 📶 **Teams 2/4** (tap for the tablet's connection sheet), 🔐 **Team Codes**.
2. The question on the TV, its owner and who is answering, and the ⚡ **Speed Bonus** countdown.
3. ✓ **Correct**.
4. × **Wrong Answer**.
5. → **Pass**.
6. The timer — tap ⏸ **Pause**.
7. ↩ **Back to Board** — "the question stays open — pick it again later".
8. **+30 Sec**.
9. **Reveal Answer** (on the TV).
10. **More Controls ▾** — ↶ **Undo**, ± **Adjust Score**, **Stop Timer**, **End Round Early**, **Open Audience View On Laptop**, **Teams Presentation Mode On/off**, ⟳ **Sync Question Database**, **Disconnect**.
11. **HOST ONLY · ANSWER — Tap To Show Answer (Only On This Tablet)**. Tap to peek; nobody else sees it.
12. Scores and **Up Next** (the turn order; not shown in Phone Buzzer Mode, where the order depends on who buzzes — build 117).
13. ✓ **Synced with the Laptop** — questions, players and games are on both devices; ⟳ **Sync Question Database Now**.



📸 *Real screenshots — the tablet's board (left) and More Controls opened (right).*

On the tablet's board, tap a value to open it. The **chips row** above the board shows each chip with **Use for <team>** (Quizmaster override).



📸 *Real screenshot — tablet chip override row.*

---

16. Audience View

The Audience View is what the room sees. Open it from **Open Audience View (TV)** (Setup) or 📺 **Audience View ▾ → Open Audience Window**, move it to the TV, press its **Full Screen** button.

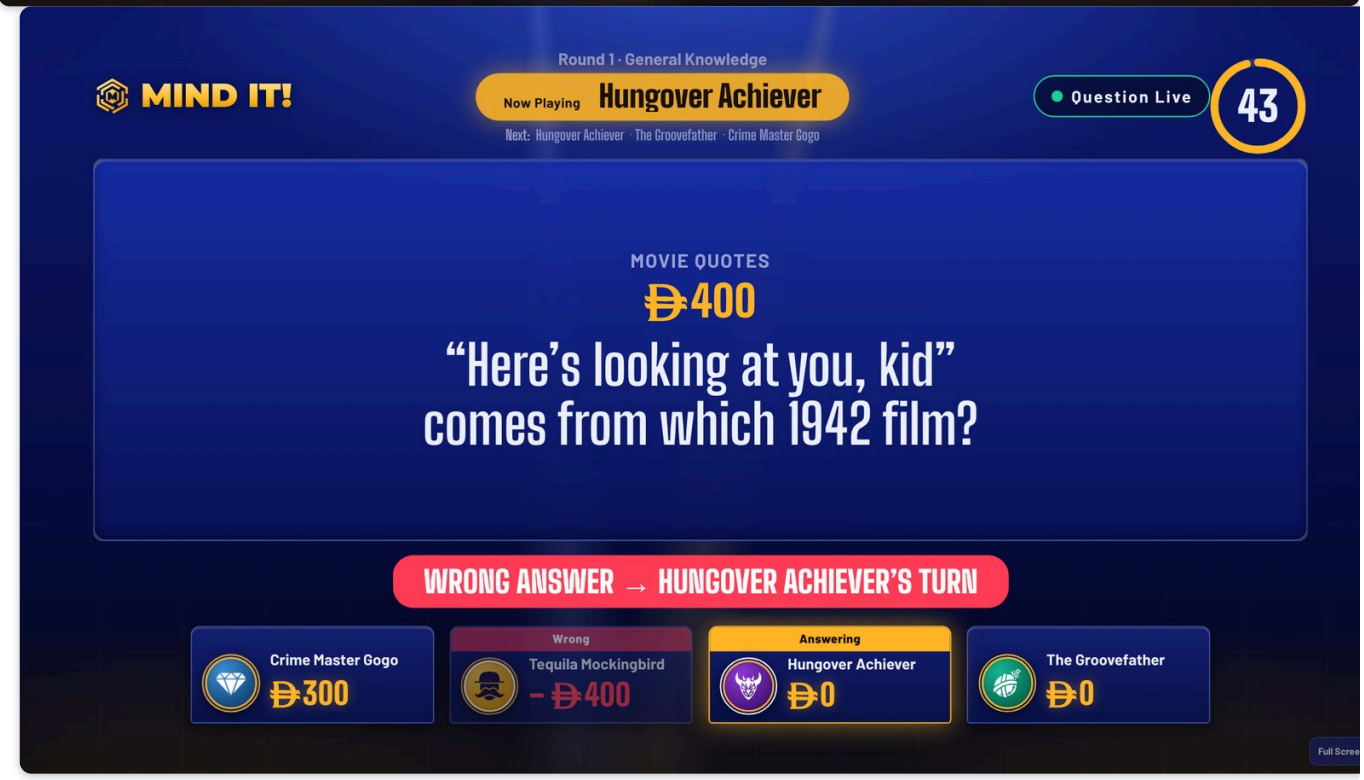
16.1 What it shows, screen by screen ✅

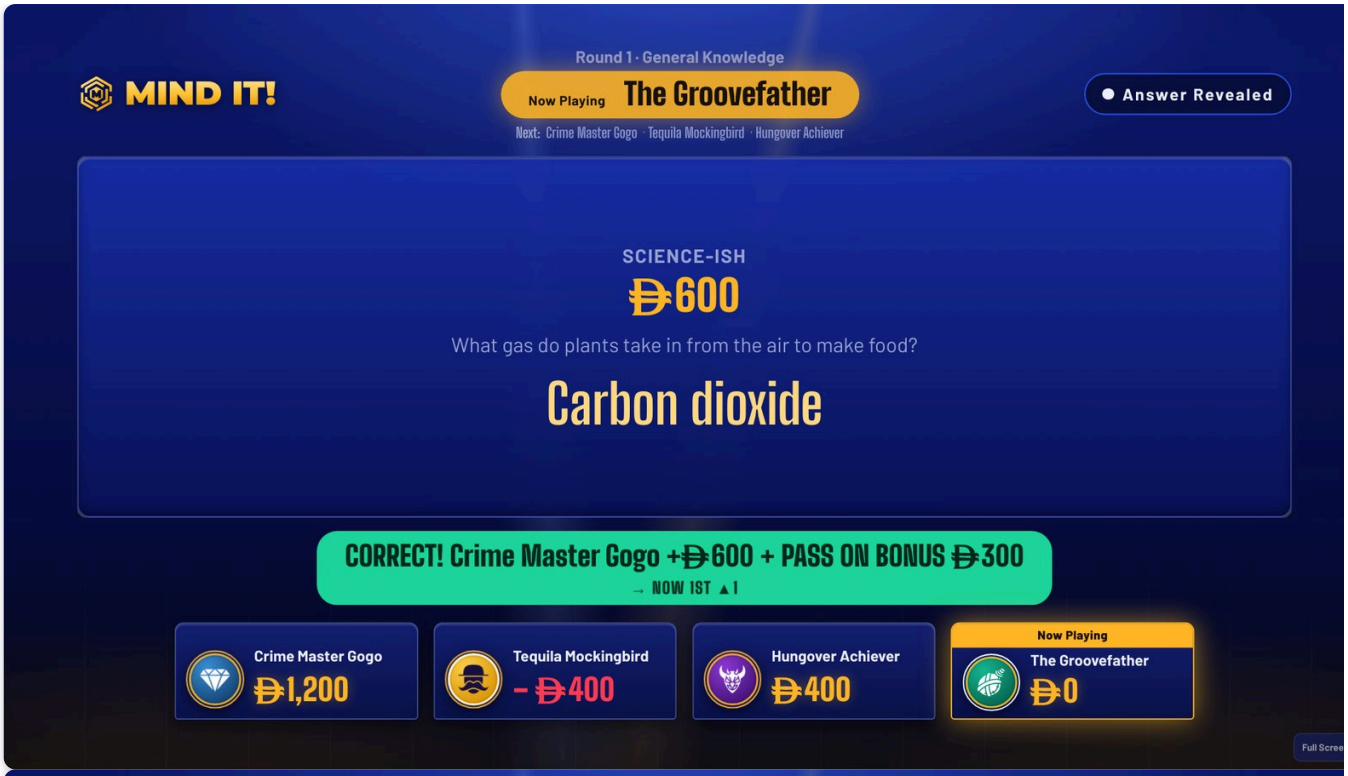
Moment	What the TV shows
Before the start	The Mind It! welcome screen, then *Tonight's Teams* — every team's picture and name (the champion walks on last, wearing the crown). Both show the **"Scan to Join Your Team"** phone QR code (bottom centre, or top right on *Tonight's Teams*) until Round 1 starts — unless it's switched off in 5 · Audio & Presentation.
Round start	The category reveal ("Round 1 · Category 2 of 6"), then the board fills (animation, skippable). "THE PHOENIX IS LIVE" if someone holds the Phoenix.
Board	Categories, values, score cards with each team's **place** (1st in gold; shown once the scores differ — build 113), **Now Playing** and **Next**. A long team name shrinks to fit the Now Playing bar.
Question	Category, value, the question, the ring timer, "⚡ Speed Bonus" countdown, chip banners. Pictures and media if the question has them.
Correct / wrong	Banners: "CORRECT! … + ⚡ SPEED BONUS … NOW 1ST", "WRONG ANSWER → <team>'S TURN", "+ PASS ON BONUS".
Daily Double	"Daily Double!" splash, "<team> plays alone · no passing", a QR code to wager, "locked in".
Special events	Triple Gamble dice, PHOENIX!, PHOENIX RISES!, BOTTOMS UP!, TRUE DAILY DOUBLE!, "⏱ TIMER EXTENDED +30 SEC", streak flames, score adjustment banners.
Buzzers	"👂 LISTEN…", "🔔 BUZZERS OPEN", "FIRST BUZZ: <team> · 0.13 s". The top bar says **Phone Buzzers · Any Team Can Buzz** until someone buzzes (build 114).
Round end	"End of Round 1" with score-race bars, places moved ▲▼ (from Round 2) and awards (Round MVP, Daily Double, Best Accuracy).
Intermission	"Back in 4:59" countdown and the standings.
Final Round	Category, a box per team ("? ? ?" · Waiting… / Locked in), a QR code; then the question and a 60-second timer; then the answer and the reveal, team by team, with live standings ▲▼.
Winner	Final standings podium, then "And the Winner Is… <team>" with fireworks of gold dots. Level on points? The team with **more correct answers** wins (18.3).
Awards	*Game Highlights* → *Achievements Unlocked* → *Fun Stats* → *Final Results* (pages turn by themselves; skippable).

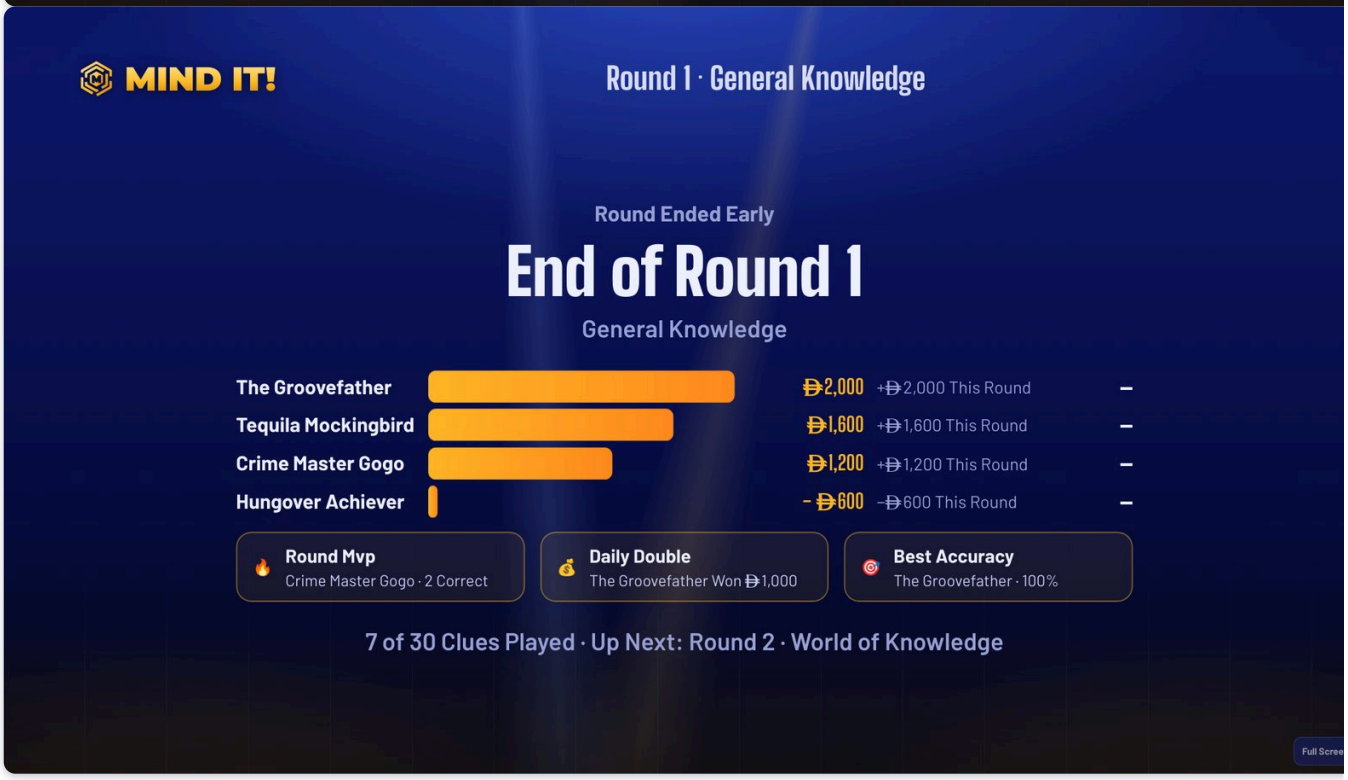


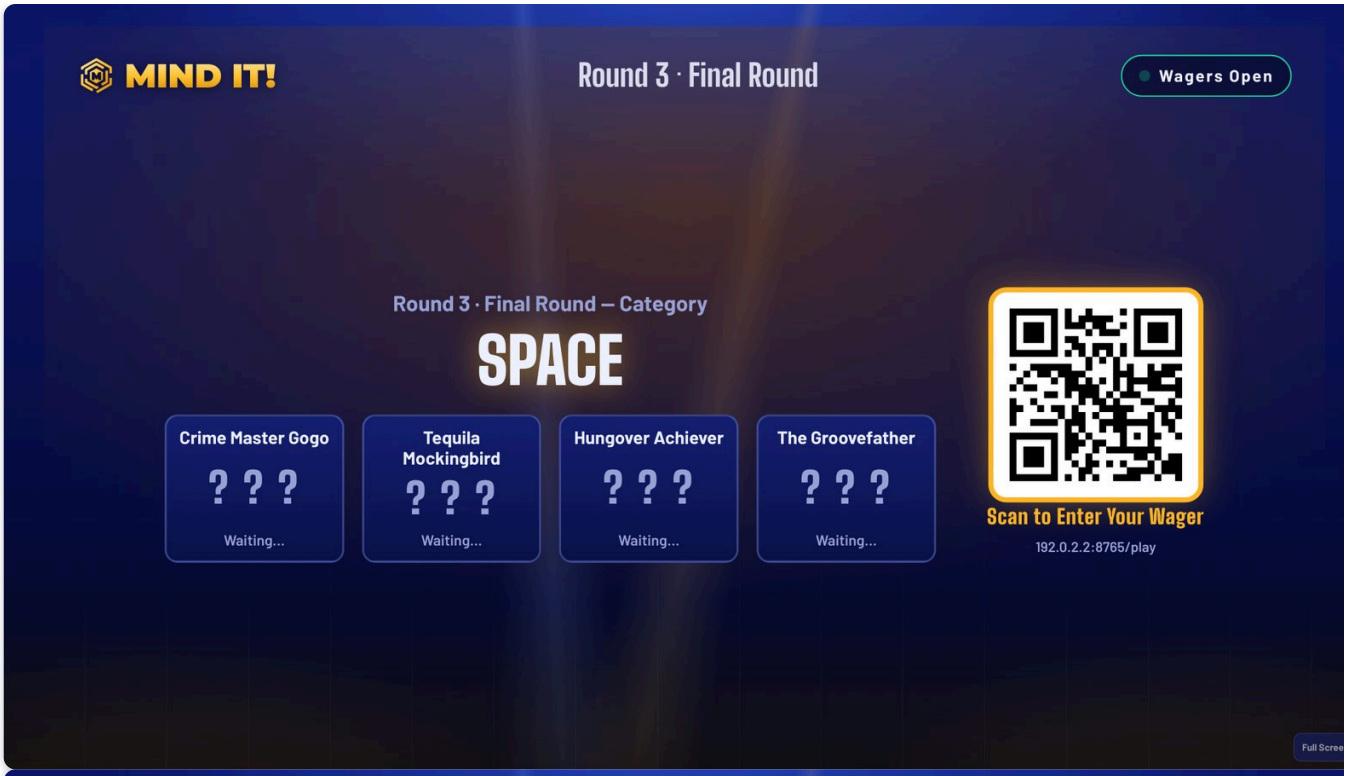
📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — the board with places on the score cards: Tequila Mockingbird leads (gold 1st); Crime Master Gogo, playing now, is "=2nd" in its Now Playing strip.*


MIND IT!
The Big Fat Quiz
Scan to Join Your Team
192.0.2.2:8765/play
Then Type Your Team Code
Tonight's Teams
Crime Master Gogo
Tequila Mockingbird
Hungover Achiever
The Groovefather
Full Screen


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Hungover Achiever
Next: Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo
Question Live
43
MOVIE QUOTES
Ð400
"Here's looking at you, kid" comes from which 1942 film?
WRONG ANSWER → HUNGOVER ACHIEVER'S TURN
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
Wrong
Tequila Mockingbird
– Ð400
Answering
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
The Groovefather
Ð0

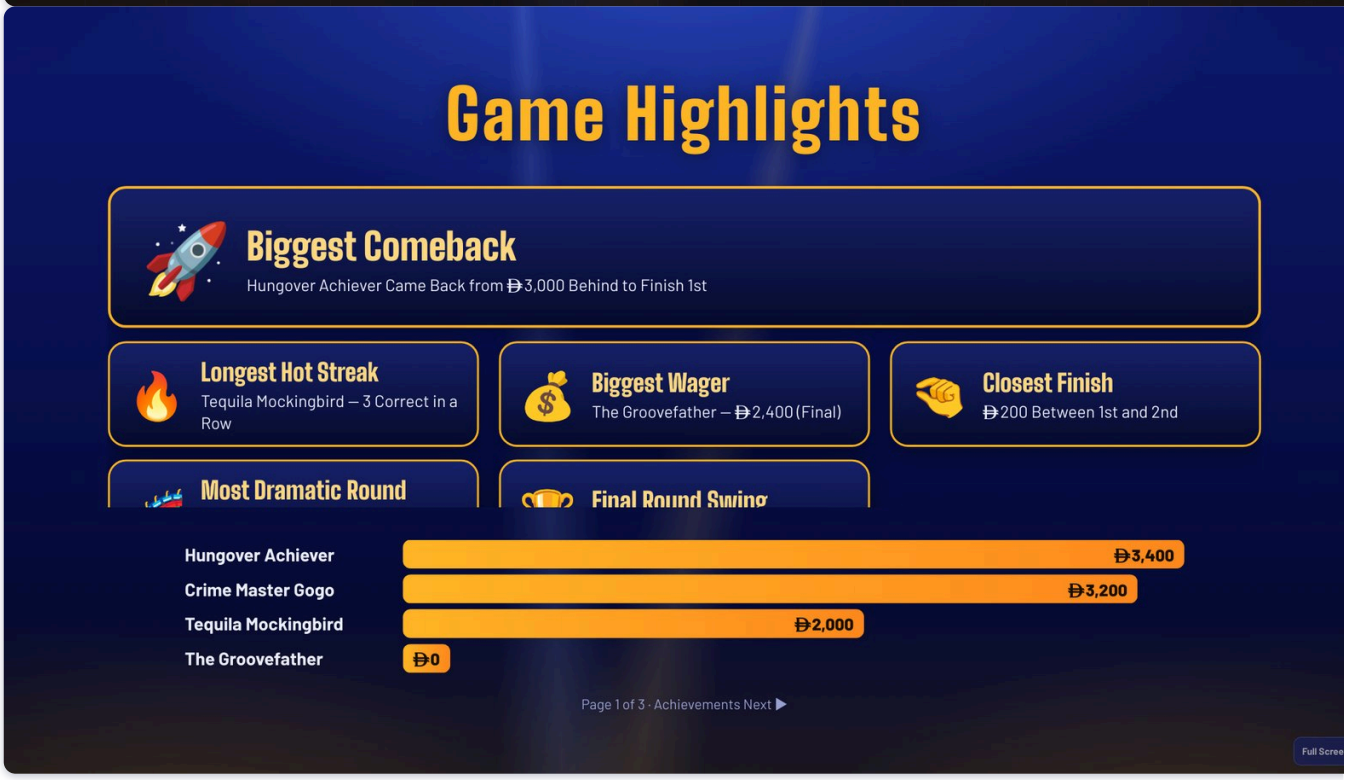

MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing The Groovefather
Next: Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird · Hungover Achiever
Answer Revealed
SCIENCE-ISH
Ð600
What gas do plants take in from the air to make food?
Carbon dioxide
CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +Ð600 + PASS ON BONUS Ð300
→ NOW 1ST ▲1
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
Tequila Mockingbird
- Ð400
Hungover Achiever
Ð400
Now Playing
The Groovefather
Ð0


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Round Ended Early
End of Round 1
General Knowledge
The Groovefather
Ð2,000 +Ð2,000 This Round
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð1,600 +Ð1,600 This Round
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200 +Ð1,200 This Round
Hungover Achiever
- Ð600 -Ð600 This Round
Round Mvp
Crime Master Gogo · 2 Correct
Daily Double
The Groovefather Won Ð1,000
Best Accuracy
The Groovefather · 100%
7 of 30 Clues Played · Up Next: Round 2 · World of Knowledge


MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Wagers Open
Round 3 · Final Round — Category
SPACE
Crime Master Gogo
? ? ?
Waiting...
Tequila Mockingbird
? ? ?
Waiting...
Hungover Achiever
? ? ?
Waiting...
The Groovefather
? ? ?
Waiting...
Scan to Enter Your Wager
192.0.2.2:8765/play


MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Answer Revealed
SPACE
This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025.
Saturn
Crime Master Gogo
Đ 1,600
Correct · Now Đ3,200
Tequila Mockingbird
Đ 0
Correct · Now Đ2,000
Hungover Achiever
Đ 1,000
Correct · Now Đ3,400
The Groovefather
Đ 2,400
Wrong · Now Đ0
1st Hungover Achiever Đ3,400
2nd Crime Master Gogo Đ3,200 ▲2
3rd Tequila Mockingbird Đ2,000
4th The Groovefather Đ0 ▼3


And the Winner Is...
Hungover Achiever
Ð3,400 Points
Crime Master Gogo
Ð3,200
2
Hungover Achiever
Ð3,400
1
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð2,000
3
Thanks for Playing!


Game Highlights
Biggest Comeback
Hungover Achiever Came Back from Ð3,000 Behind to Finish 1st
Longest Hot Streak
Tequila Mockingbird — 3 Correct in a Row
Biggest Wager
The Groovefather — Ð2,400 (Final)
Closest Finish
Ð200 Between 1st and 2nd
Most Dramatic Round
Final Round Swing
Hungover Achiever
Ð3,400
Crime Master Gogo
Ð3,200
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð2,000
The Groovefather
Ð0
Page 1 of 3 · Achievements Next ▶

Achievements Unlocked

Hot Streak
Tequila Mockingbird Had the Longest Hot Streak — 3 in a Row.

Hot Streak
The Groovefather Had the Longest Hot Streak — 3 in a Row.

Deadly Accuracy
Crime Master Gogo Were Right 75% of the Time (3/4).

Deadly Accuracy
Tequila Mockingbird Were Right 75% of the Time (3/4).

Speed Demon
Crime Master Gogo Got One Right in Just 0 Seconds.

Slow and Steady
Tequila Mockingbird Earned 3 Correct Answers the Patient Way — No Speed Bonus.

Slow and Steady
The Groovefather Earned 3 Correct Answers the Patient Way — No Speed Bonus.

Top of the Table
Hungover Achiever Finished Top

Climber
Hungover Achiever Climbed 3

Pass Master
Hungover Achiever Passed 1

Page 2 of 3 · Fun Stats Next ▶

Full Scree

Fun Stats

Phoenix Chips
Hungover Achiever (Round 2): Right → +Ð3,000 (Incl. Ð600 Catch-Up) (1 Paid Off)

Triple Gamble Chips
Crime Master Gogo Saved Theirs · Tequila Mockingbird Gambled 3× → +Ð1,200 · Hungover Achiever Saved Theirs · The Groovefather Saved Theirs (1 of 1 Paid Off)

Biggest Single Gain
Hungover Achiever +Ð3,000 from One Question

Biggest Comeback
Hungover Achiever Came Back from Ð3,000 Behind to Finish 1st

Longest Hot Streak
Tequila Mockingbird — 3 Correct in a Row

Biggest Wager
The Groovefather — Ð2,400 (Final)

Most Passes
Hungover Achiever Passed 1 Time

Most Pass Success
Crime Master Gogo Answered 1 Passed Question Correctly

Fastest Correct Answer
Crime Master Gogo with 44 Seconds Still On the Clock

Biggest Lead

Closest Finish

Most Dramatic Round
General Knowledge — Ð7,000 of

Page 3 of 3 · Final Results Next ▶

Full Scree



📸 *Real screenshots: Tonight's Teams (build 112, with the phone join code in the corner), then from the example game a wrong answer, end of Round 1, the Final wagers, the reveal, the winner and two award pages.*

16.2 Private vs public — what never goes on the TV ✅

Never on the TV	Where it lives
Answers before you reveal them	Host panel (laptop) "Host Only · Not Shown On Stage"; tablet "Tap To Show Answer"
Wager amounts before they are revealed (DD sealed by default; Final always)	Host panel / tablet
Team codes	🔐 Team Codes (host only)
Chip availability (except the public Phoenix holder)	Team phones; host Team Chips card
Final answer checker suggestions	Host panel / tablet
Setup, notes, controls, passwords	Host panel

The **host panel's** big preview is a copy of the TV — but the right-hand column of the host panel is **host only**. When sharing your screen (e.g. a Teams call), share the **Audience View window**, never the whole screen (the TV Display Guide explains how).

16.3 Connection warnings on the TV

The TV window gets its data from the host panel on the same laptop. If it hears nothing for 5 seconds, an amber pill **"Reconnecting to Host..."** appears; after 20 seconds (or if the host window closed) a red **"Connection Lost — Retrying..."**; and a green **"Connected"** for 3 seconds when it's back. The board stays visible.

16.4 Screen size tips

- The Audience View is designed for **16:9 at 1920 × 1080** (full HD). It shrinks long questions to fit.
- **Big room / far back row:** turn on **Large Text On TV** (5 · Audio & Presentation).

- **Projector or TV cutting off the edges: Audience View ▾ → TV Display Settings** (safe margins).
- **7–8 teams:** *TV Scoreboard Position → Auto* puts scores in a side column.
- **Colour-blind players: Colour-Blind-Safe Colours** shows correct in blue and wrong in orange with ✓ and ×.
- Rough guide: at least a 50-inch TV for a living room; a projector for 30+ people. Sit the Quizmaster where they can see both the laptop and the room.

---

17. Complete Example — Host an Entire Game

This chapter follows one real game, **THE BIG FAT QUIZ**, from start to finish. ✅ **Every score below was produced by the actual Mind It! 1.69 game engine** (the game was replayed in the real app and the scores were read back after every step), and then recalculated by hand.

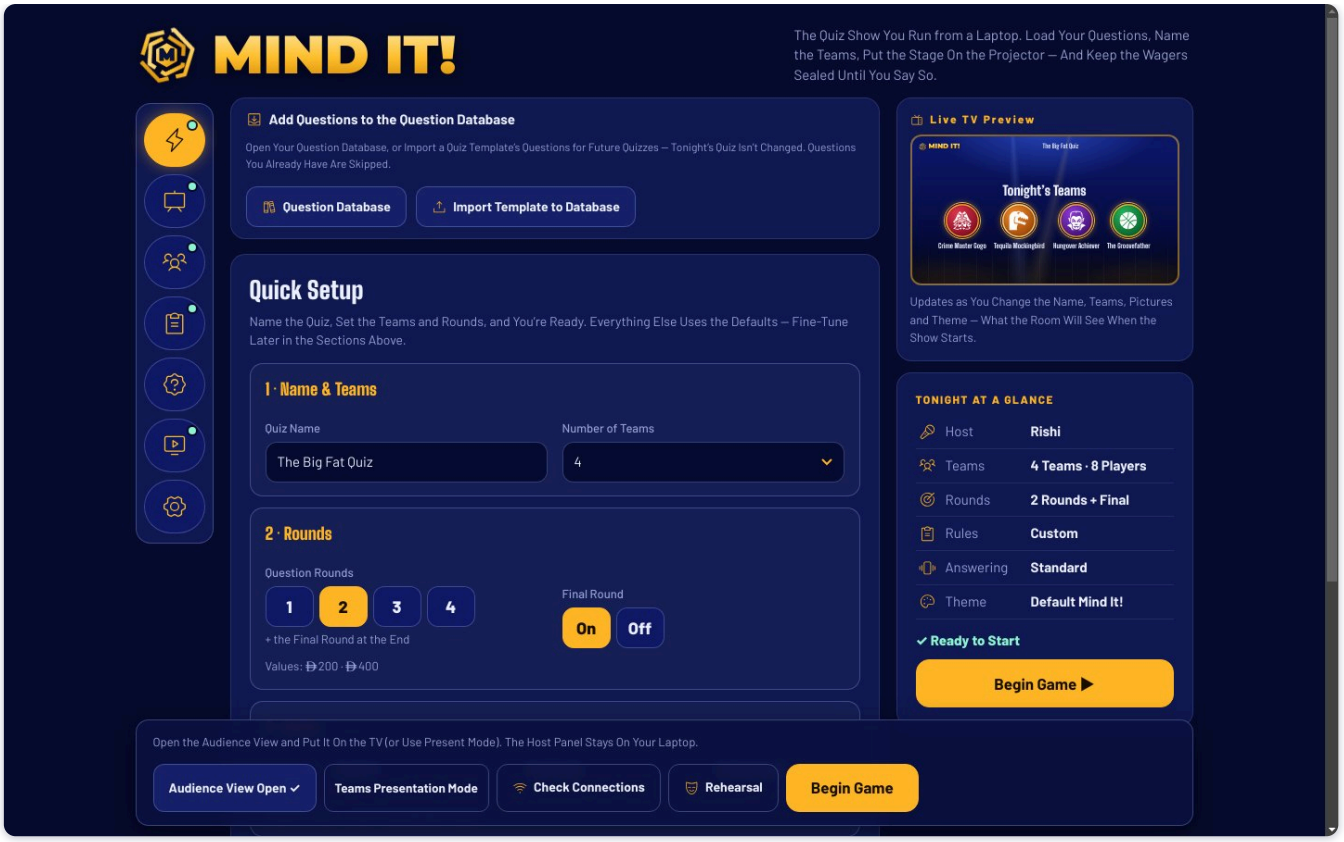
The teams (in turn order):

#	Team	Players
1	**Crime Master Gogo**	Asha, Esther
2	**Tequila Mockingbird**	Bilal, Farid
3	**Hungover Achiever**	Carmen, Gita
4	**The Groovefather**	Dev, Hamza

Quizmaster: Rishi. **Settings:** 2 question rounds + Final; Full Show rules; Standard Mode; 45-second timer. **Values:** Round 1 = 200–1,000, Round 2 = 400–2,000. **Speed bonus:** Round 1 = 100, Round 2 = 200.

Steps 1–8: before the game

1. **Open Mind It!** on the laptop. Setup opens. Open the Audience View on the TV — it shows the phone join QR code straight away.
2. **Create the quiz:** Quick Setup → Quiz Name *The Big Fat Quiz*, Number of Teams *4*.
3. **Rounds:** Question Rounds **2**, Final Round **On** (values 200 · 400).
4. **Questions:** Round 1 categories *Pub Grub, Movie Quotes, Science-ish, Geography, Music, Wildcards*; Round 2 *Sport, History, TV Shows, Food & Drink, Animals, Wordplay*; Final *SPACE*. Check them in 4 · Rounds & Questions.
5. **Teams:** name the four teams, add two players each, Quizmaster Rishi. Tonight at a Glance: *4 Teams · 8 Players · 2 Rounds + Final* ✓ Ready to Start.
6. **Tablet:** Connect ▾ → Connect Tablet; on the tablet, **Connect To Laptop → Connect**.
7. **Phones:** each team scans the join QR on the TV and types its code.
8. **Check connections:** 📶 Check Connections → TEST ALL CONNECTIONS → "All set".



📸 *Real screenshot — Setup with the tablet, the TV window and four phones connected (bottom bar: "Audience View Open ✓").*

Step 9: start the game

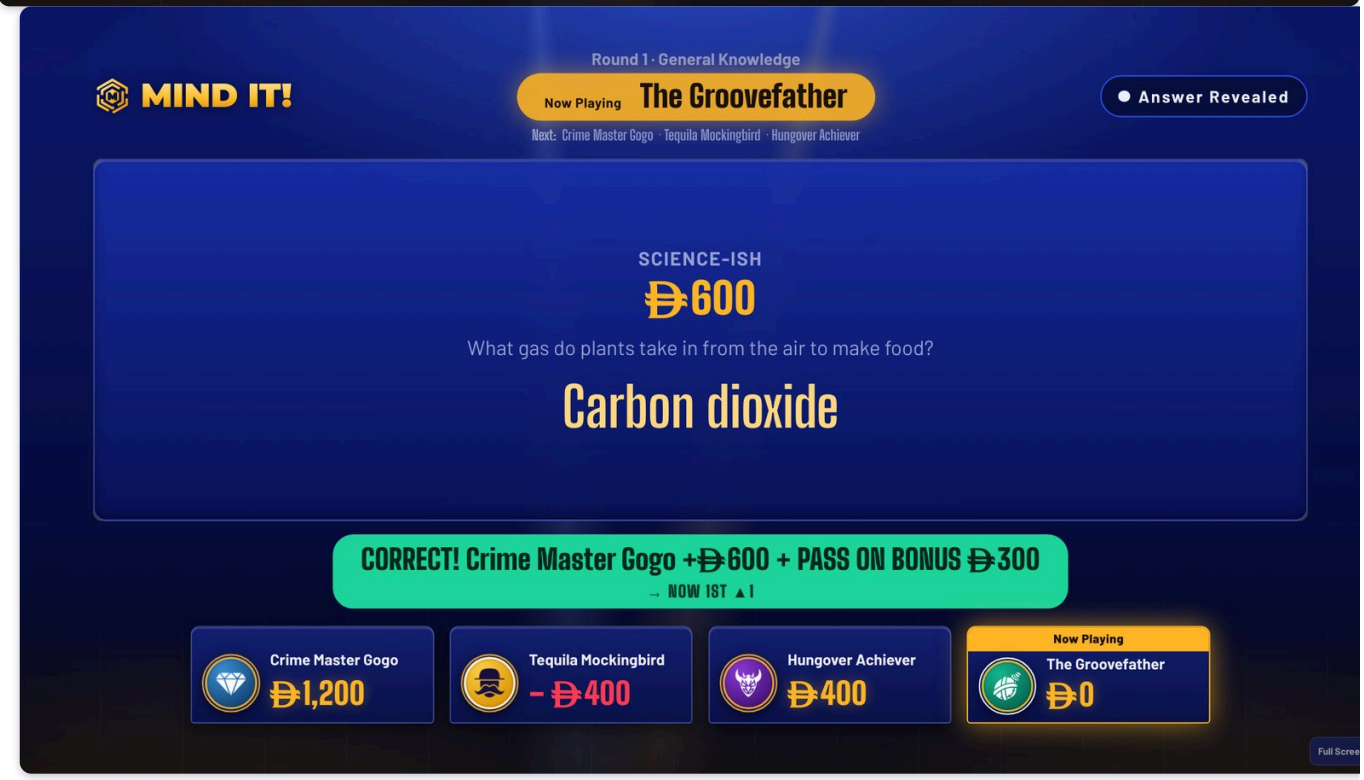
Begin Game ▶. The TV shows *Tonight's Teams*, then the Round 1 board. **Crime Master Gogo** is Now Playing.

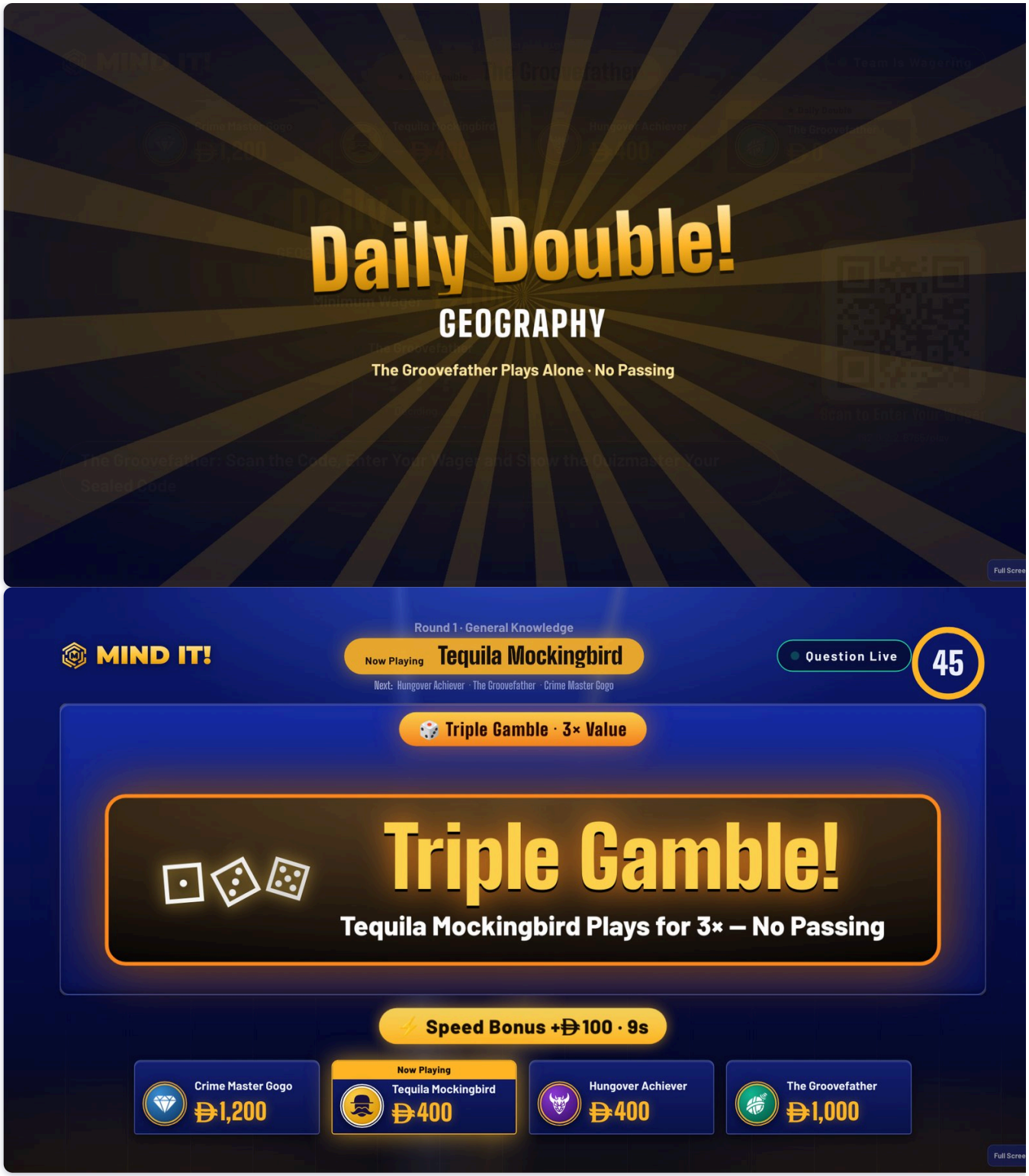
Steps 10–17: Round 1 — the running scoreboard

#	What happens	Calculation	Gogo	Tequila	Hungover	Groove
—	Start		0	0	0	0
1	**Gogo** picks *Pub Grub 200* ("Which country gave the world the croissant's ancestor, the kipferl?"). Answer "Austria" in 4 s. Quizmaster: **Correct**.	200 + speed bonus 100	**300**	0	0	0
2a	**Tequila** picks *Movie Quotes 400* ("'Here's looking at you, kid' comes from which 1942 film?"). Wrong. **Wrong Answer**.	−400	300	**−400**	0	0
2b	The question passes to **Hungover** (fresh 45 s). "Casablanca!" **Correct**.	+400 (not their pick → no speed bonus)	300	−400	**400**	0
3a	Next turn: the team after Tequila → **Hungover** picks *Science-ish 600*. They **Pass**.	0 · timer for next: 30 + 45 left → capped 45	300	−400	400	0
3b	**Groove** also **Passes**.	0	300	−400	400	0
3c	**Gogo**: "Carbon dioxide." **Correct**.	600 + 2 passes × 25% × 600 = 600 + 300	**1,200**	−400	400	0

#	What happens	Calculation	Gogo	Tequila	Hungover	Groove
4	Next turn: the team after Hungover → **Groove** picks *Geography 1,000* — **Daily Double!** Score 0, so the wager range is 1,000–1,000 (min = value; max = max(0, 1,000, 1,000)). Groove locks 1,000 on its phone. **Correct**.	+1,000	1,200	−400	400	**1,000**
5a	**Gogo** taps **Use** on **Bottoms Up** and chooses designated player **Asha**. Picks *Music 800*. Wrong! TV: "BOTTOMS UP!"	scoring pauses	1,200	−400	400	1,000
5b	Asha finishes her drink. Quizmaster: ✔ **Finished — Nothing Lost**.	0	1,200	−400	400	1,000
5c	The question passes to **Tequila**: **Correct**.	+800	1,200	**400**	400	1,000
6	Next turn: the team after Gogo → **Tequila** taps **Use** on **Triple Gamble** → Confirm. Picks *Wildcards 400*. TV: dice. **Correct**.	400 × 3 = +1,200	1,200	**1,600**	400	1,000
7a	**Hungover** picks *Music 1,000*. They're stuck — Quizmaster presses **+30 Sec** (45 → 75 s). Still wrong. **Wrong Answer**.	−1,000	1,200	1,600	**−600**	1,000
7b	Passes to **Groove**: **Correct**.	+1,000	1,200	1,600	−600	**2,000**
8	Time's getting on — Quizmaster: **More Controls → End Round Early** (asks first).		**1,200**	**1,600**	**−600**	**2,000**


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Tequila Mockingbird
Next: Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo
Answer Revealed
PUB GRUB
Ð200
Which country gave the world the croissant's ancestor, the kipferl?
Austria
CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +Ð200 + ⚡ SPEED BONUS Ð100
→ NOW 1ST
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
Now Playing
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð0
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
The Groovefather
Ð0
Full Screen


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing The Groovefather
Next: Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird · Hungover Achiever
Answer Revealed
SCIENCE-ISH
Ð600
What gas do plants take in from the air to make food?
Carbon dioxide
CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +Ð600 + PASS ON BONUS Ð300
→ NOW 1ST ▲1
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
Tequila Mockingbird
– Ð400
Hungover Achiever
Ð400
Now Playing
The Groovefather
Ð0


Daily Double!
GEOGRAPHY
The Groovefather Plays Alone · No Passing
MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Tequila Mockingbird
Next: Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo
Question Live
45
Triple Gamble · 3× Value
Triple Gamble!
Tequila Mockingbird Plays for 3× — No Passing
Speed Bonus +Ð100 · 9s
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
Now Playing
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð400
Hungover Achiever
Ð400
The Groovefather
Ð1,000



📸 *Real screenshots from this game — Step 1 (correct + speed bonus), Step 3c (pass-on bonus), Step 4 (Daily Double), Step 6 (Triple Gamble), end of Round 1.*

The TV's *End of Round 1* shows "Round Ended Early · 7 of 30 clues played", the score race (Groove 2,000 · Tequila 1,600 · Gogo 1,200 · Hungover −600) and awards: **Round MVP** Crime Master Gogo (2 correct), **Daily Double** The Groovefather won 1,000, **Best Accuracy** The Groovefather 100%.

Round 2 — the Phoenix rises

The Quizmaster presses **Start Round 2**. Hungover Achiever is last, **2,600 behind** the leader (2,000 − (−600)) — more than 2,000 — so the TV announces **THE PHOENIX IS LIVE: Hungover Achiever holds the Phoenix chip this round.** The first pick goes to **Groove** (the team after Hungover, who owned the last question).

#	What happens	Calculation	Gogo	Tequila	Hungover	Groove
—	Start of Round 2		1,200	1,600	−600	2,000
9	**Groove**: a 400, right (after 15 s — too slow for the speed bonus).	+400	1,200	1,600	−600	**2,400**
10	**Gogo**: a 400, right (slow).	+400	**1,600**	1,600	−600	2,400
11	**Tequila**: a 400, right (slow).	+400	1,600	**2,000**	−600	2,400
12	**Hungover** taps **Use** on the **Phoenix**, picks *TV Shows 1,200*, answers right (slowly).	Gap to leader = 2,400 − (−600) = 3,000. Catch-up = 20% × 3,000 = 600. 2 × 1,200 + 600 = 3,000. Capped at the gap (3,000) → **+3,000**	1,600	2,000	**2,400**	2,400

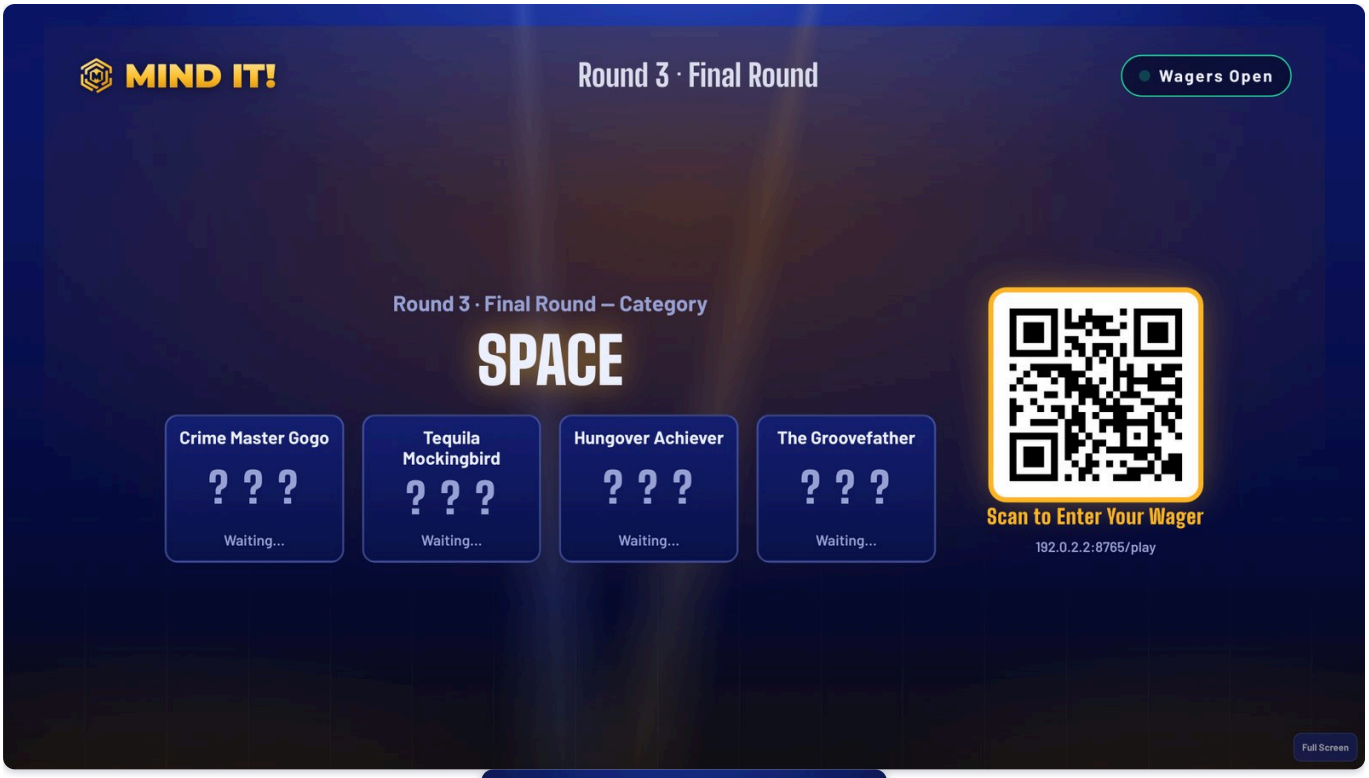
TV: **"PHOENIX RISES! Hungover Achiever +3,000 · Double Points + 600 Catch-Up"** — level with the leader, not past. The Quizmaster ends Round 2 (End Round Early) and starts the Final.

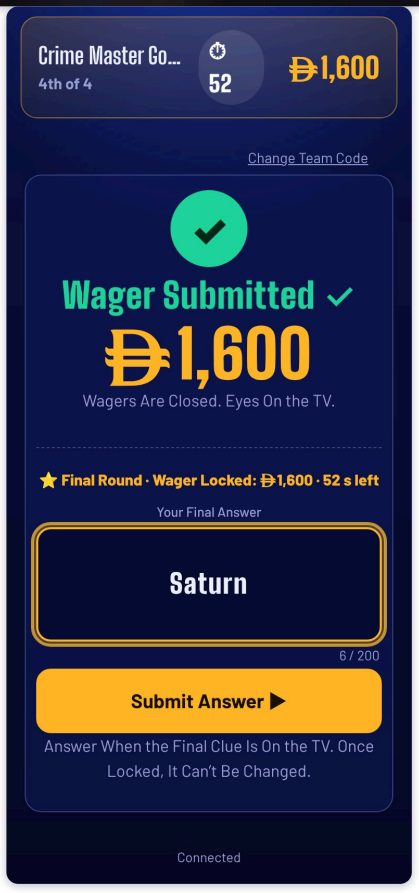
Steps 18–21: the Final Round

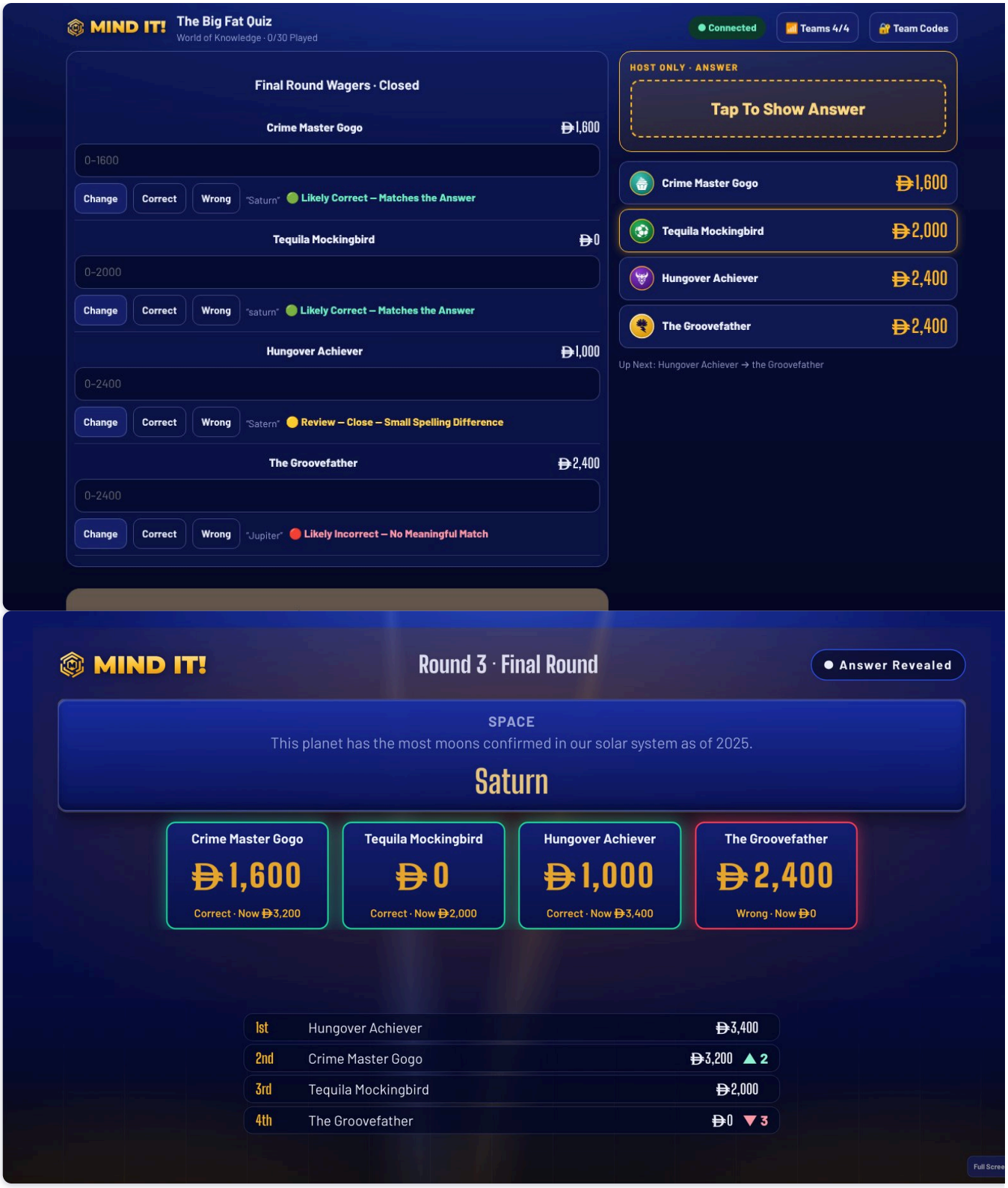
Category: SPACE. Every team has 0 or more, so all four play. Maximum wagers = their scores.

Team	Score	Allowed	Wager (on phone)	Typed answer	Checker	Quizmaster	Change	New score
Crime Master Gogo	1,600	0–1,600	**1,600** (all in)	"Saturn"	🟢 Likely Correct	Accept	+1,600	**3,200**
Tequila Mockingbird	2,000	0–2,000	**0** (nothing)	"saturn"	🟢 Likely Correct	Accept	+0	**2,000**
Hungover Achiever	2,400	0–2,400	**1,000**	"Satern"	🟡 Review — small spelling difference	Accept	+1,000	**3,400**
The Groovefather	2,400	0–2,400	**2,400** (all in)	"Jupiter"	🔴 Likely Incorrect	Reject	−2,400	**0**

The question: *"This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025."* Answer: **Saturn**. *(The wagers and scores come from the replayed game; the typed answers and the checker's verdicts come from a second real run of the same Final with the same wagers — the screenshots below are from that run.)* The reveal goes **lowest score first** (Gogo, Tequila, then the two teams on 2,400).


MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Wagers Open
Round 3 · Final Round — Category
SPACE
Crime Master Gogo
? ? ?
Waiting...
Tequila Mockingbird
? ? ?
Waiting...
Hungover Achiever
? ? ?
Waiting...
The Groovefather
? ? ?
Waiting...
Scan to Enter Your Wager
192.0.2.2:8765/play
Full Screen


Crime Master Go...
4th of 4
52
Ð1,600
Change Team Code
Wager Submitted
Ð1,600
Wagers Are Closed. Eyes On the TV.
Final Round · Wager Locked: Ð1,600 · 52 s left
Your Final Answer
Saturn
6 / 200
Submit Answer
Answer When the Final Clue Is On the TV. Once Locked, It Can't Be Changed.
Connected



📸 *Real screenshots — the Final wager screen, a phone typing its answer, the tablet with the checker's suggestions, and the TV after the last reveal.*

Steps 22–25: winner, saving, End Game, main menu

Final standings: 🥇 **Hungover Achiever 3,400** · 🥈 Crime Master Gogo 3,200 · 🥉 Tequila Mockingbird 2,000 · 4th The Groovefather 0.

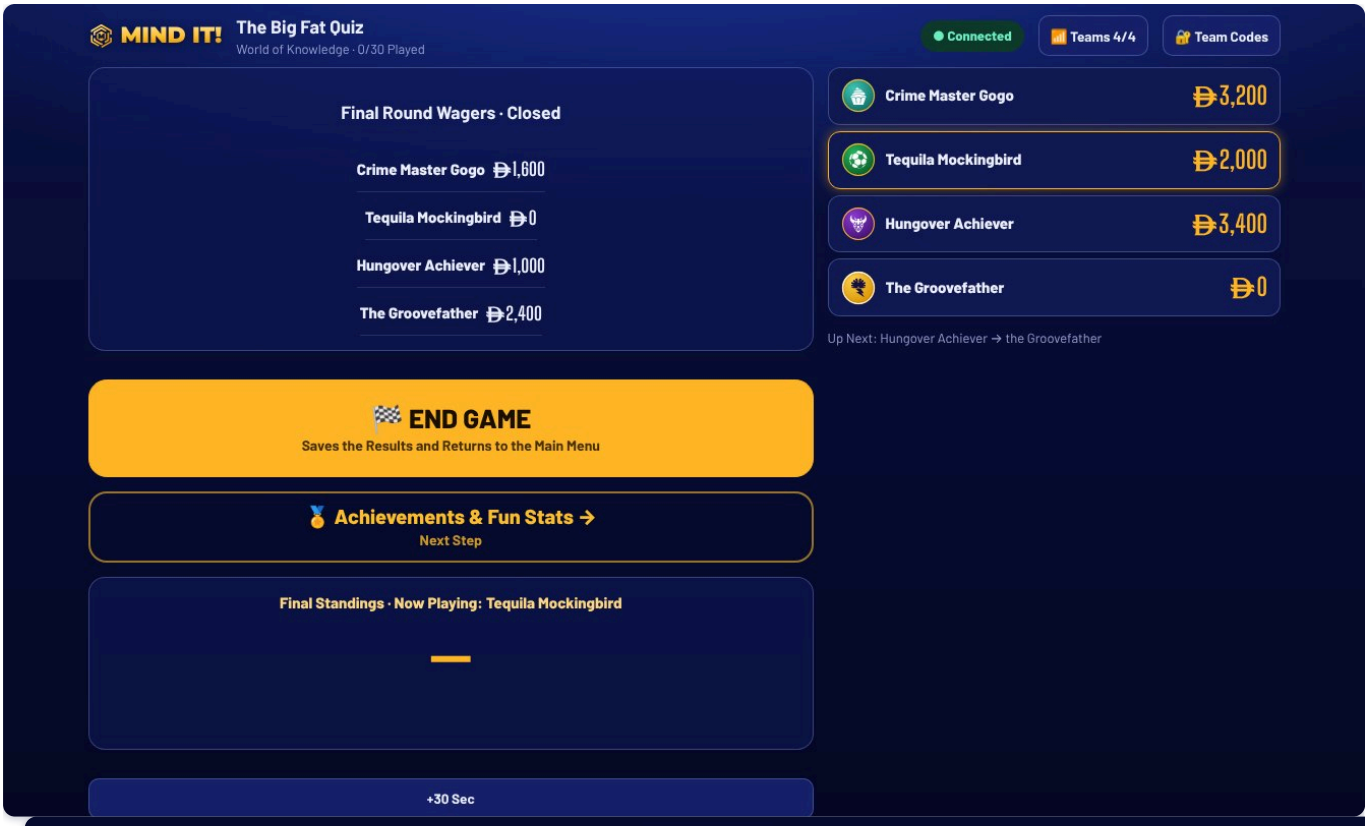
From last place at −600 to champions. 🎉

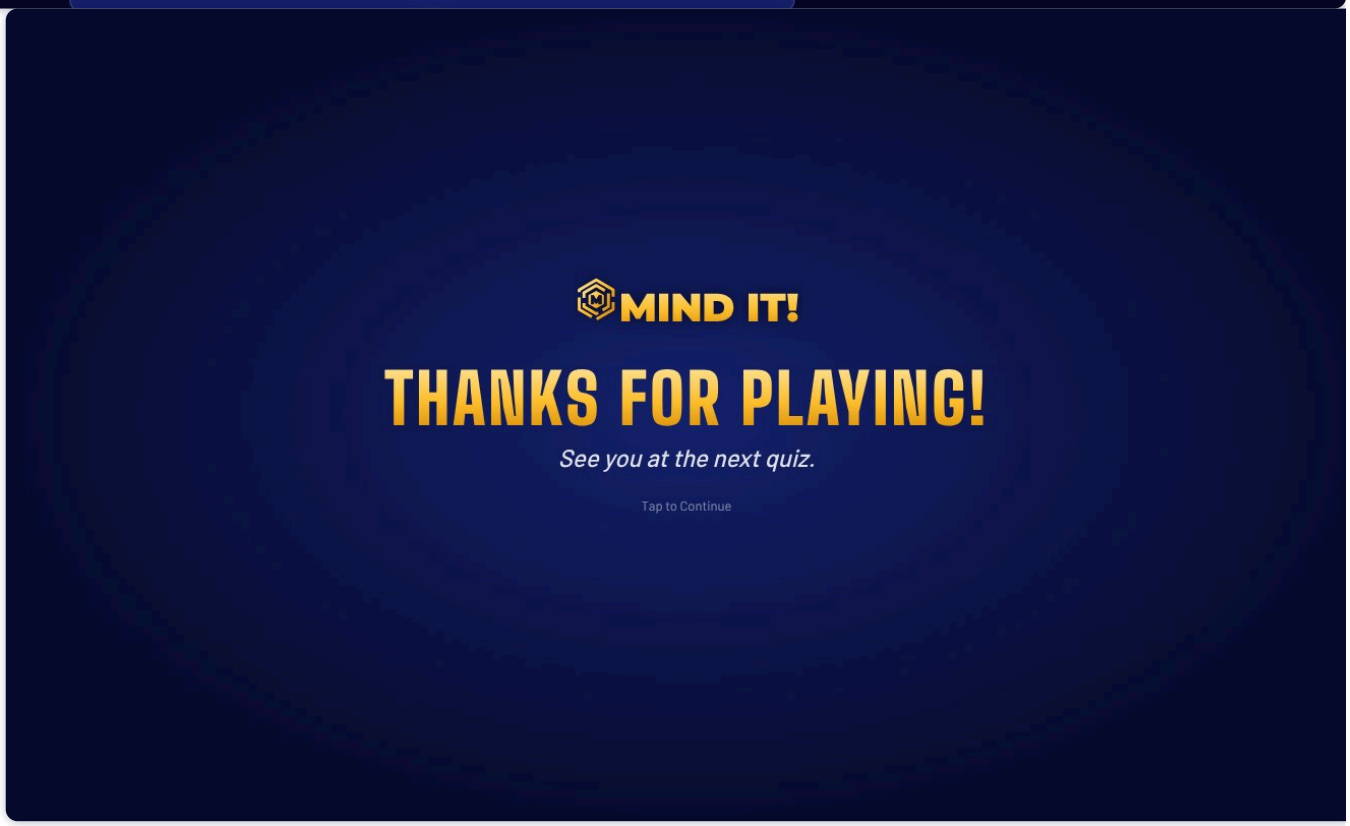


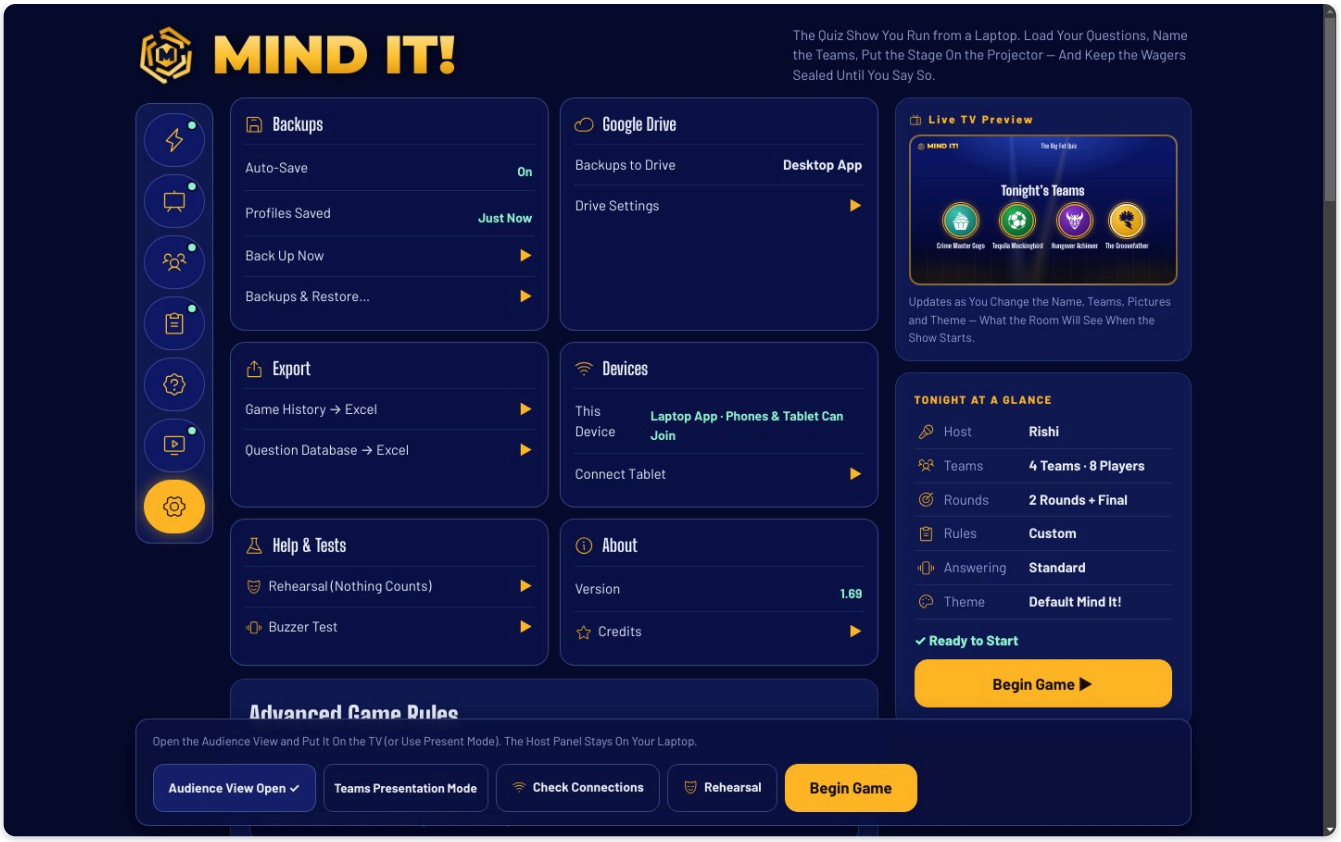
📸 *Real screenshots — the podium and the winner.*

- **22. Winner announcement:** the TV goes Final Standings → "And the Winner Is... Hungover Achiever". Press 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** for the awards slideshow. This game earned, among others: Speed Demon (Crime Master Gogo), Triple Threat (Tequila Mockingbird), Bottoms Up! (Crime Master Gogo's designated player), Overtime Hero (The Groovefather), Double Down (The Groovefather), Rise From The Ashes and the Phoenix climb award (Hungover Achiever — shown as "Comeback Kid" in build 111, "Phoenix Climber" since build 113), Photo Finish (Hungover Achiever) and Gambler's Ruin (The Groovefather).
- **23. Game saving:** the game was saved to **Historic Games** automatically when the standings appeared ("✓ Game saved to history · ✓ Questions added to the Question Database · ✓ Included in backups").

- **24. End Game:** on the tablet, the big 🏁 **END GAME** button → confirm "End the game and go back to the Main Menu? The results are saved on the laptop." The tablet shows **THANKS FOR PLAYING!**; the laptop returns to Setup.
- **25. Main menu:** the tablet is back on its Main Menu, the laptop on Setup, ready for the next quiz.


MIND IT!
The Big Fat Quiz
World of Knowledge · 0/30 Played
Connected
Teams 4/4
Team Codes
Final Round Wagers · Closed
Crime Master Gogo Ð1,600
Tequila Mockingbird Ð0
Hungover Achiever Ð1,000
The Groovefather Ð2,400
Crime Master Gogo Ð3,200
Tequila Mockingbird Ð2,000
Hungover Achiever Ð3,400
The Groovefather Ð0
Up Next: Hungover Achiever → the Groovefather
END GAME
Saves the Results and Returns to the Main Menu
Achievements & Fun Stats →
Next Step
Final Standings · Now Playing: Tequila Mockingbird
+30 Sec


MIND IT!
THANKS FOR PLAYING!
See you at the next quiz.
Tap to Continue



📸 *Real screenshots — END GAME on the tablet, the thank-you splash, and the laptop back in Setup.*

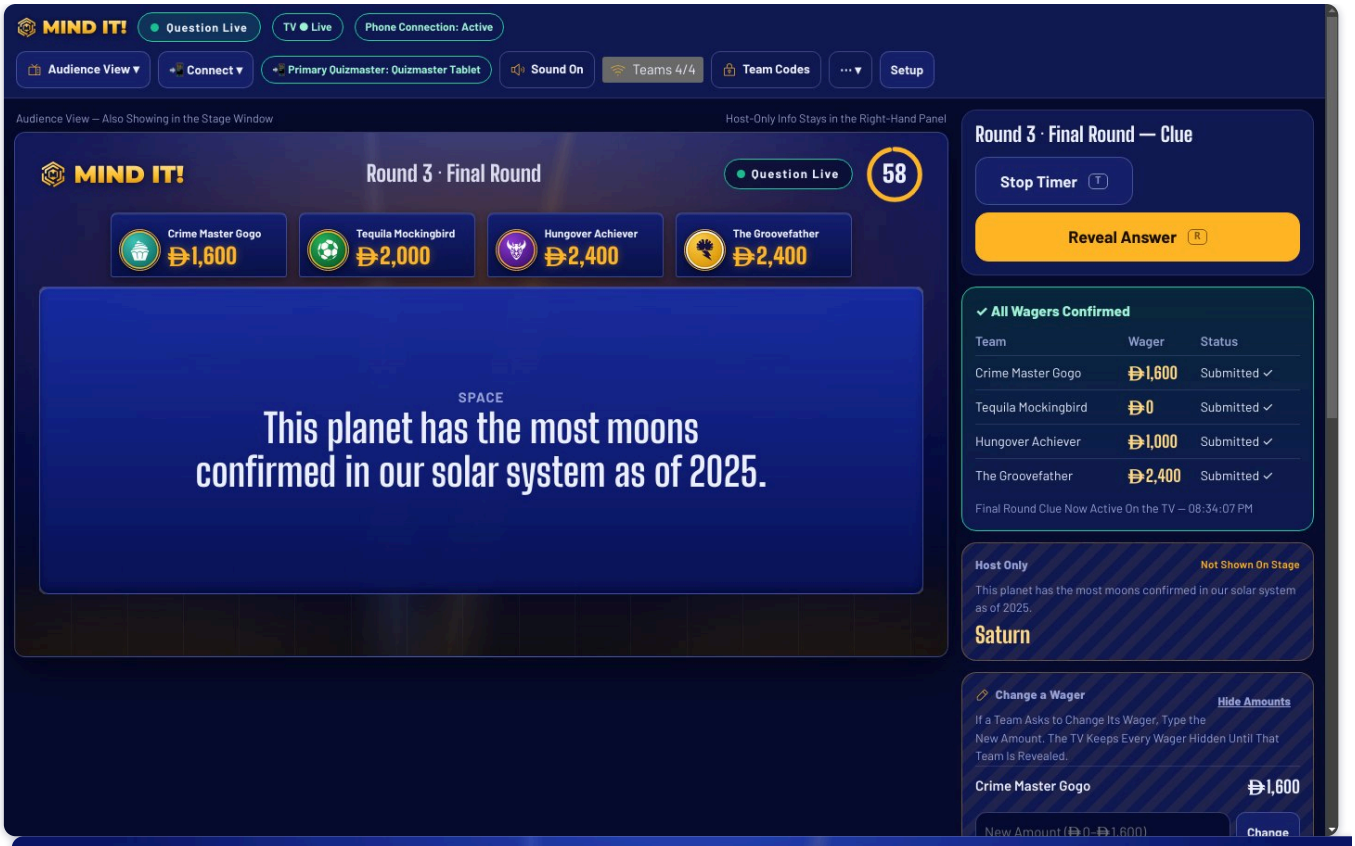
Lessons from this game: passing early cost Hungover nothing; the Daily Double minimum (1,000) gave Groove a big early jump; a 0-point Final wager kept Tequila safe but couldn't win; Groove's all-in wager was the gamble that decided the night.

---

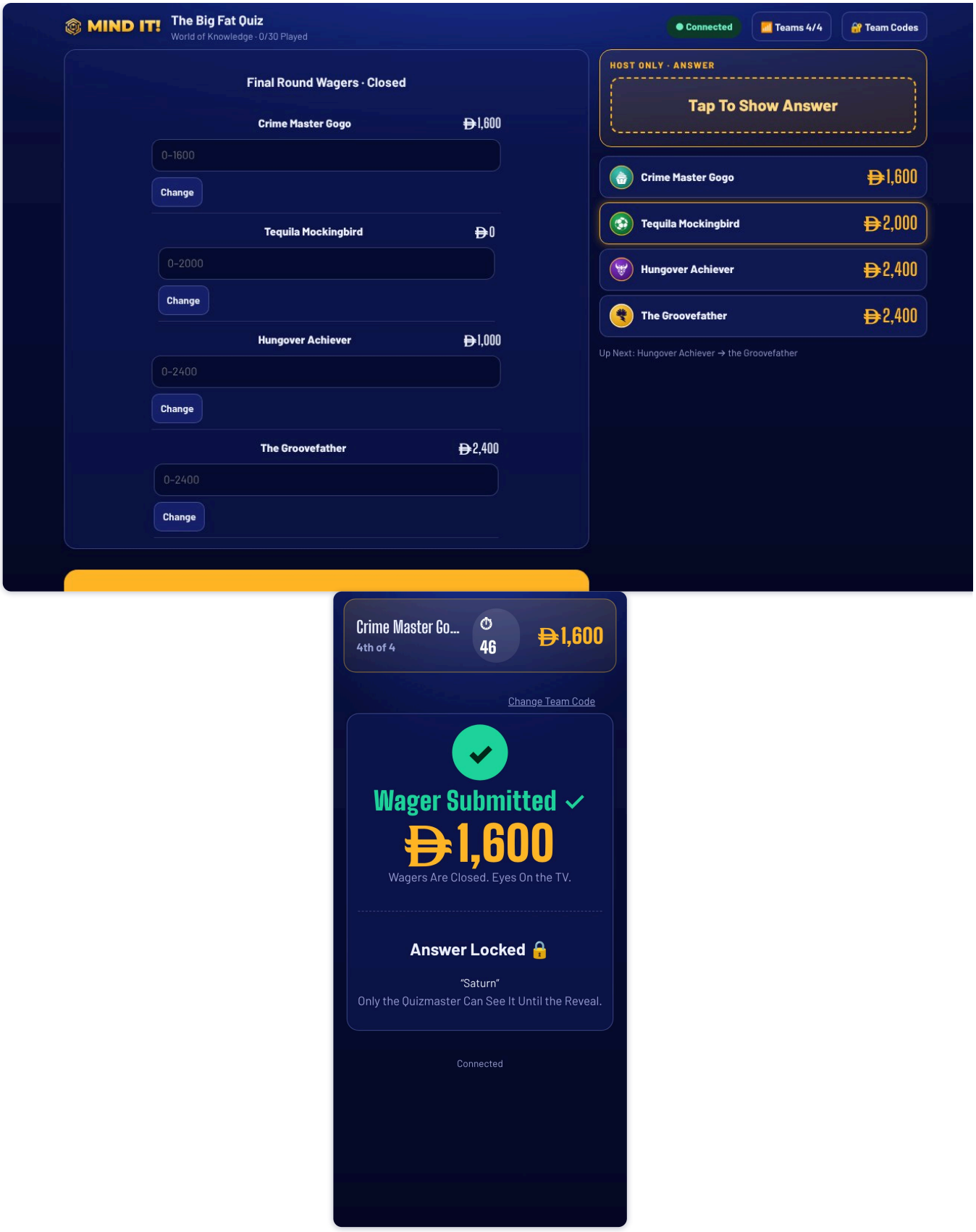
18. Final Round

18.1 The complete process ✅

1. **Category reveal.** When the last board round ends, the Final starts: the TV shows **Final Round**, the **category**, a box per eligible team ("? ? ? · Waiting...") and a **QR code**. The question is only in the host panel.
2. **The Final question is now locked** (build 114) until the game ends — no switching or editing by accident while teams are wagering or answering. You can still add **accepted alternate answers** (e.g. "USA" for "United States") in the answer review (build 115).
3. **Who plays:** every team with **0 or more** points that isn't Away. Teams below zero sit out. If nobody is eligible, the Final is skipped with a notice.
4. **Wagers open immediately.** Each team wagers privately on its phone: any whole amount from **0** to its score (quick picks **All in / Half / Nothing**) → **Lock in**. The phone shows **Wager Submitted** ✓ and "Wagers are closed. Eyes on the TV." once all are in. The TV box changes to **Locked in**.
5. **Wager confirmation.** The host panel lists each team, its wager and "Submitted ✓". When **every** eligible team has a valid wager, wagers close and **the question appears automatically**. Or press **Close Wagers** (missing wagers count as **0** and stay editable) — **Reopen Wagers** is available.
6. **Minimum wager: 0.** A team on 0 can only wager 0.
7. **The question** appears on the TV with a **60-second timer** and thinking music.
8. **Answers.** Each team **types one answer** on the same phone that wagered ("Your Final Answer" → **Submit Answer** ▶ → confirm → **Answer Locked** 🔒). Spoken answers can be marked by the Quizmaster as usual. **Typed answers close 2 seconds after time's up** (build 114): a later answer is refused and the phone shows ⏱ **Time's Up** ("If your team said its answer out loud, tell the Quizmaster"). If you add time (**+30 Sec**), answers open again.
9. **Answer checking (advisory only):** each typed answer gets 🟢 **Likely Correct**, 🟡 **Review** or 🔴 **Likely Incorrect**, with a reason ("Matches the answer", "Close — small spelling difference", "No meaningful match"). When unsure it says Review, never Correct. Accepted alternate answers count. The TV never shows these.
10. **Quizmaster overrides: Accept / Reject** (or **Accept Anyway / Mark Incorrect** if you disagree with the checker), **Wrong, No Penalty**, and ✎ **Edit Answer** (the original typing is kept in the record). Every decision is audited in the game record.
11. **Reveal**, one team at a time, **lowest score first**, in an order fixed when the Final started: **Reveal <team> (V)**. Each team must be marked before it can be revealed. The TV shows the wager, "Correct · now 3,200" / "Wrong · now 0", and the live standings with ▲▼.
12. **Scoring:** right **+wager**, wrong **–wager**, wrong-no-penalty **0**.
13. **Final standings**, then the **winner**.


MIND IT!
Question Live
TV ● Live
Phone Connection: Active
Audience View ▾
Connect ▾
Primary Quizmaster: Quizmaster Tablet
Sound On
Teams 4/4
Team Codes
Setup
Audience View — Also Showing in the Stage Window
Host-Only Info Stays in the Right-Hand Panel
MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Question Live
58
Crime Master Gogo
Đ1,600
Tequila Mockingbird
Đ2,000
Hungover Achiever
Đ2,400
The Groovefather
Đ2,400
SPACE
This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025.
Round 3 · Final Round — Clue
Stop Timer T
Reveal Answer R
All Wagers Confirmed
Team
Wager
Status
Crime Master Gogo
Đ1,600
Submitted
Tequila Mockingbird
Đ0
Submitted
Hungover Achiever
Đ1,000
Submitted
The Groovefather
Đ2,400
Submitted
Final Round Clue Now Active On the TV — 08:34:07 PM
Host Only
Not Shown On Stage
This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025.
Saturn
Change a Wager
Hide Amounts
If a Team Asks to Change Its Wager, Type the New Amount. The TV Keeps Every Wager Hidden Until That Team Is Revealed.
Crime Master Gogo
Đ1,600
New Amount (Đ0–Đ1,600)
Change


MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Question Live
60
Crime Master Gogo
Đ1,600
Tequila Mockingbird
Đ2,000
Hungover Achiever
Đ2,400
The Groovefather
Đ2,400
SPACE
This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025.



📸 Real screenshots — the laptop while the Final is live (wagers confirmed), and the phone after locking its answer.

18.2 Changing a wager ✅

Teams **can't** change their own wager after Lock in (a different amount is blocked and shown to the host as a blocked attempt). The **Quizmaster** can: ✏️ **Change a Wager** on the laptop, or **Change** on the tablet (with confirmation) — until that team is revealed. The team's phone shows the new amount.

18.3 Ties

✅ **Level on points? The team with the most correct answers wins.** (Changed in build 112 — the owner's decision. Before, only the records used this rule and the TV showed a tie.)

- **The TV and the records now agree.** The final standings, the Final reveal list and the winner screen place level teams by **most correct answers**. The standings say **"TIED ON POINTS — <TEAM> WINS ON MOST CORRECT ANSWERS"**, and the winner screen says **"And the Winner Is... <team>"** with "**Won on most correct answers (3 vs 2)**" under the score.
- **Level on points *and* correct answers?** Then it really is a tie: the TV shows **"IT'S A TIE!"** (or "IT'S A TIE AT THE TOP — A & B") and the teams share the win in the records.
- During the game (board, round summaries) level teams still simply share a place — the tie-break only decides the final result.
- **The counts are on screen** (build 113): the final standings and the winner podium show ✓ **3 Correct** under each score (and "· ✓ N" for 4th place and below), and the phones' scoreboard shows each team's ✓ count all game.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — Crime Master Gogo and Hungover Achiever both finish on 1,200; Hungover answered 3 questions correctly, Gogo 2, so Hungover takes 1st place.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the winner screen names Hungover Achiever: "1,200 Points · Won On Most Correct Answers (3 vs 2)".*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — the final standings with each team's correct answers.*

18.4 A worked example with numbers

Team	Score before	Wager	Right / wrong	Calculation	After
A	5,000	2,001	Wrong	5,000 − 2,001	2,999
B	3,000	3,000	Right	3,000 + 3,000	6,000
C	0	0	Right	0 + 0	0

Team	Score before	Wager	Right / wrong	Calculation	After
D	−400	—	(sits out)	—	−400

Strategy note: A bet 2,001 to make sure that, if right, it would end on 7,001 — more than B's maximum (6,000). Wrong, though…

---

19. Ending a Game

19.1 What happens, in order

1. **Final standings** appear (laptop and TV). **At this moment the game is saved to Historic Games** — exactly once per game (never for a Rehearsal). Player statistics, achievements, the leaderboard and "used" question marks are updated, and all the quiz's questions are added to the Question Database.
2. **Results review:** 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** (Game Highlights → Achievements Unlocked → Fun Stats → Final Results), **Winner Screen**, **Save Picture** (a PNG of the standings).
3. **End the night:** press 🏁 **END GAME** on the tablet, or **Back to Setup** on the laptop.



📸 *Real screenshots — the laptop's winner screen and the awards ("Game Highlights") with the host controls.*

19.2 What END GAME does exactly ✅

- It appears on the tablet **after the final standings** (and on a tablet-only game too). Tapping it asks: *"End the game and go back to the Main Menu? The results are saved on the laptop."*
- The tablet sends **one** End Game command. The laptop **finishes the game record once** — it's the same record the standings already made, never a second Historic Game — and goes back to Setup, exactly like "Back to Setup".

- If the connection drops right after the tap, the tablet **re-sends it automatically** when it reconnects; the laptop recognises the repeat and doesn't save twice. A stray End Game for an old game is refused.
- The tablet shows **THANKS FOR PLAYING!** ("See you at the next quiz." — tap to skip) and returns to its Main Menu.
- **In a Rehearsal**, END GAME ends the rehearsal and records nothing.
- **Team phones** say **"🏁 Thanks For Playing!"** — also after a Final played with phone wagers (fixed in build 112), and also when the laptop's **Back to Setup** ends the game.
- It changes no scores and no rules.

19.3 How the laptop and tablet stay in step

The laptop is the single source of truth. Every tablet button is a command the laptop confirms; the tablet then shows the laptop's new state. The tablet locks the END GAME button while it waits (no double taps), and if no confirmation arrives it retries. Questions, players and games are synced in both directions (**✓ Synced with the Laptop**).

19.4 Reopening results later

- **Player Profiles → Historic Games** lists every saved game; open one to see its teams, scores, questions (exactly as asked), achievements and Final answers.
- **Save Standings Picture** works from the standings/winner screens.
- **Export History to Excel** for spreadsheets.
- The **Leaderboard** tab ranks players across games.

PART SIX — ADDITIONAL FEATURES

20. Achievements, Statistics and Historic Games

20.1 How per-game achievements work ✅

- They are worked out **from real game data** at the end of a game and **never change scores, places, wagers, turns or the winner**.
- They go to **teams**; tied teams all get it; each achievement goes to a team at most once per game; nothing is given just for taking part.
- **Career totals credit every player on the team.** A few awards are for **one-player teams only** (🦸 Comeback Kid — "biggest comeback by a solo player"). The **Bottoms Up** awards go to the **designated player only**.
- They appear in the 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** TV pages and are frozen into the Historic Game.

20.2 Every per-game achievement (59 definitions)

The "v" column is the version that introduced it. All are implemented ✅; achievements were verified by the app's test suites (the worked game in Chapter 17 earned 53 awards).

Icon	Name	Condition	Notes
🔥	On Fire	5 or more correct answers in a row	
♨️	Hot Streak	Longest run of correct answers	2+
🎯	Deadly Accuracy	Best correct-answer percentage	4+ attempts
💣	Knowledge Bomb	10 or more correct answers	
⚡	Speed Demon	Fastest correct answer	
🐢	Slow And Steady	Most correct answers without a speed bonus	3+
👑	Top Of The Table	Finished with the highest score	
📈	Climber	Gained the most places during the game	
🏃	Pass Master	Passed the most questions	
↩️	Wrong Turn	Most wrong answers	
🎲	Professional Guesser	5 or more wrong answers	
🧊	Ice Cold	Longest run of wrong answers	2+
😵	What Was That?	Most wrong answers on high-value questions	top two values
💀	So Close	Smallest losing margin	
🎰	Risk Taker	Highest total wagered	
💰	Big Spender	Largest single wager	
🎲	Double Down	Most Daily Doubles won	

Icon	Name	Condition	Notes
🫠	Double Trouble	Biggest Daily Double loss	
🧨	All Or Nothing	Biggest wager compared with the score at the time	
🏆	Final Boss	Biggest Final Round gain	
🏁	Finisher	Moved up the most places in the Final Round	
🚀	Comeback Kings	Biggest recovery from their lowest score	
🦸	Comeback Kid	Biggest comeback by a solo player	one-player teams
🪀	Score Yo-Yo	Most total score movement	
🎭	Drama Queen	Biggest single-question swing	
🕵️	Last-Minute Hero	Correct answer with the least time left	
🐦	Early Bird	Biggest lead in the early rounds	
🧠	Perfect Start	First 3+ answers all correct	
✨	Clean Sweep	Every answer correct	5+ answers
🏃	Ran The Category	Answered every question in one category correctly	3+ questions
🥇	Wire To Wire	Led from the first scoring question to the end	
🧗	Bottom To Top	Was in last place at some point and still won	
🌱	Late Bloomer	Last after Round 1, finished in the top two	
💔	Heartbreaker	Led going into the Final Round but didn't win	
📸	Photo Finish	Took the lead in the Final Round	
🟢	Back From The Red	Dropped below zero but finished positive	
📊	Consistent Performer	Scored points in every round played	2+ rounds
🏀	Rebound King	Most correct answers on questions another team missed or passed	
💎	High Roller Row	Most correct answers on the top-value questions	2+
🛒	Bargain Hunter	Most correct answers on the lowest-value questions	2+
🔬	Specialist	Most correct answers in a single category	3+
🌍	All-Rounder	Correct answers in the most different categories	3+
🤠	Quick Draw	3+ correct answers within 5 seconds	
⚡	Speed Collector	Earned the most speed bonuses	
🚫	No Pass Zone	Never passed a question	5+ attempts
⏱️	Overtime Hero	Answered correctly after the host added +30 seconds	
🔥	True Daily Double Hero	Answered a True Daily Double correctly	

Icon	Name	Condition	Notes
💸	Gambler's Ruin	Lost everything on a single wager	
🧾	Final Answer Ace	Final answer right first time — the checker agreed, no override	
⚡	Lightning Reflexes	Fastest buzz of the game	Phone Buzzer Mode
🛡️	Title Defence	Returning champion who won again	Returning Champion rule
⚔️	Dethroned The Champ	Beat the returning champion to win	Returning Champion rule
🎲	Triple Threat	Answered a Triple Gamble question correctly	
💎	High Roller	Answered a Triple Gamble Daily Double correctly (6×)	
♠️	All In	Used the Triple Gamble on the highest-value question available	
🔥	Rise From The Ashes	Used the Phoenix chip and went on to win the game	
🚀	Phoenix Climber	Climbed two or more places in the round after using the Phoenix chip (called "Comeback Kid" before build 113)	
🍺	Bottoms Up!	The designated player who finished their drink on a Bottoms Up and saved the team's points	designated player only
🥛	Glass Half Full	The designated player on a Bottoms Up who couldn't finish their drink	designated player only

✅ *Until build 112 the 🚀 Phoenix award was also called "Comeback Kid" and shared the 🦸 solo award's internal id, so one could hide the other. Since build 113 it is "Phoenix Climber" and all 59 achievements are separate. Games saved before keep the name they were saved with.*

20.3 Career badges (11) — on player profiles

🏆 **First Win** · 🎩 **Hat-Trick** (3 wins in a row) · 🔥 **Unstoppable** (5 in a row) · 👑 **Serial Winner** (10 wins) · 🚀 **Comeback King** (won after being last) · 🎯 **Daily Double Specialist** (3+ Daily Doubles right) · 🧠 **Big Brain** (15+ right in a game) · 💰 **High Roller** (10,000+ in a game) · ⚖️ **Tiebreak Hero** · 🎖️ **Veteran** (10 games) · 🌟 **Quiz Legend** (25 games).

20.4 Career milestones (6)

📅 **Regular** (5 quiz nights in a row) · 💯 **Century** (100 correct) · 🏅 **Collector** (10 different achievements) · 🥈 **Always The Bridesmaid** (2nd three times) · 🗡️ **Giant Killer** (beat the leaderboard leader) · 🎰 **Gamble Master** (won a Triple Gamble in 2+ games).

20.5 Host achievements (10) — for the Quizmaster

🎤 **The Host** · 🎙️ **Master Of Ceremonies** (10 games) · 🎩 **Seasoned Host** (25) · 🏛️ **Quiz Veteran** (50) · 🏟️ **Full House** (12+ players) · 📳 **Buzzmaster** · 🔔 **Buzzer Boss** (10 buzzer games) · 🎭 **The Showman** (5 themes) · 🏆 **Final Boss Host** (25 Finals) · ❓ **Question Master** (1,000 questions).

20.6 Fun Stats ✅

After every game, the **Fun Stats** pages show team and solo-player records such as: Biggest Single Gain, Biggest Comeback, Biggest Lead, Biggest Wager, Closest Finish, Daily Double Hero, Fastest Correct Answer, Final Round Swing, Longest Hot Streak, Most Active Team, Most Dramatic Round, Most Passes, Most Pass Success, Score Yo-Yo, plus the 🎲

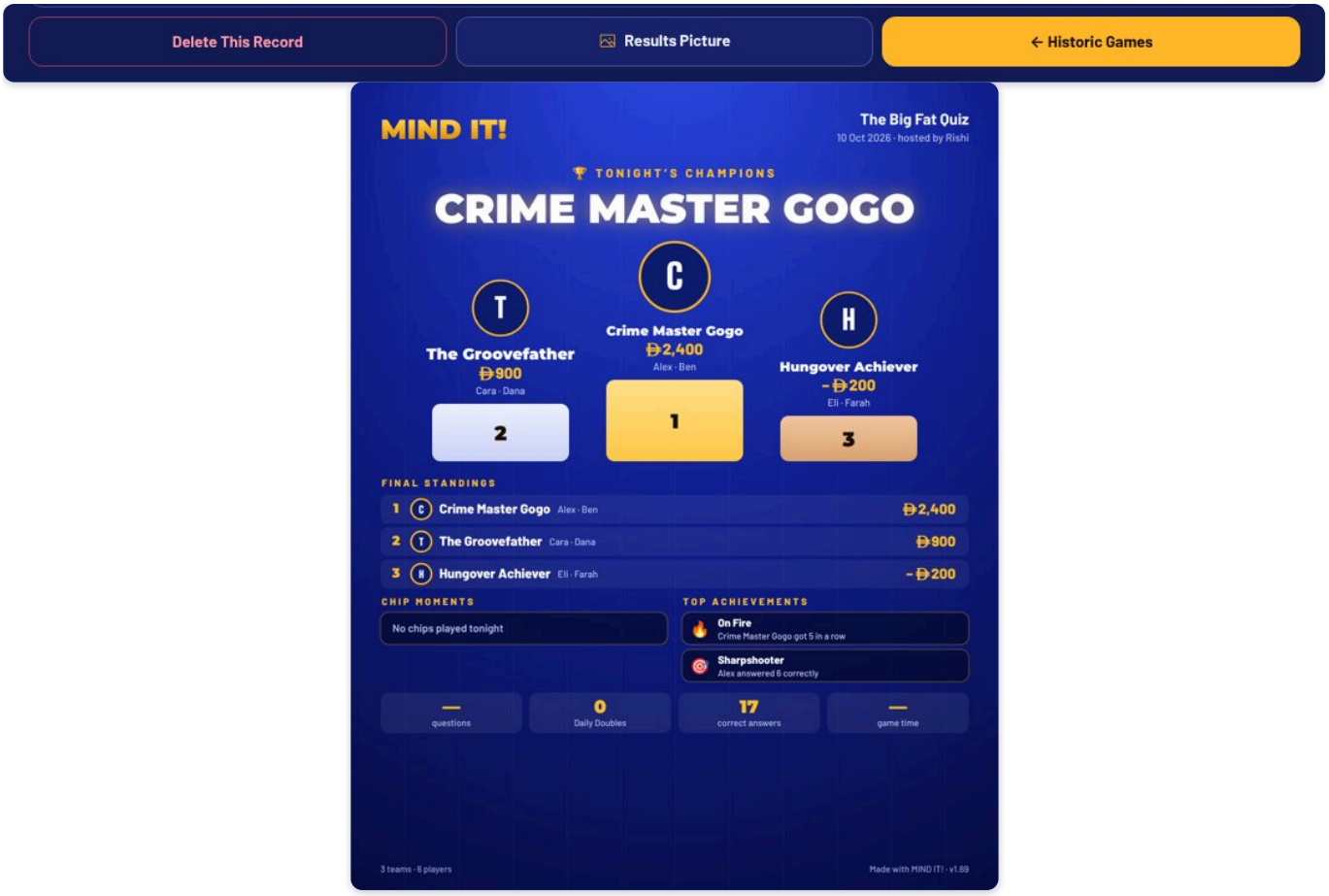
Triple Gamble Chips and 🔥 **Phoenix Chips** summaries — and in Buzzer Mode: Fastest Buzzer, Quickest On Average and Jumped The Gun.

20.7 Statistics and the leaderboard ✅

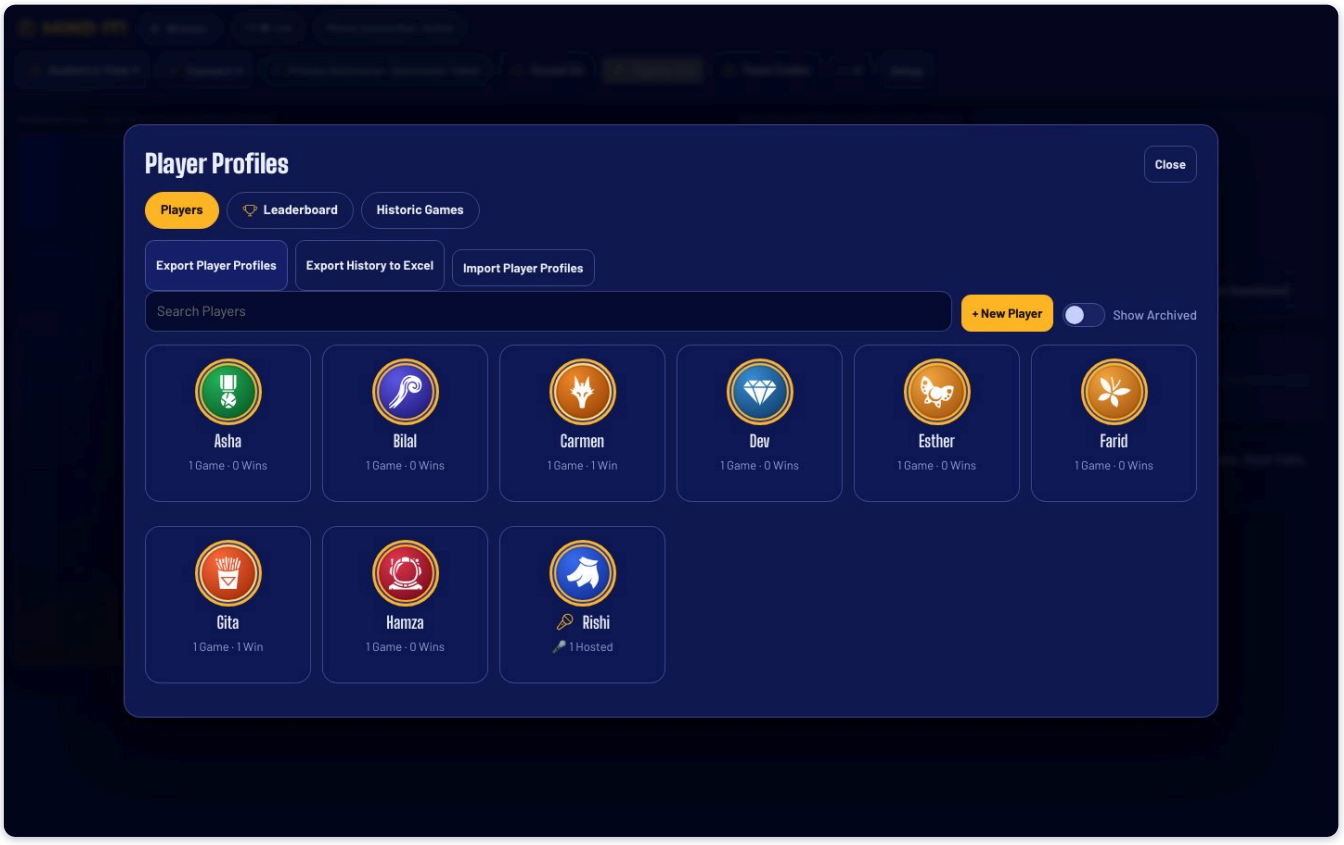
- **Player page:** Overview (games, wins, win %, best score and more) · Achievements · Games · Head-to-Head · Host stats.
- **Leaderboard** (Player Profiles → 🏆 Leaderboard, or 6 · Advanced → 🏆 Season Leaderboard): 🥇🥈🥉, periods **All Time / This Season / This Month**, ranked by **Wins / Win % / Points**, with ▲▼ and 🔥 streaks.
- **Longest Game** (host stats) starts from a 2-hour record and counts real playing time only.
- Corrections (on a player's games): **Edit Score**, **Add Past Game**, **Delete This Record**. Possible duplicate players: **Review & Merge**.

20.8 Historic Games ✅

- **Saved once per game** when the final Standings (or Winner) screen is reached. **Never for a Rehearsal.**
- **Stored:** per team — name, score, position, players, picture, correct answers, Daily Doubles, comeback; per game — quiz title, theme, tie-break, achievements and Fun Stats, host and mode, timer and buzz events, Triple Gamble and Phoenix records, champion, the Final answer audit and the playing time.
- **Frozen:** every question played (and the Final) is copied **exactly as it was asked**. Editing the Question Database later never changes a Historic Game.
- **Damaged records** are repaired when loaded if possible; unreadable ones are **set aside, never deleted** (they stay in backups) and show "This record couldn't be displayed".
- Build 111 also repairs an impossible playing time (e.g. "15 seconds" for a two-hour game) by using the game's real start and end, marked as estimated.
- 🖼 **Results Picture** (since build 125): open any game in Historic Games and press 🖼 **Results Picture** to save the same recap card as the night's 💾 **Save picture** — podium, final standings, chip moments, top achievements — for a game you played weeks ago.



📸 Real screenshot — a Historic Game's bottom row, and the picture it saves.



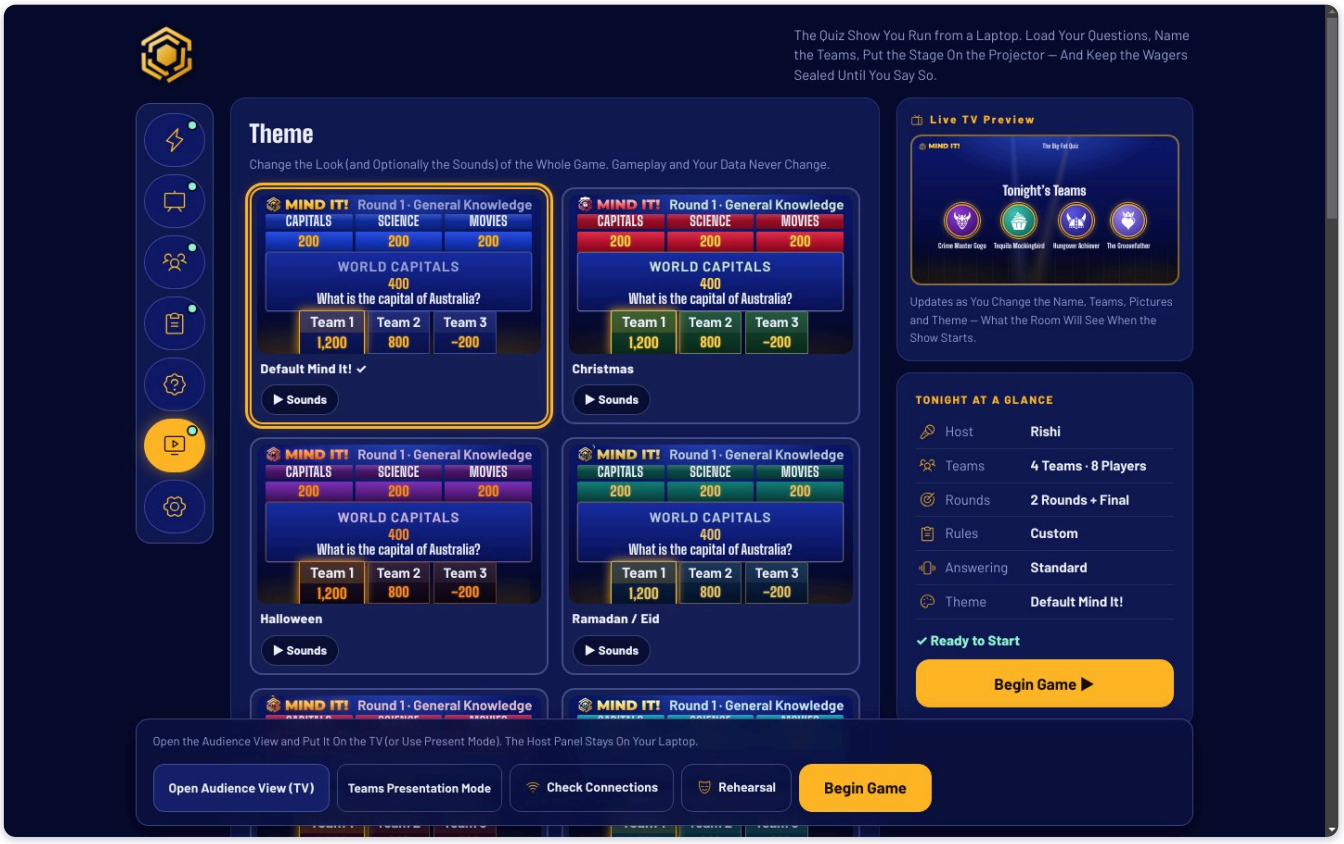
📸 Real screenshot — Player Profiles after one game (each card now shows games and wins).

21. Themes, Audio and Personalisation

21.1 The 12 themes ✅

5 · Audio & Presentation → Theme. Tap a theme card (each has a mini preview and ▶ **Sounds**):

1. **Default Mind It!** 2. **Christmas** 3. **Halloween** 4. **Ramadan / Eid** 5. **Diwali** 6. **Summer** 7. **Bollywood** 8. **Sports** 9. **Comic Book** 10. **Wizard / Magical School** 11. **Gaming** 12. **Movies**



📸 Real screenshot — the Theme cards.

- **Themes change the look (and optionally the sounds) of the whole game. Gameplay and your data never change.**
- **Theme Intensity:** Subtle · Standard · **Full** — decorations and animations only, never the layout.
- **Theme Sounds:** On, or *Off — Standard Mind It! Sounds*. The loading music, intro, the "Enna Rascala... Mind It!" sting and the explosion always stay the same.
- 🟡 Sounds can't be checked by eye; the owner approves them by ear.
- Themes that were removed in the past (e.g. "Fantasy", "Music") are not available.

21.2 Audio ✅ (🟡 by ear)

- **Master Volume** slider, 🔊 **Sound On/Off** (top bar too), **Test Sound**, 🎵 **Play Mind It! Sting**.
- 💓 **Heartbeat in the last 10 seconds** (on by default; follows the volume and mute).
- Thinking music during the Final.

21.3 Presentation options

- **Large Text On TV** — bigger scores, names, categories and status text.
- **Colour-Blind-Safe Colours** — correct in blue, wrong in orange, with ✓ and ×.
- **Show a "How to Play" slide before Round 1.**
- **Host Cam** — Off by default; a small live picture of you on the TV (video only, nothing recorded or uploaded).

- **Board & Flow** (remembered on this device): ↩️ **Back to the board automatically after a correct answer** (ON; 3½ s; "Stay Here" stops it) · 🙂 **Hide a category once all its questions are played** (Off) · 💗 **Heartbeat** (ON) · 📊 **TV Scoreboard Position** (Auto / Always at the side / Always along the top/bottom).

21.4 Pictures

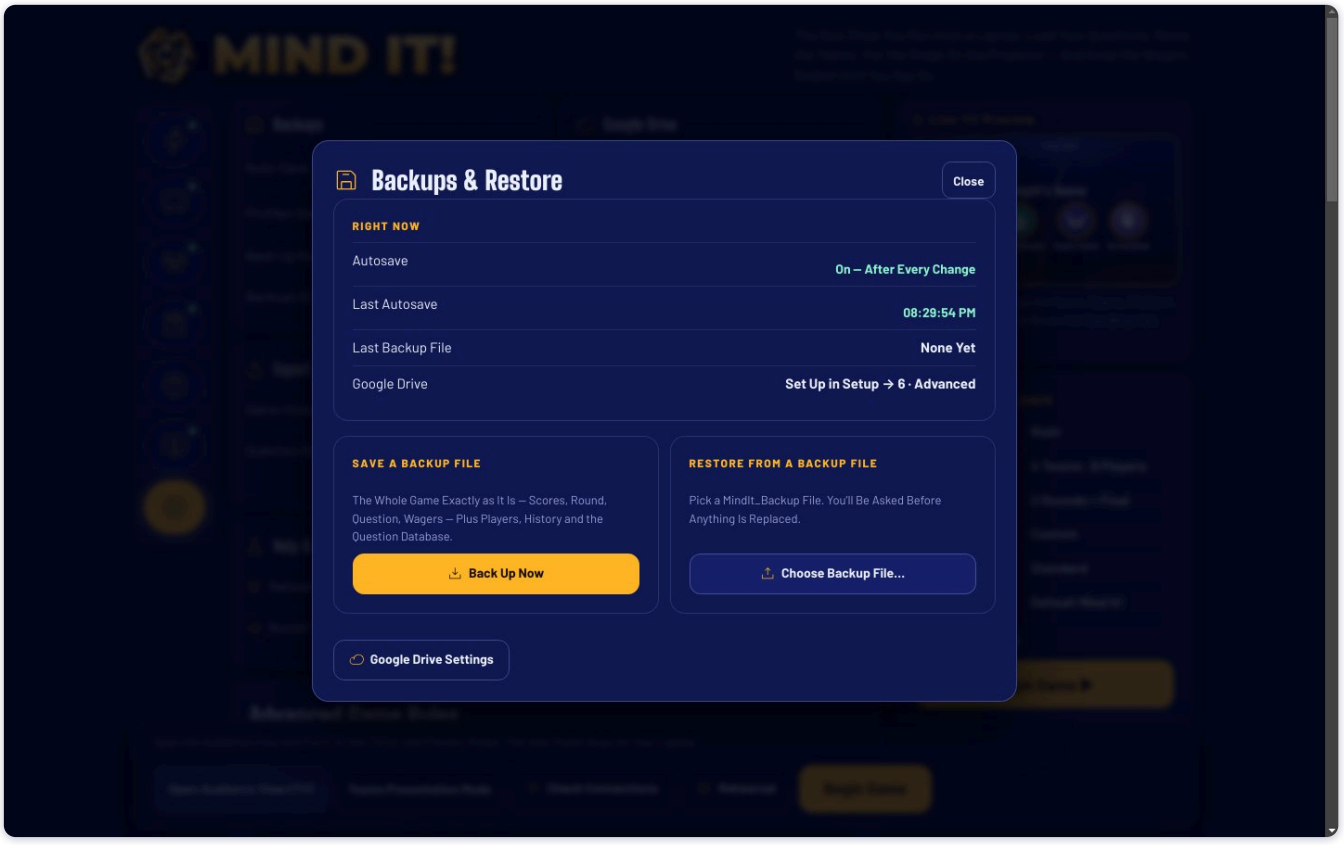
- **Player pictures:** a photo (iPhone HEIC works) cropped in the editor, or a built-in icon.
- **Team pictures:** ✎ on the team card; one-player teams use the player's picture automatically.
- **Question pictures:** Question Picture and Answer Picture on each question (and media links).
- Build 111 stores new photos at up to 800 pixels, which keeps saves small and fast.

---

22. Backups and Game Recovery

22.1 What is saved, where, and when ✅

What	Saved automatically?	Where
The current game (scores, round, question, wagers…)	**Yes — after every change** ("Autosave: On — After Every Change")	Inside the Mind It! app on that device
Players, pictures, Historic Games	Yes	Inside the app, and (laptop) a profiles file in your Windows user folder
Question Database	Yes	Inside the app
Backup file (`MindIt_Backup_….json`, named with the date and time)	**No — you make it**	Wherever you save it
Google Drive backup (optional, needs internet)	When set up	Your own Google Drive



📸 *Real screenshot — ⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore.*

22.2 Making a backup

⋯ ▾ → 💾 Backups & Restore → ⬇ Back Up Now (also **Save Backup File** in More Controls and on the round summary). The file contains **the whole game exactly as it is now — scores, round, question, wagers — plus players, history and the Question Database**, with all pictures included.

Good habit: back up before the game, at the end of each round, and after the game.

22.3 Restoring a backup

⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → ⬆ Choose Backup File... and pick a `MindIt_Backup` file. **You're always asked first** (since build 123 — before, it only asked when a game was in progress): **Restore Backup** or **Cancel**. The players, pictures and Historic Games in the backup are **merged** with what is already there (nothing is deleted); the quiz in the backup **replaces** the one that is open, so make a backup of anything you are still preparing first. Then **Return to game** to carry on exactly where it was. (You can also drop the file on **Upload Your Question Template** in 4 · Rounds & Questions.) ✅ Restoring a real backup was checked in the sandbox during build 111 work; 🟡 not end-to-end on a real Windows PC.

22.3b Safety backups (automatic, since build 125)

Just **before** Mind It! replaces or removes anything — restoring a backup, loading a game file, deleting players or a game record, **Start fresh** or **New quiz** — it keeps a safety backup of how things were, by itself. The **last 10** are kept on this device: **⋯ ▾ → 💾 Backups & Restore → 🛟 Safety backups**. Each one says what it was made before and when; **⭮ Restore** puts it back (asking first — and making a safety backup of *that* moment too), **Save File** turns it into a normal backup file.



📸 *Real screenshot — 🛟 Safety backups in Backups & Restore.*

They live inside the app on this device (the laptop, or the tablet when it runs a game on its own) — they are not a replacement for **Back Up Now** files kept somewhere else.

22.4 Preserving and moving player profiles

Player Profiles → Export Player Profiles on the old device → **Import Player Profiles** on the new one. Import merges — nothing already there is lost, and the current game isn't changed. **Export History to Excel** gives a spreadsheet copy.

22.5 Hand Over to Another Device

Move a running game to another laptop:

1. **Save Backup File** on the old device.
2. On the new device: open Mind It! as Quizmaster, go to Setup and drop the file on **Upload Your Question Template**, then press **Restore Backup**.
3. Press **Return to game** — it carries on from the exact same point.
4. Stop using the old device, so only one Quizmaster screen runs the game.

22.6 Google Drive backup 🟡

Setup → 6 · Advanced → ☁️ **Google Drive Backup**: backups go straight to *your own* Google Drive through a small web app you set up once (**How to Set It Up (5 Minutes, Once)**). Fill in **Your Backup Web App URL** and **Secret Key**, then **Save & Test Connection**. It is the only feature that uses the internet. Office networks may block it. (Your URL and key are private — never share them.)

22.7 Updating Mind It! safely

1. **Back Up Now** (and export player profiles if you're nervous).

2. Close Mind It!.
3. Windows: run the new joiner in the same folder (it replaces `Mind It!.exe`). Android: install the new APK over the old one (**Update**).
4. Open Mind It! — your players, history, questions and saved game are still there.

🆘 HELP! MY GAME CLOSED IN THE MIDDLE OF A QUIZ!

Breathe. Mind It! saved the game after the last thing you did. Tell the room: *"Quick technical time-out — nobody touch your phones, your bets are safe!"*

1. **Reopen Mind It!** on the laptop (double-click `Mind It!.exe`).
2. Setup shows **Resume saved game** / **Start fresh**. Press **Resume saved game**. ❌ *Don't* press Start fresh. (Since build 121 the offer stays until you choose: if you close Mind It! again before choosing, the game is offered again next time — before, it could disappear.)
3. You are back on the same screen: same round, same scores, same question, same wagers.
4. **Re-open the Audience View** (Open Audience View (TV)) and put it back on the TV.
5. **The tablet** reconnects by itself within a few seconds (if not: Main Menu → **Connect To Laptop**).
6. **Phones** reconnect by themselves — nobody re-types a code. Check 📶 **Teams x/y**.
7. **The timer:** if a question was live, restart or extend the timer as fair (+30 Sec), or **Back to Board (Keep Open)** and reopen it.
8. **Check the scores** against what the room remembers. Fix anything with **Adjust Score** (it's shown on the TV with your reason).

No "Resume saved game"?

- Restore your latest **backup file**: ⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Choose Backup File… → Return to game.
- **The laptop itself died?** Use another laptop: open Mind It!, load the latest backup file (Hand Over, 22.5).
- **Lost everything and no backup?** Finish the round on paper and add the scores with Adjust Score in a new game. Then start backing up at every round break. 😉

If the tablet app closed: reopen it → **Connect To Laptop**. The laptop kept everything.

If a phone closed: reopen the link (or scan again); the team code is remembered.

PART SEVEN — TROUBLESHOOTING AND HOSTING TIPS

23. Complete Troubleshooting Guide

Format: **Problem → Why it happens → Easy fix → Advanced fix.** Before anything drastic (reset, reinstall, restore), **save a backup file** (⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now).

23.1 Starting up

The Windows EXE won't launch - **Why:** the three parts weren't joined properly; Windows SmartScreen blocked it; an old copy is still running; antivirus quarantined it. - **Easy fix:** run the joiner `.bat` again and wait for "Done". If Windows says "Windows protected your PC", click **More info → Run anyway**. - **Advanced fix:** check the joined file is exactly the size the joiner expects (it tells you if not — "badsize"); re-download any part. Close every Mind It! window (Task Manager → end "Mind It!"). Allow the file in your antivirus.

The APK won't install - **Why:** "install unknown apps" not allowed; not enough space; an app with the same name but a **different signing key** is installed (Android refuses to update it). - **Easy fix:** allow *Install unknown apps* for your file manager/browser; free some space. - **Advanced fix:** if Android says the package conflicts, the installed copy was signed differently. **Back up the tablet first** (Settings → backup), then uninstall and install the new APK, then restore. (Official builds are always signed with the same original key, so updates normally install over the old app.)

23.2 Connections

The tablet can't connect - **Why:** different Wi-Fi; guest/client isolation; Windows Firewall blocked Mind It! on the first run; wrong PIN; the laptop is asleep. - **Easy fix:** same Wi-Fi for both; on the laptop open **Connect ▾ → Connect Tablet**, then on the tablet **Connect To Laptop** and scan the code or type the PIN. - **Advanced fix:** allow Mind It! on **Private networks** in Windows Firewall and set the Wi-Fi to Private; use the laptop's mobile hotspot; press **New PIN (Disconnects All)** and connect again; restart Mind It! on the laptop (Resume saved game).

The Audience View keeps saying "Reconnecting to Host..." - **Why:** before build 110, Windows slowed down the host window when it was in the background. In 1.69 build 110+ that's fixed; if you still see it, the host window may have been closed or the laptop is overloaded or going to sleep. - **Easy fix:** make sure the host panel window is open (not closed); keep the laptop plugged in; it clears by itself. - **Advanced fix:** close and reopen the Audience View (**Audience View ▾ → Open Audience Window**); close other heavy programs; set Windows sleep to Never.

The question screen freezes - **Why:** the TV window lost contact, a dialog on the laptop is waiting for an answer, or the browser window was minimised. - **Easy fix:** look at the laptop — is a question ("Are you sure...?") waiting? Answer it. Don't minimise the Audience View (it's fine for the host panel to sit on top). - **Advanced fix:** reopen the Audience View; if the laptop app itself is frozen, close and reopen it → **Resume saved game**.

Phones can't join - **Why:** different network, mobile data instead of Wi-Fi, guest isolation, VPN, firewall. - **Easy fix:** phone on the same Wi-Fi, mobile data off, scan the code on the TV again (it's there until Round 1 starts; later use 📶 **Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams)**). - **Advanced fix:** laptop's mobile hotspot for everyone; firewall Private; check the **Join Link** address (6 · Advanced) — if the laptop has several addresses ("Other addresses on this laptop"), try another.

QR code pairing problems - **Why:** glare on the screen, the code too small or too far, an old screenshot of a code, or (tablet) the camera not allowed. - **Easy fix:** move closer, turn up the brightness, type the link (phones) or the PIN (tablet) instead. - **Advanced fix:** the tablet can also find the laptop game by itself ("LAPTOP GAME FOUND"). For phones, read the Join Link out loud.

A phone joined the wrong team - **Why:** someone typed another team's code. - **Easy fix:** on the phone, **Change Team Code** and type the right one. - **Advanced fix:** if a code leaked to the wrong team, give that team a **new code** (it asks first; the old code stops working).

A team's Final answer was refused ("Time's Up") - **Why:** typed Final answers close 2 seconds after the Final timer runs out (build 114). - **Easy fix:** if the team said its answer out loud in time, mark it as usual — spoken answers still count. - **Advanced fix:** press **+30 Sec** before time runs out if the room needs longer; answers open again while the clock runs.

The Final question can't be changed - **Why:** it locks once the Final Round starts (build 114), so nobody switches it by accident. - **Fix:** none needed — it unlocks when the game ends. Fix typos in the Question Database afterwards.

My saved game is gone after restarting Mind It! - **Why:** if another program was using Mind It!'s usual network port (8765), Mind It! opens on a different one, which has its own storage. - **Fix (since build 115):** Mind It! keeps a copy of the saved game and brings it over — you'll see **Saved Game Found**; choose **Resume saved game**. Since build 116 your theme, sound and house-rule settings come over too. Players, history and the Question Database are always safe in their own file.

A phone doesn't vibrate - **Why:** only Android phones can vibrate from a web page; iPhones can't. Silent/Do Not Disturb modes and battery savers can also block it. - **Fix:** nothing to do — the phone still shows everything on screen.

Wagers not registering - **Why:** the phone isn't connected (status line), the wager is outside the allowed range, wagers were already closed, or another phone on the team already locked a wager ("Your team already has a wager locked in"). - **Easy fix:** read the message on the phone; check 📶 **Teams**. The Quizmaster can always type the wager on the laptop/tablet. - **Advanced fix:** ✏️ **Change a Wager** on the host; for the Final, **Close Wagers** (missing = 0, still editable) and enter amounts by hand.

Special chips not activating - **Why:** not the team's turn; already picked the question; chip already used; another chip is on; wrong round (Bottoms Up = Round 1 only; Phoenix = Rounds 2–4 and only the eligible team); Phone Buzzer Mode (no chips at all, and no Phoenix is handed out); the rule is switched off in this preset; it's a Daily Double (Phoenix/Bottoms Up wait for the next pick). - **Easy fix:** use the chip **before** picking, on your turn. - **Advanced fix:** the Quizmaster can **Use for <team>** in 🎟️ **Team Chips**; check 3 · Gameplay & Rules switches.

The timer isn't updating - **Why:** it's paused or stopped; auto-start is off; time's up already; a device lost contact. - **Easy fix:** press **Pause/Resume** or **T**; check the ⏰ Time's up card. - **Advanced fix:** check the TV pill; on the tablet look at the status line; the laptop's clock is the real one.

Buzzer problems - **Why:** not in Phone Buzzer Mode; reading time not over ("Wait for the light…"); early tap lockout (½ s); a team already tried and was wrong; phone disconnected. - **Easy fix:** 📳 **Buzzer Test** before the game; **Open Buzzers Now** to skip the wait. - **Advanced fix: Cancel Buzz** / **Reopen Buzzers**; switch the Early-Buzz Lockout off for children.

23.3 Game content and scores

The scoreboard looks wrong - **Why:** a wrong button press, a bonus you forgot (speed, pass-on), a Phoenix cap, a chip. - **Easy fix: Undo Last Score (U)** straight away — it reverses exactly the last entry. - **Advanced fix: Adjust Score** with a reason (it's on the TV, so everyone sees it's fair). Undo also gives back a chip the undone answer used (build 112), so prefer Undo for a chip question.

Missing questions / empty tiles - **Why:** a round isn't full (e.g. "28/30"); questions were deleted; a category had fewer than 5. - **Easy fix:** 4 · Rounds & Questions → **Rounds at a Glance** → top up empty slots from the database, or 🔄 **Replace** the category. - **Advanced fix:** the **Template Check** lists problems; re-import your template.

Missing images - **Why:** the picture was removed from the database; the backup came from an older build; a media link points to the internet (offline). - **Easy fix:** re-add the picture to the question (✎ Edit). - **Advanced fix:** restore the latest backup file (backups always include full pictures). Since build 111 a picture that's truly gone shows "no picture" — never a broken image — and is noted in the error list.

Audio problems - **Why:** muted; volume low; Windows output on the wrong device (e.g. laptop speakers instead of the TV). - **Easy fix:** 🔊 **Sound On**, raise **Master Volume**, press **Test Sound**. - **Advanced fix:** Windows sound settings → choose the TV/HDMI output; in a Teams call turn on **Include computer sound**.

Wi-Fi problems — see Chapter 9.4 and 9.5 (same network, guest isolation, VPN, firewall, hotspot).

The app is slow - **Why:** lots of large photos; a very old/busy laptop; many browser tabs. - **Easy fix:** close other programs; plug in the charger. - **Advanced fix:** use smaller photos (build 111 keeps new ones at up to 800 px); save a backup and restart Mind It!.

23.4 Saving and history

Lost game — see *HELP! My Game Closed...* (Chapter 22).

Historic Game errors ("This record couldn't be displayed") - **Why:** a damaged record (e.g. from a very old build or an interrupted save). - **Easy fix:** nothing to do — the record is set aside, never deleted; everything else works. - **Advanced fix:** it's kept in backups; send the backup file to whoever maintains your Mind It! for repair.

End Game not responding - **Why:** the tablet lost the connection; the tablet is view-only ("This tablet is view-only. Tap 'Take Control' first."); the game isn't over yet (END GAME appears only after the final standings). - **Easy fix:** wait — it says "Saving the results on the laptop..." and **retries automatically** when the connection is back; or tap **Take Control**. - **Advanced fix:** on the laptop press **Back to Setup** from the standings — the result is the same (the game is saved once).

---

24. Tips for Hosting a Great Quiz

24.1 Before the night

- Do a **2-minute Rehearsal** with someone's phone. Nothing counts.
- Put the TV where everyone can see it; put yourself where you can see the TV *and* the teams.
- Print the **Player's Guide** for each table, or put a QR code to its mobile version on the tables (see `MIND_IT_QR_PLAYERS_GUIDE_PROPOSAL.md`).

24.2 Explaining the rules (script)

> *"Welcome to The Big Fat Quiz! Here's how it works. There are six categories on the board. When it's your turn, pick a category and a value — the bigger the number, the harder the question. Answer out loud. Right, and you win the points. Wrong, and you lose them — and the question goes to the next team. Not sure? Say pass — that's free. If you answer fast, there's a speed bonus, and if you answer a question other teams passed, you get a pass-on bonus. Somewhere on the board are hidden Daily Doubles — find one and you can bet on yourself. Your phone is for your secret bets and your special chips. And at the end, the Final Round — where anything can happen. Any questions? No? Excellent. Let's play Mind It!"*

24.3 Welcoming players (script)

> *"Grab one phone per team, scan the code on the screen, and type the four-letter code I'll give you. If your phone says 'Eyes On the TV', you're in. No app, no internet, no sign-up."*

24.4 Explaining the chips (script)

> *"Each team has a Triple Gamble chip: before you pick, tap Use on your phone, and your next question is worth three times the points — but you can't pass, and if you're wrong you lose three times as much. On a Daily Double it's six times. In Round 1 there's also Bottoms Up: pick your designated drinker — if you get it wrong and they finish their drink, you lose nothing. And from Round 2, if a team falls more than 2,000 points behind, they may get the Phoenix: double points plus a catch-up, and a wrong answer costs nothing."*

24.5 During the game

- **Managing turns:** trust the **Now Playing** banner — the app keeps the order. If someone answers out of turn, either ignore it or use **A different team answered?**.
- **Encourage strategy:** remind teams that passing is free and that being below zero keeps them out of the Final.
- **Disputes:** decide quickly, explain once, use **Adjust Score** with a reason ("Answer accepted on appeal") so it's visible and fair. Use **Undo** only for your own button mistakes.
- **Pace:** 45 seconds is plenty. Use **+30 Sec** rarely, and the same way for every team. Use **End Round Early** if time runs short — the Final is the best part.
- **Noisy venue:** turn on **Large Text On TV**, raise the volume, and let the TV banners do the talking. Announce the team's name before reading the question.
- **Avoid scoring mistakes:** read the answer on your screen *before* the team answers; look at the button label (it shows the amount) before pressing; press **Correct** for the team named on the banner.
- **Technical issues:** keep calm, say "technical time-out", follow Chapter 22. Phones keep their codes; scores are saved.

24.6 Building up to the Final (script)

> *"Ladies and gentlemen, it's time for the Final Round. The category is... SPACE. On your phones, bet anything from zero to everything you've got. Nobody can see your bet — not even me until the reveal. Bet small to stay safe... or bet big to win it all. Wagers are locked... here is the question!"*

24.7 Announcing the winner (script)

> *"In third place, with 2,000 points... Tequila Mockingbird! In second, so close, 3,200... Crime Master Gogo! And your champions tonight — from minus 600 after Round 1 — with 3,400 points... HUNGOVER ACHIEVER! Give it up! Stay seated for the awards — someone here is tonight's Speed Demon..."*

PART EIGHT — QUICK REFERENCE AND APPENDICES

25. The Printable Quick-Reference Materials

These come as separate files in the documentation pack:

File	What it is
`MIND_IT_QUICK_START.pdf`	The 10-minute beginner's quick start.
`MIND_IT_QUIZMASTER_CHEAT_SHEET.pdf`	**Exactly two A4 pages** to keep next to the laptop: controls, scoring, chips, timers (page 1); before/during/emergency/ending (page 2). Prints well in black and white.
`MIND_IT_REHEARSAL_CHECKLIST.pdf`	**Two A4 pages** to tick through once on the real laptop, tablet, phones and TV before a quiz night (about 40 minutes), from installing to the Final and the backup. Build 120.
`MIND_IT_PLAYERS_GUIDE.pdf`	**Exactly two A4 pages** for the teams: how to join, play, use the phone, and win.
`MIND_IT_PLAYERS_GUIDE_MOBILE.html`	The Player's Guide as one mobile-friendly web page (for a QR code).
`MIND_IT_QR_PLAYERS_GUIDE_PROPOSAL.md`	How players could open the guide by scanning a QR code — options available today, and a proposed (not built) in-app integration.
`MIND_IT_DOCUMENTATION_AUDIT.md`	The feature-by-feature audit behind this guide.

Appendix A — Feature status at a glance

✅ Implemented and verified

Everything in Chapters 5–22 unless marked otherwise: Quick Setup and setup sections; Question Database (add, import, edit, move, delete, preview, replace round/category with exact-5 selection, reorder, switch Final); players, profiles, pictures, Random Teams, the Quizmaster rule; turns, correct/wrong/pass, pass-on and speed bonuses, timers and +30 s, Daily Doubles and True Daily Double, the Final with typed answers and the checker, wager changes, undo, score adjustments; Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up and the Quizmaster chip override; Phone Buzzer Mode (with simulated phones); Connection Health and Test All Connections; End Game; the Audience View and the 12 themes; **new in build 112:** the phone join QR code on the TV before the game (with its on/off switch), 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams), Undo giving chips back, ties decided by most correct answers on the TV, at least 2 teams, no Phoenix in Phone Buzzer Mode, one-player teams taking the player's name and picture, phones thanking after END GAME; achievements, Fun Stats, Historic Games, leaderboard, recap; Rehearsal; autosave, resume, backups and restore (in the test environment). **New in builds 113–114:** places on the TV score cards, Now Playing names that fit, the ⚡ hint on Correct, correct-answer counts on the podium and phones, kept hand-edited values, Phoenix Climber, the Final question lock, Final answers closing after time's up, 48 px tablet Setup buttons, the Replace Round duplicate warning, clearer Phone Buzzer Mode on the TV, licences in About, phones vibrating when needed.

Verified means: seen working in Mind It! 1.69 (build 111, and builds 112–114 for their changes) on a test computer (the real laptop app; tablet and phone screens opened in a browser at their real sizes), and/or covered by the app's 81 automated test suites.

🟡 Implemented, not verified on real hardware

- The EXE on a real Windows 10/11 PC (SmartScreen, firewall prompt, hotspot) and the joiner `.bat` on real Windows.
- The APK on a real Galaxy Tab (installing over an old version, finding the laptop on Wi-Fi, camera QR scanning).
- Real iPhones and Android phones; real TVs and projectors; casting (Chromecast, AirPlay, Smart View, Teams sharing).
- **All sounds and music** (they can't be checked by eye).
- Host Cam with a real camera; Google Drive backup to the real Google service.
- The browser-only "web link" version and its Quizmaster Mode (republished with build 114 on 11 Oct 2026; not checked on real devices).
- Phones vibrating (Android only; iPhones can't) and the 48 px Setup buttons on the real Galaxy Tab.

🔵 Approved, unfinished or undecided (open questions for the owner)

Fixed in builds 113–115: hand-edited question values are kept; no Phoenix where nobody can use it (Buzzer Mode, browser-only); in Buzzer Mode nothing can be scored before a buzz; the saved game survives a port change (another program on 8765); the 🚀 Phoenix award is now "Phoenix Climber" (no more duplicate "Comeback Kid").

Settled by the owner in October 2026 (no longer open): the Phoenix speed bonus after the cap stays; Daily Double spots stay in place when questions are reordered; ties are decided by most correct answers on the TV too (build 112); at least 2 teams everywhere (build 112); no Phoenix in Phone Buzzer Mode (build 112).

⚪ Ideas only — NOT in Mind It! 1.69

Don't look for these: Google Cast / Android TV apps; "Fast Track", True/False, Sequence, Evil Round; Lightning / Joker / Specialist / picture / Name-That-Tune rounds; lifelines (50:50, Ask a Friend), Hot Streak bonus points, Bonus Wheel, audience vote; sudden-death tiebreaker; extra chips (Steal, Shield, Insurance, Double Down, Bounty, Category Lock, Clock Stopper, Mystery Box…), Phoenix in the Final or in Buzzer Mode; an in-app pre-show checklist; a QR code for the Player's Guide on the TV (proposed in this pack only — the TV's QR code joins phones to the game, it doesn't open the guide); a Quick Quiz Generator; league/season mode beyond the leaderboard's "This Season"; team profiles and saved line-ups; Mac version; code signing / Microsoft Store.

Appendix B — Things found while writing this guide

The source code is the source of truth. These are places where the app's behaviour surprised us, or where the project documents and the code disagree. The guide itself changed nothing in the app; the owner then approved fixes for items 1–3, which are in build 112.

#	What	Where	Effect	Status
1	**"Phone Join Link / QR" opened the Quizmaster Phone Remote** (build 111): the Devices button switched the Phone Remote on and showed the Quizmaster remote QR code and PIN.	Laptop, Devices window	A host could show players a code that gives host controls.	✅ **Fixed in build 112** — renamed **Phone Join QR (for Teams)**; it opens the players' join code.
2	**Phones didn't say "Thanks For Playing!" after END GAME when the Final was played with phone wagers** (build 111).	Phones after End Game	Cosmetic; results were saved correctly.	✅ **Fixed in build 112** (also after the laptop's Back to Setup).
3	**The TV showed the ⚡ Speed Bonus countdown during a Triple Gamble** (build 111), although a Triple Gamble never earns one.	Audience View, laptop, tablet	Misleading label; scoring correct.	✅ **Fixed in build 112.**
4	The setup card text said players "pick their team, enter the team code", but the phone only asks for the code (the code picks the team).	6 · Advanced → Phones & Live Wagers	Wording only.	✅ **Fixed in build 113.**
5	The project documents (GAME_RULES.md and others) were behind the app.	Documents	None.	✅ Updated to build 114.
6	The remaining open questions in Appendix A (🔵).	—	As described.	Owner to decide.

Appendix C — Keyboard shortcuts (laptop)

Key	Action	Key	Action
Space	Main action (the highlighted button)	**N**	Next question
C	Correct	**T**	Timer start/stop
W	Wrong answer	**O / L**	Open / close wagers
X	Wrong, no penalty	**V**	Reveal (Final, next team)
S	Skip team (Pass)	**E**	End round
R	Reveal answer	**U**	Undo
B	Back to board (keep open)	**P**	Show standings
Esc	Leave Present mode		

Appendix D — Glossary

Word	Plain English
Audience View	The screen for the TV — what the room sees. Never shows answers early.
Host panel	The laptop window the Quizmaster uses. Shows the answers.
Quizmaster	The host. One per game; can't play in that game.
Owner (of a question)	The team whose turn it was when the question opened. The next question goes to the team after the owner.
Pass-on bonus	Extra points (25% per pass) for answering a question other teams passed.
Speed bonus	Extra points (half the round's lowest value) for the owner answering right within 10 seconds.
Daily Double (DD)	A hidden tile; the picking team bets on itself.
True Daily Double	Betting your whole score (or more) on a Daily Double.
Chip	A once-per-game special power used from the team phone: Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up.
Wager	A bet. Private until revealed.
Sealed	Hidden on the TV until the answer is scored.
Journal / Undo	Every score change is recorded; Undo reverses the last one (and gives back a chip it used).
Tie-break	Level on points at the end → the team with more correct answers wins; level on both → a shared win.
Away	A team marked absent; skipped for turns, buzzers and the Final.
Join QR	The code phones scan to open the game page. On the TV before the game, and in 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams).
Team code	4 letters a team types on its phone to join. Host-only.
PIN	4 digits the tablet uses to connect to the laptop.
Local network	Devices in the room talking through the same Wi-Fi (no internet needed).
Client isolation	A Wi-Fi setting (common on guest networks) that stops devices talking to each other. Fix: the laptop's hotspot.
Latency / round trip	How long a message takes to go to a device and back (ms = thousandths of a second).
Historic Game	A finished game saved as a frozen snapshot.
Rehearsal	A practice game where nothing is recorded.
Autosave	Mind It! saves after every change, automatically.
Backup file	A file containing the game, players, history and questions — your safety copy.

Appendix E — Frequently asked questions

Do players need an app? No. They scan a QR code and use the phone's browser.

Do we need internet? No. Only the same Wi-Fi (or the laptop's hotspot). Google Drive backup is the only online feature.

Can I run Mind It! without a TV? Yes — use **Present On This Screen**, or let teams gather round the laptop. It's more fun on a big screen.

Can I run it without phones? Yes. You type wagers yourself; chips can still be switched on from the 🎟 Team Chips card; the Final answers are spoken.

Can I run it without the laptop? Yes, on the tablet alone (**Start New Game**) — but without team phones.

How many teams? 2–8. **How many players per team?** No limit; at least one. A one-player team takes its player's name and picture.

Two teams finish level — who wins? The team with more correct answers. Level on that too? It's a tie, and they share the win.

Can the Quizmaster play? Not in the same game. Pick another Quizmaster (Chapter 7.6).

Can a team change its wager? No. The Quizmaster can (until the Daily Double is scored, or until that team is revealed in the Final).

Can a score go negative? Yes. Below zero you sit out the Final.

What if I press the wrong button? Undo (U) — it reverses exactly the last score (and gives back a chip that answer used). Or **Adjust Score**.

Can teams answer the Final late? Typed answers close 2 seconds after time's up. Spoken answers are up to the Quizmaster.

Will my phone buzz? Android phones vibrate when it's your team's turn to pick and when your wager opens. iPhones can't.

What if the laptop crashes? Reopen → **Resume saved game** (Chapter 22).

Is anything sent to the internet? No — except Google Drive backups if you set them up. Phones and the tablet talk only to your laptop. Host Cam is never recorded or uploaded.

Where are my players and history stored? On the device (laptop/tablet) and in your backup files. Updates keep them.

Mind It! v1.69 · The Complete Idiot's Guide · documentation pack updated for build 120. Team icons: game-icons.net (CC BY 3.0). Fonts: Big Shoulders Display and Barlow (SIL Open Font License).